Ashen
Role-Playing Game

Core Rulebook

Foreword

Ashen is a game born out of a simple emotion: the Game Master's frustration at not being able to design satisfying combat encounters for fear of killing player characters. What, I asked myself, could solve this problem? I considered many different answers, but the simplest, it seemed to me, was to make death irrelevant.

The days of tabletop RPGs being primarily a form of survival horror game are long past — some may regret the passing of this era, but to those who wish to feel the fear of violent death in their bones, I say: hie thee hence! For there are many games that are much better at doing this than the one you currently hold in your hands, and, indeed, Ashen owes not a small part of its rules to such games. But Ashen is not one such game.

For better or for worse, this game is very much a product of its time: the intended gameplay is narrative-driven, with the player characters taking the principal roles in a slowly unfolding drama. There will be combat — a lot of combat — but it should serve narrative purpose. In many ways, the fact that the player characters are immortal Deathless clarifies some things that other, similar systems leave obscure, if only for force of habit. The expected outcome of a failed quest, a lost battle is not the death of the player characters; it is the continuation of the story, but with an outcome that hung in the balance now decided, a path not taken now forever closed.

The characters themselves will be fine: after no more than a week or so of in-game time, they will all find themselves awoken by their soul-anchor, bound to the plane by their divine curse. As for the players, they will have to deal with the new situation.

Naturally, such an approach means that not dying is not a sufficient motivator; the characters, and ultimately the players, must want something, and be it as vulgar as power and glory, to motivate them to continue to adventure, and their enemies must want substantially the same thing — for if death is not enough to stop a rival, only taking their treasure before they do is.

From this set of thoughts come most of the other rules in this game, directly or indirectly. The rules for structured time, the item-based progression, the way XP are awarded — all of these flow out of the core question of how to make a game challenging in which a PC cannot meaningfully die. The resulting system is in many ways familiar ground: it covers substantially the same type of gameplay as some of the most popular games today — but it differs greatly in the details. As you will come to discover, Ashen uses fairly different concrete mechanics to the popular fantasy RPGs, and while it is more outwardly similar to some of its colleagues in the science-fantasy genre, even here it makes substantially diffent choices in many regards.

It is my fervent hope that you will find this game equal parts refreshing, challenging, and fun. These playtest rules, while minimalist, include a substantial portion of advice to both the players and the GM in hopes of easing them into the new game. You are encouraged, where you deem it good, not to follow it. You are equally encouraged to abuse the game wherever and whenever you manage to — every person who breaks the game during its testing phase helps make doing the same slightly harder once it is fully released.

With this out of the way, all I have left to do is to wish you happy gaming! *Ašavahttagohē!*

Table of Contents

Foreword 2
Introduction 5
Playing the Game 5
- The Core Mechanic 5
- Tracking Time 6

Characters 8
- Creating a Character 8
- Basic Rules and Common Terms 10

Races 11
- Clockwork 11
- Echoes 12
- Soot-Beasts 13
- Humans 13

Attributes and Characteristics 14
- Attributes 14
- Characteristics 15
- Derived Statistics 15
- Essence Points 16

Skills 16
- Trained and Untrained Skills 16
- Gaining and Improving Skills 16
- Using skills 16
- Difficulty 17
- Skill List 17

Skill Descriptions 18
- Untrained Skills 18
- Trained Skills 22
- Rituals and Recipes 25

Advances 29
- What is an advance? 29
- How to unlock advances 29

Advance Lists 29
- Arcane 29
- Command 30
- Dodge 30
- Grit 31
- Initiative 31
- Marksmanship 32
- Martial 32
- Potential 32
- Psychic 33
- Speed 34
- Stamina 34

Magic and Powers 34
- Reading Powers 34
- Types of Powers 35

List of Powers 36
- Arcane 36
- Divine 40
- Psychic 45
- Martial Exploits 48
- Command Powers 51
- Marksmanship Exploits 52

Equipment 54
- General Rules 54
- Types of Equipment 55
- Equipment Modifications 59
- Equipment Tables 64

Combat 78
- How combat works 78
- Strikes and Attack Powers 80
- Resolving an Attack 80
- Damage 81
- Death and Revival 81
- Melee Attacks 82
- Ranged Attacks 82
- Misfires and Fumbles 82
- Dual Wielding 83
- Area Targets 83
- Actions during Combat 84
- Combat Maneuvers 85
- Saving Throws 87
- Status Conditions 87
- Summoning and Binding 88
- Vehicle Combat 89
- Tactical Vehicles 92
- Capital Vessel Combat 93

Exploration 95
- Overland Movement 96
- Terrain 96
- The Fog 96
- Weather 100
- Vision, Light, and Senses 100
- Types of Transportation 101
- Disease, Hunger, and Exhaustion 101
- Races and the Environment 101
- Currency and Economy 103
- Lodging and Resting 103
- Death and Reincorporation 103

Setting 103
- The World of Ash 103
- History 104
- Cosmology 105
- Geography 107
- Languages 109
- Factions 110

GM Guide 113

Pacing and Time 113
Designing Creatures 114
Progression and Rewards 116
Awarding Legendary Rewards 118
Designing Equipment 119
Setting Secrets 120
Designing Rituals and Recipes 121

1

INTRODUCTION

The Basics of the Game

Pochfa sheshêp tarash nyôlwâ fêhêk
Echayâyti yi thâlâ mêzesh i khanjhi
I shayâmbô hêk i tawpanj ipish tarti
Rhôndwâ hêk talamâ yupak râykêk
Zangwô yi nhayâm.

They prayed their due as they beheld
The heavens opening in fire, on the valkyries' descent
The dead raised their rifles, held them against plate
Aloft they held their hammers, glory to await
At the end of days.

— The Death of the World

Imagine a world shattered and broken, a shell of its former self. Imagine a world reduced to cinders in the fires of the final cataclysm, that yet held on. Imagine a world walked by those cursed not to die until they lay their regrets to rest. This is the world of Ashen.

The cataclysm that ended the old world left wounds in the fabric of creation itself. From these wounds seeps the Fog — the raw power of creation, unbound and without the divine reason that once shaped it. It blankets most of the world, spawning monsters, warping those who dwell in it, and saturating the land with ambient magical energy so intense it can power entire cities. Only in scattered Clears, places where the Fog has receded or been driven back, can mortals live in relative safety.

In Ashen, you play a **Deathless**, an undying warrior, veteran of the Last War. Your curse is two-fold: you remember little of your mortal life, and you cannot die until you accomplish your purpose. It is only in the dangerous and Fog-drowned wilderness that you might find release.

Playing the Game

Ashen is a role-playing game in which the players take on the role of immortal heroes who form a group (the Party) to go on dangerous adventures in an unforgiving world. Another player, the Game Master (GM) takes on a special role: to present the other players with the scenario they find themselves in and adjudicate the results of their actions. The players, in the role of their characters, take actions in the game world and drive the plot.

Most actions do not require any special rules to resolve. Many actions succeed automatically, or fail automatically, following common sense. In some cases, an action that is particularly difficult to accomplish but not impossible, or where the precise degree of success or failure can make a material difference, must be adjudicated by more detailed and impartial means. Like most other RPGs, Ashen here makes recourse to die rolls.

Die rolls in the Ashen system are made using rolls of multiple dice of varying sides; Ashen makes use of the **d4**, **d6**, **d8**, **d10** and **d12**. Most of these dice are used to generate random numbers when the game requires it, such as when rolling for damage in combat.

When a die roll is required to do so, the rules specify a number of dice plus the type of die to be rolled (usually abbreviated as *XdY*, i.e. X Y-sided dice; where the second number is left off, six-sided dice are always meant). These dice are then rolled and the numbers on their faces added up to produce a final result.

The Core Mechanic

In any situation where the outcome is in doubt, Ashen uses die rolls to decide about the success or failure of an action. Such die rolls are referred to as "checks". For example, a character trying to open an unlocked door would not need to roll any dice — they succeed automatically. If the door is bolted shut and secured with a mag-lock, however, any character attempting to breach it would need to make a check.

Making a Check

Checks are made when a character attempts a particularly difficult action, drawing on their innate abilities and training to surmount the difficulty. When called upon to make a check, you normally roll against a particular skill or characteristic. You roll as many six-sided dice as your character's rating in that skill or characteristic.

When you roll d6 in this way, they are instead used in a slightly different way from other situations in the game when dice rolls are required. Instead of adding up all the pips, you check the number rolled on every die. If the result is 4 or higher, the die is counted as a success. If the result is 6, it counts as two successes. If the result is 1, the die counts as a negative success. To refer to d6 used in this way, the rules use the term "Ashen dice".

Checks always have a difficulty, which the GM may or may not tell you in advance. If the total number of successes is greater than or equal to the difficulty number of the roll, the check is considered successful and your character accomplishes his or her goal. If not, you suffer the consequences of failure.

Bonuses and Penalties

Many abilities, items and circumstances grant a bonus or a penalty to a check. These bonuses and penalties are expressed as numbers of Ashen dice, or ±Xd for short. As an example, a catalyst might grant you a +2d bonus to cast

spells of a certain type; firing a gun at very long ranges might give you a −2d penalty to the shot.

To apply the bonus or penalty, modify the size of your pool accordingly. For example, if your Marksmanship characteristic is 6, and you are firing your weapon at three increments of range, you would roll (6d base - 2d penalty) = 4d to make the shot. If, conversely, you were firing at point blank and your character had the *Weapon Focus* advance, granting them +2d to the attack, you would roll 8d.

Bonuses and penalties both stack and cumulate with each other. To expand the previous example, your character might have the *Weapon Focus* advance and take a *Precision Shot*, both granting a +2d bonus, for a total of +4d; however, your target might be heavily concealed (-3d penalty) and at three increments of range (-2d penalty); the total comes out to (2+2-3-2) = −1d penalty on the shot.

If, after applying all bonuses and penalties, your dice pool is reduced to zero dice, you fail the check automatically. This applies especially if additional penalties are inflicted after you have already declared your action.

Automatic Successes and Failures

In rare cases, checks can be modified by added automatic successes or failures. When they apply, add them directly to the result of the roll, without changing the size of your dice pool.

Example: *Alan's character, the Magician Myrddin, is in combat with a squad of ferocious Warboars. Heavily outnumbered and outgunned, the party has decided to flee. To buy time, Myrddin will attempt to cast the* Ice Storm *spell on the front row of Warboars.* Ice Storm *has a difficulty of 7 successes. Myrddin's Arcane characteristic is 8, and his bonuses to the roll grant him an additional 4, so he rolls 12 dice – they come up 5, 4, 3, 1, 2, 3, 6, 4, 6, 2, 5 and 3. The 6s grant two successes, but the 1 counts as a negative success: he has barely managed to beat the target number, but he has beaten it. The Warboars' war cries are drowned out by the howling wind...*

Rounding

Whenever a rule requires you to divide a number and the result is not a whole number, round down unless the rule specifically says otherwise.

Critical Failures

If, after counting all successes and negative successes, your total is **zero or negative**, the check is a **critical failure**. A critical failure is worse than ordinary failure — something has gone actively wrong.

The consequences depend on the type of check:

- **Attack rolls:** A critical failure on an attack is a **misfire** (ranged) or **fumble** (melee). See the Combat chapter for details.
- **Skill checks:** The character not only fails but creates a new problem. A critical failure on a Subterfuge check might alert additional guards; a critical failure on a Shop check might damage the item being worked on. The GM determines the specific consequence.
- **Arcane casting checks:** The spell misfires. The Focus cost is still spent, but the effect does not occur. The caster suffers **arcane backlash**: they take damage equal to the spell's Focus cost (reduced by Ward) and are Dazed until the end of their next turn. Arcane magic is formulaic and predictable — its failures are painful but contained.
- **Divine casting checks:** The prayer fails and the deity is displeased. The caster immediately loses 1 **favor** with the reliquary used. Additionally, the GM may impose a deity-specific consequence: a god of war might inflict a wound, a god of nature might cause the caster's equipment to corrode, a death god might drain Essence. The consequence should reflect the deity's domain and temperament.
- **Psychic casting checks:** The power misfires catastrophically. The Focus cost is still spent, and the caster must roll for **Cosmic Backlash** (see the Powers chapter). Psychic power draws on raw willpower and the fabric of reality itself — when it goes wrong, reality pushes back.
- **Resistance checks:** The character suffers the worst possible version of the effect they were resisting. A critical failure on a Stamina check against poison means the poison takes full effect with no save-ends — it lasts for the encounter or until treated.

A critical failure occurs naturally when the dice come up badly — many 1s and few successes. It is not the same as simply failing a check; a roll of 3 successes against a difficulty of 7 is an ordinary failure, not a critical failure.

Tracking Time

In Ashen, as in many other role-playing games, keeping track of how much time passes in the game world is essential. As the characters cannot—at least under ordinary circumstances—die, their success or failure in their quests often depends on how much time passes, and whether their enemies succeed in their goals before they can be thwarted.

However, as characters engage in various activities to fulfill their goals, the time necessary for certain milestones can vary wildly. Outside of the predictable rhythm of quiet time, when measuring time in hours and days is more than adequate, action in more hectic phases of the game can take wildly differing amounts of time. Racing to fix an airship drive might still take days, a harrowing negotiation with a crime boss might take hours, but a fight to the death mere seconds. As events in such periods can follow each other in quick succession, Ashen adopts a more abstract system of tracking time.

Game Time

Play in Ashen is structured, at the top level, into *Acts* and *Intermissions*. As the name implies, acts are where the action happens, and intermissions are the times between acts. An Act is itself divided into *Scenes*.

Acts

An act is a meaningful story unit—a period during which the characters further their goals and develop the plot. An act could be a raid on an enemy fortress, a harrowing trek across a hostile landscape, or preparing and hosting a diplomatic gathering with the leaders of other factions.

During an act, the characters' full attention is required. They must rely on the resources they've already gathered and the skills they've already learned.

Scenes

Acts are divided into *Scenes*. A scene represents a discrete event in the act. In general, a scene plays out in a single location and deals with a single issue. The archetypal example of a scene is combat encounter, but other types of plot events can also constitute a scene: a ride over a collapsing bridge, haggling with a shady merchant, or exploring a room in a ruined castle.

There are thus almost no hard and fast rules as to what constitutes a scene, with one exception—a combat encounter is always its own scene. In game terms, transitioning from one scene to the next has two effects: powers and abilities that can be used once per scene refresh, and the game can switch from *open time* to *structured time* or vice-versa.

Open Time and Structured Time

Most scenes in Ashen operate on open time—characters declare their actions in any order, and they take as long as they need to. The time tracking resolution does not usually drop below the level of minutes. However, for certain scenes, the action being described unfolds quickly enough, or under enough pressure, that finer-grained timekeeping becomes necessary. These scenes operate on *structured time*.

Structured Time

A scene using structured time is divided into **stretches** and **rounds**. A round is a fuzzy unit of time representing roughly thirty seconds—enough for every participant to take their **turn** acting. The order of turns within the round is determined by each participant's initiative, and during their turn a character can take several actions, given by the amount of action points they have. A stretch is a longer unit equal to ten rounds, or about five minutes of in-fiction time. Combat encounters are typically run round by round; other tense but slower-paced scenes—picking a stubborn lock with pursuers closing in, creeping past a patrol, or sustaining a short ritual—are run stretch by stretch.

Initiative

In the heat of the moment, fractions of seconds can decide between life and untimely death. To model this, Ashen uses **initiative**.

Every round is divided into 100 initiative ticks. The round begins at tick 99, and proceeds by every participant taking a turn at their initiative tick, with higher initiatives going first. When the count reaches initiative 0, the round ends and a new round begins at tick 99.

To decide your initiative, you must roll it when you enter into combat. To roll initiative, roll as many D6 as your character's Initiative rating, and add up all the pips. This number is your initiative and determines your place in the initiative order.

Extreme Initiative

If a participant scores an initiative X greater than 99, their initiative "rolls over": X - 100 becomes their initiative count for all subsequent rounds. In combat, this grants special benefits related to surprise (see *Surprise* in the Combat chapter).

Actions and Action Points

In structured time, everytime you wish to do something, you must take an action to do it. Actions consume **Action Points (AP)**; every creature has a set number of AP per turn, usually 4 of them. On every creature's turn, that creature can take actions by spending action points; when a creature is out of action points, it can no longer take additional actions and must end its turn. On the start of its turn, a creature recovers all its spent action points. Unspent ones are lost—they do not carry over between turns.

Stretches

Some scenes are too tense to resolve in open time, but the action does not unfold quickly enough to merit tracking initiative and action points round by round. Picking a lock with the city watch closing in, sneaking through a patrolled corridor, sustaining a short ritual, or searching a room before its occupant returns are all examples. In these situations, the GM may run the scene in **stretches**: each stretch represents about five minutes of in-fiction time, or ten rounds. On each stretch, every participating character declares one significant action—an attempt at the lock, a careful advance, a contribution to the ritual—and the GM resolves them together before checking whether the situation has changed: a guard arrives, the spell completes, the door bursts open, and so on.

A scene running in stretches can drop into rounds at any point, and vice versa. If the city watch breaks down the door mid-stretch, roll initiative and proceed in rounds; once the fight ends, the surviving characters might shift back into stretches to pursue a fleeing enemy or stabilize a wounded ally before the scene loosens out into open time.

Intermissions

When an act ends, the game enters an intermission. Intermissions are essentially downtime — during an intermission, every character's Essence, Health and Focus refresh, and the characters have the opportunity to spend XP, allocate skill points, and purchase new equipment.

Equipment Maintenance

Equipment requires regular upkeep to remain in working order. During each intermission, every character must pay a **maintenance cost** equal to **10% of the total base price** of all equipment they own (carried, equipped, and wielded). This covers repairs, replacement parts, ammunition stockpiling, power cell recharging, enchantment stabilization, and general wear.

Modifications increase the maintenance cost: add the modification's cost to the base price before calculating the 10%. A ƒ 3150 Silvered Moontouched Longsword costs ƒ 315 per intermission to maintain.

Items that are not maintained risk degradation. For each unmaintained item, the GM rolls on the following table at the start of the next act:

EQUIPMENT DEGRADATION

D10	Result
1–3	**Cosmetic wear.** The item looks battered but functions normally. No mechanical effect — this time.
4–5	**Reduced stats.** One of the item's primary stats is reduced: –1/T damage (weapons), –2/T Armor or Ward (armor), or –1/2T Casting bonus (catalysts). This penalty is cumulative across intermissions and persists until the item is repaired (costs the skipped maintenance plus 25%).

6–7	**Lost quality.** One of the item's special properties ceases to function: a treatment wears off, an enchantment goes dormant, or a material property degrades. The GM chooses which. Restoring it requires re-applying the modification at full cost.
8–9	**Gained defect.** The item develops a negative quality: weapons gain Overload or (if already Overloaded) increase their malfunction chance; armor develops weak points (–1 Evasion); catalysts become erratic (–1d to casting checks). This defect persists until repaired.
10	**Catastrophic failure.** The item breaks down entirely and cannot be used until repaired. Repair costs the full maintenance cost plus 50%, and requires a Shop or Ritual check at difficulty equal to the item's tier + 3.

Tier 0 items (Old War surplus) have no maintenance cost — they are already in the worst shape they can be in. Legendary items have unique maintenance requirements determined by the GM, usually involving rare materials or specific conditions rather than a flat currency cost.

Characters

Azal jalē vahttan
Iryane niboltvānhē
Nidaumave avorhōyō
Narvim iluiyamgo vatauhanyō
Aivašti arvahvamdō
Avahmāš nyašbittī!

As hero of the Azalmen
Truly thou art now remade
In thy hands, our hope we ken
Our silver-gleaming blade
With godly fire burn them then
Who sought to be our foes!

— The Lay of Ingin

Characters are the lifeblood of Ashen. They are the roles the players take on when they play the game. Each character is unique: they may belong to one of several different races, have their own history (reflected in their Background) and be trained in several different skills and styles of combat.

The following sections present an overview of character creation as well as an introduction to some of the most important features of player characters in game terms. Character options are listed later in dedicated chapters.

Creating a Character

To get started playing Ashen, you must create your player character. As a first step, think about the general concept of your character: do you wish to play a sly rogue, a bookish scholar, or maybe a battle-hardened veteran? Your concept will guide every choice that follows — the race you pick, the attributes you prioritize, and the advances you buy should all serve a coherent idea of who your character is and how they fight.

A word of warning: the advance system gives you a great deal of flexibility, but a character who spreads their resources too thinly will struggle compared to one who commits to one or two strengths. Decide early what your character is *good at* and invest accordingly. You can always broaden later; you cannot easily recover from a weak foundation.

Once you have made up your mind on what kind of character you wish to play, you can use the following sequence of steps to convert your concept into a fully-fledged Ashen character:

1. Pick a Race

The first step is to pick your character's race. Your race determines your starting racial traits — innate powers and abilities that define how your character interacts with the world. Some races are better suited to certain roles than others: Ironhand Clockworks make natural heavy fighters, Porcelains are gifted arcanists, Echoes are mobile and elusive, Soot-Beasts are resilient brawlers and commanders, and Humans have a unique relationship with magic

and the divine. Read the *Races* chapter for full descriptions of each race and subtype.

2. Determine Attributes

Every character has ten attributes, each starting at rank 1. Choose **three** attributes to raise to rank 2. These initial choices shape your character's strengths for the early game and influence which characteristics and skills you will excel at.

When choosing attributes, consider which characteristics matter most for your concept. Each characteristic is derived from two attributes (see *Attributes and Characteristics*), so raising an attribute that feeds multiple characteristics you care about is more efficient than spreading your choices. Some examples:

- A melee combatant might raise **Strength** (Martial, Stamina), **Endurance** (Speed, Stamina, Grit), and **Agility** (Dodge, Speed).
- An arcane caster might raise **Attunement** (Arcane, Potential), **Intelligence** (Arcane, Initiative), and **Will** (Potential, Grit).
- A divine caster or commander might raise **Presence** (Command), **Will** (Potential, Grit), and **Endurance** (Stamina, Speed, Grit).
- A marksman or scout might raise **Dexterity** (Marksmanship), **Perception** (Marksmanship, Dodge), and **Agility** (Dodge, Speed).

3. Allocate Skill Points

Every character begins with **11 skill points (SP)** — 10 base, plus 1 from your starting 1000 XP. Skill points are spent to learn trained skills (1 SP to learn, granting rank 1) and to improve any skill's rank further (cost equal to the rank you are reaching: 1 SP for rank 2, 2 SP for rank 3, and so on). See the *Skills* chapter for the full cost table and skill descriptions.

At character creation, you will typically want to learn 3–5 trained skills and raise one or two of your most important skills to rank 2 or 3. A few guidelines:

- Every character benefits from at least one social skill (Persuasion, Deception, or Intimidation) and one awareness skill (Observation or Investigation).
- Combat characters should consider investing in Athletics or Acrobatics for mobility.
- Casters should invest in the skill that matches their casting tradition: Ritual for arcane, Occultism for divine, and either for psychic.
- The Piloting skill is useful if your campaign involves vehicles.

4. Buy Advances

Every character starts with **1000 experience points (XP)** representing their previous combat experience and training. You spend XP during character creation (and later, during intermissions) to purchase **advances** — permanent improvements to your statistics and abilities.

Each advance costs a certain amount of XP and grants HP, FP, or both, in addition to its specific benefit. Advances are organized by tier; at character creation, you will be purchasing Tier 1 advances. Some advances have prerequisites — other advances, minimum characteristic ratings, or both — so plan your build with an eye toward what you want to unlock later.

Your first advances should establish your character's core role:

- **Melee fighters** will want one or more Exploit advances to gain martial powers, and may want advances that improve their Martial or Dodge characteristics.
- **Ranged fighters** similarly benefit from Exploit advances (for marksmanship exploits) and characteristic improvements.
- **Arcane casters** need Spell Memory I to prepare and cast Tier 1 spells. Without this advance, you cannot cast arcane spells at all. You will also need to acquire at least one spell to prepare (see *Arcane Spells* under Basic Rules).
- **Divine casters** need a reliquary (purchased in step 5) to access prayers. Advances that improve Command help with favor checks and prayer casting.
- **Psychic characters** need one or more Discipline advances to gain psychic powers.
- **Commanders** benefit from Command advances that grant command powers for supporting allies.

You are unlikely to spend all 1000 XP during character creation — and that is normal. Unspent XP carries forward and can be spent at the next intermission, when higher-tier advances and new powers become available.

5. Buy Equipment

Each character begins the game with ƒ **500** to spend on starting equipment. At minimum, you will need:

- A **weapon** appropriate to your fighting style (melee, ranged, or both).
- **Armor** suitable to your build (light for mobile characters and casters, medium for a balance of protection and mobility, heavy for frontline fighters).
- A **catalyst** (if you cast arcane or psychic powers) or a **reliquary** (if you cast divine prayers). Without the appropriate implement, you cannot cast.
- Basic **gear**: a pack, rope, a light source, and any tools relevant to your skills (a healer's kit, a climbing kit, an alchemy kit, etc.).

Consult the *Equipment Tables* section for prices and statistics. At ƒ 500, you can afford a full Tier 1 kit with some feathers left over for consumables and sundries, or a partial Tier 2 kit if you are willing to skimp elsewhere. You will earn more feathers through missions and loot as the game progresses.

> Arcane casters: remember that you need at least one **spell** to prepare. Your starting budget can be used to purchase a spell from a local caster or a spell scroll, if the GM makes one available. Discuss this with your GM during character creation.

6. Calculate Statistics

Once you have completed all the above steps, calculate your character's derived statistics. All of these follow directly from the choices you have already made:

- **Hit Points (HP):** 10 + HP gained from advances.
- **Focus Points (FP):** 10 + FP gained from advances.
- **Movement Speed:** 2 + your Speed rating.
- **Evasion:** Half your Dodge rating (rounded down), modified by armor.
- **Action Points (AP):** 4 (for almost all characters).
- **Essence Points (EP):** 10 + 1 per 1000 cumulative XP (11 at creation).
- **Bulk Capacity:** Equal to your Stamina rating.

- **Charge Capacity:** Equal to your Potential rating.

Verify that your equipped items do not exceed your Bulk or Charge capacity. Record your weapon damage, armor values, and any other equipment-derived numbers on your character sheet.

7. Finishing Touches

Finally, give your character a name, a brief history, and a reason to adventure. Every player character is a **Deathless** — an immortal veteran of the Last War, cursed to walk the world until they lay their regrets to rest. Consider:

- Which **faction** does your character belong to, or are they unaligned? Factions provide patrons, mission opportunities, and social connections.
- What does your character **remember** of the Last War? Most Deathless remember little or nothing — but fragments surface, and those fragments shape who they are.
- What drives your character **forward**? Deathless cannot truly die, so survival alone is not enough. What goal, grudge, or unanswered question keeps them moving?
- What **keepsake** does your character carry? Most Deathless have at least one object from their forgotten past — a weathered medal, a key to an unknown door, a faded portrait, a weapon with an unfamiliar name engraved on the blade, a letter in a language they no longer read. The character probably does not remember what it represents, or why they cannot bring themselves to discard it. Work with your GM to choose a keepsake; it may become a thread the GM can weave into the story, giving the character clues to who they were before the War took their memories.

Basic Rules and Common Terms

Many of the following rules make reference to some common concepts that bear explanation.

Character Statistics

Every character is largely defined in game terms by several sets of numbers. Fundamentally, a character is said to have **Attributes**, **Characteristics**, **Skills** and **Derived Statistics**.

Of these, **Attributes** are the most fundamental: they describe your character's most fundamental physical and mental characteristics. Attributes include things like a character's strength and intelligence.

Characteristics are a step down and measure a character's basic capability to move and act in certain ways. Characteristics are some of a character's most important numbers in combat. Characteristics describe traits such as a character's swiftness of foot or their skill in melee combat.

Skills are similar to characteristics, but describe a character's skill in more complex domains. They tend to be used outside of combat. Skills include a character's proficiency in map-reading, alchemy or disguising themselves.

Statistics, finally, is a catch-all term for numbers derived purely mechanically in some way from choices made in character creation and advancement. Such numbers include a character's hit points and armor rating.

Attributes, Characteristics and Skills all have **ranks**: a number from 1 to 6 representing a character's innate proficiency and training in that Attribute, Characteristic or Skill.

Characteristics and Skills also have ratings: a number that ranges between **3 and 18**. The ratings are composed of a character's ranks in that statistic, from 1 to 6, and their **attribute bonuses** to the statistic, equal to the character's ranks in those attributes. Each skill and characteristic gains bonuses from two attributes, listed below.

The values of derived statistics usually also have ratings, but there is no uniform way of calculating them.

Equipment States

Items a character owns can be in one of three states: **carried**, **equipped**, or **wielded**. Carried items are stowed in a pack or on a character's person but are not ready for immediate use. Equipped items are worn or readied on the body and available to be drawn quickly. Wielded items are actively held in hand and ready to use. For full definitions, see *Equipment States* in the Equipment chapter.

Advances and Powers

Apart from a character's numbers, the choices that most influence a character's development have to do with the advances and powers they learn over the course of the adventures.

Advances are improvements to your character's statistics and abilities purchased with the experience points you earn while adventuring. They can grant you a variety of benefits from increasing your attributes and characteristics to improving your skill at certain actions.

Powers are extraordinary actions you can perform during combat. Powers can span the gamut from magical spells to heroic feats of skill at your weapons. They can be learnt in a variety of ways: some can be purchased as advances, others must be obtained through instruction from a master.

Arcane Spells

Arcane spellcasters learn spells by studying written formulae — copying them from spellbooks, scrolls, or the notes of other casters. A character can know any number of arcane spells, but knowing a spell is not enough to cast it. To use an arcane spell in the field, it must first be **prepared**.

Preparation is a ritual process that requires several hours of undisturbed concentration, access to ritual materials (chalk, ink, and other minor components), and a quiet environment. Most casters prepare their spells during a long rest. Once preparation is complete, the spells remain available until the caster next prepares — there is no time limit, but there is also no way to change the selection without performing the full ritual again.

The number and tier of spells a character can prepare is determined by their **spell slots**, which are gained from the Spell Memory advances. Each spell slot holds one spell of its tier or lower. For example, a character with one Tier 1 slot and one Tier 2 slot can prepare two spells: one of Tier 1 or lower in the first slot, and one of Tier 2 or lower in the second. Each Spell Memory advance can be taken multiple times, adding an additional slot of that tier each time.

Arcane spells are, in effect, a form of loot. Larger towns often have resident casters who can be persuaded — or paid — to share their knowledge, and the ruins of the old world frequently contain spellbooks among their treasures.

Divine Prayers

Divine prayers are not learned or prepared. They are granted by a character's wielded **reliquary** — a remnant of a dead god that retains a portion of divine power. Each reliquary provides access to prayers from one or more aspects, up to the tier of the reliquary itself. As long as the reliquary is wielded and the character has earned its favor, those prayers are available to cast. See *Reliquaries* in the Equipment chapter for the full rules on favor, will, and tapping.

A character who switches to a different reliquary immediately gains access to that reliquary's prayers (assuming favor has been earned) and loses access to the previous one's. This makes the choice of reliquary one of the most important decisions a divine caster can make.

Psychic Powers

Psychic powers are intrinsic to the character. Each Discipline advance grants the character a psychic power permanently — once learned, a psychic power is always available and does not need to be prepared or equipped. Psychic powers can be taught by one practitioner to another, but the process is long — days to months of intensive mental training — and requires the student to commit XP through a Discipline advance. As with all advances, this can only be done during an intermission, unless extraordinary circumstances (a divine blessing, communion with a powerful artifact) allow it.

Martial Exploits

Martial exploits are combat techniques learned through training and battle experience. Each Exploit advance grants the character one exploit permanently. Like psychic powers, exploits are always available once learned and do not require preparation. Exploits are typically learned from a master-at-arms, a fighting school, or through the hard lessons of combat itself — but always during an intermission, when the character has time to train.

Legendary

Some items, powers, and advances are marked as **legendary**. Legendary things share two properties: they are *quest-bound* (they cannot simply be purchased or learned — they must be earned, recovered, or unlocked through a significant quest or story event), and they are *extraordinary* (they break or transcend the normal rules in some way).

For items, legendary also implies *uniqueness*: only one copy of a legendary item exists in the world. For powers and advances, the meaning is looser — legendary denotes rarity and distinction rather than strict uniqueness. A legendary power might be shared by a handful of powerful beings, or a legendary advance might be the birthright of a small group created for a specific purpose. What sets them apart is not that no one else can have them, but that they cannot be attained through ordinary means.

A legendary item might be an ancient weapon with a power that cannot be replicated. A legendary power might represent a character's latent ability, forgotten across lifetimes, that resurfaces only when the right conditions are met. A legendary advance might unlock a capability that no amount of ordinary training could produce.

The specific rules for legendary items, including enchantment slots, are detailed in the Equipment chapter. The key principle is universal: legendary things are not available at will. They are milestones, not purchases.

Races

The world of ashen is a wild place. Inhabited by magical and monstrous creatures, shaped by technology whose secrets of construction have long been lost, it is a realm of secrets and adventure.

The immortal warriors that walk this land are themselves the heirs of magic and technology beyond modern reckoning. From the sentient machines that are the Clockworks to the færie Echoes, the racial composition of immortals attests to their atypical nature.

There are seven races presented in the sections below. Each race is given a brief introduction, including what is known of their history, and typical ranges of physical traits for members of that race.

Most important are each race's special abilities: while your race does not modify your statistics, it does provide you with different physical and magical attributes that may make particular races better or worse suited to the type of character you want to play.

Clockwork

"The Goddess Third loved toys and tinkers, and when she took up arms, her toys marched alongside her."

You are a construct, a machine of supreme elegance, the watchmaker's art united with that of the wizard. Powered by the energy of your soul-anchor and the arcane workings of your mechanism, you were once created for love of art and science, and once reforged in your maker's tears to fight like no creature could fight.

There are two kinds of clockworks: Ironhands and Porcelains. All clockworks have the following traits:

Construct

You are a machine, and thus do not need to eat, breathe, or sleep. You are immune to poison and disease. However, you have other weaknesses instead: you are treated as a machine and are subject to all effects that target machines.

Wind-Up You are powered by the soul-anchor you carry within your body, which drives the mechanism that moves you. When the connection to the soul-anchor is interrupted, you become an inanimate object after three rounds until the connection is restored. This effect can be staved off for up to one hour by winding up your mechanism manually from the outside. After this time, you lose consciousness and winding up has no further effect until the underlying problem is fixed.

In addition, every clockwork must choose one of the following two subtypes:

Ironhands

You are a walking suit of armor, made to wield heavy weapons and crush your foes in melee. Your actual body is a magi-mechanic core that powers the limbs and weapons of your iron form.

You gain the following racial traits:

Walking Armor You cannot normally wear armor. Instead, your core is built to be fit into combat walker frames called Construct Bodies. You begin the game with a construct body available to you. If at any point you wish to switch to a new one, your core must be uninstalled from your current body and inserted into the new one. This is an operation that takes significant time – the engineer conducting it must roll Shop against the Equipment Rank of the construct body, with every roll taking one day.

Integrated Weapons

You can mount weaponry and gear to your construct body up to its total bulk rating. When you do this, you ignore the bulk rating on the mounted equipment. Your charge use is calculated as normal.

Porcelain

Where the Ironhands are brute force, the Porcelains are effortless grace. Lithe, youthful figures, they were originally crafted as companions for the reclusive Just-So. When the war came, she remade them as conduits for raw magical might.

You gain the following racial traits:

Graceful Form You move with supernatural grace. While you are animated, the magic within you disguises your nature as a clockwork until someone touches your cold skin. You are immune to effects that would trip you and you ignore movement penalties from Difficult and Treacherous terrain.

Spell Capacitor

Your inner workings are optimized to focus arcane energy into destructive force. Whenever you expend Focus, roll a D6. On a 5 or 6, you immediately regain the lost Focus.

Echoes

"High and Just-As-High were different from their sister. They were not content to play in silence by themselves, but made wonderful playgrounds for themselves, and filled them with playmates."

Echoes are fey creatures, born of the capricious goddesses of Magic, Knowledge and Fate. The sisters ruled over their own fey domains, twisted reflections of the material world. The Echoes that inhabited them are themselves images of humans, refracted through the lenses of their creator-goddesses. Though these faerie realms are long gone, the Echoes still retain some of their old power within themselves.

All Echoes gain the following racial traits:

Fey Jaunt

You gain the following power:

FEY JAUNT — PSYCHIC POWER

INNATE WARP

Cost: 6 FP

AP: Move Action, 2 AP

Effect: Select one square within your move range. You teleport to it.

Vindictive

It was said that those who made enemies of the Fairies would never escape their pursuers. When an enemy damages you, you can choose to hold a grudge against that enemy. When you next attack or use a spell power against that enemy, you gain 1 automatic success on your attack or spell check against him. You can only hold a grudge against one creature at a time.

There are two kinds of Echoes: Mirrors and Shades. Every Echo character must choose one of the following subtypes:

Mirrors

The Mirrors, children of Might-Be, the Fateweaver, are the fairest of the humanoid races. They lived in the beautiful lands of Faerie, once, and like many of its denizens, they are adept at misleading their foes.

Mirrors gain the following racial trait:

Dance of the Spring Court

The old, hidden world of the fey is dead, but you can still call up its echoes to bewilder your foes. You gain the following power:

DANCE OF THE SPRING COURT — PSYCHIC POWER

INNATE WARP

Trigger: You are targeted by an attack

Cost: 6 FP

AP: Reaction (Immediate Interrupt)

Effect: You may immediately teleport to any free space within 2 meters. This power does not stop the triggering attack; apply the rules for a missing target.

Shades

Shades were the favored companion of Once-Was, the Knower of Ways, Goddess of what is Hidden and Forgotten. They are said to have dwelt deep underground, in glorious palaces, until they rode out to hunt in the long winter nights of Faerie.

As a Shade, you gain the following racial trait:

Hunt of the Autumn Court In days of old, the goddess Came-To-Pass was worshipped as an unerring huntress. You retain some of her essence.

You gain the following power:

HUNT OF THE AUTUMN COURT — PSYCHIC POWER

INNATE UNERRING

Range: 15; one target

Cost: 6 FP per Tier

AP: 2 AP

Effect: Target one enemy within range that you or your allies can see. You place a mark upon it; while it is marked, your ranged attacks against the target ignore obscuration and partial cover. Additionally, whenever you use your Fey Jaunt power, you can choose to appear in a square adjacent to your enemy instead, even if the enemy would otherwise be out of range.

Soot-Beasts

"The Lion-Headed God of War, jealous of his brother, pawned his innocence to the Boar-Mother for creations of his own. Always itching for war, her work had the aspect of their mother, but the temperament of their father."

This diverse race of mostly green-skinned mostly humanoids has vexed many a scholar and led to the banning of many books. Optimized for life on the battlefield, many associate Sootbeasts with warlikeness and bravery. Although not all forms of them tend to display these traits, the ones presented here do.

There are two kinds of Sootbeasts: Warboars and Goldenbristles. All Sootbeasts have the following traits:

Asexual

Sootbeasts reproduce in idiosyncratic ways and therefore do not have the capacity to feel attraction to others, even (or perhaps especially) other Sootbeasts. You are immune to being seduced, even by magical effects.

Born for Battle

Bred to last in grueling campaigns that would wear down an army of any other race, you can find reserves of energy within yourself no matter how bloodied you are. Once per encounter, you can spend an action point to give yourself a second wind. You immediately heal up to your healing rate and end all ongoing damage effects affecting you.

Indomitable

You are the pride of your hive, a son of battle. You were born to the sound of shields cracking under axes and the drum of gun-volleys in the air. You are immune to fear effects of any kind and cannot be compelled to run away from battle.

In addition, every Sootbeast must choose one of the following two subtypes:

Warboar

You are the epitome of what people picture when they hear the word "Sootbeast" spoken. Tough, strong, bristling with claw and tusk, you make your enemies tremble with your coming and your allies glad to have you by their side. As a Warboar, you gain the following racial traits:

Unstoppable, Immovable

You gain a +2 resistance bonus against effects that would move you against your will. When you make an attack or activate an effect that would move your target, gain a +2 bonus to any roll made to activate that effect.

Tide of Iron

To see your enemies falter before you invigorates you. When you kill another creature with an action, you immediately regain up to 2 AP for this turn. You cannot regain more AP than you spent on the action that triggered this ability.

Goldenbristle

Where there is brawn, there must be brain, or else the army will falter. While nothing compels an Warboar to be stupid, and nothing compels a Goldenbristle to weakness, their temperaments are by and large very different. Where a Warboar longs to drown in the tide of battle, a Goldenbristle is content to hang back; where a Warboar is happy (to a certain point) with taking orders, a Goldenbristle is charismatic and imperious, reflecting their designated role as field commanders of Sootbeast armies. As a Goldenbristle, you gain the following racial traits:

Born Leader

You have a natural talent at winning others' respect, if not loyalty, and your orders tend to be followed. You gain a +2 bonus on Command rolls to activate Command Powers.

Time to strike!

You gain a +2 bonus to your Initiative roll. In addition, once per round, you can swap places in the initiative order with one ally you can see.

Humans

"And thus it was that the first-born of the gods were doomed to spend their lives torn between themselves, for both the Boar-Mother and the Falcon-Headed Sun had laid their claims to them, and neither would relinquish theirs until the bitter end."

Humans were the first of the humanoid races, product of a Tryst between the God of Crafts, whose name is now lost, and the Boar-Mother, the great goddess of Life and Earth. When she slew her lover in a fit of jealous rage, it was the Sun God Kharu who adopted the young race to shield them from her wrath. Their natures have been divided ever since, but they are closer to the fading glory of the Gods than any other race.

Golden Apple

Your nature makes you both beloved of the gods, and quick to incur their anger. When you attune to a reliquary, you begin with 1 favor already earned — the gods recognize their firstborn. In addition, the first time you tap a prayer each encounter, the tap costs 0 favor instead of 1. You also gain a +2 bonus to Occultism checks whenever you interact with divine essence, relics of the gods, or sacred sites.

Gift of the Sun

Falcon-Headed Khâru is a great and terrible father; he demands much, but he rewards with pride the efforts of his children. Once per round, you may spend 2 Essence Points to add 2 automatic successes to any check you make. This decision is made after rolling but before the result is determined.

Gift of the Earth

The Boar-Mother gives freely of her gift; but those who sup too greedily discover that with debt comes obedience. Beneficial magical effects on you whose duration is measured in rounds last two rounds longer than usual. However, saving throws you make against hostile magical effects require 3 successes instead of the usual 2.

Attributes and Characteristics

Attributes

Attributes describe a creature's core traits in the game. Most creatures have ten attributes: **Strength**, **Endurance**, **Dexterity**, **Agility**, **Attunement**, **Sight**, **Intelligence**, **Perception**, **Will** and **Presence**. Each attribute is rated on a scale from **1 to 6**. Every character begins with a single rank in all ten attributes before modifiers are applied.

Attributes are used together with skills to make die rolls. Every point in an attribute adds one die to the pool. For a description of each skill, see the skills section of the rules.

Attributes also influence a character's combat statistics, which are described below:

Strength

Strength is a measure of a character's capacity to exert physical force. A character with low strength will be not far beyond his race's baseline; a character with very high strength has both very well-developed musculature and significant supernatural or technological assistance.

Strength contributes to a character's capacity for Athletics and Manual Labor. It influences the Martial and Stamina characteristics of a character. It also adds to their Athletics skill.

Endurance

Endurance measures a character's capacity to keep exerting themselves without needing to rest. A low-Endurance character has to be careful not to overburden themselves, lest they fail to keep up; a very high-Endurance character can fight in the heaviest armor for hours without needing to rest.

Endurance helps a character resist harsh environments and the exertions of long travel under muscle power. It influences a character's Grit and Stamina characteristics. It also assists their Athletics skill.

Agility

Agility represents a character's ability to move their body quickly and explosively. A low-Agility character might seem almost sluggish, while a very high Agility score allows a character to run at superhuman speeds and deliver devastatingly fast blows.

Agility assists a character in almost all spheres of physical exertion. It influences a character's Martial, Speed and Dodge characteristics. It also assists their Acrobatics skill.

Dexterity

Where Agility is about speed and explosivity, Dexterity represents a character's capacity for subtlety and finesse. A character with high Dexterity is much more likely to be able to repair an extremely complicated micromechanism or wriggle out of rope bindings than one with low Dexterity.

Dexterity assists characters both in the control of their own body as well as in the manipulation of various mechanisms. Dexterity adds to a character's Marksmanship characteristic, as well as their Access, Shop and Piloting skills.

Attunement

Attunement represents a character's capacity to sense and manipulate the flow of magical energies around them. It is an indispensable attribute for would-be practitioners of Arcane magic, and those who would make effective use of the many wonders they produce. A character with low Attunement will find themselves oblivious to the presence of all but the most obvious magic, and poorly suited to make use of magical items. A high-Attunement character, on the other hand, will find these pursuits easy.

Attunement adds to a character's Arcane and Potential characteristics. It also aids in the Eerie, Magitek and Ritual skills.

Sight

Sight represents a character's proverbial Sixth Sense: an uncanny talent to know things that by rights ought to be unknowable. A character with high Sight is difficult to surprise and uncannily resourceful; with the appropriate training, sufficient Sight allows a character to pierce the veil of reality and perceive what lies beyond, allowing them a modicum of clairvoyance and the ability to make use of psychic powers.

Sight contributes to a character's Psychic and Initiative ratings. It is also useful for the Eerie and Occultism skills.

Intelligence

Intelligence represents a character's capacity to absorb and process new information. High Intelligence marks a character as quick-witted and capable of finding novel solutions to problems.

Intelligence is the foundational attribute for most technical skills. It adds to a character's Initiative and Arcane characteristics as well as their Access, Influence, Alchemy, Electronics and Magitek skills.

Perception

The mundane counterpart to Sight, Perception measures how acute a character's ordinary five senses are. A character with high Perception is more likely to notice fine details that another might have missed.

Perception contributes to many different skills. It adds to a character's Marksmanship and Dodge ratings as well as their Alchemy and Piloting skills.

Will

Will represents a character's capacity for taking decisions and seeing them through, come hell or high water. A character with high Will will be more able to resist pain or attempts at controlling them, as well as be more able to follow through on their decisions.

Will contributes to a character's Grit, Potential, Psychic and Command ratings. It also adds to their Impose, Occultism and Ritual skills.

Presence

Presence is a measure of the character's ability to capture others' attention. A character with high Presence cannot walk into a room unnoticed – they are sure to turn all the heads that can be turned. A low-Presence character is

much more forgettable, which has social disadvantages, but also lets one be more stealthy.

The Presence attribute contributes to a character's Command rating. It also adds to the Impose and Influence skills.

Characteristics

Apart from their attributes, each character also has several characteristics that are derived from them. These statistics principally influence the success and failure of a character in combat, but occasionally may also be rolled against in other situations.

Each character has a rating in a characteristic that normally ranges between 3 and 18. The ratings are composed of a character's ranks in that statistic, from 1 to 6, and their attribute bonuses to the statistic. Each statistic gains bonuses from two attributes, listed below.

A character starts with one rank in each characteristic, but may advance their ranks in the course of play. See the sections on character creation and advancement for details.

Martial

Attributes: STR + AGI

This characteristic describes a character's effectiveness in melee combat. It is used to make attack rolls with melee or thrown weapons. You need to make an opposed Martial check to resist being overpowered.

Marksmanship

Attributes: DEX + PER

This characteristic describes a character's skill with ranged weapons of all kinds. It is used to make attack rolls with ranged and thrown weapons.

Initiative

Attributes: SGT + INT

This characteristic represents a character's alertness and quickness to act. It determines how quickly your character gets a chance to act in combat (or in structured time). Initiative checks are also rolled to avoid surprises and sudden dangers, such as trap doors.

Speed

Attributes: AGI + END

This characteristic represents how quick a character is on their feet. It determines a character's movement range. You may also need to make a speed check when attempting to traverse ground within a certain amount of time.

Stamina

Attributes: STR + END

This characteristic represents your character's ability to keep fighting and exerting themselves under strain. Your character's Stamina rating determines their **Bulk capacity** (see *Bulk and Charge* in the Equipment chapter). Your character may need to make a Stamina check to resist the effects of poison, disease or fatigue.

Potential

Attributes: ATT + WIL

This characteristic represents your character's ability to control magical energy. Your character's Potential rating determines their **Charge capacity** (see *Bulk and Charge* in the Equipment chapter). You may also need to make a Potential check to resist the effects of harmful magic.

Arcane

Attributes: ATT + INT

This characteristic determines your character's skill at casting Arcane magic. It is used when making casting rolls for Arcane spells.

Psychic

Attributes: SGT + WIL

This characteristic determines your character's skill at using Psychic powers.

Command

Attributes: PRS + WIL

This characteristic represents your character's ability to persuade both allies and enemies. It is used to make casting rolls for charm abilities. Since it is also necessary to convince Reliquaries, this characteristic additionally determines your character's skill at casting Divine magic.

Dodge

Attributes: AGI + PER

This characteristic influences how easy your character is to hit with weapon attacks, and can allow them to avoid larger attacks as well. Dodge checks are usually made to avoid area attacks and effects.

Grit

Attributes: END + WIL

This characteristic influences your character's ability to resist pain, disturbing mental effects and similar noxious influences.

Derived Statistics

The following statistics are derived from a character's attributes, characteristics and advances. Unlike attributes and characteristics, they do not have ranks — they are calculated from other values.

Hit Points (HP)

Hit Points represent how much damage a character can sustain before falling. Every character begins with **10 HP**. Additional HP is gained from advances: each advance a character purchases grants a certain amount of HP as listed in its description. A character's total HP is the sum of their base 10 plus all HP gained from advances. For rules on how damage is dealt and reduced, including damage types, Armor, Ward, and resistances, see *Damage* in the Combat chapter.

Focus Points (FP)

Focus Points fuel a character's extraordinary abilities, including spells, prayers and psychic powers. Every character begins with **10 FP**. Additional FP is gained from advances in the same way as HP. A character's total FP is the sum of their base 10 plus all FP gained from advances.

Movement Speed

A character's Movement Speed determines how many squares they can move with a single move action. Movement Speed is equal to **2 + the character's Speed rating**. A starting character typically has a Movement Speed of 5 squares, while a character at the peak of their physical ability can reach 20 or more with advances.

Evasion

Evasion represents how difficult a character is to hit with attacks. A character's base Evasion is equal to **half their Dodge rating, rounded down**. This base value is then modified by armor (light armor typically grants a bonus, heavy armor imposes a penalty) and other effects.

Action Points (AP)

Every character has **4 Action Points** per turn. AP is spent to take actions during combat; unspent AP is lost at the end of a character's turn. Some advances and effects can modify the number of AP available.

Essence Points

Each character has a number of **Essence Points (EP)** that control that character's ability to recover from damage and exhaustion. A character starts with 10 EP and gains an additional EP every time he or she gains 1000 experience.

Characters can spend EP to recover from damage and even return from the dead. The costs are as follows:

A Deathless character who dies may spend 5 EP on their next turn to revive on the spot. See *Death and Revival* in the Combat chapter for the full rules, and *Death and Reincorporation* in the Exploration chapter for what happens when spot-revival is not possible.

When taking a rest, a character may spend 1 EP to recover either **half their health** or **their entire focus**. Characters suffering from magical effects that do not require special measures to end may also spend 1 EP to end them.

Whenever you take a **long rest**, you recover 3 EP.

Skills

Skills represent your character's abilities and aptitudes that are not directly related to their performance in combat.

Trained and Untrained Skills

Skills are divided into untrained and trained skills. Untrained skills are available to every character, and start at rank 1. Trained skills, as the name suggests, require special training. Characters without training in a trained skill have 0 ranks in it and cannot make skill checks using that skill.

Gaining and Improving Skills

Characters improve their skills by spending **skill points (SP)**. Every character begins the game with **11 SP** (10 base and 1 from their starting 1000 XP). During play, characters earn 1 additional SP for every 1000 XP they accumulate.

Skill points can be spent during character creation or during intermissions to improve your skills in the following ways:

- **Learn a trained skill** (rank 0 ⟶ 1): 1 SP. This represents acquiring the basic training needed to use the skill, whether through instruction from a mentor, self-study, or hard-won experience. Characters may choose
- **Improve a skill by one rank**: The cost to raise a skill from rank N to rank N+1 is equal to N skill points.

COST PER SKILL RANK

Rank	SP Cost	Cumulative (from rank 1)
2	1	1
3	2	3
4	3	6
5	4	10
6	5	15

The maximum rank in any skill is 6, representing absolute mastery. A skill's total **rating** — the number of dice you roll for skill checks — equals your ranks in the skill plus your ranks in its two linked attributes, for a maximum of 18.

Using skills

Skills are usually called upon in situations where unusual danger must be confronted or special knowledge is required. As such, using a skill requires making a skill check.

To roll a skill check, first determine your total **rating** for that skill. Every skill is associated with two attributes; add up your skill ranks with your ranks in those attributes to obtain your total rating. The end result will be a number between 3 and 18. This is the total number of dice you have to roll. If the number of successes you roll beats the difficulty indicated by your GM, your skill check was successful.

The modalities of your skill check depend on the circumstances and your character's training. Some advances or items can grant you a bonus to your skill check, while some external circumstances may increase the difficulty of your task. As an example, if you are making an athletics check to climb up a cliff face, you may benefit from a bonus to your check if you have taken along proper mountaineering equipment. Conversely, if you are surprised by a sudden storm, your skill check may become more difficult than you expected.

There are also some special ways you can use your skills that are not making the usual skill check.

Taking the Average

If you are not otherwise distracted or endangered, you can choose to take the average of your skill rather than roll. If you do so, you can automatically

attempt to succeed at a skill check with a number of successes equal to half your rating in that skill (rounded down). This usually results in an automatic success for many routine tasks.

You cannot take the average if you are in combat or in another situation that makes it impossible for you to devote your full concentration to the skill check. You also cannot take the average on skill checks made as part of skill challenges. At your GM's discretion, you may also not be allowed to take the average on intrinsically dangerous or high-stakes skill checks, even if you have a high rating in the skill.

Taking the average is risk-free but also routine — it does not represent a moment of growth or challenge for your character.

Taking the Maximum

If you have plenty of time, and failing a skill check does not entail any particular consequences (i.e., you can retry it indefinitely) then you can elect to treat the result of your skill check as equal to your rating in it.

Doing so takes 10 times as long as making a single check, as it is assumed that your character fails at, and retries, the task several times before arriving at a satisfactory outcome; that is, if you keep making skill checks, eventually you will roll your rating's worth of successes or higher.

Taking the maximum assumes your character spends the time to get the job done right, failing and retrying as needed until they arrive at a satisfactory outcome.

Helping Another

Some tasks are amenable to being performed in groups. If you decide to join another in making such a skill check, then you can grant them a bonus to their check. The first helper adds a +2 bonus, every helper after that a +1 bonus. In order to qualify to help another in their skill check, your skill rating must be at least equal to the difficulty of the task. For example, to help somebody in a ritual with difficulty 6, your Ritual rating must be 6 or higher.

You cannot help another with a task requiring a trained skill if you are not yourself trained in that skill.

Difficulty

The skill descriptions below include a set of sample skill checks along with their difficulties. If a particular use of a skill is not listed in these chapters, apply the following guidelines:

The merely hard is difficulty 0

An immortal is by nature far above the powers of ordinary mortals. Any task that would be readily learnable by a mortal of average talent and skill does not require a skill check from a character, unless the circumstances are truly adverse.

One level of difficulty equals two dice

When determining difficulties, consider the skill level of the character the challenge ought to be appropriate for. At the absolute minimum level, three dice, a character will statistically pass a check of difficulty 2 50% of the time. Every two dice above that, the cutoff for passing 50% of the time increases by one.

For determining the chance of success at different dice pools, consider the following chart:

SUCCESS CHANCES

Pool Size	< 10%	25%	50%	75%	>90%
3	5	3	2	1	-1
5	6	5	3	1	0
7	8	6	4	2	0
9	9	7	5	3	1
11	11	8	6	4	1
13	12	9	7	5	2
15	13	10	8	6	3
17	15	12	9	6	3
19	16	13	10	7	4
21	17	14	11	8	5
23	18	15	12	9	6

Skill List

Untrained Skills

- **Acrobatics (U; AGI + DEX)**

Control your body, maintain your balance.

- **Athletics (U; STR + END)**

Perform feats of strength and speed.

- **Awareness (U; PER + SGT)**

Know your surroundings, detect and avoid threats.

- **Deceive (U; INT + PRS)**

They didn't need to know that. Or maybe they did.

- **Eerie (U; SGT + ATT)**

Use your sixth sense.

- **Impose (U; PRS + WIL)**

Leave a lasting impression.

- **Influence (U; PRS + INT)**

Give people really good advice.

- **Investigate (U; INT + PER)**

Perform research.

- **Subterfuge (U; DEX + INT)**

Steal, hide, cheat, and all other such sporting activities.

Trained Skills

- **Access (T; DEX + INT)**

Circumvent locks, access control systems and structurally unsound walls.

- **Alchemy (T; INT + PER)**

Straw to gold, lead to uranium, grapes into illegal booze.

- **Electronics (T; DEX + INT)**

Deal with sentient creatures' worst mistake.

- **Magitek (T; INT + ATT)**

Figure out how that magical gizmo works.

- **Occultism (T; SGT + ATT)**

Commune with your Luigi Board and other things inhabited by a supernatural presence.

- **Piloting (T; DEX + PER)**

Control high-speed vehicles of all kinds.

- **Ritual (T; WIL + ATT)**

Perform pious and/or blasphemous invocations to the spirits and cast really fancy spells.

- **Shop (T; DEX + STR)**

Welding, riveting, lathing... the works!

Skill Descriptions

Skill descriptions adhere to the following guidelines.

Skill Name: The name of the skill.

Training required: Whether a skill is untrained ("U") or trained ("T"). **Key Attributes**: The name line also includes the abbreviations of the attributes that contribute to your skill rating.

Check: What a character ("you" in the skill description) can do with a successful skill check and the usual difficulties (D) of such checks.

Action: The amount of AP or the amount of time required for a check.

Try Again: Any conditions that apply to successive attempts to use the skill successfully. If the skill doesn't allow you to attempt the same task more than once, or if failure carries an inherent penalty, you can't take the maximum. If this paragraph is omitted, the skill can be retried without any inherent penalty other than the additional time required.

Special: Any extra facts that apply to the skill.

Untrained Skills

Acrobatics (U; AGI + DEX)

Your ability to move securely through space. This skill covers keeping your balance on particularly treacherous ground (such as tightropes), performing feats of jumping or tumbling, and even avoiding or lessening injury when you take a fall.

Checks

Balance: You can make an acrobatics check to balance across narrow surfaces, highly slippery or uneven ground, or a surface in motion.

Some general modifiers apply to checks made to balance. These modifiers stack between categories, but only the most severe penalty per category applies. Thus, trying to run across a narrow (0,75 m) walkway that is iced over and slopes slightly upward carries a total difficulty of 9 (D 1 base + D 3 icy + D 1 slope + D 4 running speed).

BALANCE DIFFICULTIES

Terrain Condition	Difficulty Modifier
Severely Obstructed (cavern, rubble)	+1
Slightly Slippery (wet)	+1
Severely Slippery (icy)	+3
Slightly Sloped (<45°)	+1
Severely Sloped (>45°)	+3
Slightly Unsteady (boat in rough water)	+1
Mildly Unsteady (boat in a storm)	+2
Severely Unsteady (earthquake)	+4
Move at full speed on narrow or uneven surfaces	+2
Run across narrow or uneven surfaces (double speed)	+4

The base difficulties for narrow surfaces are given below.

NARROW SURFACE DIFFICULTIES

Surface Width	Base Acrobatics Difficulty
Greater than 1 m wide	0
0,4-1 meters wide	1
20-40 cm wide	2
5-20 cm wide	3
Less than 5 cm wide	4

Jumping: The acrobatics skill also allows you to make jumps and aerobatic maneuvers.

JUMP DIFFICULTIES

Attempted Jump	Difficulty (Modifier)
High Jump (2 m)	2
High Jump (per additional meter)	+2
Long Jump (Quarter Speed)	2
Long Jump (Half Speed)	4
Long Jump (per quarter speed)	+2
Running start	-2
Wearing Medium or Heavy armor	+Bulk of the armor

Tumbling and Rolling: You can make acrobatics checks to perform various maneuvers while in mid-air. Usually, these checks are made in reaction to another event, either a previous Acrobatics check to jump, or because something knocked you away.

If you make an acrobatics check to bypass an obstacle while moving quickly, you lose some speed: an obstacle counts as difficult terrain. You can make your check with an additional +2 difficulty to keep moving at your original speed.

Action

Acrobatic Maneuver	Difficulty (Modifier)
Vault an Object	Corresponding High Jump difficulty +2
Slide under an obstacle while moving (0.5-1m of space)	2
Slide under an obstacle while moving (30-50 cm of space)	4
Cartwheels, somersaults or twists while jumping	Jump difficulty + 1 per turn
Kick off a wall to keep moving	4 (+ high jump difficulty if moving upwards)
Land on your feet after being knocked over	2
Roll to absorb fall damage	1 per meter fallen

Table 1: Maneuver Difficulties

None. Acrobatics checks are made as reactions or as part of move actions. They do not take additional time.

Try Again

Varies. An Acrobatics check that doesn't put you in physical danger can be retried indefinitely. If you would fall a dangerous distance on failure, you cannot retry before resolving the effects of the fall (you cannot take the maximum on such checks).

Special

Porcelains' *Graceful Form* ability also affects their Acrobatics checks. A porcelain treats every conditional modifier to an Acrobatics check made to balance on narrow or uneven as 1 lower than it actually is, and does not take a penalty to Acrobatics checks to perform a movement at full speed. If the check difficulty is reduced to 0 in this way, they do not need to make a check. For example, Porcelains can move across a wet floor or a 30 centimeter wide plank at full speed without requiring an acrobatics check, and only need to succeed at a D 6 Acrobatics check to cross a frozen tightrope without falling.

Any other effects that allow a character to ignore penalties from difficult terrain have the same influence on their Acrobatics checks.

Athletics (U; STR + END)

Athletics measures your skill at exerting force on the world. Where proficiency in Acrobatics allows you to jump and wheel freely to the world, proficiency in Athletics lets you lift great weights, throw objects very far, climb up sheer cliff faces and swim swiftly through rough waters.

Checks

Climb: You can make an Athletics check to climb up or down surfaces that are too steep to traverse normally. You can also climb horizontally across walls or traverse a chasm or gap hanging off overhead handholds.

CLIMBING DIFFICULTIES

Example Surface or Activity	Check Difficulty
... on very wet or otherwise slippery surfaces	+2
... in strong wind	+2

Lift and Throw: Your athletics checks also allow you to exert strength and move objects, whether by lifting, throwing, or even just pushing.

LIFTING AND THROWING DIFFICULTIES

Example activity	Check Difficulty
Push your body weight	2
... per additional times your weight	+2
Lift half your body weight overhead	2
... per additional half times	+2
Throw (per quarter body weight)	2

Swim: You can use an Athletics check to swim. In calm conditions with no external dangers, characters usually require no check to swim (except if they would otherwise sink due to their composition); to swim in adverse conditions or to move particularly quickly, a check is required.

A character without an innate Swim speed moves half their land speed by default when swimming. They can exert themselves to swim twice as fast, but this always requires a check.

SWIMMING DIFFICULTIES

Water Condition	Check Difficulty
Calm	0
Rough	2
Very Rough*	4
Storm*	6
... moving at full speed	+2
... with flotsam in the water	+2
... with heavy flotsam or underwater obstacles*	+4

* These conditions are hazardous and characters cannot take the average to swim

Special

Constructs do not float. Constructs automatically fail any checks made to swim and sink to the bottom of any body of water unless equipped with flotation devices (or effects) capable of handling their weight.

Awareness (U; SGT + PER)

The awareness skill allows a character to maintain awareness of their surroundings and notice changes or oddities that less trained observers might miss. It's used to navigate unfamiliar environments, spot hidden objects and creatures, and notice inconsistencies in narrative.

In general, Awareness is the skill used for spontaneous perception, whereas Investigation is the skill used for directed search and research.

The GM might call for an Awareness check when:

- ... a character fears an ambush
- ... a character must find their way in a place they've not been to before
- ... a character is attempting to spot a hidden individual or item
- ... a character is attempting to evaluate whether a narrative is plausible

Sample Awareness difficulties:

- Detecting the approach of a large vehicle: 2
- Spotting an acquaintance in a crowded pub: 3
- Finding your way around a maze: 4
- Noticing a well-laid ambush: 5
- Detecting that you are being followed by someone in thermal camo: 8

Deceive (U; INT + PRS)

The Deceive skill measures a character's ability to mislead others. Characters with a high rating in Deceive are adept at strategically omitting information, convincing others of half-truths and untruths, and pretending to be who they are not.

The GM may call for a Deceive check when:

- ... a character attempts to pass themselves off as someone else or mislead another as to their motives
- ... a character wishes to tell a story from which they are omitting crucial details
- ... a character is trying to bluff their hand at a game of cards

A Deceive check is usually opposed by the victim's Eerie or Awareness. Both parties might receive modifiers to their checks based on the outrageousness of the attempted fib and the pre-existing relationship between them.

Opposing a Deceive Check

Two skills can oppose Deceive: Awareness and Eerie. Awareness can help a character notice logical errors or factual inconsistencies, while Eerie acts to allow another to sense the Deceive user's intentions.

If the defender has no reason to mistrust the Deceive user, they might be able to detect the Deceive user's unfriendly motives with their passive Eerie skill. Alternatively, if they are somewhat well-informed about the facts in question, they might be able to notice that something is being misrepresented using their Awareness. In general, if the victim is well-disposed toward the Deceive user, the GM should use the lower of those two numbers. If the victim is already suspicious, the GM should use the higher of the two numbers.

Sample Deceive Difficulties

- Lie to a suspicious mortal: 2
- Successfully pass yourself off as a locally known figure: 4
- Bluff a table of professional card-players: 6
- Successfully pass yourself off as an intimate acquaintance of your interlocutor: 8
- Lie to an extremely adept psychic: 11

Eerie (U; SGT + ATT)

The Eerie skill represents a character's aptitude for sensing things not entirely amenable to mundane senses. This includes the presence of magical or otherworldly energies as well as the motivations of an interlocutor.

Detect Magic

You can make an Eerie check to determine the presence of magical energy. The difficulty of such a check varies with the intensity of the magical energy as well as whether any attempts were made to hide its presence.

Sense Motive

You can make an Eerie check in order to discern the intentions of another by sensing their aura. A successful Eerie check to sense motive allows you to divine whether your interlocutor is lying or speaking the truth, and whether he is well- or ill-disposed towards you. Eerie checks to sense motive are opposed by the target's Deceive.

Detect Danger

A character with a high Eerie rating may feel a sense of impending doom when about to confront a significant danger. Characters may roll Eerie to attempt to sense danger; the difficulty to detect danger is 12 - the threat's level.

For significant threats, the GM may opt to compare the threat's level against characters' passive Eerie, even if the characters do not explicitly make a check.

Sample Eerie difficulties:

- Detect the presence of powerful magic: 2
- Detect a malicious lie: 3
- Detect the presence of subdued magic: 5
- Detect the presence of very well-disguised magic: 8
- Detect a lie from an extremely adept manipulator: 9

Impose (U; PRS + WIL)

The Impose skill measures a character's ability to impress another. It can be used to browbeat, intimidate or otherwise overpower another in a test of wills. It also serves as the skill governing a character's ability to captivate and win over others.

The GM might call for an impose check when:

- ... a character gives an impassioned speech
- ... a character wishes to force another to do their bidding
- ... a character is interrogating another and pressures them to reveal information

Sample Impose difficulties:

- Browbeating a hapless mortal: 2
- Winning over a neutral crowd: 4
- Winning over a hostile crowd: 7
- Blackmailing a powerful immortal: 9

Influence (U; INT + PRS)

The influence skill measures a character's proficiency at the subtler arts of social conduct. Negotiation, diplomacy, manipulation – everything requiring a good sense of decorum, tact, and charisma.

The GM might call for an Influence check when:

- ... a character is attempting to negotiate the price of goods or services
- ... a character is arguing a legal case
- ... a character is attempting to establish friendly relations with an important figure

Sample influence difficulties:

- Haggling down an inexperienced seller: 2
- Securing a favor from an important figure: 4
- Arguing an extremely difficult case in court: 7
- Negotiating a ceasefire between two Immortal Orders: 9

Investigate (U; INT + PER)

The investigate skill allows a character to research, collate and correlate information. It is the skill used for searching through dusty tomes for clues as to the whereabouts of a long-lost temple, making sense of an archaic electronic records system, or poring over ledgers in search of a specific transaction. It is also the skill used for cultivating informants within a city, tracking the movements of a target, and distilling actionable intelligence from diverse sources.

A specialized use of the skill is to attempt to recall information that a character might have accidentally come by in their previous information-gathering efforts. The more widely read and traveled a character is, after all, the more likely it is they might have seen something before.

Checks

Research Documents: A character can use the Investigate skill to attempt to find information in documents of some kind, be they books in a library or entries in an electronic database. The difficulty of doing so is generally related to how concretely the information the character is looking for is available within the documents, if at all.

Sample Research difficulties:

- Information is somewhat obscure: 2
- Information is very obscure and requires specialist knowledge to understand and extract: 4
- Information is highly arcane and requires intricate knowledge to extract: 6
- Information has been deliberately suppressed and must be reconstructed from traces: 8
- Character does not entirely know what they are looking for: +3
- Information must be gathered from several different information stores: +2

Develop and Use Contacts: A character can use the Investigate skill to research and identify useful people to know. Once they have built a relationship with such people (a matter for the Influence skill) they can use Investigate to attempt to use their network to obtain information. Such information can include dirt on a person of interest, information on the markets in a city or area, as well as, of course, introductions to people in other areas.

Sample Contacts difficulties:

- Obtain insight into the goings-on within a city: 2
- Gain information on the schedule and whereabouts of a public figure: 4
- Gain information on the schedule and whereabouts of a highly secretive person: 6
- Obtain insight into the secret agendas of Immortal factions: 8

The GM may, at their discretion, call for an Influence check alongside the Investigate check when the character attempts to call in favors. The results of that Influence check decide how the character's actions affect their ability to use Investigate in this fashion in the future.

Search for Tracks: A character can use the Investigate skill to analyze a scene, looking for any traces and tracks left behind by others. They can also use this skill to track down a creature and attempt to follow it or surmise its whereabouts.

Sample Tracks difficulties:

- Tracking an animal in unfavorable conditions: 2
- Tracking a Mist Creature in unfavorable conditions: 4
- Tracking a human in a city: 6
- Discovering the route taken by someone through a town a week before: 8
- Tracking down a professional deploying countermeasures in a city: 11

Subterfuge (U; DEX + INT)

The Subterfuge skill allows a character to move quietly and avoid detection, as well as perform feats of sleight of hand, such as pickpocketing or unseen manipulation of objects. The difficulty of a Subterfuge check generally depends on the scrutiny placed upon a character. Forging a document that nobody will pay too close attention to while nobody is watching is a much easier feat than sneaking through a fortress equipped with CCTV in order to lift an artifact from a heavily guarded vault.

Subterfuge is generally opposed by Awareness, but can be opposed by Investigate (where the objective of the Subterfuge check is to conceal, destroy, or alter evidence or records). If a Subterfuge check is being made to evade automated or magical countermeasures, the GM sets the difficulty of that check as a function of the sophistication of these devices.

Checks

Hide and Sneak: A character may use Subterfuge to move around undetected. As a special case of this use of the Subterfuge skill, a character may also attempt to lose pursuers. Making such a check requires that the character have concealment from any hostile creatures or countermeasures. If a character is being pursued and wishes to evade their pursuers, they must find a hiding place.

The sensory spectrum of the threat determines whether a character counts as having concealment; see **Senses** for more.

Sample Sneak difficulties:

- Evade a simple CCTV system: 2
- Evade the attention of professional guards equipped with night vision or IR goggles: 4
- Slip through the cracks of a magical intrusion detection system: 6

- Infiltrate a facility protected by multiple redundant high-power surveillance systems: 8
- Lose a highly skilled pursuer equipped with multi-spectrum sensorics: 10

Sleight of Hand: A character may use the Subterfuge skill to perform a sleight of hand. This includes pickpocketing, planting an item on another, concealing the presence of an item (such as a weapon) on themselves under search, or cheating at card games.

Sample Sleight of Hand difficulties:

- Perform a simple magic trick: 2
- Steal a small item from an observant victim: 4
- Conceal an item on someone conversing with you without them noticing: 6
- Smuggle a weapon past a high-security checkpoint: 8

Forgery: A character may use the Subterfuge skill to alter, replace or falsify physical documents or evidence. Making such a check is a protracted affair, and requires the character to manufacture the forgery ahead of time or, if it is possible to perform the manipulation on site, bring the appropriate tooling with them. If the item to be forged is particularly difficult to manufacture, the character might need to make an appropriate crafting check or, if they do not have the requisite training in the skill required, find someone who can help them.

Sample Forgery difficulties:

- Manipulate an invoice or other unsecured document: 2
- Forge a watermarked or holo-secured document: 4
- Duplicate a well-known piece of art: 6
- Forge a cryptographic access token: 8

Trained Skills

Access (T; DEX + INT)

The Access skill allows a character to circumvent security systems of various kinds, using more or less violent means. With sufficient training, a character trained in Access can pick locks, hack into computers, place breaching charges, disable traps, and generally go where they are not supposed to go.

The Access skill is by nature somewhat interdisciplinary, and proficiency in skills such as Subterfuge, Electronics or Shop is helpful when using it.

Checks

Lockpicking: The Access skill can be used to bypass locks of all kinds. Effectively using the skill in this way requires a set of appropriate tools for the job at hand (for which see the Equipment chapter). While better tools usually lead to better results, even improvised tools have to do sometimes. In this case, raise the difficulty of the job by 2.

A character who has no tools whatsoever on them may be unable to bypass a lock regardless of how well they roll on their check, at the GM's discretion.

Sample Lockpicking difficulties:

- Picking a well-made lock with improvised tools: 4
- Picking a high-security lock: 6
- Bypassing a multi-modal access control system: 8
- Bypassing a magically reinforced, mastercrafted multi-lock: 10

Hotwiring and Hacking: The Access skill can be used to manipulate electric and electronic systems of all kinds, whether by crude bypasses or more subtle methods. When attempting more sophisticated attacks, especially against computer systems, the GM may rule that a successful Electronics check is also required to subdue the recalcitrant machine.

Sample Hacking difficulties:

- Hotwiring a simple motor or electronic lock: 2
- Gaining unauthorized access to a simply secured computer system: 4
- Performing a privilege escalation attack on a well-secured computer system: 6
- Mechanically suborning an AI core: 10

Traps: A character trained in the Access skill can detect and disable traps. The difficulties for doing so are similar to lockpicking.

Alchemy (T; INT + PER)

The alchemy skill allows a character to study, analyze and perform chemical reactions in or outside of the presence of magical energies. Successfully using the Alchemy skill requires having access to the appropriate equipment for the job at hand; even the most experienced alchemist cannot work without a laboratory.

Proficiency in Occultism and Eerie is helpful when working with magically charged substances, while Shop assists in crafting and modifying alchemical equipment and containers.

Checks

Analyzing Substances: A character trained in Alchemy can use their skills to analyze substances and detect certain components or alchemical-magical properties within them. The difficulty of doing so depends on the number of distinct components making up the substance as well as the number and concentration of components to be detected.

Sample Analyzing difficulties:

- Identify whether a common substance has been tampered with: 2
- Identify the active components of an unfamiliar compound: 4
- Detect trace quantities of a rare reagent within a complex mixture: 6
- Fully analyze an unknown substance of extraplanar or magical origin: 8

Synthesizing Substances: A character can use their Alchemy skill to perform alchemical procedures — combining, refining, and transforming materials to produce compounds with specific properties. This subsumes everything from distilling poisons to crafting alchemical reagents for use in rituals.

When synthesizing a known recipe, the difficulty is set by the recipe itself. When working without a recipe — improvising or experimenting — the GM sets a difficulty appropriate to the desired effect and the character's available materials.

Consumable reagents and equipment are spent whether or not the synthesis succeeds.

Sample Synthesizing difficulties:

- Brew a simple stimulant or sedative from common materials: 3
- Prepare a ritual reagent of moderate power: 5
- Synthesize a compound with precisely calibrated alchemical-magical properties: 7
- Produce a substance of legendary potency or unprecedented effect: 10

Alchemical Rituals: When performing an alchemical recipe, Alchemy is the only applicable skill — Ritual and Occultism do not apply (see *Rituals and Recipes*).

Electronics (T; DEX + INT)

The Electronics skill covers the hands-on diagnosis, repair, modification, and construction of electronic devices and systems — from simple motors and locks to computing hardware and AI subsystems. It is the skill of the engineer and the scrapper alike.

Access is the natural complement when the goal is bypassing or subverting a system rather than understanding it; Magitek applies where magical and electronic systems are intertwined; Investigate can assist when researching technical documentation or an unfamiliar device's design.

Checks

Repair & Maintenance: A character trained in Electronics can diagnose malfunctions and restore damaged or broken devices to working order. The difficulty depends on the complexity of the device and the severity of the damage.

Sample Repair difficulties:

- Fix a common appliance or simple motor: 2
- Restore a damaged circuit board or control system: 4
- Bring a sophisticated computing system back online after catastrophic failure: 6
- Reconstruct a destroyed AI subsystem from salvaged components: 8

Modification & Construction: A character can use Electronics to alter existing devices or build new ones from salvaged or raw parts. When building something with no reference design, the GM may require a prior Investigate or Magitek check to establish the specifications.

Sample Modification & Construction difficulties:

- Jury-rig a simple bypass or adapter: 2
- Build a functional device from salvaged parts: 4
- Modify military-grade hardware for unauthorized use: 6
- Construct a novel electronic component with no reference design: 8

Assisted Hacking: When using the Access skill to attack sophisticated computer systems, the GM may additionally call for an Electronics check to manipulate the underlying hardware — particularly when physical access to the machine is available.

Magitek (T; INT + ATT)

The Magitek skill covers understanding, operating, and working with technology that incorporates magical components or principles — the ancient relics, enchanted machinery, and hybrid devices that populate a world where magic and technology were once unified.

Electronics handles the non-magical circuitry within a magitek device; Eerie can supplement Magitek when sensing a device's magical state or charge; Alchemy and Ritual are relevant when a magitek device's function overlaps with alchemical or ritual processes.

Checks

Identifying Magitek: A character trained in Magitek can examine an unknown device to determine its function, origin, and magical properties. The difficulty depends on the complexity of the device and how much information is being sought.

Sample Identifying difficulties:

- Identify the function of a simple magitek tool: 2
- Determine the magical properties of an unfamiliar device: 4
- Analyze a magitek device of ancient or unknown design: 6
- Reverse-engineer a unique magitek artifact: 8

Operating Magitek: Using a familiar magitek device does not require a check. Checks arise when the device is unfamiliar, damaged, unstable, or actively resisting the user — or when the character is attempting to use it in a way it was not designed for.

Sample Operating difficulties:

- Operate an unfamiliar but standard magitek device: 2
- Safely activate an unstable or partially damaged device: 4
- Override a device's magical safeguards: 6
- Operate a device fundamentally hostile or incompatible with the user: 8

Repair & Modification: A character can use Magitek to restore damaged devices or alter their function, including re-seating magical cores and recalibrating enchantments. Electronics may be required alongside Magitek when the damage extends to non-magical components.

Sample Repair & Modification difficulties:

- Repair a lightly damaged magitek device: 3
- Restore a device with a damaged magical core: 5
- Modify a device to function outside its intended parameters: 7
- Integrate two incompatible magical systems within a single device: 9

Crafting Magitek: A character with sufficient expertise can attempt to create new magitek devices. Magitek provides the overall design and integration of magical and technical systems, but is rarely sufficient on its own: crafting the physical components typically requires Shop, the electronic elements require Electronics, and the magical workings require Ritual or Occultism. Substantial facilities are also required — improvised or field-expedient construction raises difficulties significantly, and some projects may be impossible without a proper workshop.

Occultism (T; SGT + ATT)

Where Ritual treats magic as a natural force to be studied and reproduced, Occultism is the practice of engaging with forces that resist systematic understanding: spirits, divine powers, and the deeper currents of Fate and the Void. The effects it produces can be profound, but the forces involved are capricious — failure is not merely a lack of result, and a catastrophic failure may invite consequences far beyond what the caster intended.

Occultism is primarily the skill of Divine magic, and applies to Psychic magic of an esoteric or entropic nature, such as the Fate and Void domains. Eerie is a natural complement, helping a character sense and interpret the presences they are dealing with. Ritual, by contrast, is not interchangeable with Occultism — the two approaches are fundamentally different in method.

Checks

Identifying Supernatural Entities: A character trained in Occultism can attempt to recognize the nature, origin, and intent of a spirit or divine presence. This typically precedes any attempt to commune with or bind it.

Sample Identifying difficulties:

- Identify the broad category of a supernatural presence (spirit, divine fragment, etc.): 2
- Determine the domain or allegiance of a known type of entity: 4
- Assess the disposition and intent of an unfamiliar entity: 5
- Identify a rare, concealed, or actively deceptive supernatural presence: 8

Communing: A character can use Occultism to contact or negotiate with a spirit or divine force. Unlike ritual casting, the outcome of a communion is not guaranteed even on a success — the entity retains its own will. On a failure, the entity may ignore the character, respond with hostility, or extract a price of its own choosing.

Divination: A character trained in Occultism can petition the forces of Fate or Void for glimpses of the past, present, or future. The specificity and reliability of the vision depends on the difficulty; Fate can be consulted but not commanded.

Sample Divination difficulties:

- Seek a broad impression of a past event: 3
- Seek a clear image of a specific past event: 5
- Request a vision of a probable future: 6
- Seek precise knowledge of a hidden or deliberately obscured truth: 9

Warding & Binding: A character can use Occultism to ward a location against supernatural intrusion or to bind a spirit, constraining its actions. The difficulty depends on the power of the entity and the scope of the constraint.

Sample Warding & Binding difficulties:

- Ward a small space against minor spirits: 3
- Bind a willing or weakened entity: 4
- Ward against a powerful or persistent supernatural presence: 6
- Bind an unwilling and powerful entity: 9

Casting Rituals: Occultism may be used in place of Ritual for the casting of rituals that draw on Divine or esoteric Psychic magic, such as those of the Fate and Void domains. All other rules for ritual casting apply (see *Rituals and Recipes*). Unlike ritual casting with the Ritual skill, a failed check using Occultism may produce unintended consequences beyond the loss of reagents.

Piloting (T; DEX + PER)

The Piloting skill covers the operation of vehicles of all kinds — ground vehicles, aircraft, and watercraft alike. A trained pilot can push a vehicle to its limits, navigate hostile conditions, and fight from behind the wheel or controls. Routine travel under safe conditions does not require a check; rolls arise when speed, hazards, or hostile action demand precise control.

Electronics and Magitek are useful when diagnosing or improvising repairs to a vehicle's systems while in motion.

Checks

Hazardous Navigation: A character can use Piloting to traverse difficult terrain, severe weather, or complex environments at speed. The difficulty depends on the combination of speed, conditions, and the demands of the route.

Sample Navigation difficulties:

- Navigate a damaged road or choppy water at speed: 2
- Pilot through dense terrain, storm conditions, or heavy traffic: 4
- Thread through a collapsing structure or tight urban canyon at speed: 6
- Pilot a badly damaged vehicle through extreme or rapidly changing conditions: 8

Pursuit & Evasion: When one vehicle is chasing or fleeing another, both pilots make opposed Piloting checks. The victor gains or maintains positional advantage. The GM may call for multiple checks over the course of a prolonged chase, with environmental hazards adding to the difficulty.

Combat Maneuvers: A character can use Piloting to perform aggressive or evasive maneuvers in a fight — ramming a target, breaking away from a pursuer, or positioning to give allies a firing advantage. These are typically opposed checks or checks against a fixed difficulty set by the GM based on the target's speed and maneuverability.

Sample Combat Maneuver difficulties:

- Ram a stationary or slow-moving target: 2
- Execute a precise intercept or blocking maneuver: 4
- Perform a high-speed attack run through hostile fire: 6
- Execute a maneuver against a vastly more agile vehicle: 8

Ritual (T; WIL + ATT)

The Ritual skill represents a character's command of magic as a natural, learnable force. Ritual magic is systematic and reproducible — its effects are well-scoped and knowable, and a sufficiently skilled practitioner can analyze an unfamiliar working and reverse-engineer it almost like a piece of technology. Ritual is primarily the skill of Arcane magic, and applies to Psychic magic of a structural or physical nature, such as the Space and Time domains.

Where Ritual treats magic as a force to be understood and controlled, Occultism deals with the ineffable: spirits, divine powers, and forces that do not follow predictable rules. Characters trained in Eerie may find it easier to sense the presence and nature of active ritual effects.

Note that alchemical recipes, while mechanically similar to rituals, use the Alchemy skill exclusively — Ritual does not apply to them (see *Rituals and Recipes*).

Checks

Casting Rituals: The primary use of the Ritual skill is the casting of rituals, for which see the full rules in *Rituals and Recipes*. Ritual applies to any non-alchemical ritual that draws on Arcane or structurally-oriented Psychic magic.

Because ritual magic is well-understood and bounded, a failed Ritual check typically results in nothing happening and the consumption of reagents — not in uncontrolled or catastrophic effects.

Identifying & Reading Magic: A character trained in Ritual can examine an active magical effect, a ritual circle, or an arcane inscription and attempt to understand what it does. The difficulty depends on the complexity of the working and how well it has been obscured.

Sample Identifying difficulties:

- Identify the school or broad domain of an active magical effect: 2
- Determine the function and approximate power of a ritual circle: 4
- Fully analyze a complex or layered arcane working: 6
- Decode a deliberately obfuscated or alien magical inscription: 8

Shop (T; DEX + STR)

The Shop skill covers the creation, repair, and modification of physical objects — from welding and machining to woodworking, leatherworking, and general fabrication. DEX provides the precision for fine work; STR handles the heavy labour of raw construction. A character trained in Shop is equally at home in a forge or a field workshop, and can turn salvaged materials into functional equipment given enough time and tools.

Electronics and Magitek are natural complements when working on devices with technical or magical components; Access benefits from Shop when physical bypass work — cutting, breaking, or fabricating parts — is required.

Checks

Repair: A character can use Shop to restore damaged or broken physical items to working order. The difficulty depends on the severity of the damage and the complexity of the object.

Sample Repair difficulties:

- Repair a simple tool or piece of equipment: 2
- Restore a damaged weapon or piece of armour: 4
- Rebuild a complex mechanical device from partial components: 6
- Reconstruct a badly damaged or intricate item with missing parts: 8

Fabrication: A character can use Shop to create new items from raw or salvaged materials. Working from known plans or patterns reduces the difficulty; improvising a design or working without proper tools increases it.

Sample Fabrication difficulties:

- Fabricate a simple tool or fitting: 2
- Craft a functional weapon or piece of armour: 4
- Construct a complex mechanical assembly: 6
- Produce a masterwork item requiring exceptional skill and materials: 9

Appraisal: A character trained in Shop can assess the quality, provenance, and condition of physical objects. This covers identifying fine craftsmanship, detecting structural flaws, and recognizing forgeries or unusual construction techniques.

Sample Appraisal difficulties:

- Assess the general quality of a common item: 2
- Identify a notable flaw or point of weakness in a well-made object: 4
- Determine the origin or maker of an unusual or deliberately disguised item: 6
- Detect a masterfully executed forgery: 8

Rituals and Recipes

In the mystical realms of Ashen, the casting of rituals is an intricate and powerful art. To bring forth the desired magical effects, players must navigate the complexities of difficulty, magnitude, and available power. Alchemical recipes function as rituals do, so for the purposes of the following rules, "rituals" includes them.

The rules for rituals are as follows:

1. Difficulty and Magnitude

A ritual is defined by two essential factors: difficulty and magnitude.

Difficulty: This represents the base challenge level of the ritual, reflecting the innate complexity of the magical task at hand.

Magnitude: The magnitude sets the minimum total power value required to successfully cast the ritual. Players can harness power from various sources, including reagents, implements, locations, or unique circumstances like magical terrain or alchemical laboratories.

2. Power Management

Every point of available power beyond the ritual's magnitude is a boon to the caster. Surplus power can be derived from a variety of sources and contributes to making the ritual easier.

Power Sources: Reagents, implements, locations, and circumstantial factors all contribute to the available power pool.

Difficulty Reduction: For each point of available power exceeding the ritual's magnitude, the difficulty of the ritual is reduced by 1, down to the tier of the ritual.

3. Skill Checks

Executing a ritual requires a careful balance of knowledge, skill, and finesse. Players can employ one of the following skills for the ritual's casting: Ritual, Occultism, or Alchemy. The appropriate skill depends on the nature of the ritual.

4. Casting and Success Conditions

Success hinges on the outcome of a skill check against the adjusted difficulty.

Success: If the result of the check equals or exceeds the adjusted difficulty, the ritual is successful. The desired magical effects manifest as intended.

Failure: Should the skill check fall short, the ritual fails. Despite the failure, consumable power sources like reagents are still expended. Depending on the ritual, there may be additional consequences.

5. Consequences of Failure

Failing a ritual doesn't come without repercussions. In addition to the consumption of consumables, other consequences may unfold, varying based on the specific nature of the ritual. Players should be prepared for the unexpected in the arcane arts.

Ritual List

RITE OF OPENING — RITUAL 1

KEY

With the final twist of your implement, you open a path to your destination.

Skill: Ritual, *Difficulty*: 3, *Magnitude*: 3, *Casting Time*: 5 minutes

Modifiers:

- Target guarded by magical barriers: +(tier of barrier) per barrier.
- Target behind rock or earth: +2 per meter.
- Target behind steel: +2 per 10 cm.
- Target known to within <10 m accuracy: +2.
- Target known to within <50 m: +5.
- Target >30 m away: +1 per 10 m.

Effect The Rite of Opening creates a physical path between you and a location of your choosing whose approximate whereabouts are known to you. The Rite

is potentially destructive but never creative: it can tear down barriers, but it cannot construct bridges. When opening artificial obstacles like locked doors, the rite may open simple obstacles non-destructively, but may simply unhinge a door equipped with a complex magical lock. It can burrow or blast through natural barriers that are sufficiently thin.

WARD OF ALARM — RITUAL 1

CROWN

Skill: Ritual, *Difficulty*: 3, *Magnitude*: 2, *Casting Time*: 10 minutes

Effect You inscribe a ward on a doorway, window, or area up to Burst 3. For the next 8 hours, if any creature of size 1 or larger crosses the ward, the caster is immediately alerted, even if asleep. The alert is mental and silent — only the caster perceives it. The ward is invisible but can be detected with Eerie (difficulty 4).
Failure The ward is created but is unstable — it triggers once randomly during the duration, then fails.

ARCANE LOCK — RITUAL 2

CROWN

Skill: Ritual, *Difficulty*: 5, *Magnitude*: 4, *Casting Time*: 10 minutes

Effect You seal a door, chest, window, or other closeable object with arcane energy. The lock can only be opened by the caster, by a creature they designate during casting, or by a successful Rite of Opening or Magitek check against a difficulty equal to the caster's casting check result. The lock persists until dispelled or broken.
Failure The lock is created but is brittle — its effective difficulty is halved.

CIRCLE OF BINDING — RITUAL 3

CROWN MIST

Skill: Ritual, *Difficulty*: 7, *Magnitude*: 6, *Casting Time*: 30 minutes

Effect You inscribe a circle of binding on a surface up to 3 squares in diameter. Any summoned, extraplanar, or undead creature that enters or is summoned into the circle cannot leave it by any means (including teleportation) unless the circle is physically broken or the creature succeeds on a D8 Potential check at the start of each of its turns. The circle persists for 24 hours or until broken.
Failure The circle appears complete but has a hidden flaw. The first creature bound in it may attempt to escape with a D4 Potential check instead.

PLANAR GATE — RITUAL 5

KEY MIST

Skill: Ritual, *Difficulty*: 12, *Magnitude*: 11, *Casting Time*: 8 hours

Effect You tear open a portal to another plane of existence. The portal is a circle up to 3 squares in diameter and remains open for 1 minute per success on the casting check. Creatures can pass through in both directions. The caster may close the portal early as a free action. The destination must be a plane the caster has visited or possesses a fragment of (a physical object originating from that plane).
Failure The portal opens to an unintended location on the target plane, or to the wrong plane entirely. The caster takes an additional 5 Strain.

RESURRECTION RITE — RITUAL 5

SCARAB

Skill: Ritual, *Difficulty*: 11, *Magnitude*: 10, *Casting Time*: 12 hours

Effect You perform a lengthy rite that revives all dead creatures within the ritual circle at no EP cost to them. Each revived creature returns with full HP and full Focus, with all status conditions removed. This ritual can revive creatures whose remains have been destroyed, as long as a personal belonging or fragment of the creature is available as a focus. Uniquely, this ritual can also restore mortal creatures to life — an effect not otherwise available through any power or prayer. The ritual cannot revive creatures affected by effects that prevent revival (such as Noble Eightfold Blade's death effect).
Failure The ritual fails. Components are consumed. Creatures remain dead. If the check fails by 5 or more, a hostile entity may be drawn to the ritual site.

Enchantment Rituals

The following rituals apply enchantments to items (see *Enchantments* in the Equipment chapter). In each case, the listed difficulty is the base; half the tier of the target item (rounded up) is added to the difficulty. For example, applying Moontouched (base difficulty 3) to a tier 5 weapon requires a difficulty 6 check. If the item already has an enchantment in the slot being used, replacing it increases the difficulty by 2.

ENCHANT WEAPON — MOONTOUCHED — RITUAL 2

MIST MOON

Skill: Ritual, *Difficulty*: 3 + half item tier, *Magnitude*: 4, *Casting Time*: 4 hours
Sacrifice: Components (moonstone dust or similar lunar reagent)

Effect You imbue a weapon with captured moonlight. On a successful hit, the target is surrounded by a halo of moonlight: attacks against it gain a +2 bonus and it cannot benefit from invisibility until the end of the wielder's next turn.
Failure The enchantment is unstable — it functions normally but fades after 1d6 encounters.

ENCHANT WEAPON — SPACERENDER — RITUAL 3

MIST KEY

Skill: Ritual, *Difficulty*: 5 + half item tier, *Magnitude*: 6, *Casting Time*: 8 hours
Sacrifice: Components (void essence or spatial reagent)

Effect You fold the space around a melee weapon, extending its effective reach. The weapon gains Reach 2.

Failure The spatial fold is unstable. The weapon gains Reach 2, but on any attack roll where no successes are scored, the enchantment collapses and must be reapplied.

ENCHANT ARMOR — LIGHTBENDER RITUAL 2

MIST MOON

Skill: Ritual, *Difficulty*: 3 + half item tier, *Magnitude*: 4, *Casting Time*: 4 hours
Sacrifice: Components (prismatic glass or light-aspected reagent)

Effect You treat a piece of armor to bend light around its wearer. When the wearer is fighting in bright light, the armor's Evasion bonus increases by 1.
Failure The treatment is imprecise — the Evasion bonus applies, but the armor glows faintly, imposing a -2d penalty on Subterfuge checks in darkness.

ENCHANT ARMOR — DEFLECTING RITUAL 3

MIST CROWN

Skill: Ritual, *Difficulty*: 5 + half item tier, *Magnitude*: 6, *Casting Time*: 6 hours
Sacrifice: Components (warding sigils or abjuration reagent)

Effect You inscribe magical deflection patterns onto a piece of armor. When the wearer is targeted by an area-effect spell or magical ability, the armor grants light cover against that effect.
Failure The sigils are flawed — the deflection works, but each time it activates there is a 1-in-6 chance the sigils burn out permanently.

ENCHANT IMPLEMENT — RESONATING RITUAL 4

MIST

Skill: Ritual, *Difficulty*: 7 + half item tier, *Magnitude*: 8, *Casting Time*: 12 hours
Sacrifice: Components (harmonic crystal or resonance reagent)

Effect You attune a catalyst or weapon to resonate with the caster's magical frequency. For every spell channeled through the implement on a given turn, its casting bonuses increase by 1, up to a maximum of its base bonus + 3.
Failure The resonance is erratic — the bonus increases as normal but resets to 0 at the start of each round instead of persisting.

ENCHANT IMPLEMENT — MANABIND RITUAL 5

MIST

Skill: Ritual, *Difficulty*: 9 + half item tier, *Magnitude*: 10, *Casting Time*: 1 day

Effect You bind an implement with counter-magical properties. The implement grants a +6 bonus to counterspelling. If used to perform a successful counterspell, the wielder recovers Focus equal to the cost of the countered spell.
Failure The binding is incomplete — the counterspell bonus is only +3, and Focus recovery is halved (round down).

Occultism Ritual List

AUGURY RITUAL 1

MOON

Skill: Occultism, *Difficulty*: 4, *Magnitude*: 2, *Casting Time*: 10 minutes

Effect You perform a divination to glimpse the near future. Ask the GM one question about a specific course of action you plan to take within the next hour. The GM answers with one of: Weal (good outcome), Woe (bad outcome), Weal and Woe (mixed), or Nothing (no significant consequence). The GM is not required to reveal details — only the general tenor of the outcome.
Failure The augury gives a misleading answer (GM's choice).

SCRYING RITUAL 3

MOON

Skill: Occultism, *Difficulty*: 7, *Magnitude*: 6, *Casting Time*: 30 minutes
Modifiers:

- Target possesses anti-scrying wards: +(tier of ward).
- Target is on another plane: +4.
- You possess a piece of the target (hair, belonging): -2.

Effect You observe a creature or location remotely. You must have either met the target creature, visited the target location, or possess an object closely associated with either. On success, you perceive the target's immediate surroundings (sight and sound) for up to 10 minutes. The target may sense the scrying with a D6 Potential check — on success, they know they are being observed and by whom.
Failure The scrying fails and the target is automatically alerted to the attempt.

COMMUNE RITUAL 4

MOON

Skill: Occultism, *Difficulty*: 10, *Magnitude*: 9, *Casting Time*: 2 hours
Sacrifice: Essence (3 EP)

Effect You open a channel of communication with an otherworldly entity — a god, a powerful spirit, or an echo of a dead deity. You may ask up to three questions, which the entity answers truthfully but not necessarily completely. The entity may demand a price for its knowledge (additional Essence, a future favor, or information in return). The nature of the entity contacted depends on the circumstances and location of the ritual.
Failure The channel opens but connects to an unintended entity. The entity may lie, demand payment, or be hostile.

FATE UNRAVELING RITUAL 6

MOON SKULL

Skill: Occultism, *Difficulty*: 14, *Magnitude*: 14, *Casting Time*: 1 day
Sacrifice: Essence (10 EP) + Influence (major Skull, major Moon)

Effect You unravel the threads of fate surrounding one subject — a person, an object, an event, or a place. The GM reveals the complete truth about the subject: its history, its current state, its connections, and its most likely future. This information is absolute and cannot be obscured by any magic short of divine intervention. The caster experiences the revelation as a trance-vision lasting several hours.
Failure The revelation is partial and fragmented. The caster takes the full Strain and Influence cost. The caster is Dazed for 24 hours from the psychic backlash.

Occultism Enchantment Rituals

As with the Ritual enchantments above, half the tier of the target item (rounded up) is added to the base difficulty. Replacing an existing enchantment increases the difficulty by 2.

ENCHANT WEAPON — BLOODTHIRST RITUAL 2

MIST MOON

Skill: Occultism, *Difficulty*: 3 + half item tier, *Magnitude*: 4, *Casting Time*: 4 hours
Sacrifice: Components (fresh blood of a predatory creature)

Effect You awaken a hunger for blood in a weapon. If the weapon successfully deals damage to a living target, the wielder gains a +2 bonus to the next attack with the weapon.
Failure The hunger is indiscriminate — the bonus applies, but the wielder must also make a D4 Grit check after each combat or attack the nearest living creature (friend or foe) once.

ENCHANT WEAPON — CURSEBRINGER RITUAL 4

MIST SKULL

Skill: Occultism, *Difficulty*: 7 + half item tier, *Magnitude*: 8, *Casting Time*: 12 hours
Sacrifice: Components (cursed relic or hexed remains) + Essence (2 EP)

Effect You bind a malevolent curse into a weapon. On a successful hit that deals damage, the target must make a Potential save at difficulty equal to the weapon's tier + 2. On failure, the target takes a -2 curse penalty to all of its rolls (save ends).
Failure The curse is bound but unstable — it functions normally, but each time it activates, the wielder takes 1 Strain.

ENCHANT WEAPON — SOULDRINKER RITUAL 4

SKULL

Skill: Occultism, *Difficulty*: 7 + half item tier, *Magnitude*: 8, *Casting Time*: 12 hours
Sacrifice: Components (soul gem or essence of the dying) + Essence (3 EP)

Effect You bind the weapon with soul-draining properties. On a successful hit that deals damage, the target must make a Potential save at difficulty equal to the weapon's tier + 2. On failure, the target loses 1 EP and Focus equal to 3 × the weapon's tier.
Failure The drain is reversed — on a failed save, the target loses the EP and Focus as normal, but the wielder also loses Focus equal to the weapon's tier.

Alchemical Recipe List

HEALING POTION RITUAL 1

Skill: Alchemy, *Difficulty*: 3, *Magnitude*: 2, *Casting Time*: 10 minutes

Effect You brew a potion that restores HP equal to 100% of the catalyst used in its creation. The potion can be consumed as a 1 AP action. Potions expire after one week.
Failure The potion is inert — it has no effect but is otherwise harmless.

ANTIDOTE RITUAL 1

Skill: Alchemy, *Difficulty*: 3, *Magnitude*: 2, *Casting Time*: 10 minutes

Effect You brew a potion that removes the Poisoned condition from the drinker. If the poison is of a tier higher than this recipe's tier, the difficulty increases by 2 per tier difference. The antidote can be consumed as a 1 AP action.
Failure The antidote is ineffective.

STIMULANT DRAFT RITUAL 2

Skill: Alchemy, *Difficulty*: 5, *Magnitude*: 4, *Casting Time*: 20 minutes

Effect You brew a stimulant that sharpens the drinker's abilities. When consumed (1 AP action), the drinker chooses one skill. They gain +2d on checks with that skill for 1 hour. A creature cannot benefit from more than one stimulant at a time; consuming a second replaces the first.
Failure The stimulant works but inflicts a -1d penalty on all other skills for its duration.

WEAPON OIL RITUAL 2

Skill: Alchemy, *Difficulty*: 5, *Magnitude*: 4, *Casting Time*: 15 minutes

Effect You create an oil that can be applied to a weapon (1 AP action). The weapon gains a damage type of your choice (Thermal, Cold, Electric, or Acid) for 1 encounter. While active, the weapon's damage is treated as that type for the purposes of resistances and vulnerabilities. Only one oil can be active on a weapon at a time.
Failure The oil is unstable — it lasts only 3 rounds instead of 1 encounter.

PARALYTIC POISON RITUAL 3

Skill: Alchemy, *Difficulty*: 7, *Magnitude*: 6, *Casting Time*: 30 minutes

Effect You create a dose of paralytic poison (3 applications). The poison can be applied to a weapon (1 AP action) or slipped into food/drink. On the next hit (or when ingested), the target must pass a D6 Stamina check or be Stilled (save ends). Whether the save succeeds or fails, the application is consumed.
Failure The poison is weak — the resist DC is reduced to D4.

ELIXIR OF FORTITUDE — RITUAL 4

Skill: Alchemy, *Difficulty*: 9, *Magnitude*: 8, *Casting Time*: 1 hour

Effect You brew a powerful protective elixir. When consumed (1 AP action), the drinker gains +3 Armor and +3 Ward for 1 encounter. Additionally, the drinker gains +2d on Stamina resistance checks for the duration. A creature cannot benefit from more than one elixir at a time.
Failure The elixir provides only +1 Armor and +1 Ward, and its duration is halved.

PHILOSOPHER'S REAGENT — RITUAL 5

MIST SUN

Skill: Alchemy, *Difficulty*: 12, *Magnitude*: 10, *Casting Time*: 8 hours
Sacrifice: Essence (5 EP)

Effect You create a single universal reagent of extraordinary purity, worth 8 Magnitude for the purpose of any ritual. This exceeds the magnitude of any readily obtainable reagent (capped at 6 for standard materials). The Philosopher's Reagent does not expire and can provide any single aspect at up to magnitude 4 when used as Influence.
Failure The reagent is created but is flawed — it is worth only 5 Magnitude and cannot provide aspect Influence.

Alchemical Enchantment Recipes

SILVER A WEAPON — RITUAL 1

Skill: Alchemy, *Difficulty*: 2 + half item tier, *Magnitude*: 2, *Casting Time*: 2 hours
Sacrifice: Components (alchemical silver)

Effect You coat a weapon in alchemical silver through a chemical bonding process. The weapon gains the Silvered keyword: it bypasses immunity or resistance to non-silvered weapons, and deals bonus damage to undead creatures equal to 50% of its base damage. Silvering is permanent but can be stripped by re-treating the weapon with a different material. This recipe can alternatively be performed as a Shop check at the same difficulty.
Failure The silver coating is thin and uneven — it functions but wears off after 1d6 encounters.

Advances

What is an advance?

Advances represent unique skills and talents your character gains or remembers as they gain experience. They usually affect primarily a character's abilities in combat, although they may also have uses during exploration.

How to unlock advances

Advances are unlocked by spending experience points (XP) during downtime. To unlock an advance, you must meet its prerequisites (if any) and pay the XP cost listed in its entry. Once unlocked, an advance is permanent — you benefit from it for the rest of the campaign.

Characters gain XP from completing missions, overcoming challenges, and achieving story milestones, as determined by the GM.

Advance Lists

Arcane

SPELL MEMORY I — TIER 1 (150 XP)

ARCANE POWER

Prerequisites: None — 0 HP, 2 FP

You gain the ability to cast Tier 1 spells. You can prepare up to one Tier 1 spell each time you memorize spells for the day. You may take this advance multiple times, adding a new Tier 1 spell slot each time.

SPELL MEMORY II — TIER 2 (250 XP)

Prerequisites: Spell Memory I — 0 HP, 2 FP

You gain the ability to cast Tier 2 spells. You gain a Tier 2 spell slot with which you can prepare one Tier 2 or lower spell each time you memorize spells for the day. You may take this advance multiple times, adding a new Tier 2 slot each time.

SPELL MEMORY III — TIER 3 (375 XP)

Prerequisites: Spell Memory II, Arcane 8 — 1 HP, 2 FP

You gain the ability to cast Tier 3 spells. You gain a Tier 3 spell slot with which you can prepare one Tier 3 or lower spell each time you memorize spells for the day. You may take this advance multiple times, adding a new Tier 3 slot each time.

SPELL MEMORY IV — TIER 4 (500 XP)

Prerequisites: Spell Memory III — 1 HP, 4 FP

You gain the ability to cast Tier 4 spells. You gain a Tier 4 spell slot with which you can prepare one Tier 4 or lower spell each time you memorize spells for the day. You may take this advance multiple times, adding a new Tier 4 slot each time.

SPELL MEMORY V — TIER 5 (750 XP)

Prerequisites: Spell Memory IV, Arcane 10 — 2 HP, 5 FP

You gain the ability to cast Tier 5 spells. You gain a Tier 5 spell slot with which you can prepare one Tier 5 or lower spell each time you memorize spells for the day. You may take this advance multiple times, adding a new Tier 5 slot each time.

SPELL MEMORY VI — TIER 6 (1100 XP)

Prerequisites: Spell Memory V, Arcane 12 — 3 HP, 8 FP

You gain the ability to cast Tier 6 spells. You gain a Tier 6 spell slot with which you can prepare one Tier 6 or lower spell each time you memorize spells for the day. You may take this advance multiple times, adding a new Tier 6 slot each time.

AMBIENT POWER — TIER 3 (550 XP)

Prerequisites: Arcane 8 — 1 HP, 4 FP

You gain a +3 bonus to your Arcane rolls to cast every spell beyond the first one on your turn.

ARCANE WELLSPRING — TIER 4 (750 XP)

Prerequisites: Arcane 10, Ambient Power — 2 HP, 5 FP

The focus cost of every spell you cast on your turn beyond the first one is reduced by one quarter.

MANA FLOW — TIER 5 (1100 XP)

Prerequisites: Arcane 12, Ambient Power — 3 HP, 8 FP

The AP cost of every spell you cast on your turn beyond the first one is reduced by 1, to a minimum of 1.

Command

WARLOCK ACOLYTE — TIER 1 (200 XP)

Prerequisites: None — 1 HP, 1 FP

While you are controlling a summoned creature, you gain one extra AP per round. This AP can only be spent to perform a move action.

RALLYING PRESENCE — TIER 1 (200 XP)

Prerequisites: Command 3 — 2 HP, 0 FP

Allies within 5 squares of you gain +1d on saving throws against fear and morale effects. This bonus is lost if you are unconscious or Stunned.

TACTICAL COORDINATION — TIER 2 (350 XP)

Prerequisites: Command 5, Rallying Presence — 2 HP, 2 FP

Once per round, when an ally within 10 squares hits with an attack, you may spend a reaction to grant a different ally within 10 squares a free shift of 2 squares.

IRON AUTHORITY — TIER 3 (550 XP)

Prerequisites: Command 7 — 3 HP, 3 FP

When you use a Command power that targets enemies, you may add +2d to the casting check. Additionally, enemies that fail a resistance check against your Command powers take a −1d penalty on their next saving throw against the effect.

WARMASTER — TIER 4 (1000 XP)

Prerequisites: Command 9, Tactical Coordination, Iron Authority — 5 HP, 4 FP

At the start of each round, choose one ally within 10 squares. That ally gains +1 AP this round. You may not choose the same ally in consecutive rounds.

Dodge

ACTION ROLL — TIER 3 (500 XP)

Prerequisites: Dodge 7 — 3 HP, 2 FP

Your dive range is increased from 3 to 5 squares.

PARTING STRIKE — TIER 2 (350 XP)

Prerequisites: Dodge 5, Martial 5 — 3 HP, 0 FP

When you disengage, you may make a melee attack against an adjacent target. This attack cannot hit more than once.

VAULT — TIER 1 (150 XP)

Prerequisites: None 2 HP, 0 FP

You can pass through squares occupied by enemy creatures as if they were difficult terrain.

OUTMANEUVER TIER 1 (200 XP)

Prerequisites: Press the Advantage, Vault 1 HP, 1 FP

When an enemy misses you with a melee attack, you can immediately move through its space as a free action, ending on the other side of it. While neither you nor that enemy perform any further actions, you have combat advantage against it.

BULLET TIME TIER 4 (1000 XP)

Prerequisites: None 6 HP, 4 FP

When targeted by a single-target ranged attack, you can spend a reaction to make a Dodge resist. Add half the successes to your Evasion for the purposes of calculating hits for this attack only.

Grit

DAUNTLESS TIER 2 (500 XP)

Prerequisites: Grit 5 3 HP, 2 FP

You are immune to fear effects. If you are within the area of an enduring fear-inducing effect (such as an *Aura of Fear*), you gain a +2 bonus to attack rolls.

LORD OF MYSELF TIER 3 (600 XP)

Prerequisites: Grit 7 3 HP, 3 FP

You are immune to being dominated or charmed.

TENACITY TIER 3 (700 XP)

Prerequisites: Grit 8 4 HP, 3 FP

You can always revive on your next turn after dying, even if you died in the same round. Effects that prevent revival have no effect on you.

WILL OF STEEL TIER 5 (1100 XP)

Prerequisites: Grit 10, x 7 HP, 4 FP

When an attack would reduce you to 0 Health: you may make a D6 Grit resist; on success, you survive with 1 Health. Every time you invoke this power per scene, the Grit difficulty increases by 2.

WILL TRIUMPHANT TIER 6 (1800 XP)

Prerequisites: Grit total 12, Grit base 5, Will of Steel 12 HP, 6 FP

Reviving costs you 4 instead of 5 EP.

Initiative

SWIFT AS LIGHTNING TIER 2 (350 XP)

Prerequisites: Initiative 6 1 HP, 2 FP

During your first turn, you may treat all combatants that have not yet acted as *dazed*.

SEIZE THE MOMENT TIER 3 (550 XP)

Prerequisites: Initiative 8 2 HP, 3 FP

When you act before all other combatants do, you gain 2 extra AP on your first turn.

RIPOSTE TIER 1 (150 XP)

Prerequisites: None 1 HP, 0 FP

If an enemy within your reach misses you with a melee attack: as a reaction, you can immediately make an attack against that enemy with your equipped melee weapon.

PRESS THE ADVANTAGE TIER 1 (200 XP)

Prerequisites: None 2 HP, 0 FP

You become adept at exploiting moments of inattentiveness. When you have combat advantage against a creature, your attacks and powers against that target have a +2 bonus to hit; additionally, your attacks against that target gain extra AP equal to your tier. You gain combat advantage against a creature when you are totally obscured from it, or when you are in a flanking position.

LIGHTNING REFLEXES — TIER 3 (600 XP)

Prerequisites: Initiative 7, at least two Reaction advances — 3 HP, 3 FP

You may take up to two reactions per round.

Marksmanship

HEAVY GUNNER — TIER 3 (500 XP)

Prerequisites: Marksmanship 6, Stamina 5 — 5 HP, 0 FP

Wielding heavy weapons is second nature to you. You can brace your weapon as a free action.

Martial

EXPLOIT (TIER 1) — TIER 1 (250 XP)

Prerequisites: None — 0 HP, 2 FP

This advance stands in for learning any Tier 1 Exploit. You learn one Tier 1 Exploit of your choice.

PURSUIT — TIER 1 (250 XP)

Prerequisites: Opportunity Attack — 2 HP, 1 FP

When you use your opportunity attack reaction, after the attack resolves, you can immediately move up to your speed in the direction of the triggering enemy. You must end your move adjacent to the triggering enemy if possible.

EXPLOIT (TIER 2) — TIER 2 (550 XP)

Prerequisites: Any Tier 1 Exploit — 2 HP, 4 FP

This advance stands in for learning any Tier 2 Exploit. You learn one Tier 2 Exploit of your choice.

WEAPON FOCUS — TIER 2 (300 XP)

Prerequisites: None — 2 HP, 1 FP

Pick a class of melee weapon (such as sword, hammer, or axe). All attack rolls with a weapon of that type gain a +2 bonus. You may take this advance multiple times, but each one must apply to a different weapon type.

MONKEY GRIP — TIER 2 (375 XP)

Prerequisites: None — 4 HP, 0 FP

You can wield a two-handed weapon in one hand. When you do so, you gain a −2 penalty to attack rolls with that weapon.

LOTUS LEAF KATA — TIER 2 (300 XP)

Prerequisites: Lotus Art: Impenetrable, Martial 5, Dodge 5 — 2 HP, 1 FP

While *Impenetrable* stance, you gain a +3 bonus to Parry checks.

EXPLOIT (TIER 3) — TIER 3 (1000 XP)

Prerequisites: Any Tier 2 Exploit — 4 HP, 6 FP

This advance stands in for learning any Tier 3 Exploit. You learn one Tier 3 Exploit of your choice.

EXPLOIT (TIER 4) — TIER 4 (1850 XP)

Prerequisites: Any Tier 3 Exploit — 9 HP, 9 FP

This advance stands in for learning any Tier 4 Exploit. You learn one Tier 4 Exploit of your choice.

EXPLOIT (TIER 5) — TIER 5 (2500 XP)

Prerequisites: Any Tier 4 Exploit — 12 HP, 13 FP

This advance stands in for learning any Tier 5 Exploit. You learn one Tier 5 Exploit of your choice.

EXPLOIT (TIER 6) — TIER 6 (3500 XP)

Prerequisites: Any Tier 5 Exploit — 15 HP, 20 FP

This advance stands in for learning any Tier 6 Exploit. You learn one Tier 6 Exploit of your choice.

Potential

LEYLINE ATTUNEMENT — TIER 1 (200 XP)

Prerequisites: Potential 3 — 0 HP, 2 FP

You can sense the presence and school of magical effects within 10 squares. Additionally, your catalyst's focus increment is reduced by 1 (minimum 1).

ARCANE SMOOTHING — TIER 2 (300 XP)

Prerequisites: Potential 5, any casting Characteristic 5 — 0 HP, 3 FP

You are an adept wielder of Catalysts. You may reduce the focus increment of any Catalyst you wield by one-half its tier, rounding up.

PARMA ARCANA — TIER 3 (600 XP)

Prerequisites: Potential 6 — 3 HP, 3 FP

You gain a resistance to enemy magic. When targeted by a spell or magical ability, you may roll a Potential resist with difficulty equal to the casting check. On success: you are unaffected by the spell.

WELLSPRING — TIER 4 (1000 XP)

Prerequisites: Potential 9, Arcane Smoothing — 2 HP, 6 FP

Your connection to ambient magical energy deepens. Allies within 5 squares of you reduce the increment cost of their spells and powers by 1 (minimum 1). This does not stack with other sources of increment reduction.

Psychic

QUICKEN MAGIC — TIER 1 (300 XP)

Prerequisites: None — 0 HP, 3 FP

When you manifest a psychic power that costs 2 or more AP, you can expend one additional increment of focus to reduce the AP cost of that power by 1.

MAXIMIZE MAGIC — TIER 1 (300 XP)

Prerequisites: None — 0 HP, 3 FP

When you manifest a psychic power, you can expend one additional increment of focus to use the maximum value for each die roll to determine the effects or duration of the power instead of rolling.

TELEPATHY — TIER 1 (300 XP)

Prerequisites: None — 1 HP, 2 FP

You can communicate telepathically with creatures within 30 squares that you can see. Neither party requires a common spoken language.

DISCIPLINE (TIER 1) — TIER 1 (250 XP)

Prerequisites: None — 1 HP, 2 FP

This advance stands in for learning any Tier 1 Psychic power. You learn one Tier 1 Psychic power of your choice.

DISCIPLINE (TIER 2) — TIER 2 (550 XP)

Prerequisites: Any Tier 1 Psychic power — 1 HP, 5 FP

This advance stands in for learning any Tier 2 Psychic power. You learn one Tier 2 Psychic power of your choice.

DISCIPLINE (TIER 3) — TIER 3 (1000 XP)

Prerequisites: Any Tier 2 Psychic power — 3 HP, 7 FP

This advance stands in for learning any Tier 3 Psychic power. You learn one Tier 3 Psychic power of your choice.

DISCIPLINE (TIER 4) — TIER 4 (1850 XP)

Prerequisites: Any Tier 3 Psychic power — 5 HP, 13 FP

This advance stands in for learning any Tier 4 Psychic power. You learn one Tier 4 Psychic power of your choice.

DISCIPLINE (TIER 5) — TIER 5 (2500 XP)

Prerequisites: Any Tier 4 Psychic power — 7 HP, 18 FP

This advance stands in for learning any Tier 5 Psychic power. You learn one Tier 5 Psychic power of your choice.

DISCIPLINE (TIER 6) — TIER 6 (3500 XP)

Prerequisites: Any Tier 5 Psychic power — 10 HP, 25 FP

This advance stands in for learning any Tier 6 Psychic power. You learn one Tier 6 Psychic power of your choice.

Speed

FLEET OF FOOT — TIER 1 (150 XP)

Prerequisites: Speed 3 — 1 HP, 1 FP

Your base Movement Speed increases by 2.

EVASIVE SPRINT — TIER 2 (300 XP)

Prerequisites: Speed 5, Fleet of Foot — 2 HP, 1 FP

When you use the Dash action, you do not provoke opportunity attacks for the rest of your turn.

LIGHTNING DASH — TIER 3 (550 XP)

Prerequisites: Speed 7, Evasive Sprint — 3 HP, 2 FP

Once per encounter, you may take a move action as a free action at the start of your turn.

IMPOSSIBLE SWIFTNESS — TIER 4 (1000 XP)

Prerequisites: Speed 9, Lightning Dash — 4 HP, 3 FP

Your base Movement Speed increases by an additional 3 (stacks with Fleet of Foot). You may move through difficult terrain at normal speed.

Stamina

CONDITIONING — TIER 1 (150 XP)

Prerequisites: Strength 2, Endurance 2 — 2 HP, 0 FP

Treat the bulk of all armor as 1 lower than it actually is (subject to category minimums).

IRON CONSTITUTION — TIER 2 (300 XP)

Prerequisites: Stamina 4, Conditioning — 4 HP, 0 FP

You gain +1d on all Endurance checks and saving throws against Poisoned, Diseased, and Exhausted conditions.

POWERED PROFICIENCY — TIER 3 (550 XP)

Prerequisites: Conditioning, Stamina 6 — 4 HP, 1 FP

You gain the ability to use powered armor in powered mode. While wearing powered armor, you benefit from all your advances that improve your wearing of armor.

UNSTOPPABLE — TIER 4 (1000 XP)

Prerequisites: Stamina 9, Iron Constitution — 8 HP, 0 FP

Once per encounter, when you would be reduced to 0 HP, you are instead reduced to 1 HP. Additionally, you are immune to the Stunned condition from non-magical sources.

Magic and Powers

Apart from their wits, their skill and their weapons, Ashen characters also have at their disposal mystical abilities to defend against a hostile world. Whether they are magical spells, esoteric martial disciplines or psychic manipulations, collectively these abilities are referred to as Powers.

Reading Powers

Powers come in many different types, and the effects they can manifest are accordingly diverse. To keep the complexity manageable, Power entries are formatted in a structured way.

Header

Every power starts with a header that lists the power's name, type and rank, as well as any keywords the power has.

Keywords

Keywords on a power's header serve three purposes: they identify **what type of effect the power is** (e.g., Weapon, Zone, Stance), they indicate **prerequisites or interactions** (e.g., Dual Wield powers require two weapons), and they tag the power's **thematic aspect**. Aspect keywords correspond to the nine aspects of the dead gods — Ash, Crown, Sun, Key, Mist, Moon, Scarab, Skull, and Maiden — as well as elemental and discipline tags like Fire, Cold, Fate, and Lotus Art. Aspect keywords determine which reliquaries grant access to which prayers, and may interact with equipment or abilities that reference specific aspects.

The **Summon** keyword indicates that the power creates a summoned creature. Summoning powers follow the rules described in *Summoning and Binding* in the Combat chapter.

Flavor Text

The next line in the power describes what the power does from the perspective of the game world.

Prerequisites

The first entry in the power block proper describes what conditions a character must fulfill to be able to invoke the power. For example, a power might require a specific type of weapon

Range

This entry describes what the power affects and at what range it does so. Ranges are expressed in the form [target] [within [range][; [special]]], where *target* is either a number of valid targets and their description or an area, *range* expresses the distance from the user that the power can be manifested in (if any) and *special* expresses any special modifiers to the range.

Targets can be creatures, allies, enemies or objects. If all kinds of entities can be targeted, the power will simply refer to *targets*.

Area targets are referred to as *bursts*, *cones* or *lines*. See the section *area targets* for more details.

Special modifiers mostly apply when the target is an area, but the power does not affect everything inside the area indiscriminately. For example, a healing spell may have a range line of "Burst 2 within 12; all allies in burst", indicating that only allies within its area target are affected.

Difficulty

Most powers require that the user pass a particular characteristic check to cause the power to take effect. For example, arcane spells require an Arcane check to cast. Such powers will have the relevant ability and the check difficulty noted on this line. Some powers cannot fail: for such powers, the difficulty line reads *unerring*. Yet other powers inherently require a check as part of resolving their effect; for example, martial powers that cause the user to make a weapon attack. Such powers may lack a difficulty line altogether.

Cost

Most powers also have a focus cost that a character must spend to use the power. Focus costs can be expressed in one of two ways: a power that depends on a weapon or catalyst to use will have its cost expressed in *increments*. Each increment costs an amount of Focus Points equal to the wielded implement's focus increment value. For example, a power costing 2 increments used through a catalyst with a focus increment of 8 would cost 16 FP. Powers that do not require any implement to use, such as command powers, will instead have a fixed cost in focus points. A character who wishes to use a power that has a focus cost must have enough focus to use the power. The focus cost is paid upon resolution of the effect; that is, a power that has a difficulty does not consume focus until after the relevant characteristic check has been passed.

Some powers create permanent effects that last as long as the power is kept alive. These powers will have a *sustain* cost listed after their main cost, denominated in the same unit as the main cost. For example, a power reading *Cost: 2 Increments; sustain 1* would cost 2 increments of focus to use and 1 increment of focus per round thereafter to sustain.

Action Points

This line indicates how many AP a power takes to use. If a power has a sustain cost, it may also require AP to sustain. In this case, the AP cost to sustain the power will be listed after the main cost.

Resistance

This line indicates whether the target(s) can make a check to resist the effects of the power, listing the characteristic to check against as well as the check difficulty. This line only appears on powers that damage or hinder their targets.

Effect

These lines describe the actual effect of powers. For interpreting effects, see *damage* and *status conditions*.

On hit

Powers that require an attack roll to take effect or that can be resisted will have their main effect listed in an "on hit" block.

Miss

Some powers have effects even if they missed or were resisted by their target. Such effects will be listed under the "miss" block for the power, if any.

Catalyst

Some magical powers have effects that vary based on the weight category of the catalyst used to cast them. Such powers will include a line indicating the effect variation.

Types of Powers

Arcane Powers

Arcane Powers are also known as *Spells*. In order to use an Arcane power, a character must have a catalyst equipped. A spell's effects and focus cost depend on the catalyst equipped. Spells that have non-damaging effects usually become more or less powerful depending on the weight class of the catalyst equipped, with heavier catalysts being able to cast more powerful spells.

Spellcasting is an intricately formulaic affair, and due to the required accuracy in the motions and incantations it is necessary to refresh one's knowledge periodically. However, unlike most other kinds of power, the very formulaic nature of spells means that for a trained practitioner, learning (or relearning) to use a spell can be done in comparatively very little time, even starting from only a written description. For this reason, a character may learn an arbitrary amount of spells, but they can only equip a certain number of them at a time, depending on the Arcane advances they have unlocked.

Psychic Powers

Where arcane powers represent an almost scientific approach to the working of magic, supernatural might distilled into repeatable and distributable formulas accessible to any one with the required training, psychic powers are a much older and more primal way of using magical power. It is said that psychic magic is as close as mortals may get to understanding the power wielded by the gods when they still walked the earth.

Psychic powers may be **augmented**, trading a greater difficulty to manifest the power for greater effects. This comes at a risk, as psychic powers manipulate reality itself; if a practitioner loses control over their magic, the consequences can be dire indeed.

Psychic powers require a great deal of practice and study to master, and thus require XP to be spent for each power learned.

Cosmic Backlash

When a psychic casting check results in a **critical failure** (zero or negative total successes), the power tears loose from the caster's control. The Focus cost is still spent, and the intended effect does not occur. Instead, the caster must roll on the Cosmic Backlash table. The severity of the backlash depends on the tier of the power that was attempted.

COSMIC BACKLASH

D10	Result
1–2	**Psychic Feedback.** The caster takes Psychic damage equal to the power's Focus cost, reduced by Ward. The caster is Dazed until the end of their next turn. *(The mildest outcome — similar to arcane backlash.)*
3–4	**Sensory Overload.** The caster's senses are overwhelmed by a flood of unfiltered perception. The caster is **Blinded** and **Deafened** (save ends both). While this effect lasts, the caster perceives fragments of nearby creatures' thoughts and emotions — disorienting but occasionally informative, at the GM's discretion.
5–6	**Reality Fracture.** The fabric of space distorts in a Burst 2 centered on the caster. All creatures in the area (including the caster) are teleported to random unoccupied squares within 10 squares of their current position. The GM determines the destinations. Additionally, the affected area becomes **difficult terrain** for the remainder of the encounter as space knits itself back together.
7–8	**Ego Dissolution.** The caster's psychic identity partially unravels. The caster loses **Focus** equal to 3 × the attempted power's tier and is **Stunned** for 1 round (no save). At the GM's discretion, a fragment of the caster's thoughts may be broadcast to all psychically sensitive creatures within 30 squares — allies and enemies alike.
9	**Warp Manifestation.** The power manifests — but not as intended. The GM chooses a different valid target for the power (possibly the caster or their allies), or the power's effect is inverted (healing becomes damage, a buff becomes a debuff, a teleport sends the target in the wrong direction). The power uses its normal stats but strikes where reality, not the caster, directs it.
10	**Cosmic Breach.** The failed power rips a momentary hole in the veil between the physical world and the Fog. All creatures within Burst 3 of the caster take Psychic damage equal to 200% of the caster's catalyst damage, reduced by Ward. The caster loses **1 EP** as the Fog drinks from their essence. The breach lingers for 1D4 rounds as a zone of **Dense Fog** (see Exploration chapter). Creatures that start their turn in the zone must make a D6 Potential check or be **Frightened** (save ends).

Add the power's tier to the D10 roll if the attempted power was T4 or higher. A caster who rolls a natural 10 on a T5 power, for example, rolls 10 + 5 = 15 — the Cosmic Breach result, with appropriately devastating consequences.

Divine Powers

Divine powers are also known as *Prayers*. In order to use a prayer, a character must have a Reliquary equipped. A prayer's effects and focus cost depend on the reliquary equipped.

Unlike spells, characters normally do not permanently learn new prayers. Instead, the divine power contained within a reliquary temporarily gives them access to a list of prayers specific to that reliquary as long as the reliquary remains equipped.

Prayers are organized by *aspect*, which represent a facet of the divine power that a given deity has dominion over. Aspects typically encompass one prayer per tier, but this may be more or fewer depending on the aspect.

Divine powers may have a *tap* effect, which increases the strength of the power, but consumes favor (see *reliquaries* for an explanation of favor).

Martial Powers

Martial powers, also known as *Exploits*, are special techniques and disciplines practiced by warriors and fighters. Unlike spells, exploits do not require a catalyst; most require only a weapon to use. Exploits are learned permanently and remain available for as long as the character meets their prerequisites.

Command Powers

Command powers represent the use of authority and force of will over other creatures. They include abilities to direct summoned creatures, rally allies, and break the morale of enemies.

Marksmanship Powers

Marksmanship powers, also known as *Marksmanship Exploits*, are ranged combat techniques practiced by sharpshooters, gunslingers, and archers. Like martial exploits, they do not require a catalyst; they require a ranged weapon to use.

List of Powers

Arcane

Tier 1

FLAMETHROWER **ARCANE SPELL 1**

FIRE

Your catalyst suddenly erupts in a burst of white-hot flame to scour your foes.

Range: Cone 10

Difficulty: 2
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2
Resistance: Yes (Dodge vs Arcane Check)
Effect: All creatures and objects within the cone take 100% Thermal damage. All flammable objects within the area catch fire. All targets struck take ongoing 3/T Thermal damage (save ends).

LIGHTNING BOLT — ARCANE SPELL 1

LIGHTNING

You raise your catalyst, and with a deafening peal of thunder, a bolt of lightning erupts from it to smite your enemies.

Range: Line 10
Difficulty: 3
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2
Resistance: Yes (Stamina 3)
Effect: On hit: 100% electric damage, and the target is stunned for one round.

FROST BOLT — ARCANE SPELL 1

COLD

Range: one creature within 15
Difficulty: 2
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2
Resistance: Yes (Stamina 3)
Effect: On hit: 100% Cold damage. The target is Slowed (5) for 1 round.

CORROSIVE SPRAY — ARCANE SPELL 1

ACID

Range: Cone 5
Difficulty: 3
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2
Resistance: Yes (Dodge 3)
Effect: On hit: 100% Acid damage. The target's Armor value is reduced by 1 until the end of the encounter (stacks up to 3 times).

CONJURE ELEMENTAL SERVANT — ARCANE SPELL 1

SUMMON KEY

A flickering shape coalesces from the air --- fire, frost, stone, or crackling lightning, bound to your will.

Range: one unoccupied space within 5
Difficulty: 3
Cost: 2 Increments; sustain 1
AP: 3 AP; sustain 1 AP
Effect: You conjure a small elemental from raw magical energy. The elemental is a mindless summon (see _Summoning and Binding_) with the following baseline stats: 15 HP, 4 Armor, 2 Ward, 3 Evasion, 4 AP, Speed 4. It makes melee attacks at 5 dice dealing 6+D6 damage of a type matching its element (Thermal for fire, Cold for ice, Impact for earth, Electric for air). The elemental persists as long as you sustain this power.

ANIMATE DEAD — ARCANE SPELL 1

SUMMON SKULL

The dead rise at your command, hollow-eyed and obedient.

Range: one corpse within 5
Difficulty: 3
Cost: 2 Increments; sustain 1
AP: 3 AP; sustain 1 AP
Effect: You animate a corpse within range as a skeletal servant. The skeleton is a mindless summon with the following baseline stats: 12 HP, 3 Armor, 0 Ward, 2 Evasion, 4 AP, Speed 3. It wields whatever weapon was on the corpse (or makes unarmed attacks at 4 dice dealing 4+D4 Rending damage). The skeleton persists as long as you sustain this power. If there is no suitable corpse within range, this spell fails and the Focus cost is not paid.

Tier 2

FIREBALL — ARCANE SPELL 2

FIRE

With a wave of your hand, a brilliant sphere of energy erupts from your catalyst, streaking towards your target before detonating with a dull roar.

Range: Burst 3 within 30
Difficulty: 4
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2
Resistance: Yes (Dodge 4)
Effect: On hit: All creatures and objects within the burst take 200% Thermal damage. Flammable objects within the target area catch fire; all creatures take ongoing 5/T Thermal damage (save ends).

SHATTERBLAST — ARCANE SPELL 2

FORCE

Range: one creature or object within 20

Difficulty: 4
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2
Resistance: Yes (Stamina 5; armor damage only)
Effect: On hit: 200% Impact damage. Objects and constructs take double damage. If the target is wearing armor, they must pass a resistance check or their armor's value is permanently reduced by 2 (until repaired).

VENOMCLOUD — ARCANE SPELL 2

ACID ZONE

Range: Burst 2 within 20
Difficulty: 4
Cost: 2 Increments; sustain 1
AP: 2; sustain 1
Resistance: Yes (Stamina 4)
Effect: On hit: All creatures in the area take 100% Acid damage and are Poisoned (save ends). The cloud persists as a zone of light obscurement as long as you sustain it; creatures that enter or start their turn in the zone take 100% Acid damage.

CONJURE WAR ELEMENTAL — ARCANE SPELL 2

SUMMON KEY

Range: one unoccupied space within 5
Difficulty: 5
Cost: 3 Increments; sustain 1
AP: 3 AP; sustain 1 AP
Effect: You conjure a combat-ready elemental, larger and more aggressive than a servant. The elemental is a mindless summon with the following baseline stats: 25 HP, 6 Armor, 4 Ward, 3 Evasion, 4 AP, Speed 5. It makes melee attacks at 7 dice dealing 10+D8 damage of a type matching its element. The elemental persists as long as you sustain this power.

RAISE SKELETAL GUARD — ARCANE SPELL 2

SUMMON SKULL

Range: one corpse within 5
Difficulty: 5
Cost: 3 Increments; sustain 1
AP: 3 AP; sustain 1 AP
Effect: You raise an armored skeleton from a corpse, binding it with stronger magic than a simple animation. The skeleton is a mindless summon with the following baseline stats: 20 HP, 8 Armor, 0 Ward, 3 Evasion, 4 AP, Speed 3. It fights with a shield and weapon: 6 dice dealing 8+D6 Rending damage, and it has Parry +2d. The skeleton persists as long as you sustain this power. If there is no suitable corpse within range, this spell fails and the Focus cost is not paid.

Tier 3

FULMINATION — ARCANE SPELL 3

LIGHTNING

For a split second, hair stands on end and the air crackles with anticipation before a terrifying burst of electrical energy discharges from your catalyst, sending bolts of brilliant blue plasma tearing into every foe unfortunate enough to stand close to you.

Range: Close Burst 5; all enemies within burst
Difficulty: 6
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3
Resistance: Yes (Stamina 6)
Effect: On hit: 200% electric damage, and the target is stunned for one round.
Miss: Half damage and the target is dazed instead.

ICE STORM — ARCANE SPELL 3

ICE WIND

Temperatures start to drop precipitously as a whirlwind picks up. The storm lasts only a few seconds, leaving everything covered in a sheet of glistening ice.

Range: Burst 5 within 20
Difficulty: 8
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3
Resistance: Yes (Stamina 6)
Effect: All targets within the range take 200% cold damage and must make a D6 Stamina resist. On failure, they are stunned for one round; afterwards, they are dazed and slowed (5) (save ends).

CONJURE GREATER ELEMENTAL — ARCANE SPELL 3

SUMMON KEY

Range: one unoccupied space within 5
Difficulty: 7
Cost: 3 Increments; sustain 2
AP: 3 AP; sustain 1 AP
Effect: You conjure a powerful elemental, a towering figure of raw elemental force. The elemental is a mindless summon (Size 2) with the following baseline stats: 40 HP, 30 FP, 8 Armor, 6 Ward, 4 Evasion, 4 AP, Speed 5. It makes melee attacks at 10 dice dealing 14+D10 damage of a type matching its element. It also has a ranged attack (range 10, 8 dice, 10+D8 damage of the same type). The elemental can cast an elemental burst (Burst 2 within 15, 8 dice, difficulty 5, cost 10 FP): fire elementals cast Fireball (100% Thermal damage, Burning on hit); cold elementals cast Frozen Burst (100% Cold damage, Slowed (4) on failed

D6 Stamina save, save ends); lightning elementals cast Thunder Burst (100% Lightning damage, Dazed on failed D6 Stamina save, save ends); earth elementals cast Shatter (100% Impact damage, knocked prone on failed D6 Stamina save). The elemental's base damage of 14+D10 is used as its catalyst damage for percentage calculations. The elemental persists as long as you sustain this power.

Tier 4

SOLAR FLARE — ARCANE SPELL 4

FIRE

You stretch out your hand and cast a wave of blazing plasma, bathing all before you in the fury of a burning star.

Range: Line 15
Difficulty: 8
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3
Resistance: Yes
Effect: All creatures and objects within the line take 300% Thermal damage. Additionally, all targets must make a D9 Stamina resist; on failure, they lose 3/T armor/hardness. Flammable objects and living targets reduced to 0 Health by this power turn to ash.

VITRIOLIC DELUGE — ARCANE SPELL 4

ACID

Range: Burst 3 within 20
Difficulty: 8
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3
Resistance: Yes (Dodge 8)
Effect: A torrent of caustic liquid pours over the area. All creatures in the area take 200% Acid damage. Their armor and Hardness are permanently reduced by 3 (until repaired). On each subsequent turn for 3 rounds, affected creatures take ongoing 100% Acid damage (save ends the ongoing damage, but not the armor reduction).
Miss: Half initial damage, ongoing 50% Acid for 1 round, no armor reduction.

Tier 5

CHAIN LIGHTNING — ARCANE SPELL 5

ELECTRIC

Range: one creature within 20; chains to up to 3 additional creatures within 5 of the previous target
Difficulty: 9
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: Stamina 8
Effect: A bolt of electricity arcs from the primary target to up to three additional targets, each of which must be within 5 squares of the previous target. Make a separate attack roll against each target. Each target struck takes 200% electric damage. A target that fails their resistance check is stunned for 1 round.
Miss: Half damage, no stun.

PETRIFICATION — ARCANE SPELL 5

TRANSMUTATION

Range: one creature within 15
Difficulty: 10
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D8 Stamina
Effect: You attempt to turn the target to stone. On a failed resistance check, the target is Stilled and Slowed (5) (save ends both). If the target fails three saving throws against this effect before succeeding one, they are permanently petrified (turned to stone and unconscious) until freed by a Tier 4+ ritual.
Miss: The target is Slowed (5) for 1 round.

WALL OF FORCE — ARCANE SPELL 5

FORCE

Range: Wall 10 within 20
Difficulty: 9
Cost: 3 Increments; sustain 1
AP: 3 AP; sustain 1 AP
Effect: You create an impassable wall of translucent force up to 10 squares long and 5 squares high. The wall blocks all movement, projectiles, and line of effect for spells. The wall has HP equal to 300% of your catalyst's damage and Hardness 10. It lasts as long as you sustain it or until destroyed.

INFERNO — ARCANE SPELL 5

FIRE ZONE

Range: Burst 3 within 20
Difficulty: 10
Cost: 4 Increments; sustain 1
AP: 3 AP; sustain 1 AP
Resistance: Dodge 8 (halves damage, negates Burning)
Effect: You create a zone of roaring flame. Any creature that enters the zone or starts its turn there takes 200% Thermal damage and is Burning (save ends). The zone provides total concealment and lasts as long as you sustain it.

Tier 6

DISINTEGRATION — ARCANE SPELL 6

FORCE

Range: one creature or object within 20
Difficulty: 12
Cost: 4 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D10 Stamina
Effect: A thin green ray strikes the target. On a hit, the target takes 300% Impact damage, ignoring all armor and Hardness. If this damage reduces the target to 0 HP, they and all equipment they carry are reduced to fine dust. Objects and structures targeted by this spell take double damage.
Miss: 100% Impact damage, ignoring armor.

METEOR SWARM — ARCANE SPELL 6

FIRE

Range: four Burst 3 areas within 30
Difficulty: 11
Cost: 4 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: Dodge 10
Effect: Four meteors slam into the battlefield. Each meteor targets a Burst 3 area and deals 200% Thermal damage. You may target the same or different areas; a creature caught in multiple blasts takes damage from each separately. Each impact leaves the area as difficult terrain covered in burning rubble (creatures starting their turn in the rubble take 100% Thermal ongoing damage).
Miss: Half damage from each meteor, no ongoing.

ABSOLUTE ZERO — ARCANE SPELL 6

COLD

Range: Close Burst 5
Difficulty: 11
Cost: 4 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D10 Stamina
Effect: You drain all heat from the area, flash-freezing everything in place. All creatures in the area take 300% Cold damage. Creatures that fail their resistance check are Stunned for 1 round, then Stilled and Slowed (5) (save ends both). The area becomes difficult terrain covered in ice for the rest of the encounter. Creatures that start their turn in the ice must pass a D6 Stamina check or fall Prone.
Miss: Half damage, Slowed (5) for 1 round.

Divine

Divine prayers are organized by **aspect** — the nine fundamental facets of the dead gods' power. Each aspect represents a facet of divine power: Ash (destruction), Crown (law), Sun (crafting, light), Key (opening, summoning), Mist (magic), Moon (mind), Scarab (rebirth), Skull (death), and Maiden (nature). A reliquary grants access to prayers from the aspects listed in its aspect entry, up to the reliquary's tier.

Some aspects have **minor aspects** — narrower expressions of the parent aspect's power. A reliquary that grants access to a minor aspect also grants access to the parent major aspect. For example, Serpent is a minor aspect of Skull: a reliquary with the Serpent aspect grants access to both Serpent and Skull prayers, while a reliquary with only the Skull aspect does not grant access to Serpent prayers. This means minor-aspect reliquaries are broader in scope, combining their specialized prayers with the more general powers of their parent.

Scarab — Rebirth, Cycles

MEND WOUNDS — PRAYER 1

DIVINE SCARAB

Range: one creature within 15
Difficulty: 3
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2 AP
Effect: The target recovers HP equal to 100% of your catalyst's damage.
Tap: The recovery increases to 200%.

VIGOR OF THE LIVING — PRAYER 2

DIVINE SCARAB

Range: Close; one creature
Difficulty: 4
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2 AP
Effect: The target gains temporary HP equal to 100% of your catalyst's damage. These temporary HP last until the end of the encounter.
Tap: The target also gains +2d to Endurance checks until the end of the encounter.

CLEANSING LIGHT — PRAYER 3

DIVINE SCARAB

Range: Short; one creature
Difficulty: 7

Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2 AP
Effect: Remove one status condition from the target (Poisoned, Diseased, Bleeding, Burning, or Blinded). The target then recovers HP equal to 100% of your catalyst's damage.
Tap: You may remove up to two status conditions instead of one.

BREATH OF RESURRECTION — PRAYER 4

DIVINE SCARAB

Range: Burst 3 centered on you; all allies
Difficulty: 8
Cost: 4 Increments + 2 EP
AP: 3 AP
Effect: All dead allies in the burst are restored to life with 1 HP and their current Focus total; then all allies in the burst heal 200% of your catalyst's damage.
Tap: Dead allies revive with 50% HP and 100% Focus instead.

REGENERATION — PRAYER 5

DIVINE SCARAB

Range: Close; one creature
Difficulty: 9
Cost: 3 Increments; sustain 1
AP: 2 AP; sustain 1 AP
Effect: At the start of each of the target's turns, they recover HP equal to 100% of your catalyst's damage.
Tap: The regeneration increases to 200%.

CIRCLE OF VITALITY — PRAYER 6

DIVINE SCARAB

Range: Burst 4 centered on you; all allies in burst
Difficulty: 11
Cost: 4 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Effect: All allies in the area immediately recover HP equal to 300% of your catalyst's damage. Additionally, all allies gain immunity to one status condition of your choice (chosen when you cast this prayer) for 3 rounds.
Tap: Allies also gain temporary HP equal to 100% of your catalyst's damage and the immunity duration increases to 5 rounds.

Ash — Destruction, Desolation

BATTLE CRY — PRAYER 1

DIVINE ASH

Range: one ally within 10
Difficulty: 3
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2 AP
Effect: One ally within range gains +2d on their next attack roll and +2 to their Movement Speed until the end of their next turn.
Tap: The bonus increases to +3d on the attack roll.

SMITE THE FAITHLESS — PRAYER 2

DIVINE RADIANT ASH

Difficulty: 4
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2 AP
Effect: Your next weapon attack before the end of your turn deals an additional 100% damage as radiant. If the target is Undead or Fiend, the additional damage increases to 200%.
Tap: The attack also ignores the target's Hardness.

INSPIRING CHARGE — PRAYER 3

DIVINE ASH

Range: Burst 3 centered on you; up to 3 allies
Difficulty: 7
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2 AP
Effect: You and up to three allies within range each gain +1 AP and +3 Movement Speed until the end of your next turn. Each affected creature may immediately shift 1 square.
Tap: Affected allies also gain +2d on attack rolls until the end of their next turn.

DIVINE WRATH — PRAYER 4

DIVINE RADIANT ASH

Range: Burst 3 within 20
Difficulty: 8
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D8 Stamina
Effect: You call down a pillar of radiant fury on the battlefield. All enemies in the area take 300% radiant damage. Enemies that fail their resistance check are also Dazed (save ends).
Miss: Half damage, no Dazed.

AVATAR OF WAR — PRAYER 5

DIVINE RADIANT ASH

Range: one creature within 10
Difficulty: 10
Cost: 3 Increments; sustain 1
AP: 3 AP; sustain 1 AP
Effect: You or one ally within range becomes an avatar of divine battle for the duration. The avatar gains +1 AP, +3d on all attack rolls, and their weapon attacks deal an additional 100% radiant damage. While the avatar is active, enemies within 3 squares of the avatar take a -2d penalty on attack rolls.
Tap: The avatar also gains Resistance 5 to all damage types for the duration.

DIVINE STORM OF BLADES — PRAYER 6

DIVINE | RADIANT | ASH

Range: Burst 5 within 20
Difficulty: 11
Cost: 4 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D10 Stamina
Effect: Spectral weapons rain from the sky across the battlefield. All enemies in the area take 300% radiant damage. Each enemy hit must pass a resistance check or be Stunned for 1 round, then Exposed (save ends). Allies in the area are unaffected and recover HP equal to 100% of your catalyst's damage.
Miss: Half damage, Exposed for 1 round.

Maiden — Nature

ENTANGLING GROWTH — PRAYER 1

DIVINE | MAIDEN

Range: Burst 2 within 15
Difficulty: 3
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2 AP
Resistance: D3 Stamina
Effect: Grasping vines and roots erupt in the target area. The area becomes difficult terrain for the rest of the encounter. Each creature in the area when it appears must pass a resistance check or be Slowed (5) for 1 round.
Tap: Creatures that fail are also Immobilized until the end of their next turn.

BARKSKIN — PRAYER 2

DIVINE | MAIDEN

Range: one creature within 10
Difficulty: 4
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2 AP
Effect: The target's skin hardens to the resilience of oak. The target gains +3 Armor and +2 Hardness until the end of the encounter. This bonus does not stack with worn armor.
Tap: The target also gains Resistance 3 to Thermal and Cold damage.

CALL LIGHTNING — PRAYER 3

DIVINE | ELECTRIC | MAIDEN

Range: Burst 5 within 20; one creature in area per turn
Difficulty: 7
Cost: 2 Increments; sustain 1
AP: 2 AP; sustain 1 AP
Resistance: D6 Stamina
Effect: You summon a storm cloud in the area. When you cast this prayer and at the start of each of your subsequent turns while you sustain it, a bolt of lightning strikes a creature of your choice within the area, dealing 200% electric damage.
Miss: Half damage.
Tap: You may target two creatures per bolt instead of one.

WRATH OF THE WILD — PRAYER 4

DIVINE | MAIDEN

Range: Burst 4 within 20
Difficulty: 8
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: Dodge 8
Effect: The terrain itself turns hostile. All enemies in the area take 200% damage as thorns, roots, and stone erupt beneath them. The area becomes heavily obscured difficult terrain for 3 rounds. Enemies that start their turn in the area take 100% ongoing damage.
Miss: Half damage, ongoing damage still applies.

VERDANT RESURRECTION — PRAYER 5

DIVINE | MAIDEN

Range: one dead ally within 10
Difficulty: 10
Cost: 3 Increments + 3 EP
AP: 3 AP
Effect: You encase a dead ally in a cocoon of living wood that rapidly restores their body. The target revives with HP equal to 300% of your catalyst's damage and 100% Focus. Additionally, the cocoon removes all status conditions from the target upon revival. The cocoon takes 1 round to open — the target cannot act until the start of their next turn.
Tap: The target revives with full HP and all status conditions removed from all allies within 3 squares.

PRIMEVAL CATACLYSM — PRAYER 6

DIVINE MAIDEN

Range: Burst 5 within 20
Difficulty: 12
Cost: 4 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D10 Stamina
Effect: You unleash the full fury of the natural world. The terrain in the area is permanently transformed: trees erupt from stone, chasms split open, and rivers divert. All enemies in the area take 300% damage and must pass a resistance check or be Prone and Immobilized (save ends both). The transformed terrain is difficult terrain permanently and provides cover to your allies but not to your enemies.
Miss: Half damage, Prone for 1 round.

Crown — Law, Order

SHIELD OF FAITH — PRAYER 1

DIVINE CROWN

Range: one creature within 10
Difficulty: 3
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2 AP
Effect: The target gains +2 Evasion and +2 to all resistance checks until the end of the encounter.
Tap: The bonuses increase to +3.

WARDING BOND — PRAYER 2

DIVINE CROWN

Range: one ally within 10
Difficulty: 4
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2 AP
Effect: You create a divine link between yourself and the target. While the bond persists, the target gains Resistance 5 to all damage types, but you take damage equal to the amount resisted. The bond lasts until the end of the encounter or until you dismiss it (free action).
Tap: You take only half of the redirected damage.

DISPELLING WAVE — PRAYER 3

DIVINE CROWN

Range: Burst 3 within 15
Difficulty: 7
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2 AP
Effect: A wave of divine energy washes over the area, stripping away magical effects. Each ongoing spell, power, or magical effect in the area is immediately ended if its tier is equal to or less than 3. For effects of tier 4 or higher, make a Command check against the effect's original difficulty; on success, the effect is dispelled.
Tap: Automatically dispels effects up to tier 4 instead of 3.

AEGIS OF THE FAITHFUL — PRAYER 4

DIVINE CROWN

Range: Close Burst 3 centered on you
Difficulty: 8
Cost: 3 Increments; sustain 1
AP: 3 AP; sustain 1 AP
Effect: A dome of golden light surrounds you and your allies. All allies within the area gain Resistance 10 to all damage types. Projectiles and ranged spell attacks that cross the barrier take a -3d penalty to hit. The aegis lasts as long as you sustain it, but you cannot move while sustaining.
Tap: You may move at half speed while sustaining the aegis.

INVIOLABLE SANCTUARY — PRAYER 5

DIVINE CROWN

Range: one creature within 10
Difficulty: 10
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Effect: You designate one creature within range. For 3 rounds, that creature cannot be targeted by attacks or harmful effects. The creature cannot attack or use offensive powers while the sanctuary is active; if they do, the sanctuary ends immediately. At the end of the duration, the creature recovers HP equal to 200% of your catalyst's damage.
Tap: The sanctuary duration increases to 5 rounds and the healing increases to 300%.

DIVINE BULWARK — PRAYER 6

DIVINE CROWN

Range: Burst 5 centered on you; all allies in burst
Difficulty: 12
Cost: 4 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Effect: You invoke the full protective power of your deity. For 3 rounds, all allies within the area gain immunity to two status conditions of your choice, Resis-

tance 10 to all damage types, and +3 Evasion. The first time each ally would be reduced to 0 HP during this effect, they are instead reduced to 1 HP. When the effect ends, all allies recover HP equal to 100% of your catalyst's damage.
Tap: The duration increases to 5 rounds and allies recover 200% instead.

Serpent — Poison, Disease *(minor aspect of Skull)*

VENOMOUS TOUCH — PRAYER 1

DIVINE POISON SERPENT

Difficulty: 3
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2 AP
Resistance: D3 Stamina
Effect: You channel a potent toxin through your hand or weapon. Your next melee attack or touch before the end of your turn deals an additional 100% of your catalyst's damage as Poison damage. If the target takes damage, it must pass a resistance check or become Poisoned (save ends).
Tap: The target also takes ongoing 3/T Poison damage (save ends) regardless of whether the Poisoned save succeeds.

MIASMA — PRAYER 2

DIVINE POISON ZONE SERPENT

Range: Burst 2 within 15
Difficulty: 4
Cost: 2 Increments; sustain 1
AP: 2 AP; sustain 1 AP
Resistance: D4 Stamina
Effect: You exhale a cloud of noxious fumes that fills the area. The zone provides light obscurement. Any creature that enters or starts its turn in the zone takes 100% Poison damage and must pass a resistance check or be Poisoned and Weakened (-2d on attack rolls) for 1 round. The zone lasts as long as you sustain it.
Tap: The zone also imposes a -2 penalty to saving throws against Poisoned while creatures remain within it.

WITHER — PRAYER 3

DIVINE POISON DISEASE SERPENT

Range: one creature within 10
Difficulty: 7
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2 AP
Resistance: D6 Stamina
Effect: You curse the target with a wasting toxin that saps their vitality. The target takes 200% Poison damage. On a failed resistance check, the target is Diseased (save ends): while Diseased, all healing received by the target is halved, and the target takes ongoing 5/T Poison damage at the start of each of its turns.
Miss: Half damage, Poisoned for 1 round.
Tap: The Disease also reduces the target's Stamina by 2 for the duration.

PLAGUE BEARER — PRAYER 4

DIVINE POISON DISEASE SERPENT

Range: one creature within 10
Difficulty: 8
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D7 Stamina (spread only; primary target auto-fails)
Effect: You infect a target with a virulent plague that spreads to nearby enemies. The primary target takes 200% Poison damage and is automatically Diseased (save ends). At the end of each of the primary target's turns, all enemies within 2 squares of it must pass a resistance check or also become Diseased. The disease spreads in this manner up to 3 times. Diseased creatures have their healing halved and take ongoing 5/T Poison damage.
Miss: Half damage, Poisoned (save ends) instead of Diseased.
Tap: The spreading radius increases to 3 squares and the maximum number of spreads increases to 5.

NECROTIC VENOM — PRAYER 5

DIVINE POISON NECROTIC SERPENT

Range: one creature within 10
Difficulty: 10
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D9 Stamina
Effect: You inject a target with a toxin that attacks the boundary between life and death. The target takes 300% Poison damage, ignoring Ward. On a failed resistance check, the target cannot be healed by any means (save ends). While this effect persists, any damage the target takes also reduces its maximum HP by the same amount. Maximum HP lost this way is restored when the effect ends.
Miss: Half damage, healing halved for 1 round.
Tap: The target's maximum HP reduction persists for 24 hours after the anti-healing effect ends.

WORLD SERPENT'S EMBRACE — PRAYER 6

DIVINE POISON DISEASE NECROTIC SERPENT

Range: Burst 4 within 20; all enemies in burst
Difficulty: 12
Cost: 4 Increments

AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D10 Stamina
Effect: You call upon the World Serpent to devour your enemies' vitality. All enemies in the area take 300% Poison damage and are Diseased and Poisoned (save ends both). Diseased creatures have their healing halved and take ongoing 100% Poison damage per turn. For each enemy affected, one ally of your choice within the area recovers HP equal to 100% of your catalyst's damage. Enemies reduced to 0 HP by this prayer cannot be resurrected for 1 week.
Miss: Half damage, Poisoned for 1 round.
Tap: Allies in the area also gain immunity to Poison and Disease for 3 rounds.

Skull — Death, the End of Things

CALL ANCESTOR SPIRIT — PRAYER 1

DIVINE SUMMON SKULL SKULL

Range: one unoccupied space within 5
Difficulty: 3
Cost: 2 Increments; sustain 1
AP: 3 AP; sustain 1 AP
Effect: You call forth the spirit of a fallen warrior from beyond the veil. The spirit is a willful summon (see _Summoning and Binding_) that requires a binding check (your Command vs the spirit's Potential of 4). The spirit has the following baseline stats: 15 HP, 2 Armor, 5 Ward, 3 Evasion, 4 AP, Speed 5 (hover). It is *incorporeal*: Rending and Impact damage from weapons without an enchantment or the Force keyword is halved (after Armor). It makes melee attacks at 6 dice dealing 6+D8 Cold damage and has Lifesense 10. The spirit acts autonomously in your interest. It persists as long as you sustain this prayer.
Tap: The spirit's attacks also deal ongoing 3 Cold damage (save ends).

CALL REVENANT — PRAYER 3

DIVINE SUMMON SKULL SKULL

Range: one unoccupied space within 5
Difficulty: 7
Cost: 3 Increments; sustain 2
AP: 3 AP; sustain 1 AP
Effect: You call forth a revenant --- a powerful undead with a remnant of its living will. The revenant is a willful summon that requires a binding check (your Command vs the revenant's Potential of 8). The revenant has the following baseline stats: 40 HP, 10 Armor, 6 Ward, 4 Evasion, 4 AP, Speed 4. It makes melee attacks at 10 dice dealing 14+D10 Rending damage and has Lifesense 15. On hit, the target must make a D6 Stamina save or be Weakened (save ends). The revenant acts autonomously in your interest. It persists as long as you sustain this prayer.
Tap: The revenant gains +2d to all attacks and its Weakened effect no longer allows a save on the first hit.

Sun — Crafting, Light

SUNFIRE BLESSING — PRAYER 1

DIVINE FIRE SUN

Range: one ally within 10
Difficulty: 3
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2 AP
Effect: You kindle the light of Khâru in an ally's weapon. The target's weapon attacks deal additional Thermal damage equal to 25% of your reliquary's damage per hit and shed bright light in 5 squares for the duration. Lasts until the end of the encounter or until dismissed.
Tap: The bonus damage increases to 50% and the weapon's attacks gain Burning (save ends).

SOLAR WARD — PRAYER 1

DIVINE FIRE SUN

Range: one creature within 10
Difficulty: 3
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2 AP
Effect: You wreath the target in a halo of warm light. The target gains Ward equal to the reliquary's tier + 2 and immunity to the Blinded condition for the duration. Undead and incorporeal creatures that start their turn adjacent to the warded target take Thermal damage equal to the reliquary's tier × 3. Lasts until the end of the encounter or until dismissed.
Tap: The Ward bonus doubles and the aura damage increases to tier × 5.

Psychic

Tier 1

TWIST OF FATE — PSYCHIC POWER 1

FATE REACTION

Range: 1 within 12
Difficulty: 5
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2
Effect: On the target's next roll, you may modify the result by +1 or -1. Augment 2: You may use this power as a reaction.

SLOW — PSYCHIC POWER 1

TIME

Range: 1 creature within 12
Difficulty: 4
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2
Effect: The target must make a D4 Potential save. On failure: the target loses 1 AP while the spell lasts. They also gain a -2 penalty to their Movement Speed and a -10 penalty to their Initiative value. This effect cannot decrease Movement Speed below 2 or Initiative below 0. Augment 1: The duration changes to save ends. Augment 2: The resist difficulty is increased to D7.

PIERCING SILENCE — PSYCHIC POWER 1

VOID

Range: Burst 3 within 10
Difficulty: 5
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2
Effect: The target area becomes a zone of magical silence. While the spell is active, no-one within the zone may cast a spell or manifest a power. It is possible to brute-force the silence; a casting check over a difficulty of 8 will break this spell.

Tier 2

REVERSAL OF FORTUNE — PSYCHIC POWER 2

FATE

Range: 1 within 12
Difficulty: 6
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2
Resistance: Yes (Potential 5)
Effect: On the target's next roll, all 6s count as 1 success. Augment 2: You may use this power as a reaction.

HASTE — PSYCHIC POWER 2

TIME

Range: 1 creature within 10
Difficulty: 5
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2
Effect: The target gains 1 additional AP while the spell lasts. They also gain a +2 bonus to their Movement Speed and a +10 bonus to their Initiative value. Duration: 2 rounds. Augment 2: The duration increases to 2+1d3 rounds. Augment 2: The bonuses to speed and initiative increase to +3 and +15, respectively.

BANISH — PSYCHIC POWER 2

VOID DEATH

Range: 1 within 12
Difficulty: 6
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2
Resistance: Yes (Stamina 4)
Effect: The target must make a D4 Stamina save. On failure, it is banished to the Void and dies instantly. Augment 2: The resist difficulty increases to 6.

SUMMON VOID SHADE — PSYCHIC POWER 2

SUMMON VOID

A dark shape peels itself from your shadow, its edges flickering like a candle flame in a draft.

Range: one unoccupied space within 5
Difficulty: 6
Cost: 3 Increments; sustain 1
AP: 3 AP; sustain 1 AP
Effect: You tear a hole in reality and pull through a shade --- a fragment of the Void given semi-sentient form. The shade is a willful summon (see _Summoning and Binding_) that requires a binding check (your Command vs the shade's Potential of 5). The shade has the following baseline stats: 20 HP, 0 Armor, 8 Ward, 4 Evasion, 4 AP, Speed 6 (hover). It is *incorporeal*: Rending and Impact damage from weapons without an enchantment or the Force keyword is halved (after Armor). It makes melee attacks at 7 dice dealing 8+D8 Cold damage. On hit, the target must make a D4 Potential save or be Dazed (save ends). The shade acts autonomously in your interest. It persists as long as you sustain this power.

Tier 3

CURSED FATE — PSYCHIC POWER 3

FATE CURSE

Range: 1 within 12
Difficulty: 7
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2
Resistance: Yes (Potential 6)
Effect: For the duration of the effect, all 1s count as -2 successes, rather than -1. Duration: save ends. Augment 2: Saving against this effect requires 3 successes.

MASS SLOW — PSYCHIC POWER 3

TIME

Range: Burst 3 within 16

Difficulty: 7
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2
Effect: The target(s) must make a D6 Potential save. On failure: the target loses 1 AP while the spell lasts. They also gain a -2 penalty to their Movement Speed and a -10 penalty to their Initiative value. This effect cannot decrease Movement Speed below 2 or Initiative below 0. Duration: 2 rounds. Augment 1: The duration changes to save ends. Augment 2: The resist difficulty is increased to D9.

SUMMON FATE WARDEN — PSYCHIC POWER 3

SUMMON FATE TIME

It has no face, but you feel its attention --- the weight of something that has seen every possible version of this moment.

Range: one unoccupied space within 5
Difficulty: 7
Cost: 3 Increments; sustain 2
AP: 3 AP; sustain 1 AP
Effect: You weave strands of fate into a semi-corporeal guardian --- a faceless figure wreathed in shimmering temporal distortion. The warden is a willful summon that requires a binding check (your Command vs the warden's Potential of 7). The warden has the following baseline stats: 35 HP, 5 Armor, 10 Ward, 5 Evasion, 4 AP, Speed 5 (hover). It makes melee attacks at 9 dice dealing 12+D8 Impact damage. As a reaction (1 AP), the warden can interpose itself between an ally within 3 squares and an incoming attack, redirecting the attack to itself. Once per round, the warden can impose Slow on a creature it hits (D6 Potential save, save ends). The warden acts autonomously in your interest. It persists as long as you sustain this power.

SHARED SENSES — PSYCHIC POWER 3

MOON

Range: one creature you control or an ally within 30
Difficulty: 5
Cost: 1 Increment; sustain 1 (Focus only)
AP: 1 AP; sustain 0 AP
Effect: You link your senses to those of a summoned or allied creature. For the duration, you can perceive through the creature's senses (including any special senses such as Lifesense) as a free action, switching between your own and the creature's perspective at will. While perceiving through the creature, you can use it as the origin point for ranged attacks and powers. The sustain cost is 1 Focus increment per round (no AP required).

Tier 4

MASS HASTE — PSYCHIC POWER 4

TIME

Range: Burst 3 within 16
Duration: 2 Rounds
Difficulty: 8
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3
Effect: The target(s) gain 1 additional AP while the spell lasts. They also gain a +2 bonus to their Movement Speed and a +10 bonus to their Initiative value.
Augment 2: The duration increases to 2+1d3 rounds.
Augment 2: The bonuses to speed and initiative increase to +3 and +15, respectively.

IMPLOSION — PSYCHIC POWER 4

VOID

A tiny portal to the void opens where the caster directs it to, sucking in the surrounding air as it expands briefly before it collapses in on itself, blinking out of existence.

Range: Burst 10 within 30
Difficulty: 7
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 3
Resistance: Yes (Stamina 8)
Effect: All targets within the burst must make a D8 Stamina resist; on failure, they are moved up to 5 m toward the center of the burst.
Secondary: All targets within 3 m of the center take 200% Untyped damage. Any target in the center square of the burst takes 300% Untyped damage.
Tertiary: Any target in the center of the burst must make a D6 Stamina resist or be banished to the Void (death effect).

Augment 3: The range increases to Burst 12 within 36.
Augment 2: The resist difficulty for the banishment effect increases to D8.

GRAVITY WELL — PSYCHIC POWER 4

SPACE

Range: Burst 4 within 20
Difficulty: 8
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3
Resistance: Yes (Stamina 8)
Effect: You create an intense gravitational singularity. All creatures in the area are pulled 3 squares toward the center. Creatures in the center square take 300% Impact damage; creatures elsewhere in the area take 200% Impact damage. Creatures that fail their resistance check are Prone and Slowed (5) (save ends). Augment 2: The pull increases to 5 squares and the area increases

to Burst 6.
Miss: Half damage, Slowed (5) for 1 round.

Tier 5

CURSED FATE, MASS — PSYCHIC POWER 5

FATE CURSE

Range: Burst 5 within 20; all enemies in burst
Difficulty: 10
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3
Resistance: Yes (Potential 8)
Effect: For the duration of the effect, all 1s count as -2 successes, rather than -1. Duration: save ends. Augment 2: Saving against this effect requires 3 successes.

Tier 6

TIME STOP — PSYCHIC POWER 6

TIME

Difficulty: 12
Cost: 4 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Effect: You freeze the flow of time for all creatures except yourself. You immediately take 2 additional turns. During these turns, you may move and take actions as normal, but you cannot deal damage to or directly target any other creature. Any area effect you create during the stopped time takes effect when time resumes. If you directly attack or target a creature, the spell ends immediately.

MASS BANISHMENT — PSYCHIC POWER 6

VOID

Range: Burst 5 within 20
Difficulty: 11
Cost: 4 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D10 Potential
Effect: You rip open the boundary between planes, pulling all enemies in the area toward oblivion. Each target that fails their resistance check is banished to a void between worlds for 1 round, then returns to an unoccupied space of your choice within the area. Banished creatures are removed from play during this time. Creatures that fail by 5 or more successes are permanently banished.
Miss: The target is Dazed for 1 round.

REWRITE FATE — PSYCHIC POWER 6

FATE

Range: Burst 5 within 20
Difficulty: 12
Cost: 4 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D10 Potential (option 1 only)
Effect: You seize the threads of destiny and rewrite them. Choose one: (1) force all enemies in the area to reroll every die roll and take the worse result for 3 rounds (save ends); or (2) grant all allies in the area the ability to reroll every die roll and take the better result for 2 rounds. This effect cannot be dispelled by non-Psychic means.

Martial Exploits

Tier 1

LOTUS ART: IMPENETRABLE — EXPLOIT 1

LOTUS ART STANCE

"The true sage does not seek to counter strength with strength, but redirects it. The blade runs off him like water off a lotus leaf."

Cost: --
AP: 1; sustain 1
Effect: While in Impenetrable stance, you gain a +2 bonus to your Evasion.

MEASURED STRIKE — EXPLOIT 1

WEAPON

Range: Weapon
Difficulty: +1
AP: 2 AP
Effect: You make a careful, controlled attack. The attack deals 100% damage and you gain +2 Evasion until the start of your next turn.

GUARDIAN STANCE — EXPLOIT 1

STANCE

Cost: --
AP: 1; sustain 1
Effect: While in Guardian stance, enemies that move out of a square adjacent to you provoke an opportunity attack from you, even if they use Disengage. You may make one such attack per round.

STAGGERING BLOW — EXPLOIT 1

WEAPON IMPACT

Prerequisites:
- You are wielding a blunt weapon

Range: Weapon
Difficulty: +1
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2 AP
Effect: On hit: the target takes 100% Impact damage and must make a D4 Stamina save. On failure, the target is Staggered for 1 round; at the end of the Staggered duration, the target is Dazed until the end of its next turn. If the target is wearing heavy armor or is a construct, this power deals 150% damage instead.

Tier 2

LOTUS ART: PURE LAND BURIAL — EXPLOIT 2

LOTUS ART

Every soul yearns to return to the soil of the Pure Land from which it was born. This blade will show it the way.

Range: Weapon
Difficulty: +2
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2
Effect: On hit: the target takes 200% damage. Secondary: The target must make a D6 Potential resist. On failure: the target loses 5 EP, if applicable. A target killed by this power must make a D8 Potential resist each round it is dead; on failure, it cannot revive or be revived that turn. This power does not prevent discorporation.

KEEP YOUR DISTANCE — EXPLOIT 2

REACTION IMMEDIATE INTERRUPT

Prerequisites:
- You are wielding a reach weapon

Difficulty: +2
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: Reaction
Effect: When a creature moves into your weapon reach, as a reaction: you may make an attack against it. On hit: it takes 100% damage and you push it up to one square away from you. This interrupts its movement.

PIERCING THRUST — EXPLOIT 2

PIERCING

Prerequisites:
- You are wielding a weapon that deals piercing damage

Range: Weapon + 1
Difficulty: +3
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2
Effect: You lunge forward, thrusting your weapon at a weak point in the enemy's armor. On hit: the target suffers 200% damage. The attack's Pen value is equal to the damage roll.

SWEEPING STRIKE — EXPLOIT 2

WEAPON POLEARM

Prerequisites:
- You are wielding a reach weapon

Range: All enemies within weapon reach
Difficulty: +2
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2 AP
Resistance: D4 Stamina (prone only)
Effect: You sweep your weapon in a wide arc. All enemies within your weapon's reach take 100% damage. Targets that fail a D4 Stamina save are knocked prone.

Tier 3

LOTUS ART: PEARL SCISSOR — EXPLOIT 3

LOTUS ART DUAL WIELD

The honed blade cuts the line of the soul.

Prerequisites:
- You must be wielding two bladed weapons

Range: Line, Movement Range
Difficulty: 5
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2
Resistance: Yes (Dodge 6)
Effect: All targets on the line are hit once by each wielded weapon, halving armor. Secondary: The target must make a D8 Potential save; on failure: it is stilled (save ends).

CRASHING WAVE — EXPLOIT 3

SPEAR

Prerequisites:
- You are wielding a polearm

Range: Weapon
Difficulty: +3

Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 3
Resistance: Yes (Stamina 6)
Effect: On hit: the target takes 200% damage and must make a D6 Stamina resist; on failure: the target is vaulted into the air, pushing it up to 3 squares. Secondary: You may make a secondary attack against the target at the same difficulty; on hit: the target takes 100% damage ignoring armor, is knocked prone, and must make a D6 Stamina resist; on failure: the target is stunned for one round.

Tier 4

LOTUS ART: THOUSAND PETAL — EXPLOIT 4

LOTUS ART | DUAL WIELD

When the creator made the universe, it is said that he first made a lotus flower of a thousand petals, and when he scattered the petals, from each one there blossomed a world.

Prerequisites:
- You must be wielding two bladed weapons

Range: Close Burst 5
Difficulty: 7
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 3
Resistance: Yes (Dive; Dodge 8)
Effect: On hit: the target takes 100% damage, halving armor. The target must also make a D7 Potential save; on failure: it loses 2 EP.

SUNDERING BLOW — EXPLOIT 4

WEAPON

Range: Weapon
Difficulty: +4
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D7 Stamina (equipment damage only; HP damage always applies on hit)
Effect: You strike with such force that you damage the target's equipment. The target takes 300% damage. If the target fails their resistance check, one piece of their worn armor or wielded shield permanently loses 3 Armor value (until repaired). This reduction stacks with multiple uses.

WHIRLWIND STRIKE — EXPLOIT 4

WEAPON

Range: Close Burst 2; all enemies
Difficulty: 7
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D7 Stamina (push only; damage always applies on hit)
Effect: You spin in a devastating arc, striking all nearby enemies. Each enemy in range takes 200% damage. Enemies that fail their resistance check are also pushed 2 squares away from you.

Tier 5

LOTUS ART: NOBLE EIGHTFOLD BLADE — EXPLOIT 5

LOTUS ART | DUAL WIELD

"The master said: there are eight worlds in creation. To truly kill your enemy, you must cut him down in each of them."

Prerequisites:
- You must be wielding two bladed weapons

Range: Weapon
Difficulty: Special
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3
Resistance: Yes (Potential 9)
Effect: When you perform this exploit, you may make four attacks against the same or different targets. The difficulty of the first attack is equal to the target's evasion, increasing by 2 on each subsequent attack, up to +6 on the fourth. Each attack deals 100% damage at half armor. Secondary: After performing all attacks, targets hit must make a D9 Potential check. On failure, they suffer the following effects depending on how many times they were hit (these effects stack): 1 hit: the target is stilled. 2 hits: the target loses 5 EP. 3 hits: the target is exposed. 4 hits: the target dies instantly and loses 5 more EP.

DEATHBLOW — EXPLOIT 5

WEAPON

Range: Weapon
Difficulty: +4
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D9 Stamina (instant-kill effect only)
Effect: You deliver a single, devastating strike aimed to kill. The target takes 300% damage. If this reduces the target to half HP or below, they must pass a resistance check or be reduced to 0 HP. This exploit can only be used once per encounter.

Tier 6

FOREST OF CORPSES — UNIQUE POWER 6

WEAPON

You thrust Kazykly deep into the earth. For a second, everything is still before sharpened stakes of solid shadow erupt beneath your enemies.

Prerequisites:
- You must be wielding Kazykly

Range: Close Burst 10
Difficulty: 7
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3
Resistance: Yes (Stamina 8)
Effect: Every creature targeted by this power must take a Dive reaction to avoid the stake (Dodge DC equal to this power's attack roll). On failure, it takes 300% piercing damage and is immobilized; in addition, it must make a D8 Stamina check or be stunned for one round. On each of the target's turns, it must make a D6 Athletics check to vault off the stake or take 100% damage and remain immobilized. Special: If you fail the attack roll to invoke this power, Kazykly becomes stuck in the ground. Pulling it back out is a 1 AP action and requires a successful D7 Martial check.

Command Powers

Tier 1

RALLY — COMMAND 1

COMMAND MORALE

Range: one ally within 10
Difficulty: 3
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2 AP
Effect: One ally within range immediately gains +2d on their next attack roll or saving throw (their choice). If the ally is suffering from a fear effect, they may immediately make a saving throw against it with +2d.

COMPEL OBEDIENCE — COMMAND 1

COMMAND

Range: one creature within 10
Difficulty: 3
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2 AP
Resistance: D3 Potential (only if not already under your control)
Effect: You issue a forceful command to a summoned or dominated creature. The target must immediately use its next turn to perform one specific action of your choice (move, attack a target, or use a specific power). If the creature is not under your control, it may resist.

Tier 2

COORDINATED STRIKE — COMMAND 2

COMMAND TACTICAL

Range: two allies within 10
Difficulty: 5
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2 AP
Effect: You direct two allies to strike in unison. Each ally within range may immediately make a basic attack as a free action against a target of your choice. If both allies hit the same target, that target is Dazed until the end of its next turn.

TERRIFYING SHOUT — COMMAND 2

COMMAND MORALE FEAR

Range: Close Burst 3
Difficulty: 5
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2 AP
Resistance: D5 Potential
Effect: You unleash a shout that breaks the morale of your enemies. All enemies in the area that fail their resistance check are Frightened of you (save ends). Frightened creatures take a -2d penalty on attack rolls and cannot willingly move closer to you.

STRENGTHEN BOND — COMMAND 2

COMMAND SUMMON

Range: one summoned creature you control within 10
Difficulty: 5
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2 AP
Effect: You reinforce your connection to a summoned creature you are sustaining. Until the end of the encounter, the sustain cost of the summoning power is reduced by 1 Focus increment (minimum 0). Additionally, the summoned creature gains +2d on all attack rolls and +5 temporary HP for the duration. You may only benefit from one Strengthen Bond at a time.

Tier 3

HOLD THE LINE — COMMAND 3

COMMAND TACTICAL

Range: Burst 3 centered on you; up to 4 allies
Difficulty: 7

Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2 AP
Effect: You command your allies to form a defensive formation. Up to four allies within range gain +3 Evasion and +2d on resistance checks until the end of your next turn. While this effect is active, enemies that move through or out of a square adjacent to an affected ally provoke an opportunity attack.

BREAK WILL — COMMAND 3

COMMAND | DOMINATION

Range: one creature within 10
Difficulty: 7
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 2 AP
Resistance: D7 Potential
Effect: You shatter an enemy's resolve with sheer authority. The target that fails their resistance check is Dominated (save ends). While Dominated, the target acts on your turn under your control, but can only take basic actions (move, basic attack). At the end of each of its turns, the target may attempt a saving throw.
Miss: The target is Dazed for 1 round.

Tier 4

OVERWHELMING PRESENCE — COMMAND 4

COMMAND | MORALE | FEAR

Range: Close Burst 5
Difficulty: 8
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D8 Potential
Effect: Your authority is absolute. All enemies in the area must pass a resistance check or be Stunned for 1 round, then Frightened of you (save ends). Allies in the area are immune to fear effects and gain +2d on all checks for 2 rounds.
Miss: Frightened for 1 round (no Stun).

Tier 5

GRAND TACTICIAN — COMMAND 5

COMMAND | TACTICAL

Range: Burst 5 centered on you; up to 5 allies
Difficulty: 10
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Effect: You orchestrate a devastating coordinated assault. Up to five allies within range each immediately take a standard action of their choice as a free action. Each ally that attacks gains +3d on their attack roll. An ally may not be targeted by this power more than once per encounter.

Tier 6

ABSOLUTE AUTHORITY — COMMAND 6

COMMAND | MORALE | DOMINATION

Range: Burst 5 centered on you
Difficulty: 12
Cost: 4 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D10 Potential (option 1 only)
Effect: Your word becomes law on the battlefield. Choose one: (1) All enemies in the area are Dominated for 1 round (no save). During this round, dominated enemies cannot use powers above Tier 2 and must use their movement to move to a location you designate. (2) All allies in the area gain +1 AP, +3d on all attack rolls, and immunity to all status conditions for 2 rounds.
Miss: Dazed for 1 round (option 1 only).

Marksmanship Exploits

Tier 1

STEADY SHOT — EXPLOIT 1

WEAPON | RANGED

Range: Weapon range
Difficulty: +2
AP: 2 AP
Effect: You take careful aim and fire. Make a ranged attack with +2d. If you have not moved this turn, the attack deals an additional 50% damage.

GUN AND RUN — EXPLOIT 1

WEAPON | RANGED

Prerequisites:
- You are wielding a one-handed ranged weapon

Range: Weapon range; one creature
Difficulty: +1
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2 AP
Effect: You fire while moving. As part of this action, you may move up to half your Speed before or after the attack (or split the movement). This movement does not provoke opportunity attacks. The attack deals 100% damage.

Tier 2

PINNING SHOT — EXPLOIT 2

WEAPON RANGED

Range: Weapon range; one creature
Difficulty: +3
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2 AP
Resistance: D5 Stamina (negates Immobilized/Restrained, damage still applies)
Effect: Your shot pins the target in place. On a hit, the target takes 100% damage and is Immobilized (save ends). If the target is adjacent to a wall or solid surface, they are also Restrained (save ends) instead.

TRICK SHOT — EXPLOIT 2

WEAPON RANGED

Range: Weapon range; one creature
Difficulty: +3
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2 AP
Effect: You ricochet a shot off a surface to strike a target behind cover. This attack ignores cover and concealment. The target takes 200% damage.

Tier 3

SUPPRESSING FIRE — EXPLOIT 3

WEAPON RANGED ZONE

Range: Burst 3 within weapon range
Difficulty: 6
Cost: 2 Increments; sustain 1
AP: 3 AP; sustain 1 AP
Resistance: Dodge 6
Effect: You lay down a hail of fire across an area. The zone becomes hazardous: any enemy that enters the zone or starts its turn there must pass a resistance check or take 100% damage and be Prone. Enemies in the zone take a -3d penalty on attack rolls. The zone lasts as long as you sustain it; you cannot move while sustaining.

CALLED SHOT: VITALS — EXPLOIT 3

WEAPON RANGED

Range: Weapon range; one creature
Difficulty: +3
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2 AP
Effect: You aim for a critical point. On a hit, the target takes 200% damage and is Bleeding (save ends). If this attack scores 3 or more hits above the target's Evasion, the target is also Stunned for 1 round.

Tier 4

KILLZONE — EXPLOIT 4

WEAPON RANGED ZONE

Range: Burst 3 within weapon range
Difficulty: 7
Cost: 3 Increments; sustain 1
AP: 3 AP; sustain 1 AP
Effect: You designate a Burst 3 area within weapon range as a killzone. Enemies that enter the zone or start their turn there provoke a free ranged attack from you that deals 200% damage. You may make one such attack per enemy per turn. You cannot move while sustaining the killzone.

HEADSHOT — EXPLOIT 4

WEAPON RANGED

Prerequisites:
- Must not have moved this turn

Range: Weapon range; one creature
Difficulty: +4
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D8 Stamina (Dazed only; damage always applies on hit)
Effect: You take a single, devastatingly precise shot. The target takes 300% damage. If the target fails their resistance check, they are also Dazed (save ends) as the impact rattles them.

Tier 5

DEATH FROM AFAR — EXPLOIT 5

WEAPON RANGED

Prerequisites:
- Must not have moved this turn

Range: Double weapon range; one creature
Difficulty: +4
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D9 Stamina (instant-kill effect only)
Effect: You fire a single shot with lethal precision. The attack's range is doubled. The target takes 300% damage, ignoring Hardness. If this reduces the target to half HP or below, they must pass a resistance check or be reduced to 0 HP instead.

Tier 6

BULLET HELL — EXPLOIT 6

WEAPON | RANGED

Prerequisites:

- You are wielding an automatic weapon.

Range: Cone 15 or Line 20
Difficulty: 8
Cost: 4 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D9 Stamina
Effect: You unleash a storm of projectiles across the battlefield. Make a ranged attack against every enemy in the area. Each target hit takes 200% damage. Targets that fail their resistance check are also Prone and Dazed (save ends both). The area becomes difficult terrain littered with spent ammunition.
Miss: Half damage, Prone for 1 round.

Equipment

The Deathless carry the remnants of a lost age: weapons forged in factories that no longer run, armor plated with alloys whose formulas are half-remembered, catalysts housing fragments of power that predate the cataclysm. Equipment in Ashen is not simply purchased off a shelf — it is scavenged, repaired, inherited, and occasionally crafted anew by artisans working from incomplete knowledge.

A character's equipment defines their role in combat as much as their powers do. The weapon they wield determines their damage output and range; their armor shapes whether they stand in the open or fight from cover; their catalyst or reliquary channels the powers they have learned. Choosing equipment is choosing a style of play.

This chapter covers the rules for acquiring, carrying, and using equipment, as well as the systems for masterwork craftsmanship and magical enchantments that allow items to grow alongside the characters who bear them.

General Rules

This section covers the rules that apply to all equipment regardless of type: how items are carried and readied, how encumbrance works, how powers interact with implements, and how items can be improved through masterwork craftsmanship and enchantment.

Equipment States

Items a character possesses can be in one of three states:

- **Carried:** The item is stowed in a pack, bag, or otherwise on the character's person, but is not ready for immediate use. Retrieving a carried item to equip or wield it takes significant effort (typically a full action). Carried items contribute to a character's encumbrance but do not count against their Bulk or Charge capacity (see *Bulk and Charge* below).
- **Equipped:** The item is worn on the body or stored in a readily accessible location (a belt, holster, or sheath). Armor must be equipped to provide its benefits. Equipped items can be drawn to be wielded as a minor action (see *Draw/Stash* in the Combat chapter). Equipped items count against a character's Bulk and Charge capacity.
- **Wielded:** The item is actively held in hand and ready to use. A character can wield items in as many hands as they have free (typically two). Weapons must be wielded to attack with them; catalysts and reliquaries must be wielded to channel powers through them. Some items — notably light catalysts such as pendants, circlets, and tiaras — can be wielded without occupying a hand, as they are worn on the body in a way that allows the user to channel through them. Wielded items count against a character's Bulk and Charge capacity.

Bulk and Charge

Every piece of equipment has a **Bulk** value representing its physical weight and size, and a **Charge** value representing its magical resonance and encumbrance.

A character's **Bulk capacity** is equal to their **Stamina rating**. A character's **Charge capacity** is equal to their **Potential rating**. The total Bulk and Charge of all *equipped and wielded* items must not exceed these capacities. Carried items (stowed in a pack) do not count against Bulk or Charge capacity, but are subject to the character's carrying capacity instead (see below).

Non-magical items (mundane weapons, basic armor) have Charge 0. Lightly magical items have Charge roughly half their Bulk. Heavily magical items (catalysts, reliquaries, enchanted robes) may have high Charge and low Bulk. This creates a meaningful equipment tradeoff: physical warriors invest in Bulk capacity, casters invest in Charge capacity, and hybrid characters must balance both.

Carrying Capacity

A character's **carrying capacity** represents the total Bulk of items they can carry on their person, including both equipped and carried items. A character's base carrying capacity is equal to **twice their Bulk capacity** (i.e., twice their Stamina rating). Some races have a different carrying capacity multiplier:

- **Ironhands:** ×3 (their construct frames are built for heavy loads)
- **Warboars:** ×3 (bred for endurance on long campaigns)
- All other races: ×2

A character whose total carried and equipped Bulk exceeds their carrying capacity is **encumbered**: their Movement Speed is halved and they suffer a −2d penalty on all physical checks.

Focus Increments

Weapons, catalysts, and reliquaries each have a **focus increment** value. This value determines how much Focus a character spends when using powers through that implement. When a power's cost is expressed in *increments* (e.g., "Cost: 2 Increments"), the actual Focus Point cost is equal to the number of increments multiplied by the wielded implement's focus increment value. For example, a character using a power that costs 2 increments through a weapon with a focus increment of 5 would spend 10 FP.

Higher-tier and heavier implements tend to have larger focus increments, reflecting their greater power output. This creates a tradeoff: more powerful implements deal more damage but are more expensive to fuel with Focus. A character choosing between two weapons of the same tier might opt for one with a lower increment if they rely heavily on exploits, or a higher increment if they prefer raw damage and use powers sparingly.

Masterwork Items

Most equipment available to characters is **generic**: mass-produced or commonly available gear whose quality is determined by its materials and the technology used to manufacture it. Generic items exist at tiers 0 through 4.

A **masterwork** item is one crafted with exceptional skill, superior materials, or both. Masterwork quality allows an item to exceed the tier 4 generic ceiling, and for weapons, grants an intrinsic bonus to attack rolls. Masterwork items come in two grades:

- **Masterwork +1:** The item is one tier above its generic equivalent. Masterwork weapons grant +1d to attack rolls. Available at tier 3 and above; **required** at tier 5 and above.
- **Masterwork +2:** The item is two tiers above its generic equivalent. Masterwork weapons grant +2d to attack rolls. Available at tier 5 and above only; **required** at tier 6.

For armor and catalysts, masterwork quality is reflected in the item's stat line (higher Armor, Ward, Evasion, or casting bonuses) rather than granting a separate numerical bonus. Reliquaries, being remnants of the dead gods rather than crafted objects, are not subject to masterwork rules.

Crafting a masterwork item requires a Shop check at difficulty 9 or higher, along with appropriate materials. Not every skilled artisan can produce masterwork items — the combination of talent, tools, and materials needed is rare.

Equipment can be improved through technologies, treatments, and enchantments. These are described in the *Equipment Modifications* section below.

Types of Equipment

Weapons

Weapons are divided into **melee weapons** and **ranged weapons**. Each weapon has a **weight class** (Light, Medium, or Heavy) that affects its damage, bulk, and handling characteristics.

Light weapons are small and quick. They have low bulk and can often be drawn as a free action. Light melee weapons include daggers, short swords, and gauntlets. Light ranged weapons include pistols and holdout guns.

Medium weapons represent the standard arms of a professional soldier. They balance damage and handling well. Medium melee weapons include longswords, maces, and spears. Medium ranged weapons include rifles and carbines.

Heavy weapons are large, powerful, and unwieldy. They deal the most damage but have the highest bulk and often require two hands. Heavy melee weapons include greatswords, mauls, and halberds. Heavy ranged weapons include machine guns, cannons, and sniper rifles. Heavy ranged weapons must be **braced** before they can be fired accurately; firing without bracing is called **hip-firing** and incurs a −2d penalty to the attack roll.

Weapon Stats

- **Damage:** The base damage dealt on a successful hit, expressed as a flat value plus a die roll (e.g., 9+D8).
- **Penetration (Pen):** How much of the target's Armor value this weapon ignores.
- **Bulk:** The physical weight and size of the weapon.
- **Hands:** The number of hands required to wield the weapon (1 or 2).
- **Range:** For ranged weapons, the effective range in squares. For melee weapons, this is typically "Melee" (adjacent squares) unless the weapon has reach.
- **Fire Mode (FM):** For ranged weapons only. Determines the weapon's hit rate (see *Ranged Attacks* in the Combat chapter). S = single shot (one hit maximum), SA = semi-automatic (hit rate 3, or 4 for heavy weapons), FA = full automatic (hit rate 2 for light/medium, 3 for heavy). Melee weapons use "—".
- **Special:** Any keywords or unique properties the weapon has.

Weapon Keywords

Weapons may have one or more **keywords** — standardized traits with defined mechanical effects. Some keywords are innate to a weapon type (Sidearm for daggers, Reach for polearms); others are granted by technologies, treatments, or enchantments. Keywords are defined in the *Equipment Modifications* section below.

Melee Weapon Types

Daggers and Knives are Light weapons, easily concealed and quick to draw. They have the Sidearm keyword by default, allowing them to be drawn or stowed as a free action. Daggers deal less damage than larger weapons but excel as backup weapons, off-hand options for dual wielders, and tools for parrying.

One-handed Swords are the standard melee weapon for most combatants, leaving a hand free for a catalyst, shield, pistol, or second weapon. They come in Light (shortswords, force swords) and Medium (longswords, sabres) variants, balancing damage and versatility.

Two-handed Blades — greatswords, claymores, and similar large bladed weapons — sacrifice versatility for raw damage. They are Heavy, requiring significant Bulk capacity, but their damage output exceeds anything a one-handed weapon can match at the same tier.

Blunt Weapons — hammers, maces, and mauls — deal **Impact** damage rather than Rending. Impact damage is particularly effective against constructs and heavily armored targets whose plating can absorb cuts but not concussive force.

Polearms — spears, lances, halberds — grant the wielder **Reach**, allowing them to strike targets beyond adjacent squares. This makes them uniquely valuable for controlling space. The tradeoff is that most polearms cannot strike directly adjacent targets, leaving the wielder vulnerable if an enemy closes the distance.

Gauntlets are fist-mounted weapons — powered gloves, cestus, and similar devices. They are the lightest melee weapons available, leaving the wielder's hands effectively free. Their damage is modest, but their negligible Bulk makes

them ideal for characters who need a melee option without committing carrying capacity.

Several **melee weapon technologies** alter base construction. **Force** weapons project an energy edge that grants Penetration and reduces weight. **Chain** weapons use mechanically driven teeth for devastating raw damage at the cost of weight and the Powered keyword. **Power Field** weapons generate a localized disruption field for the highest available Penetration. These are described in the *Equipment Modifications* section.

Ranged Weapon Types

Ranged weapons are defined by their base technology, which determines their damage type, innate keywords, and tactical role. The following technologies are available.

Conventional Firearms

Conventional firearms launch solid projectiles using chemical propellants or compressed gas — a technology so fundamental that even the most ruined communities can produce ammunition for them. They range from crude Old War relics scavenged from ancient battlefields to the precision-engineered Perfector-pattern arms manufactured by the few remaining industrial forges.

Conventional firearms have no innate special properties: no armor-piercing plasma, no explosive warheads, no exotic damage types. What they offer is **availability**, **reliability**, and **versatility**. A conventional rifle is the weapon a mercenary carries because rounds for it can always be found. A Perfector pistol is the weapon an officer carries because it will never malfunction at the wrong moment. At higher tiers, materials and engineering improve steadily rather than introducing new physics — the guns simply hit harder, shoot straighter, and hold together better.

Conventional firearms deal **Rending** damage. They have the highest base damage per shot of any ranged weapon technology at the same tier, compensating for their lack of innate Penetration or special damage riders. They are available from T0 upward.

Plasma Weapons

Plasma weapons fire superheated bolts of ionized gas that burn through flesh and melt through armor alike. They represent the most sophisticated energy weapon technology widely available — compact magnetic containment bottles that hold and release star-hot matter in controlled bursts.

Their defining advantage is **Penetration**. Superheated plasma melts through physical armor that would stop a conventional round cold, making plasma weapons the premier choice against heavily armored targets, constructs, and vehicles. The tradeoff is **range**: plasma disperses rapidly in open air, limiting most plasma weapons to close engagements. At higher tiers, the Sunfury and Nova engineering patterns push containment technology to its breaking point — these weapons hit harder and reach further, but risk catastrophic **Overload** when the containment fields destabilize.

All plasma weapons deal **Thermal** damage and have the **Burning** keyword. They become available at T2.

Jet Weapons

Jet weapons — sometimes called gyrojets — fire miniature self-propelled rockets. What they sacrifice in per-round accuracy they make up for in sheer volume of fire. Every jet weapon is **fully automatic**, filling the air with a screaming hail of projectiles that saturates kill zones and suppresses targets behind cover.

At lower tiers the rockets are simple kinetic penetrators — cheap, mass-produced, effective by quantity rather than quality. At higher tiers the rockets carry explosive warheads, and every burst becomes a small bombardment. The Annihilator pattern represents the apex of this philosophy: a weapon that treats cover as a temporary inconvenience.

Jet weapons are the arms of choice for construct troops (who can absorb the recoil), heavy gunners laying down suppressive fire, and anyone who subscribes to the doctrine that volume of fire solves all problems. All jet weapons deal **Rending** damage and fire in **Full Auto** mode. They become available at T1.

Magnetic Weapons

Magnetic weapons use electromagnetic coils — railgun tracks or Gauss-type solenoids — to accelerate solid projectiles to extreme velocities. There is nothing exotic about the projectile itself; the damage comes entirely from the sheer kinetic energy of impact. A railgun round hits like a battering ram concentrated into a point.

All magnetic weapons deal **Impact** damage and have the **Reliable** keyword. The electromagnetic firing mechanism has no chemical propellant to misfire, no plasma to destabilize, no rocket to dud — just metal, magnets, and physics. Their inherent Penetration at higher tiers comes not from any exotic property, but from raw velocity.

The tradeoff is **infrastructure**. Magnetic weapons require significant power to operate and are heavier than conventional equivalents due to the coil assemblies. They first appear at T2 as heavy, braced railguns; by T4, the Gauss pattern has miniaturized the technology enough to produce automatic rifles. At T6, master-crafted railguns are precision instruments of devastating lethality — the quietest and most lethal weapons on any battlefield.

Flame Weapons

Flame weapons project continuous streams of burning material — promethium gel, magmatic compound, or alchemical accelerant. Where plasma weapons fire discrete bolts at specific targets, flame weapons saturate areas. They are not precision instruments; they are tools of area denial and terror.

All flame weapons deal **Thermal** damage and have the **Burning** keyword. They lack the armor-piercing properties of plasma, but their area coverage is unmatched. A flamethrower doesn't care if the target is behind cover — the fire goes around it, over it, through every gap. Flame weapons are favored by breachers clearing fortified positions, commanders who need to deny terrain, and the occasional pyromancer who finds that magical fire isn't enough. They become available at T2.

Cold Weapons

Cold weapons fire cryogenic projectiles or focused beams of cold energy that flash-freeze targets on impact. The technology descends from pre-cataclysm research into moonlight energy — the same principles that produced artifacts like the Hoarfrost blade and the Coldlight Robes. Where fire burns and plasma melts, cold **arrests**: it saps heat, stiffens joints, and makes brittle what was once flexible.

All cold weapons deal **Cold** damage and have the **Freezing** keyword. Their tactical value lies as much in control as in lethality — a frozen target is a helpless target, and even a slowed one is easy prey. Cold weapons also have moderate innate Penetration, as the rapid thermal contraction of armor plating creates stress fractures that the cryogenic payload exploits. They are rarer and more expensive than plasma or conventional arms, produced primarily by artisans who have inherited or reverse-engineered the old moonlight forges. They become available at T2.

Arc Weapons

Arc weapons discharge focused bolts of electrical energy — artificial lightning contained and directed by electromagnetic focusing arrays. The discharge follows the path of least resistance, arcing between conductive surfaces and grounding itself through anything in its path.

All arc weapons deal **Electric** damage and have the **Chaining** and **Disrupting** keywords. Their signature property is that the lightning doesn't stop at the primary target: it jumps to nearby conductors — other enemies, their equipment, their shield generators. This makes arc weapons devastating against clustered formations and shielded targets. A single well-placed shot can cascade through an entire squad.

The tradeoff is that electricity is stopped cold by insulated or non-conductive armor. Arc weapons have no innate Penetration; against a heavily armored solo target, a conventional rifle will outperform an arc rifle every time. Their power lies in disruption and area control, not single-target damage. Arc weapons are a relatively new technology, developed by adapting shield generator engineering into offensive applications. They become available at T2.

Armor

Armor protects the wearer from physical and magical damage. Like weapons, armor comes in weight classes: Light, Medium, and Heavy.

Light armor offers modest physical protection but does not hinder the wearer's mobility. Light armor typically grants a positive Evasion bonus. Robes, combat suits, and cloaks fall into this category.

Medium armor balances protection and mobility. Medium armor typically has no Evasion penalty. Combat plates, reinforced suits, and construct frames fall into this category.

Heavy armor offers the greatest protection but significantly reduces mobility. Heavy armor imposes an Evasion penalty. Power armor, battle plates, and siege frames fall into this category.

Armor Stats

- **Armor:** Physical damage reduction. Incoming physical damage is reduced by this value.
- **Ward:** Magical damage reduction. Incoming magical damage is reduced by this value.
- **Evasion:** Bonus or penalty to the wearer's Evasion score.
- **Bulk:** Physical weight and encumbrance.
- **Charge:** Magical encumbrance (see *Bulk and Charge* above).
- **Profile:** The armor's physical form factor, which determines how it layers with other armor (see *Armor Layering* below).

Armor Layering

A character may wear up to one piece of armor in each of three **profile** slots. From innermost to outermost, these are:

- **Close-fit (C):** Form-fitting garments worn directly against the body. Combat suits, bodysuits, and similar items.
- **Plating (P):** Rigid or semi-rigid protective layers worn over close-fit garments. Flak vests, armor plates, and combat frames.
- **Overgarment (O):** Large, flowing, or draped garments worn as the outermost layer. Robes and mantles.

A character may wear one piece of armor in each slot. Full-body armor such as power armor and construct frames occupies both the Close-fit and Plating slots (marked **C+P** in the armor table), meaning nothing can be worn underneath them.

When multiple pieces of armor are worn, their **Armor**, **Ward**, **Evasion**, **Bulk**, and **Charge** values are all added together. Special properties such as camouflage or stealth bonuses only apply if the piece with that property is the character's outermost worn layer.

Armor Materials

Protective gear's base characteristics depend on the materials from which they are made, as it is the case for melee weapons, and much as a ranged weapon's characteristics depend on the mechanism by which it delivers energy onto the target.

Close-Fit

Close-Fit pieces of equipment really only come in one type: most of them are bodysuits made from various types of *Synfiber*: a composite weave of several different substances, elastic, lightweight and engineered to be thermoregulating. Synfiber can be reinforced in various ways: by spinning carbon fiber into the base matrix, a Synfiber suit becomes naturally resistant to cuts and slashes; by layering nanoscales into the weave, it can disperse impact. Stealthy fighters often adopt camouflage Synfiber gear that helps them avoid detection.

The following Synfiber variants are available. Each grants its bonus on top of the base Close-fit stats without changing them:

- **Carbon Weave:** Carbon fiber is spun into the base matrix, hardening the suit against cuts and slashes. Grants resistance to **Rending** damage (2 × tier).
- **Nanoplate:** Nanoscale ceramic plates are layered into the weave, dispersing concussive force across the suit's surface. Grants resistance to **Impact** damage (2 × tier).
- **Thermostatic:** The suit incorporates thermostatic fibers that regulate heat exchange, insulating the wearer against both extreme heat and cold. Grants resistance to **Thermal** and **Cold** damage (1 × tier each). Additionally, the suit suppresses the wearer's thermal signature, granting advantage on Subterfuge checks to avoid detection by infrared vision and thermal cameras.
- **Insulated:** Rubberized layers and non-conductive polymers are woven into the suit, grounding electrical current before it reaches the wearer. Grants resistance to **Electric** damage (2 × tier).

Particularly rare suits of this kind may be made from more exotic materials — magic weaves with supernatural properties.

Plating

Plating layers are usually worn over (or, in some cases, under) Synfiber suits by warrior who require more protection and do not mind the extra weight. The lightest and least cumbersome type of plating are thin kevlar vests, sometimes with thin ceramic inserts, that can be worn under a Synfiber suit to provide extra protection from damage without compromising on the stealth capabilities of a camo suit.

The next type up are what is conventionally known as Flak Vests, bulkier pieces of chest protection that can stop substantially more powerful attacks than the thin bulletproofs. Flak plating can range from a beefier carbon-ceramic composition over sintered steel-ceramic armor plates to the lost technology of Echo Crystplate.

The heaviest forms of Plating add partial limb protection and helmets, being just one step down from full-body armor.

The following plating materials are available:

- **Ceramic Composite:** The standard plating material — sintered steel-ceramic or carbon-ceramic plates. Uses the base Plating stats with no special resistance. Available, affordable, effective.
- **Cerafiber:** A hardened, fibrous material that frays on impact, catching and stopping all but the most high-velocity projectiles. Grants resistance to **Rending** damage (3 × tier), but its Armor value is reduced by 1 × tier compared to the base.
- **Reactive:** Plates with shock-dampening gel or reactive explosive elements sandwiched between layers. When struck, the reactive layer detonates inward, cushioning the impact. Grants resistance to **Impact** damage (3 × tier), but its Armor value is reduced by 1 × tier compared to the base.
- **Ablative:** Layered heat-sink material designed as a countermeasure to plasma weapons. Each layer chars and flakes off to dissipate thermal energy, protecting the layers beneath. Grants resistance to **Thermal** damage (3 × tier).
- **Insulated:** Multi-layered insulation combining cryo-resistant polymers and non-conductive barriers. Grants resistance to **Cold** and **Electric** damage (1½ × tier each, rounded down).
- **Crystplate:** Echo Crystplate — a lost pre-cataclysm technology. The crystalline lattice resonates with incoming magical energy, dispersing it across the plate's structure. Crystplate is the only plating material that grants meaningful Ward: bonus Ward equal to **2 × tier** on top of normal plating stats. Crystplate cannot be manufactured; it must be salvaged, recovered, or reworked by an artisan with fragments of the old techniques. *(Rare.)*

Full-Body

These pieces of armor encase the entire body, consisting of a tight-fitting base layer with fully jointed armor on top that forms closed suit once fully donned. The underlying materials of these suits are the same or similar as for more disjointed plating layers. More advanced suits of full-body armor are air-tight when the helmet and heat vents are closed, and can be used with a rebreather system to venture into contaminated areas.

Powered armors usually go a step further — they are so heavy they are impossible to move without the power servos assisting the wearer's movement, and to prevent their occupants from overheating, they usually have temperature control systems that integrate with the armor's base layer to run climatized water close to the wearer's body.

The final progression, of course, are the Ironhands' construct frames — rather than wear a suit of armor, an Ironhands has their clockwork core integrated into a new armored frame that then becomes their new body.

Full-body armor uses the same material variants as Plating, but at higher resistance rates due to the greater surface area and thicker construction:

- **Ceramic Composite:** Base stats, no special resistance.
- **Cerafiber:** Rending resistance (5 × tier for heavy, 4 × tier for medium). Armor reduced by 2 × tier.
- **Reactive:** Impact resistance (5 × tier for heavy, 4 × tier for medium). Armor reduced by 2 × tier.
- **Ablative:** Thermal resistance (4 × tier for heavy, 3 × tier for medium).
- **Insulated:** Cold and Electric resistance (2 × tier each for heavy, 1½ × tier each for medium, rounded down).
- **Crystplate:** Bonus Ward equal to 3 × tier for heavy, 2 × tier for medium. *(Rare.)*

Overgarments

Under this rubric are grouped flowing garments that are usually worn not for their physical protection, but for the other benefits they provide. Thermal Camo Synfiber cloaks are used to provide both protection from sight as well as avoid detection by infrared vision, and are often draped over light or medium gear by those on infiltration missions.

Finally, robes are the mainstay of magic practitioners everywhere — they are usually woven of fibers that conduct magic well, and do not provide any physical protection beyond what their enchantment offers. It is not uncommon for frontline casters to wear a mage's cape or robe over a more physically protective base layer.

Damage Resistance

Some armor provides **resistance** to a specific damage type — Thermal, Cold, Electric, Chemical, or Rending — based on its materials or construction. Resistance reduces incoming damage of that type by a flat value, applied after Armor or Ward reduction (whichever is relevant).

The amount of resistance an armor piece grants scales with its tier and weight class:

- **Light armor** (Close-fit, Overgarment): resistance equal to **2 × tier**.
- **Medium armor** (Plating, medium Full-body): resistance equal to **3 × tier**.
- **Heavy armor** (heavy Full-body): resistance equal to **4 × tier**.

Not every piece of armor has a damage resistance. Resistance is a property of the specific materials used — a Synfiber suit reinforced with thermostatic weave might resist Thermal damage, while one layered with insulated nanoscales might resist Lightning. The base armor tables show stats without resistance; resistance is noted in the item's description or granted by a treatment or enchantment.

A character wearing multiple pieces of armor with resistance to the same damage type adds those resistances together.

Catalysts

Catalysts are implements used to channel magical energy. They are required to cast arcane spells and psychic powers. Each catalyst has a **damage** value

(the base for spell damage calculations — when a spell deals "100% catalyst damage," it deals damage equal to the catalyst's damage value), a **focus increment** value that determines the Focus cost of spells channeled through it (see *Focus Increments* above), and a **casting bonus** that grants bonus dice on the skill check to cast spells through it.

Catalysts come in two types: **Arcane catalysts** (rods, staves, orbs) are used for arcane spells. **Psychic catalysts** (crystals, masks, circlets) are used for psychic powers. A character must wield a catalyst of the appropriate type to cast spells or powers of that school. A catalyst's base stats are determined by its **tier** and **weight class**, not its type — an Arcane staff and a Psychic crystal of the same tier and class have the same base stats.

Catalysts come in three weight classes:

Light catalysts — pendants, circlets, amulets, crystals — do not occupy a hand. They have the lowest damage, increments, and casting bonuses, but free the wielder's hands for weapons, shields, or other implements.

Medium catalysts — rods, wands, orbs, short staves — occupy one hand. They balance damage, cost, and casting bonus, and are the standard choice for most casters.

Heavy catalysts — great staves, war-orbs, siege foci — require two hands. They have the highest damage and casting bonuses, but also the largest focus increments, meaning each spell costs significantly more Focus to fuel. Their bulk and charge demands are substantial. Heavy catalysts are the choice of dedicated siege casters who trade versatility for raw channeling power.

Casting Bonus

A catalyst's casting bonus is added as bonus dice to the skill check made to cast spells through it (Arcane check for arcane spells, Psychic check for psychic powers). Higher-tier and heavier catalysts grant larger casting bonuses, reflecting their superior ability to focus and amplify magical energy.

Some catalysts have the **Specialized** trait: their general casting bonus is reduced, but the bonus for spells of a specific school, element, or domain is significantly increased. For example, a catalyst specialized in Time magic might grant +2 to all Psychic powers but +5 to Time powers. Specialized catalysts are common among practitioners focused on a single discipline.

Reliquaries

Reliquaries are remnants of the dead gods, retaining some of their power even long after they passed. Reliquaries can be used by characters with the appropriate training to cast divine prayers.

Unlike catalysts, reliquaries do not grant a casting bonus. This is compensated in two ways: divine prayers have lower base difficulties than arcane or psychic spells of the same tier (see the tier guidelines in the Powers chapter), and the reliquary's **favor** system grants benefits that catalysts cannot — the ability to tap prayers for increased power and to override failed casting checks.

Reliquaries are catalysts with two unique stats: **will** and **favor**. These represent the strength of the divine will contained within the reliquary. All reliquaries begin in a state unfriendly to their users; in this state, casting any prayer with the reliquary adds the reliquary's will to the base difficulty of the prayer. To use a new reliquary without these penalties, a character must make a favor check; the difficulty of that favor check is equal to the tier of the reliquary plus its will.

If the favor check is passed, the character loses the casting penalties to prayers with that reliquary and gains the amount of **favor** indicated on the reliquary's stat block (usually 1). A character may expend favor in two ways: to **tap** a prayer, increasing its power (see the section on prayers for an explanation) as well as to pass a failed command check made to cast a prayer. If a character's favor with a reliquary drops to 0, casting prayers with that reliquary is again subject to the will penalty of the reliquary.

If a character fails a favor check, they have displeased the deity and suffer the consequences.

Reliquaries also control the prayers that a wielder can make use of. Each reliquary typically gives access to prayers from between one to three aspects. The maximum tier of prayer that a wielder receives from the reliquary is equal to the tier of the reliquary. For example, a tier three reliquary that grants access to the Scarab and Ash aspects would grant access to prayers in those aspects up to tier three, as long as it remained wielded.

Some reliquaries may grant access to unique prayers not part of any aspect, or specific prayers outside of the aspects they ordinarily grant access to. In these cases, those prayers are specially noted in the reliquary's stat block.

Equipment Modifications

Apart from the base statistics of an item of its type and tier, most items the players will encounter past a certain point in the game carry **modifications**. Modifications are several things: material, technology, treatment, enchantment. These modifications are detailed below.

Many modifications grant **keywords** — standardized traits with defined mechanical effects. The same keyword always works the same way regardless of how the item acquired it.

Keywords

The following keywords may appear on weapons, armor, or other equipment. Some are innate to a weapon type (such as Sidearm for daggers); others are granted by modifications.

- **Assault:** Hip-fire penalty is halved (-1d instead of −2d).
- **Burning:** Target catches fire on hit (ongoing Thermal damage, save ends).
- **Chaining:** On a successful hit, the electrical discharge arcs to one additional target within 3 squares of the original. The secondary target takes 50% of the primary hit's damage, reduced by its own defenses. Each hit from a multi-hit attack may chain separately, but the same secondary target cannot be chained to more than once per attack.
- **Disrupting:** On hit, the target must make a Potential check at difficulty 2 + the weapon's tier. On failure, the target is Disrupted, losing Ward equal to the weapon's tier. This effect stacks with other sources of Disrupt.
- **Explosive:** The weapon has a blast radius affecting adjacent squares.
- **Freezing:** On hit, the target must make a Stamina check at difficulty 2 + the weapon's tier. On failure, the target is Slowed (save ends). A target that is already Slowed when hit by a Freezing weapon is instead Frozen (stunned; save ends).

- **Heavy:** The weapon must be **braced** before it can be fired accurately. Firing a heavy weapon without bracing is called **hip-firing** and incurs a −2d penalty to the attack roll (see also Assault).
- **Parry +Nd:** Grants +N bonus dice on parry checks while wielded.
- **Poisonous (N):** Target must pass a D(N) Stamina check or become Poisoned.
- **Powered:** Requires a power source or charge to function.
- **Rapid Fire:** When the target is within half the weapon's range, attack rolls gain +2 automatic successes.
- **Reach N:** The weapon can strike targets up to N squares away, but cannot strike directly adjacent targets.
- **Reliable:** Reduced chance of malfunction.
- **Sidearm:** Can be drawn or stowed as a free action once per turn, even while wielding a two-handed weapon.
- **Split damage:** The weapon's damage is split between two types, each reduced by its respective defense separately. The weapon's item description specifies the split.

Negative Keywords:

The following keywords represent defects, wear, and damage. They may be found on looted or salvaged equipment, or gained through neglected maintenance (see *Equipment Maintenance* in the Intermissions section). Negative keywords can be removed by repairing the item during an intermission (Shop or appropriate skill check, difficulty equal to the item's tier + 2, plus the cost of any skipped maintenance).

- **Brittle:** The armor's structure is compromised — cracked plates, weakened weave, stressed crystal lattice. Each time the wearer takes damage that is reduced by this armor's Armor value, the armor temporarily loses 1 Armor. Lost Armor is restored at the end of the encounter. If the armor's Armor value reaches 0 during an encounter, it provides no physical protection for the remainder of that encounter.
- **Dulling:** The weapon's edge or striking surface has degraded. Each time this weapon deals damage, its base damage is temporarily reduced by 1. Lost damage is restored at the end of the encounter. If the weapon's base flat damage reaches 0, the weapon deals only its die roll.
- **Overload:** The weapon risks catastrophic failure on a misfire. When an Overload weapon misfires, the wielder takes 200% of the weapon's base damage and the weapon is disabled until field-repaired. See *Misfires* in the Combat chapter.
- **Unreliable:** The item's mechanism is worn or damaged. Each time the wielder uses this item (attacks with a weapon, channels through a catalyst, relies on armor), they must roll a save. On a result of 0, the item fails: the attack misses, the spell fizzles, or the armor provides no protection against that hit. The Reliable keyword cancels Unreliable; if an item with Reliable gains Unreliable, the two cancel each other out.

Technologies

Technologies are physical or mechanical modifications that alter a weapon's construction. They change the weapon's base stats — typically damage, penetration, weight, or damage type — and may add keywords. A technology is chosen when the weapon is crafted or retrofitted; a weapon incorporates at most one technology. Technologies are not available for catalysts or reliquaries, which are enhanced through enchantments instead.

Melee Weapon Technologies

- **Force:** An energy edge or sheath replaces or supplements the weapon's physical blade. Force weapons gain Penetration equal to their tier × 2, deal Rending damage regardless of form factor, and reduce their weight class by one step (Heavy → Medium, Medium → Light; Light weapons are unaffected). A force weapon's Bulk is reduced by ½ (minimum 0). *(Shop or Ritual, uncommon.)*
- **Chain:** Mechanically driven teeth or a motorized cutting edge. Chain weapons increase their base damage by 50% (round up) and gain the Powered keyword, but increase their Bulk by ½. Chain weapons are loud and distinctive. *(Shop, common at T1+.)*
- **Power Field:** A localized energy field that destabilizes matter on contact. Power Field weapons gain Penetration equal to their tier × 4 and the Powered keyword. Power Field technology is rare and expensive — it represents the pinnacle of melee penetration. *(Shop at difficulty 10+, rare. Requires rare materials.)*

Ranged Weapon Technologies

Ranged weapons are defined by their base technology (conventional, plasma, jet, magnetic, flame), which determines their damage type, innate keywords, and form factors. The base technology is not a modification — it is the weapon itself.

The following modifications can be applied to ranged weapons:

- **Irradiated Ammunition:** The weapon fires radioactive or chemically toxic rounds. On hit, the target must make a Stamina check at difficulty 2 + the weapon's tier. On failure, it is Weakened (3 + tier) and takes ongoing Chemical damage equal to 3 × the weapon's tier per round (save ends both). Irradiated ammunition is expensive and difficult to manufacture. *(Alchemy, uncommon.)*

Armor Technologies

- **Camouflage Systems:** The armor incorporates active or passive camouflage. The wearer gains a bonus to Subterfuge checks to avoid detection. The bonus depends on the system's tier and type (thermal, visual, magical). *(Shop, uncommon.)*
- **Powered Servos:** The armor incorporates mechanical assistance, increasing the wearer's effective Stamina for carrying capacity by 2 and granting +1 to Movement Speed. Requires the Powered keyword. *(Shop, uncommon at T3+.)*

Treatments

Treatments are material or alchemical processes applied to a finished item. They add a keyword or property without significantly altering the item's base stats. Treatments are applied through the Alchemy or Shop skills. An item can bear one treatment.

- **Silvered:** The weapon or ammunition has been treated with alchemical silver. Some creatures are immune or resistant to damage from non-silvered weapons; a silvered weapon bypasses this protection. Additionally, silvered weapons deal bonus damage to undead creatures equal to 50% of their base

damage. *(Alchemy or Shop recipe, common. Costs approximately 200 × the item's tier in feathers.)*

Enchantments

An **enchantment** is a magical effect layered onto an item. Enchantments grant special abilities — they do not change the item's base stats or tier. A standard item can hold up to **two** enchantments. Enchantments can be added, removed, or replaced through rituals (using the Ritual or Occultism skill). Each enchantment has its own ritual describing the process, difficulty, cost, and skill required. The rituals for known enchantments are found in the Skills chapter.

Weapon Enchantments

- **Bloodthirst:** The weapon hungers for blood. If the weapon successfully deals damage to a living target, the wielder gains a +2 bonus to the next attack with the weapon. *(Occultism recipe.)*
- **Cursebringer:** The weapon brings doom to anything it strikes. On a successful hit that deals damage, the target must make a Potential save (difficulty equals the weapon's tier + 2). On failure, the target takes a −2 curse penalty to all of its rolls (save ends). *(Occultism recipe.)*
- **Moontouched:** A target hit by this weapon is surrounded by a halo of moonlight. Any attacks against the afflicted target gain a +2 bonus until the end of the wielder's next turn; additionally, the halo cancels the effects of invisibility for this duration. *(Ritual.)*
- **Rimebound:** The weapon is suffused with a freezing cold that never fades. On hit, the weapon deals additional Cold damage equal to 50% of its base damage + D12, reduced by Ward (but not Armor). *(Ritual.)*
- **Souldrinker:** On a successful hit that deals damage, the target must make a Potential save (difficulty equals the weapon's tier + 2). On failure, the target loses 1 EP and Focus equal to 3 × the weapon's tier. *(Occultism recipe.)*
- **Spacerender:** The weapon cuts through the fabric of space, extending its effective reach. The weapon gains Reach 2. *(Ritual.)*

Armor Enchantments

- **Deflecting:** The armor's surface is magically treated to scatter incoming magical energy. When the wearer is targeted by an area-effect spell or magical ability, the armor grants the wearer light cover against that effect. *(Ritual.)*
- **Lightbender:** The armor bends light around itself. When the wearer is fighting in bright light, the armor's Evasion bonus increases by 1. *(Ritual.)*

Catalyst and Implement Enchantments

- **Specialized (School):** The catalyst is attuned to a specific school, element, or domain. Its general casting bonus is reduced by 1, but its casting bonus for the specified school increases by 3. A catalyst can be specialized during crafting or enchanted afterward. *(Ritual, common.)*
- **Resonating:** The implement becomes more efficient at channeling magical energy with every spell cast in quick succession. For every spell channeled through the implement on a given turn, its casting bonuses increase by 1, up to a maximum of its base bonus + 3. *(Ritual.)*
- **Manabind:** The implement grants a +6 bonus to counterspelling. If the implement is used to perform a successful counterspell, the wielder recovers Focus equal to the cost of the countered spell. *(Ritual.)*

Legendary Items

Legendary items (see *Legendary* in the Basic Rules chapter) are unique artifacts with an intrinsic trait that cannot be replicated or transferred. This legendary trait is part of the item's identity and **does not count against its enchantment slots**. A legendary item can therefore have up to three total effects: its intrinsic legendary trait plus up to two enchantments. Most tier 6 weapons and some tier 5 weapons are legendary.

Building an Item

Every piece of equipment in Ashen is built from a combination of a **base item**, an optional **material** (for armor) or **technology** (for weapons), an optional **treatment**, and up to two **enchantments**. Understanding how these layers combine is the key to building, pricing, and evaluating equipment.

To construct or evaluate any piece of equipment, follow these steps:

1. **Choose the base type and tier.** Look up the base stats in the Equipment Tables. For weapons, this is the weapon type (dagger, plasma rifle, etc.) at the desired tier. For armor, this is the profile (C, P, O, or C+P) at the desired tier. For catalysts, this is the weight class (Light, Medium, Heavy) at the desired tier. The base type determines the item's fundamental stats.
2. **Choose a material (armor only).** Armor is made from a specific material that may grant damage resistance or other properties. The default material (Synfiber for Close-fit, Ceramic Composite for Plating and Full-body) uses the base stats as-is. Specialized materials may modify the base stats (Cerafiber and Reactive reduce Armor) or add bonuses (Crystplate adds Ward). A piece of armor has exactly one material.
3. **Apply a technology (weapons only).** Weapons may incorporate one technology (Force, Chain, or Power Field) that modifies their base stats. Technologies change fundamental properties like Penetration, damage, weight class, or damage type. A weapon has at most one technology. Catalysts and armor do not use technologies — catalysts are enhanced through enchantments only, and armor uses the material system instead.
4. **Apply a treatment (optional).** A treatment is a material or alchemical process that adds a keyword or property without significantly altering base stats. An item can bear at most one treatment. Treatments can be applied to weapons, armor, or ammunition.
5. **Apply enchantments (optional).** Enchantments are magical effects layered onto an item. A standard item can hold up to **two** enchantments. Enchantments can be applied to weapons, armor, or catalysts. They grant special abilities but do not change base stats or tier.
6. **Apply masterwork quality (if applicable).** Masterwork +1 and +2 raise the item's effective tier and, for weapons, grant bonus attack dice. Masterwork quality is required at T5+ (see *Masterwork Items* above).

The final item is the sum of all these layers. The following examples illustrate the process at various tiers.

Naming Conventions

Items are typically named by combining their origin or manufacturer, their distinguishing material or technology, and their base form. For example: "Perfector Mk IV Suppressed Rifle" (manufacturer + generation + trait + form), "Midnight Nanoplate Bodysuit" (brand + material + form), or "Silvered Dragon

Guard Longsword" (treatment + manufacturer + form). Unique and legendary items often have a single proper name: "Hoarfrost," "Silence," "Kazykly."

Worked Examples

Old War Longsword (T0 Medium Sword)

Base: T0 Medium One-handed Sword — 4+D4 damage, 0 Pen, 1 Bulk, Inc 3.

Modifications: None.

Cost: Free.

Standard-issue swords from before the cataclysm. Found everywhere, maintained by nobody.

Lantern Force Sword (T1 Light Sword, Force)

Base: T1 Light One-handed Sword — 4+D8 damage, 0 Pen, ½ Bulk, Inc 3.

Technology: Force — adds Pen 2 (tier × 2), Rending damage. +50% base price.

Cost: ƒ 375.

Final: 4+D8 damage, **2 Pen**, ½ Bulk, Inc 3. Force, Rending.

An energy-edged blade manufactured by the Lantern foundries. Light enough to pair with a catalyst.

Nanoplate Midnight Bodysuit (T2 Close-fit, Nanoplate)

Base: T2 Close-fit — Armor 5, Ward 4, Eva +1, Bulk 1, Charge 0.

Material: Nanoplate — Impact resistance 4 (2 × tier). No cost increase for standard material.

Cost: ƒ 600.

Final: Armor 5, Ward 4, Eva +1, Bulk 1, Charge 0. **Impact Resistance 4.**

A stealth operative's suit with impact-dispersing nanoscales woven into the synfiber.

Cerafiber Flak Vest, Deflecting (T3 Plating, Cerafiber + Deflecting enchantment)

Base: T3 Plating — Armor 10, Ward 2, Eva −1, Bulk 2½, Charge 0.

Material: Cerafiber — Armor reduced by 3 (1 × tier), Rending resistance 12 (4 × tier). +25% base price.

Enchantment: Deflecting — light cover vs area spells. Enchantment cost ƒ 1500.

Cost: ƒ 1875 (base) + ƒ 1500 (enchantment) = ƒ 3375.

Final: **Armor 7**, Ward 2, Eva −1, Bulk 2½, Charge 0. **Rending Resistance 12.** Deflecting.

A fibrous vest that frays to stop bullets, magically treated to scatter area spells. Built for soldiers expecting both conventional and magical fire.

Silvered Dragon Guard Longsword, Moontouched (T2 Medium Sword, Silvered + Moontouched)

Base: T2 Medium One-handed Sword — 9+D8 damage, 0 Pen, 1 Bulk, Inc 5.

Treatment: Silvered — bonus damage vs undead (50% base), bypasses undead resistance. Cost: ƒ 400 (200 × tier).

Enchantment: Moontouched — halo on hit (+2 to attacks vs target, cancels invisibility). Cost: ƒ 2000.

Cost: ƒ 750 (base) + ƒ 400 + ƒ 2000 = ƒ 3150.

Final: 9+D8 damage, 0 Pen, 1 Bulk, Inc 5. Silvered, Moontouched.

A Dragon Guard officer's blade treated with alchemical silver and blessed with moonlight. Standard issue for undead operations.

Masterwork +1 Specialized Polybind Staff (T4 Medium Arcane Catalyst, Specialized + Resonating)

Base: T4 Medium Catalyst — 15+D10 damage, Inc 13, +4 Casting, 1 Bulk, 3½ Charge, 1 Hand.

Enchantment 1: Specialized (Ice) — general casting reduced to +3, Ice casting increased to +7.

Enchantment 2: Resonating — casting bonus increases by +1 per spell per turn (max +6/+10).

Masterwork +1: +1d to attack rolls. +50% base price.

Cost: ƒ 9000 (base + MW) + ƒ 4000 (two enchantments) = ƒ 13000.

Final: 15+D10 damage, Inc 13, **+3 Casting (+7 Ice)**, 1 Bulk, 3½ Charge. MW+1, Resonating.

An artisan-crafted staff of polybind crystal, attuned to ice magic and responsive to rapid casting. A dedicated cryomancer's implement.

Combination Rules

- **Armor:** one material (optional) + one technology (optional) + up to two enchantments.
- **Weapons:** one technology (optional) + one treatment (optional) + up to two enchantments.
- **Catalysts:** Specialized trait (optional, counts as one enchantment) + up to two enchantments.
- **Reliquaries:** Not subject to modification. Their properties are intrinsic to the divine remnant.

A material and a treatment are always compatible. A technology and a treatment are always compatible. Two enchantments are always compatible unless their descriptions say otherwise.

Pricing Guidelines

The cost of a finished item is the sum of its base cost and the costs of its modifications:

Base item cost by tier:

- **Tier 0:** Free (starting gear, Old War surplus).
- **Tier 1:** 200–500 feathers.
- **Tier 2:** 600–1,500 feathers.
- **Tier 3:** 1,500–3,500 feathers.
- **Tier 4:** 4,000–8,000 feathers.
- **Tier 5:** 8,000–15,000 feathers (masterwork required).
- **Tier 6:** Unique. Cannot be purchased; must be found, earned, or crafted from legendary materials.

Within each tier, heavier and more complex items cost more. A T2 Heavy railgun (3,000 feathers) costs more than a T2 Light plasma pistol (800 feathers).

Modification costs:

- **Standard material variant** (Carbon Weave, Nanoplate, Ceramic Composite, Ablative, Insulated, Thermostatic): included in the base item price. Choosing a standard material does not increase cost.
- **Tradeoff material** (Cerafiber, Reactive): +25% of base price. These require specialized construction.
- **Rare material** (Crystplate): +100% of base price, if available at all. Crystplate items are not sold on the open market; they must be salvaged or commissioned from a specialist.
- **Treatment** (Silvered, etc.): approximately 200 × the item's tier in feathers. Treatments can be applied after purchase.

- **Technology** (Force): +50% of base price. (Chain): +25%. (Power Field): +100%, and only available at T3+.
- **Enchantment:** 500–2,000 × the item's tier in feathers, depending on the enchantment's power and rarity. Requires a ritual or recipe (see Skills chapter).
- **Masterwork:** +50% of base price for +1, +100% for +2. Requires a Shop check at difficulty 9+.

These are guidelines, not fixed prices. The GM should adjust based on availability, the local economy, and the story.

Tier Appropriateness

Not every modification is available at every tier. The following guidelines help the GM determine what is reasonable:

- **T0:** No modifications. Old War gear is what it is.
- **T1:** Standard materials. Simple treatments (Silvered). Basic technologies (Force, Chain). No enchantments — the item is not sophisticated enough to hold one.
- **T2:** All standard materials. All treatments. All technologies. First enchantment slot becomes available. Plasma, Cold, Arc, and Magnetic weapons first appear.
- **T3:** Crystplate first becomes available (rare). Power Field technology becomes available (rare). Two enchantment slots available.
- **T4:** All modifications available. Generic items cap at T4 without masterwork quality.
- **T5–T6:** Masterwork required. Rare materials and powerful enchantments are expected at this tier. T6 items are unique by definition.

Equipment Tables

Melee Weapons by Type

All melee weapons deal **Rending** damage unless otherwise noted. Blunt weapons deal **Impact** damage instead. See *Melee Weapon Types* and *Equipment Modifications* for descriptions of weapon types and technologies.

Daggers and Knives

BASE DAGGERS AND KNIVES — LIGHT, 1 HAND, SIDEARM

Tier	Price	Damage	Pen	Bulk	Inc
0	—	2+D6	0	½	2
1	*ƒ 200*	5+D6	0	½	3
2	*ƒ 500*	7+D6	0	½	4
3	*ƒ 1500*	9+D8	0	½	7
4	*ƒ 4000*	11+D8	0	½	11
5	*ƒ 8000*	13+D10	0	½	14
6	*ƒ 12000*	16+D10	0	½	17

One-handed Swords

BASE ONE-HANDED SWORDS — 1 HAND

Tier	Wt	Price	Damage	Pen	Bulk	Inc
0	M	—	4+D4	0	1	3
1	L	*ƒ 250*	4+D8	0	½	3
1	M	*ƒ 350*	6+D6	0	1	4
2	L	*ƒ 500*	7+D8	0	½	4
2	M	*ƒ 750*	9+D8	0	1	5
3	L	*ƒ 1800*	9+D10	0	1	8
3	M	*ƒ 2500*	11+2D8	0	2	9
4	L	*ƒ 4000*	11+D10	0	1	11
4	M	*ƒ 5500*	14+D10	0	2	12
5	L	*ƒ 8000*	14+D12	0	1	15
5	M	*ƒ 10000*	16+D12	0	2	15
6	L	*ƒ 12000*	16+2D8	0	1	17
6	M	*ƒ 16000*	18+2D8	0	2	17

Two-handed Blades

BASE TWO-HANDED BLADES — HEAVY, 2 HANDS

Tier	Price	Damage	Pen	Bulk	Inc
0	–	4+D6	0	2	4
1	*ƒ 500*	7+D8	0	2	5
2	*ƒ 1200*	10+D10	0	2	7
3	*ƒ 2500*	13+2D8	0	3	9
4	*ƒ 6000*	16+D12	0	3	12
5	*ƒ 12000*	20+D12	0	3	15
6	*ƒ 20000*	24+2D10	0	3	18

Blunt Weapons

BASE BLUNT WEAPONS — HEAVY, 2 HANDS, IMPACT DAMAGE

Tier	Price	Damage	Pen	Bulk	Inc
0	–	6+D3	0	2	4
1	*ƒ 500*	8+D6	0	2	5
2	*ƒ 800*	10+D6	0	2	6
3	*ƒ 2000*	14+D8	0	3	8
4	*ƒ 5500*	17+D10	0	3	12
5	*ƒ 11000*	20+D12	0	3½	16
6	*ƒ 20000*	24+2D8	0	4	18

One-handed blunt weapons (maces, disruption hammers) are Medium weight, 1 hand, and use the damage of the next lower tier's two-handed variant as a guideline.

Polearms

BASE POLEARMS — 2 HANDS, REACH 2

Tier	Price	Damage	Pen	Bulk	Inc
0	–	5+D3	0	2 (M)	3
1	*ƒ 350*	7+D6	0	2 (M)	4
2	*ƒ 900*	10+D8	0	2½ (H)	6
3	*ƒ 2200*	13+D10	0	3 (H)	8
4	*ƒ 5500*	16+D10	0	3 (H)	12
5	*ƒ 11000*	20+D12	0	3 (H)	15
6	*ƒ 18000*	25+2D10	0	3 (H)	18

Gauntlets

BASE GAUNTLETS — LIGHT, 1 HAND

Tier	Price	Damage	Pen	Bulk	Inc
0	—	2+D4	0	¼	2
1	*ƒ 200*	4+D6	0	¼	3
2	*ƒ 600*	7+D6	0	½	5
3	*ƒ 1500*	9+D8	0	½	7
4	*ƒ 4000*	11+D8	0	½	10
5	*ƒ 8000*	13+D10	0	½	13
6	*ƒ 12000*	16+D10	0	½	16

Ranged Weapons by Type

See *Ranged Weapon Types* for descriptions of each weapon technology.

Conventional Firearms

Form factors:

- **Pistol:** Light, 1 hand, Short–Medium range, Single shot, Sidearm.
- **Rifle:** Medium, 2 hands, Long–Very Long range, Single or Semi-Auto (SA 3).
- **Heavy:** Heavy, 2 hands, Very Long range, Single shot, Heavy keyword.

BASE CONVENTIONAL FIREARMS — RENDING DAMAGE

Form	Tier	Price	Damage	Pen	Bulk	Inc
Pistol	0	—	1+D4	0	½	2
Rifle	0	—	3+D3	0	1	3
Pistol	1	*ƒ 200*	7+D4	0	½	3
Rifle	1	*ƒ 350*	6+D8	0	1	4
Heavy	1	*ƒ 450*	11+D3	0	2	5
Pistol	2	*ƒ 600*	11+D6	0	1	5
Rifle	2	*ƒ 1000*	15+D6	0	1	5
Heavy	2	*ƒ 1500*	20+D6	0	3	5
Pistol	3	*ƒ 1800*	11+D6	0	1	6
Rifle	3	*ƒ 2500*	14+D8	0	2	7
Heavy	3	*ƒ 3000*	18+D8	0	3	8
Pistol	4	*ƒ 4500*	13+D8	0	1	9
Rifle	4	*ƒ 5500*	17+D10	0	2	10
Heavy	4	*ƒ 7000*	22+D10	0	3	11
Pistol	5	*ƒ 9000*	15+D10	0	1	13
Rifle	5	*ƒ 11000*	20+D10	0	2	14
Heavy	5	*ƒ 13000*	26+D12	0	3	15
Pistol	6	*ƒ 14000*	18+D12	0	1	17
Rifle	6	*ƒ 18000*	23+D12	0	2	18
Heavy	6	*ƒ 22000*	30+D12	0	4	18

Plasma Weapons

Form factors:

- **Pistol:** Light, 1 hand, Short range, Single shot.

- **Rifle:** Medium, 2 hands, Medium range, Semi-Auto (SA 3).
- **Caster:** Medium, 2 hands, Cone area, Single shot.
- **Lance:** Heavy, 2 hands, Line area, Single shot, Heavy keyword.

BASE PLASMA WEAPONS — THERMAL DAMAGE, BURNING

Form	Tier	Price	Damage	Pen	Bulk	Inc
Pistol	2	*ƒ 800*	5+D8	8	1	5
Rifle	2	*ƒ 1200*	5+D8	8	1	5
Caster	3	*ƒ 3000*	6+D10	12	2	7
Lance	3	*ƒ 3500*	8+D12	16	3	8
Pistol	4	*ƒ 6000*	7+D12	14	1	9
Rifle	4	*ƒ 7000*	8+D12	15	2	10
Heavy	4	*ƒ 8000*	9+2D10	18	4	11
Caster	5	*ƒ 10000*	7+2D12	16	3	13
Lance	5	*ƒ 12000*	9+2D10	18	4	14
Pistol	6	*ƒ 18000*	10+2D12	22	2	17
Rifle	6	*ƒ 22000*	12+2D12	24	2	18
Heavy	6	*ƒ 28000*	17+3D10	34	5	18

Jet Weapons

Form factors:

- **Jet Pistol:** Light, 1 hand, Short–Long range, Full Auto (FA 3–4).
- **Jetgun:** Medium–Heavy, 2 hands, Medium range, Full Auto (FA 3–4). Heavy variants require bracing.

BASE JET WEAPONS — RENDING DAMAGE, FULL AUTO

Form	Tier	Price	Damage	Pen	Bulk	Inc
Jetgun	1	*ƒ 500*	8+D8	0	3 (H)	5
Pistol	2	*ƒ 700*	6+D10	0	½	6
Jetgun	2	*ƒ 1000*	9+D10	0	2	6
Pistol	3	*ƒ 2200*	7+D12	0	½	8
Jetgun	3	*ƒ 2800*	12+D12	0	2½	7
Pistol	4	*ƒ 5400*	8+2D8	0	½	9
Jetgun	4	*ƒ 6000*	12+2D10	0	2	10
Pistol	5	*ƒ 9000*	10+2D10	0	1	13
Jetgun	5	*ƒ 11000*	15+2D10	0	2½	14
Pistol	6	*ƒ 14000*	13+2D10	0	1	17
Jetgun	6	*ƒ 18000*	18+2D12	0	3	18

Magnetic Weapons

Form factors:

- **Magnetic Rifle:** Medium, 2 hands, Long range, Single or Full Auto (FA 3). Reliable.
- **Railgun:** Heavy, 2 hands, Very Long range, Single shot, Heavy keyword. Reliable.

BASE MAGNETIC WEAPONS — IMPACT DAMAGE, RELIABLE

Form	Tier	Price	Damage	Pen	Bulk	Inc

Railgun	2	*ƒ 1200*	9+2D8	0	3	8
Rifle	3	*ƒ 2000*	12+D10	0	1	9
Railgun	3	*ƒ 2500*	18+D10	5	3	9
Rifle	4	*ƒ 5400*	15+D8	5	1	10
Railgun	4	*ƒ 6000*	25+D10	5	3	11
Rifle	5	*ƒ 10000*	18+D12	5	2	14
Railgun	5	*ƒ 12000*	28+D12	8	3½	15
Rifle	6	*ƒ 20000*	22+D12	8	2	18
Railgun	6	*ƒ 25000*	32+2D8	10	4	18

Flame Weapons

Form factors:

- **Flame Pistol:** Light, 1 hand, Short range, Single shot.
- **Flamethrower:** Medium, 1 hand, Cone area, Single shot.

BASE FLAME WEAPONS — THERMAL DAMAGE, BURNING

Form	Tier	Price	Damage	Pen	Bulk	Inc
Pistol	2	*ƒ 600*	8+D4	0	½	5
Thrower	2	*ƒ 800*	6+D8	0	1	5
Pistol	3	*ƒ 2000*	11+D4	0	1	6
Thrower	3	*ƒ 2500*	9+2D8	0	1	7
Pistol	4	*ƒ 5000*	14+D6	0	1	9
Thrower	4	*ƒ 6000*	11+2D10	0	1½	10
Pistol	5	*ƒ 9000*	17+D8	0	1	13
Thrower	5	*ƒ 11000*	14+2D10	0	2	14
Pistol	6	*ƒ 14000*	20+D10	0	1	17
Thrower	6	*ƒ 18000*	17+2D12	0	2	18

Cold Weapons

Form factors:

- **Cryo Pistol:** Light, 1 hand, Short range, Single shot.
- **Cryo Rifle:** Medium, 2 hands, Medium range, Single or Semi-Auto (SA 3).
- **Cryo Cannon:** Heavy, 2 hands, Cone area, Single shot, Heavy keyword.

BASE COLD WEAPONS — COLD DAMAGE, FREEZING

Form	Tier	Price	Damage	Pen	Bulk	Inc
Pistol	2	*ƒ 900*	7+D8	4	½	5
Rifle	2	*ƒ 1300*	7+D8	4	1	5
Pistol	3	*ƒ 2500*	10+D10	6	1	7
Rifle	3	*ƒ 3000*	10+D10	6	1½	7
Cannon	3	*ƒ 3500*	8+D10	6	2½	8
Pistol	4	*ƒ 6500*	12+D12	8	1	9
Rifle	4	*ƒ 7500*	12+D12	8	2	10
Cannon	4	*ƒ 8000*	10+D12	8	3	11

Pistol	5	*ƒ 11000*	15+D12	10	1	13
Rifle	5	*ƒ 13000*	15+D12	10	2	14
Cannon	5	*ƒ 14000*	13+D12	10	3½	15
Pistol	6	*ƒ 18000*	18+2D8	12	1	17
Rifle	6	*ƒ 22000*	18+2D8	12	2	18
Cannon	6	*ƒ 26000*	15+2D8	12	4	18

Arc Weapons

Form factors:

- **Arc Pistol:** Light, 1 hand, Short range, Single shot.
- **Arc Rifle:** Medium, 2 hands, Medium range, Semi-Auto (SA 3).
- **Arc Projector:** Heavy, 2 hands, Cone area, Single shot, Heavy keyword.

BASE ARC WEAPONS — ELECTRIC DAMAGE, CHAINING, DISRUPTING

Form	Tier	Price	Damage	Pen	Bulk	Inc
Pistol	2	*ƒ 800*	8+D8	0	½	6
Rifle	2	*ƒ 1100*	8+D8	0	1	6
Pistol	3	*ƒ 2200*	11+D10	0	1	8
Rifle	3	*ƒ 2800*	11+D10	0	1½	8
Projector	3	*ƒ 3000*	9+D10	0	2½	8
Pistol	4	*ƒ 5500*	14+D10	0	1	10
Rifle	4	*ƒ 6500*	14+D10	0	2	10
Projector	4	*ƒ 7000*	11+D12	0	3	11
Pistol	5	*ƒ 10000*	17+D12	0	1	14
Rifle	5	*ƒ 12000*	17+D12	0	2	14
Projector	5	*ƒ 13000*	14+D12	0	3½	15
Pistol	6	*ƒ 16000*	21+D12	0	1	17
Rifle	6	*ƒ 20000*	21+D12	0	2	18
Projector	6	*ƒ 24000*	17+2D8	0	4	18

The following tables show base armor stats organized by profile (see *Armor Layering* above). A character may wear one piece in each of the C, P, and O slots. Full-body armor (C+P) occupies both the close-fit and plating slots and comes in medium and heavy variants.

BASE ARMOR — CLOSE-FIT (C)

Tier	Price	Armor	Ward	Eva	Bulk	Charge
1	*ƒ 250*	3	3	+1	1	1
2	*ƒ 600*	5	4	+1	1	0
3	*ƒ 2000*	8	5	+1	1	1
4	*ƒ 5000*	12	8	+2	1	1
5	*ƒ 10000*	15	9	+2	2	2
6	*ƒ 14000*	18	10	+3	2	3

BASE ARMOR — PLATING (P)

Tier	Price	Armor	Ward	Eva	Bulk	Charge
2	*ƒ 500*	6	1	-2	2	0
3	*ƒ 1500*	10	2	-1	2½	0
4	*ƒ 4500*	16	5	-1	3	1
5	*ƒ 9000*	20	6	-1	3½	1
6	*ƒ 12000*	24	8	0	4	1

BASE ARMOR — OVERGARMENT (O)

Tier	Price	Armor	Ward	Eva	Bulk	Charge
1	*ƒ 300*	3	6	+1	1	2
2	*ƒ 1000*	4	8	+1	1	3
3	*ƒ 2500*	7	10	0	2	3
4	*ƒ 5000*	9	18	0	1	4
5	*ƒ 10000*	10	12	+1	2	3
6	*ƒ 16000*	12	22	+2	1	4

BASE ARMOR — FULL-BODY (C+P)

Tier	Wt	Price	Armor	Ward	Eva	Bulk	Charge
1	H	*ƒ 500*	7	5	-2	5	2
2	M	*ƒ 1200*	8	6	0	3½	3
2	H	*ƒ 1500*	9	10	-2	5	3
3	M	*ƒ 2500*	12	8	-1	4	2
3	H	*ƒ 3000*	15	10	-4	5	1
4	M	*ƒ 6000*	18	12	-1	4½	2
4	H	*ƒ 6500*	25	19	-4	5	3
5	M	*ƒ 12000*	16	10	-1	4	2
5	H	*ƒ 18000*	24	16	-3	6	1
6	M	*ƒ 20000*	20	14	-1	5	2
6	H	*ƒ 25000*	30	20	-3	6½	2

Named armor with special traits or unique properties is described in the *Item Descriptions* section.

Shields

Shields provide additional protection beyond what armor alone offers. They come in two forms: **physical shields** made of metal, composite, or hardened material, and **shield generators** that project a localized arcane ward field.

Physical Shields

Physical shields are held or strapped to an arm. They absorb incoming damage directly, adding their Armor value to the wielder's total. A physical shield occupies one hand unless it has the **Arm-Strapped** keyword, in which case it is secured to the forearm and leaves the hand free (but at reduced effectiveness, as noted in the item description).

Physical shields come in two sizes:

- **Small shields** (bucklers and parrying shields) are light and maneuverable. They grant **Parry +Nd** dice on defensive maneuver checks, making them ideal for characters who rely on active defense.

- **Large shields** (riot shields and tower shields) are too heavy and unwieldy to parry with. Instead, the wielder can spend 1 AP to **Brace Shield**: until the wielder moves, takes an action other than Command or Brace Shield, or is knocked prone, the wielder benefits from **light cover**. Large shields are the tool of choice for characters who need to hold a position under fire.

Shield Generators

A shield generator is a compact magitek device, typically strapped to the forearm or mounted on armor, that projects a localized ward field. Shield generators provide Ward rather than Armor, protecting against both physical and magical damage. They consume Charge capacity and do not occupy a hand.

Shield generators are small enough to grant **Parry +Nd** dice, as the ward field can be reflexively shaped to deflect incoming strikes. However, they provide no benefit when unpowered (if total Charge exceeds the character's capacity, the generator is dead weight).

Shield Stats

- **Armor** (physical) or **Ward** (generator): The defensive value provided.
- **Parry +Nd:** Bonus dice on defensive maneuver checks (small shields and generators only).
- **Brace:** The shield can be braced for light cover (large shields only).
- **Bulk:** Physical weight and encumbrance.
- **Charge:** Magical encumbrance (generators only).
- **Hands:** 1 if held, 0 if arm-strapped or a generator.

SHIELDS

Name	Tier	Price	Armor	Ward	Defense	Bulk	Charge	Hands	Special
Old War Buckler	0	*ƒ 0*	2	0	Parry +2d	½	0	1	
Lantern Riot Shield	1	*ƒ 250*	4	0	Brace	2	0	1	
Light Shield Generator	1	*ƒ 300*	0	3	Parry +1d	¼	1	0	Arm-Strapped
Dragon Guard Tower Shield	2	*ƒ 800*	6	0	Brace	3	0	1	–1 Speed
Combat Shield Generator	2	*ƒ 700*	0	5	Parry +2d	½	2	0	Arm-Strapped
Perfector Shield Generator	3	*ƒ 2000*	0	8	Parry +3d	½	2	0	Arm-Strapped
Breacher Shield	3	*ƒ 1800*	5	0	Brace	2	0	1	Ram: 10+D10 on charge

BASE CATALYST STATS

Tier	Class	Price	Damage	Inc	Casting	Bulk	Charge	Hands
1	Light	*ƒ 250*	3+D6	5	+0	0	2	0
1	Medium	*ƒ 350*	7+D6	8	+1	½	2	1
1	Heavy	*ƒ 500*	10+D8	11	+2	1½	3	2
2	Light	*ƒ 600*	5+D8	7	+1	0	2	0
2	Medium	*ƒ 850*	9+D8	9	+2	½	3	1
2	Heavy	*ƒ 1200*	14+D10	13	+3	2	4	2
3	Light	*ƒ 2000*	7+D10	10	+2	0	2½	0
3	Medium	*ƒ 2600*	12+D10	11	+3	1	3	1
3	Heavy	*ƒ 3000*	18+D10	15	+4	2½	4	2
4	Light	*ƒ 4500*	9+D10	12	+2	0	3	0
4	Medium	*ƒ 6000*	15+D10	13	+4	1	3½	1
4	Heavy	*ƒ 7000*	22+D12	18	+5	3	5	2
5	Light	*ƒ 9000*	11+D12	14	+3	0	3½	0
5	Medium	*ƒ 11000*	20+D12	16	+5	1½	4	1
5	Heavy	*ƒ 13000*	28+D12	21	+7	3½	5½	2

6	Light	*ƒ 14000*	14+2D8	17	+4	0	4	0
6	Medium	*ƒ 18000*	25+2D8	18	+6	2	4½	1
6	Heavy	*ƒ 22000*	35+2D10	24	+8	4	6	2

Common catalysts include Soul Crystals and Prana Crystals (Light, T1), Amber Rods and Blackbone Staves (Medium, Arcane), Angel Masks and Resonance Masks (Medium, Psychic), and the widely-traded Polybind Staff (Medium, T3). These are generic examples of their tier and class; named catalysts with special traits are listed in the *Item Descriptions* section.

RELIQUARIES

Name	Tier	Price	Class	Bulk	Charge	Damage	Inc	Will	Aspects
The Princess' Locket	1	*ƒ 300*	Light	0	2	4+D6	5	3	Scarab, Crown
Battlefield Dust	1	*ƒ 300*	Light	0	2	3+D8	5	3	Ash
Khâru's Ember	1	*ƒ 250*	Light	0	1	4+D3	5	2	Sun, Scarab
Battlefield Relic	2	*ƒ 800*	Light	½	2	6+D8	7	4	Ash, Crown
Heartwood Icon	2	*ƒ 700*	Light	0	3	5+D6	7	3	Maiden, Scarab
Skull Fetish	2	*ƒ 900*	Light	0	2	7+D6	7	5	Serpent
Warden's Seal	3	*ƒ 2000*	Medium	½	3	9+D10	9	5	Crown, Ash
Void Lantern	3	*ƒ 2500*	Medium	½	3	8+D8	9	6	Skull, Key
Chalice of Renewal	3	*ƒ 2200*	Medium	1	3	10+D6	9	4	Scarab, Maiden

CONSUMABLES — GRENADES

Name	Tier	Type	Bulk	Range	Effect	Cost
Acid Grenade	0	Grenade	¼	Burst 1/10	4+D10 Acid damage	*ƒ 100*
Frag Grenade	1	Grenade	¼	Burst 1/10	6+D3 damage, DC 2	*ƒ 150*
AP Grenade	1	Grenade	½	5	8+D3 damage, Pen 3	*ƒ 300*
Flashbang Grenade	2	Grenade	¼	Burst 2/10	Dazed + Blinded 1 round (D4 Stamina negates)	*ƒ 300*
Plasma Grenade	3	Grenade	¼	Burst 2/10	12+D10 Thermal damage, Burning (save ends)	*ƒ 600*
EMP Grenade	3	Grenade	¼	Burst 3/10	No damage; all magitek and shield generators in area shut down for 2 rounds. D6 Stamina negates for worn items.	*ƒ 800*
Mist Grenade	4	Grenade	¼	Burst 3/10	Creates Dense Fog zone for 3 rounds. Creatures in zone at start of turn suffer Dense Fog exposure.	*ƒ 1000*

CONSUMABLES — POTIONS & DRAUGHTS

Name	Tier	Type	Bulk	Range	Effect	Cost
Red Healing Potion	1	Potion	¼	Self/Touch	Recover 1D6+6 HP	*ƒ 250*
Ether Flask	1	Potion	¼	Self/Touch	Recover 2D4+10 Focus	*ƒ 250*
Regeneration Draught	2	Potion	¼	Self/Touch	Recover 2D4+4 HP per round for 3 rounds	*ƒ 500*
Potent Regeneration Draught	2	Potion	¼	Self/Touch	Recover 2D6+8 HP per round for 3 rounds	*ƒ 650*
Potent Ether Flask	2	Potion	¼	Self/Touch	Recover 2D6+18 Focus	*ƒ 500*
Vermillion Healing Potion	3	Potion	¼	Self/Touch	Recover 2D8+16 HP	*ƒ 700*

Resistance Draught	3	Potion	¼	Self/Touch	Gain resistance 5 to one damage type (chosen when brewed) for 1 encounter	*ƒ 900*
Superior Ether Flask	4	Potion	¼	Self/Touch	Recover 4D6+30 Focus	*ƒ 1000*
Scarlet Healing Potion	5	Potion	¼	Self/Touch	Recover 4D8+36 HP	*ƒ 1200*
Ether Concentrate	6	Potion	¼	Self/Touch	Recover 5D10+40 Focus	*ƒ 1800*

CONSUMABLES — SPECIAL

Name	Tier	Type	Bulk	Range	Effect	Cost
Revitalization Charge	0	Special	¼	5 squares	Revive a dead Immortal at full HP and Focus	*ƒ 5000*
Pure Land Water	5	Special	¼	Self/Touch	Regain 5 EP	*ƒ 12000*

REAGENTS & MATERIALS

Name	Tier	Bulk	Effect	Cost
Alchemical Reagents (Common)	2	¼	1 Magnitude for Ritual or Alchemy checks	*ƒ 600*
Alchemical Reagents (Rare)	2	¼	3 Magnitude for Ritual or Alchemy checks	*ƒ 2000*
Alchemical Reagents (Precious)	4	¼	6 Magnitude for Ritual or Alchemy checks	*ƒ 4500*
Prima Materia, Vial	6	¼	Legendary crafting ingredient; glows with inner power	—*
Materia Nigra, Vial	6	¼	Corrupted Prima Materia; ingredient for some Legendary Rituals. Corrupts lesser rituals	—*
Materia Rubrior, Vial	6	¼	Realized Prima Materia; ingredient for some Legendary Rituals. Worth 20 Magnitude	—*

**Prima Materia and its derivatives are extraordinarily rare and cannot ordinarily be purchased. They must be found, won, or created through Legendary Rituals.*

GENERAL EQUIPMENT

Name	Bulk	Cost	Effect
Rope (50 ft)	1	*ƒ 10*	+2d to Athletics checks for climbing when secured
Grappling Hook	½	*ƒ 25*	Allows rope to be thrown and anchored at range
Climbing Kit	2	*ƒ 50*	+2d to Athletics checks for climbing; prevents falls on 1 failed check
Camping Kit	3	*ƒ 30*	Tent, bedroll, fire starter. Required for comfortable rest in the field
Healer's Kit (10 uses)	1	*ƒ 100*	Required to perform Alchemy checks for healing. Each use expended per patient
Alchemy Kit	3	*ƒ 200*	Required to perform Alchemy checks and brew potions
Electronics Kit	2	*ƒ 150*	Required to perform Electronics checks
Magitek Kit	2	*ƒ 200*	Required to perform Magitek checks. Charge: 2
Lantern	½	*ƒ 5*	Bright light in 10 squares, dim light in 20
Rations (1 week)	1	*ƒ 10*	Sufficient food for one person for seven days
Binoculars	½	*ƒ 50*	+2d to Awareness checks at long range
Comm Unit	¼	*ƒ 100*	Encrypted short-range communication (range: 5 km)
Lockpick Set	¼	*ƒ 75*	Required to pick mechanical locks. +2d to Infiltration checks for locks
Manacles	½	*ƒ 30*	D6 Athletics to break free

EXPLORATION & FIELD EQUIPMENT

Name	Bulk	Cost	Effect
Tactical Flashlight	¼	*ƒ 30*	Weapon-mountable. Bright light 10 squares. As 1 AP action, Dazzle an adjacent creature (D3 Stamina or Blinded 1 round)
Fog-Shielded Lantern	½	*ƒ 150*	Bright light 10 squares, dim light 20. Shielded emission does not attract Fog creatures
IR Goggles	¼	*ƒ 300*	See in darkness. Spot heat signatures. +2d to Awareness in low light or darkness. Charge: 1
Combat Visor	¼	*ƒ 500*	Heads-up display. Negates concealment penalties from smoke and dim light. +1d Marksmanship. Charge: 1
Mist Filter	¼	*ƒ 200*	Reduces Fog exposure severity by one step (Extreme → Dense, Dense → Light). Lasts 8 hours per filter cartridge
Rebreather	½	*ƒ 400*	Full respiratory protection. Negates Fog exposure effects and airborne poisons for 4 hours per canister
Multi-Spectrum Sensor	½	*ƒ 350*	Handheld scanner. Detects magical, thermal, and radiation signatures within 15 squares. +2d to Awareness for detection. Charge: 1
Motion Sensor	¼	*ƒ 250*	Deployable. Alerts to movement within 15 squares for 8 hours. Can be linked to a comm unit
Signal Flare Kit (6)	½	*ƒ 50*	Visible at extreme range. Can mark locations or signal allies. Burns for 1 minute
Grapnel Launcher	1	*ƒ 200*	Fires a grappling hook up to 20 squares. 1 AP to fire. Includes 50 ft integrated line
Portable Fog Ward	1	*ƒ 800*	Creates a 2-square safe zone where Fog exposure is suppressed for 8 hours. Charge: 3
Advanced Comm Unit	¼	*ƒ 500*	Encrypted long-range communication (50 km). Fog-resistant signal. Charge: 1
Breaching Charge	½	*ƒ 400*	Destroys doors, walls, and barricades. 30+3D10 damage to structures; Burst 1 to creatures adjacent to the breach

Item Descriptions

Power Field Parry Dagger

Tier 4 Dagger; Powered

This dagger grants a +4 equipment bonus to parry checks.

Memento Mori

Tier 4 Psychic Catalyst; Time, Fate

An amulet carved in the form of a miniature human skull. The Dark-Elven inscription reads 'Remember thou, o mage, that one day thou, too, shalt face oblivion'.

The Memento Mori grants its wielder a +2 equipment bonus to manifesting Psychic powers. The bonus increases to +5 for Time and Fate powers.

Hoarfrost

Tier 5 Medium Sword; Cold

A longsword of pale blue steel, rimed with frost that never melts.

Hoarfrost is a +2 Masterwork Rimebound Longsword. It has the following traits:

Rimebound Blade: Hoarfrost deals an additional 7+D12 Cold damage on hit, reduced by Ward (but not Armor). The listed damage in the weapon table is the physical component only; the total effective damage is 14+2D12 split between physical and magical defenses.

Unmelting Edge: Attacks with this weapon gain a +2 equipment bonus to their accuracy.

Void Blade

Tier 5 Legendary Katana; Void

The Void Blade is a +1 Masterwork Spacerender Souldrinker Katana. It has the following traits:

Spacerender: The Void Blade has a reach of 2.

Soul Drain: A target hit by the Void Blade must make a D6 Potential save. On failure, the target loses 1 EP and 15+D10 Focus.

Nowhere Edge: *(Legendary.)* The wielder of this katana gains access to the Wounds from Nowhere legendary power.

WOUNDS FROM NOWHERE — INNATE 5

VOID

Prerequisites:

- You must be wielding the Void Blade.

Range: 1 within 15
Difficulty: 7
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2
Resistance: No (Ward applies)
Effect: The target must make a D8 Potential save; on failure, it takes 300% damage, ignoring armor. On success: it takes 100% damage. Whether the check fails or succeeds, the Void Blade cannot be used until the end of your next turn after you attempt to manifest this power, when it returns to your hand.

Poynting Rad-Fleche

Tier 5 Masterwork Pistol; Radiation, Poison, Sidearm

A heavy pistol chambered for depleted uranium flechettes. The weapon is warm to the touch and faintly hums when loaded.

The Poynting Rad-Fleche is a +1 Masterwork conventional pistol. It has the following traits:

DU Fleche-Rounds: The heavy metal flechettes fired by this weapon have a tendency to burst into flame. When this weapon strikes a target whose Armor value exceeds the weapon's Penetration, the weapon deals an additional 5+2D10 Thermal damage.

Toxic Rounds: The flechettes fired by this gun are both radioactive and highly toxic. A target hit by this weapon must make a D7 Stamina save; on failure, it is Weakened (8) and takes 15 Chemical damage per round (save ends both).

Caesium Rod

Tier 5 Psychic Catalyst; Time

A rod of radioactive caesium, encased in a protective sheet of rune-etched lead glass. The resonance of the metal core enhances this catalyst's power in manifesting Time powers.

Resonant Frequency: This rod grants the wielder a +3 equipment bonus to manifesting Psychic powers, increasing to +6 for Time powers.

Kazykly

Tier 6 Legendary Spear; Blood, Shadow, Two-handed, Reach

Kazykly is a Legendary +2 Masterwork Cursebringer Bloodthirst Lance. It has the following traits:

Bloodthirst: The weapon hungers for the blood of its foes. If Kazykly successfully deals damage to a living target, the wielder gains a +2 bonus to the next attack with the weapon.

Cursebringer: The weapon brings doom to anything it strikes. If Kazykly successfully deals damage to a target, the target must make a D7 Potential save. On failure, it takes a −2 curse penalty to all of its rolls (save ends).

Reach: This weapon has a range of 3, but it cannot strike directly adjacent targets.

The Lord Impaler: *(Legendary.)* Kazykly grants its wielder the Forest of Corpses unique power.

Moonlight Shortsword

Tier 6 Masterwork Shortsword; Moonlight

The Moonlight Shortsword is a +2 Masterwork Moontouched Bloodthirst Shortsword. It has the following traits:

Moontouched: A target hit by this sword is surrounded by a halo of moonlight that makes it easier to hit. Any attacks against the afflicted target gain a +2 bonus until the end of the wielder's next turn; additionally, the halo cancels the effects of invisibility for this duration.

Bloodthirst: The weapon hungers for the blood of its foes. If this sword successfully deals damage to a living target, the wielder gains a +2 bonus to the next attack with the weapon.

Silence

Tier 6 Legendary Sniper Rifle; Blood, Moonlight

On the field where bloody battle had raged, there reigned a great silence.

Silence is a Legendary +2 Masterwork Moontouched Bloodthirst Sniper Rifle. It has the following traits:

Moontouched: A target hit by a shot from Silence is surrounded by a halo of moonlight that makes it easier to hit. Any attacks against the afflicted target gain a +2 bonus until the end of the wielder's next turn; additionally, the halo cancels the effects of invisibility for this duration.

Bloodthirst: If Silence successfully deals damage to a living target, the wielder gains a +2 bonus to the next attack with the weapon.

Piercing Silence: *(Legendary.)* Shots from this weapon are magically silenced and cannot be detected by auditory means outside of a radius of 5 meters from the weapon itself. Additionally, a target struck by Silence must make a D6 Potential check or be silenced (save ends). A target killed by a shot from Silence fails this check automatically.

Moonlight Railgun

Tier 6 Masterwork Sniper Rifle; Blood, Moonlight

The Moonlight Railgun is a +2 Masterwork Moontouched Bloodthirst Sniper Rifle. It shares the Moontouched and Bloodthirst traits with its legendary counterpart Silence.

Coldlight Robes

Tier 6 Masterwork Light Armor; Robe, Ice, Light

The priests of Iyalan specialized in spinning the silver light of the moon into magical threads, cold to the touch as silver, yet sheer as silk.

Moonsilver: These robes grant the wearer a +3 bonus to casting Ice and Moonlight spells.

Aura of Cold: In battle, these robes generate a vortex of cold air. The vortex is an Aura 1; any creature that enters or starts its turn in the aura takes 20 Cold damage. Suppressing or reactivating this aura is a free action, but can only be done once per round.

Sheer Reflection: In moonlight, the robes become suffused with magical power. Their Ward and Evasion bonuses increase to 30 and +5 respectively; additionally, the casting bonuses increase to +5 each.

Moonlight Combat Suit

Tier 6 Masterwork Light Armor; Moonlight

Branded with the sigil of the Heirs, this masterwork combat suit was made for one of the Blood Moon's Oathpledged.

This suit is a +2 Lightbender Deflecting Synscale combat suit.

Masterwork Synscale: The overlapping plates of ultra-thin material provide excellent protection and hide the wearer's physical and magical emissions. The wearer gains a +4d bonus to subterfuge checks to avoid detection by any senses, including lifesense and magicsense, other than smell.

Light Bender: This suit bends the light around it. When fighting in bright light, its Evasion bonus increases by 1.

Deflecting: The synscales are magically treated. When the wearer is targeted by an area-effect spell or magical ability, the suit grants the wearer light cover against that effect.

Moonlight Blessing: In moonlight, as a 1 AP action, the wearer can spend 2 EP to become invisible to all senses for the scene or while they remain in the moonlight.

Vanth's Sypharion

Tier 6 Legendary Light Armor

This set of armor was once owned by Vanth, shadow of the midnight gates. Seemingly composed of the actual black scales of some monstrous serpent, it does not provide the protection of heavier materias, but its magical powers more than make up for it.

Shadowscale: The scales attenuate the presence of the wearer. The wearer gains a +5d bonus to subterfuge checks made to avoid detection by any senses, including supernatural ones. Its Evasion bonus increases to +5 in low light or darkness.

Keratin Point: The scales are artfully arranged to present very few flat surfaces, deflecting a great proportion of incoming thrusts. The wearer gains cover against attacks dealing piercing damage.

Slough Off: *(Legendary.)* When damaged, the armor can expel a thin layer of skin, like the moult of a snake. Once per round, when hit by an attack, a wearer possessing the Fey Jaunt ability can use it to escape the attack, leaving behind a husk of sloughed-off skin. The attack affects the husk instead.

Moonray

Tier 6 Legendary Staff; Arcane, Cold, Moonlight

Legendary staff of Iyalan, cast from millions of strands of solid moonlight. The staff is cold to the touch and smooth like glass, emanating a faint silver glow.

Moonray is a Legendary +2 Masterwork Resonating Manabind Staff.

Resonating: Moonray becomes more efficient at channeling magical energy with every spell it casts in quick succession. For every spell channeled through Moonray on a given turn, its casting bonuses increase by 1, up to a maximum of +6/+9.

Manabind: Moonray grants a +6 bonus to counterspelling. If Moonray is used to perform a successful counterspell, the wielder recovers Focus equal to the cost of the countered spell.

Solid Moonlight: *(Legendary.)* Moonray grants a +4 bonus to casting Arcane spells. This bonus increases to +7 for Ice and Moonlight spells.

Serpent Staff

Tier 6 Catalyst; Psychic, Divine

A staff shaped like a winding snake, carved from green-lacquered wood and topped with a glowing green gemstone held between the serpent's teeth. An eerie power emanates from it.

The Serpent Staff is a Legendary Masterwork Psychic catalyst.

Psychic: Grants a +4 equipment bonus to manifesting Psychic powers, and a +7 bonus to manifesting Fate powers.

Mana Toxin: Powers manifested using this staff apply a −3 penalty to attempts to counterspell them. When a power is successfully manifested through this catalyst, the wielder gains an Aura 10 until the beginning of their next turn; attempts to cast Arcane spells in this aura suffer a −4 penalty.

Vessel of the World Serpent: *(Legendary.)* The Serpent Staff is also a Reliquary of the World Serpent (Aspects: Scarab, Serpent; Will 8; Favor 3).

Combat

Zalahaiči ūyir čama mai yih kazna ayavurohu kawav ova zā.

All the treasure in the world is not worth the glory of a single battle.

— Elth, Twin Swords of the Midnight Gates

Sometimes, characters' conflicts cannot be resolved in a way other than coming to blows. These situations are handled by the combat rules.

How combat works

When characters find themselves in combat, they enter into **structured time** - because the action being described usually happens over the course of just a few seconds, it is important to track the time in detail. To do so, each combat scene is modeled as a cyclical sequence of rounds.

The order of combat

Combat is structured time (see *Structured Time* in the Core Rules chapter). Each combat scene is divided into rounds, and the order of turns within each round is determined by initiative. For the core rules on rounds, initiative ticks, and action points, refer to that section.

Surprise

A combat begins when the first hostile action is taken or declared.

If a combat begins and some participants are not aware of their opponents, they are surprised. A surprised combatant is **exposed** until they take their first turn.

If this happens, the aware combatants may act in a special surprise round before the combat proper begins. During the surprise round, only aware combatants may act; surprised combatants skip their turns.

Extreme Initiative and Surprise

A combatant that achieves Extreme Initiative takes their first turn during the surprise round. If this happens, they may treat all other combatants as surprised during their first turn, even if they would not otherwise be surprised.

A combatant that already has surprise and rolls an initiative higher than 99 also receives this benefit, in effect obtaining two surprise turns.

The Grid

Combat in Ashen takes place on a square grid. Each square represents a 1-meter by 1-meter area. Miniatures, tokens, or other markers are used to track the positions of creatures and objects on the grid.

Creature Size

A creature's size determines how many squares it occupies. A creature of Size X occupies a space of X by X squares. Most player characters are Size 1. Larger creatures — such as a warhorse (Size 2) or a dragon (Size 3) — occupy correspondingly larger spaces.

Facing

Creatures do not have a facing. A creature can see and act in all directions equally unless an effect specifically limits its field of vision.

Movement

During combat, creatures move across the grid by spending movement from their Movement Speed. A creature's Movement Speed determines how many squares it can traverse with a single move action.

Orthogonal and Diagonal Movement

Moving one square in a cardinal direction (north, south, east, or west) costs 1 square of movement. Moving one square diagonally costs 1.5 squares of movement, rounded down. In practice, this means that every second diagonal step in a single move costs 2 squares of movement instead of 1. The count of diagonal steps resets at the start of each move action.

> *Example:* A character with Movement Speed 5 takes a move action. They step diagonally (1 square spent), then diagonally again (2 squares spent — the second diagonal costs 2), then move north (1 square spent), then diagonally (1 square spent). They have spent 5 squares total and their move ends.

Difficult and Treacherous Terrain

Some squares contain terrain that impedes movement.

- **Difficult terrain** costs 2 squares of movement per square entered. A creature cannot charge through difficult terrain.
- **Treacherous terrain** costs 2 squares of movement per square entered, as difficult terrain. Additionally, a creature moving through treacherous terrain must make an Acrobatics or Athletics check (difficulty 3) each round of movement or fall prone.

These costs stack with diagonal movement costs. A diagonal step into difficult terrain costs 3 squares of movement on an odd step and 4 on an even step.

Moving Through Other Creatures

You can move through a square occupied by an allied creature, but you cannot end your turn in that square. Moving through an ally's space does not cost extra movement.

You cannot move through a square occupied by a hostile creature unless you have an ability that specifically allows it (such as the Vault advance). Creatures may always move through the space of a creature at least 2 sizes larger or smaller than them.

Occupied Squares

A creature cannot voluntarily end its movement in a square occupied by another creature. If an effect forces a creature into an occupied square, the displaced creature is shunted to the nearest unoccupied square of its choice.

Prone Movement

A prone creature can only crawl. Crawling uses the creature's land movement speed at half its normal rate (rounded down). Standing up from prone costs 1 AP.

Movement Types

A creature may have several different movement types, each with its own speed. When you take a move action, you choose one of your available movement types and move up to that speed. You cannot mix movement types within a single move action — to switch from one type to another, you must take a separate move action (at the usual escalating AP cost).

The following movement types exist:

- **Land** is the default movement type. All creatures have a land speed unless otherwise noted. A creature's Movement Speed refers to its land speed unless a different type is specified.
- **Climb** allows a creature to scale vertical surfaces without making skill checks. A creature with a climb speed can move along walls and ceilings at that speed.
- **Swim** allows a creature to move through water without making skill checks. A creature with a swim speed can move freely in any direction while submerged.
- **Fly** allows a creature to move through the air. A flying creature can gain and lose altitude freely during its movement.
- **Burrow** allows a creature to tunnel through earth and loose rock. A burrowing creature cannot normally pass through solid stone unless its description says otherwise.
- **Teleport** allows a creature to instantaneously relocate. Teleport movement does not provoke opportunity attacks, ignores difficult and treacherous terrain, and is not blocked by obstacles or creatures — but requires line of sight to the destination unless otherwise specified.

A creature without a climb or swim speed can still attempt to climb or swim by making skill checks (see *Acrobatics* and *Athletics*), using its land speed at half rate. A creature without a fly speed cannot fly.

Elevation and Vertical Distance

When moving vertically — whether climbing, flying, swimming, or otherwise — each meter of elevation costs 1 square of movement, just as horizontal distance does. Diagonal movement in three dimensions follows the same rounding rules as on a flat grid.

> *Example:* A swimming creature with Swim Speed 8 wants to dive diagonally: 4 meters forward and 4 meters down. The diagonal distance is approximately 6 meters, so the movement costs 6 squares of its swim speed.

Forced Movement

Some powers and effects push, pull, or slide creatures involuntarily. Forced movement follows these rules:

- **Push** moves the target in a straight line directly away from the source of the effect.
- **Pull** moves the target in a straight line directly toward the source of the effect.
- **Slide** moves the target in any direction.

Forced movement is measured in squares. It does not consume the moved creature's movement speed, and it does not require the moved creature to spend AP. Forced movement **does** provoke opportunity attacks.

Forced movement cannot move a creature through solid obstacles. If a creature is pushed or pulled into an obstacle, it stops in the last unoccupied square before the obstacle.

Actions and Action Points

In combat (or other structured game time), everytime you wish to do something, you must take an action to do it. Actions consume action points; every creature has a set number of **Action Points (AP)**, usually 4 of them. On every creature's turn, that creature can take actions by spending action points; when a creature is out of action points, it can no longer take additional actions and must end its turn. On the start of its turn, a creature recovers all its spent action points. Unspent ones are lost - they do not carry over between turns.

Reactions

Reactions are special actions that can be taken when it is not your turn. Reactions do not cost AP. Each character can take one reaction per round; this reaction resets at the start of the character's turn. Some powers or advances may grant additional reactions.

Triggering Reactions

Each reaction specifies a **trigger** — the event that allows you to use it. Reactions may trigger during different phases of an attack or action:

- **Target selection** — triggers when you are chosen as a target (e.g., Fire Overwatch triggers when you are targeted by a charge).
- **Resolution** — triggers when the attack hits or misses (e.g., certain defensive abilities trigger on being hit).
- **Damage** — triggers when you would take damage or be affected (e.g., Dive triggers when you would be damaged by an area effect).

You may only use a reaction whose trigger matches the current phase.

Reaction Chains

A reaction can trigger further reactions from other creatures, forming a chain. However, a creature whose action started the chain cannot also react to something within it. In other words, each creature may only appear once in a reaction chain — either as the original actor or as a reactor, never both.

For example: you move away from an enemy, provoking an opportunity attack. You cannot parry the opportunity attack, because your action started the chain. But if an ally uses an attack and an enemy uses a reaction to interfere, you *can* yourself use another reaction in response to that reaction — your action did not start the chain.

> *Example:* Kael and his ally Ârwân are fighting a dangerous Psychic. Kael attacks the psychic with him sword. In response, the psychic invokes *Twist of Fate* as a reaction to make him miss. Ârwân, who is himself a psychic, counterspells the *Twist of Fate*, and Kael's attack lands normally.

Interrupts and Responses

Reactions come in two types:

- **Interrupt** — the reaction resolves *before* the triggering action completes. If the interrupt removes the conditions that made the triggering action possible (for example, moving out of range), the triggering action is wasted without effect.

- **Response** — the reaction resolves immediately, but does not inherently stop the triggering action. The triggering action continues after the response resolves, unless the response's outcome makes it impossible (for example, a creature killed by an opportunity attack does not continue moving).

A reaction's type is noted in its description. If a reaction does not specify, it is a response.

Universal Reactions

Every character automatically has access to the following reactions.

Counterspell

When another creature within 20 squares uses a magic power of a type that you can currently cast (for example, an Arcane spell while you are wielding an Arcane catalyst), you can counterspell as an interrupt. To counterspell, roll the same check as the one used to cast the spell; if you score an equal number or more successes than the original caster, their spell fizzles without effect.

Dive

When you would be damaged by an area attack or magical effect, you can attempt to dive out of the affected area (response). Count the minimum number of squares you would need to move to exit the area. If that distance is more than 3 squares, you cannot Dive. Otherwise, roll your Dodge characteristic against a difficulty of 3 per square you must cross. If you succeed, you move to the nearest unoccupied square outside the area and are unaffected by the attack. This movement does not provoke opportunity attacks.

Fire Overwatch

If you are wielding a ranged weapon and are targeted for a charge, you can make a strike against the charging enemy (interrupt). If the strike kills or stuns the charger, the charge ends immediately.

Opportunity Attack

When you are wielding a melee weapon, and another creature takes a move action that passes through your weapon reach and does not end next to you, you can immediately make a strike against it (response).

Strikes and Attack Powers

When a character attacks in combat, the basic unit is the **strike**. A strike is a single attack roll against a target: roll your attack characteristic (Martial for melee or thrown weapons, Marksmanship for ranged weapons) and count successes. If your successes equal or exceed the target's Evasion, the strike hits and you roll damage.

An **attack power** is any power that includes one or more strikes as part of its effect. Whether an attack power scores multiple hits depends on the power itself.

Some effects allow a creature to "make a strike" rather than use an attack power. A strike always produces at most one hit, regardless of excess successes.

Every character has access to the following attack power:

BASIC ATTACK **INNATE 0**

ATTACK | MARTIAL | WEAPON

AP: 2

Effect: Make a strike against a target within your weapon's range. For every [hit rate] successes scored above the target's Evasion, this attack scores one additional hit. Each hit deals the weapon's damage separately.

> *Example:* Kael attacks a Warboar (Evasion 5) with a dagger (hit rate 2). He rolls his Martial characteristic and scores 8 successes. The first hit lands because he met the Evasion of 5. He has 3 excess successes; at a hit rate of 2, that's 1 additional hit (3 ÷ 2 = 1, rounded down). Kael hits twice and rolls damage for each hit separately.

Resolving an Attack

When you use an attack power or make a strike, follow these steps:

1. **Choose a target.** Select a target within your weapon's range. You must have line of sight to the target unless the power states otherwise.
2. **Roll the attack.** Roll your attack characteristic — Martial for melee and thrown weapons, Marksmanship for ranged weapons. Apply any bonuses and penalties from powers, conditions, concealment, and other effects to determine your final dice pool.
3. **Determine if you hit.** Compare your total successes to the target's Evasion. If your successes equal or exceed the target's Evasion, the attack hits. If not, it misses. If the target has cover, a hit triggers a cover save before proceeding — if the save succeeds, the attack misses.
4. **Determine the number of hits.** If the attack power scores multiple hits (such as Basic Attack), divide the excess successes by the weapon's hit rate, rounding down. Add 1 for the initial hit. A strike or an attack power that does not specify multiple hits always scores exactly one hit.
5. **Roll damage.** Roll the weapon's damage once for each hit. Each hit deals damage independently.
6. **Apply defenses.** For each hit, reduce the damage by the target's defenses (see *Damage* below). The attacker's weapon Penetration reduces the target's effective Armor for that attack. Damage cannot be reduced below zero.
7. **Apply damage.** Subtract the remaining damage from the target's Hit Points.

> *Example:* Kael charges a Warboar (Evasion 5, Armor 4) with a longsword (damage 9+D8, Penetration 2, hit rate 3). Charging grants him +4d to his Martial characteristic of 7, so he rolls 11 dice and scores 9 successes. The attack hits (9 ≥ 5). He has 4 excess successes at hit rate 3: that's 1 additional hit, for 2 hits total. He rolls 9+D8 twice, getting 14 and 12. The Warboar's effective Armor is 4 − 2 Pen = 2, so the hits deal 12 and 10 damage respectively.

Damage

When a character or creature takes damage, that damage has a **type** and a **source**. The type determines what kind of energy or force is involved; the source determines whether the damage is mundane or magical in origin. Together, these determine which defenses apply.

Damage Types

- **Ablative:** Damage inflicted by weapons or effects that strip material from the target in layers, from sand-blasters to disintegration rays.
- **Chemical:** Damage inflicted by strong acids, poisons, and other corrosive or toxic substances.
- **Cold:** Damage caused by freezing effects, whether from Ice magic, cold-gas cannons, or environmental exposure.
- **Impact:** Blunt force damage. Clubs, falling rocks, concussive blasts, and magical force effects all deal Impact damage.
- **Lightning:** Damage dealt by electricity, whether natural, technological, or magical. *Lightning damage bypasses Armor.*
- **Psychic:** Damage dealt by effects that attack the mind or soul. Almost all sources of Psychic damage are magical. *Psychic damage bypasses Armor.*
- **Radiant:** Damage dealt by ionizing radiation. X-rays, radioactive materials, and similar sources cause Radiant damage. *Radiant damage bypasses Armor.*
- **Rending:** Cutting, tearing, and piercing damage. Blades, bullets, claws, and shrapnel all deal Rending damage. This is the most common damage type for conventional weapons.
- **Thermal:** Damage inflicted by extreme heat. Fire, plasma weapons, and heat lasers all cause Thermal damage.
- **Untyped:** Damage that has no elemental or physical classification. Flesh-warping magic, organ damage, and severe bleeding are typical sources. *Untyped damage bypasses Armor. It is not possible to have resistance to Untyped damage.*

Defenses Against Damage

Two statistics protect against incoming damage: **Armor** and **Ward**.

Armor reduces damage from all sources unless the damage type specifically bypasses it (Lightning, Psychic, Radiant, and Untyped bypass Armor). Armor represents physical toughness — worn protection, natural hide, or structural reinforcement. A weapon's **Penetration** value reduces the target's effective Armor against that weapon's attacks.

Ward reduces damage from **magical sources only**. If a spell, magical ability, or enchanted effect deals damage, Ward applies in addition to any other applicable defenses. A technological weapon that deals Thermal damage is reduced only by Armor; a fire spell that deals Thermal damage is reduced by both Armor and Ward. Some spells deal damage types that bypass Armor (such as Lightning or Psychic) — in these cases, Ward is the only defense.

Spells and magical powers generally specify in their description whether Armor applies, to avoid ambiguity.

Resistances

A creature may have **resistance** to one or more specific damage types. Resistance provides a flat reduction to damage of that type, applied after Armor and Ward. For example, a creature with Cold Resistance 5 reduces all Cold damage it takes by 5, after any reduction from Armor or Ward.

Resistances can come from racial traits, magical effects, enchanted equipment, or other sources. A creature cannot have resistance to Untyped damage.

Death and Revival

When a creature is reduced to 0 HP, they die. For a Deathless character, death is a severe setback but not the end — provided their body remains intact.

Dying as a Deathless

At the start of your next turn after dying, you may choose to spend 5 EP to revive. If you do, on the first turn in the round after you died, you return to life at full HP, standing in the square where you fell (or prone, if standing is not possible), and you immediately take a full turn with your normal AP. The regenerative surge is swift: a mangled corpse knits itself back together in moments, rising ready for vengeance. Mortals who witness this are often unnerved by the display.

You pay the 5 EP only if revival actually manifests. If an ally's revival power or a *Revitalization Charge* brings you back before your turn comes around, you revive without spending any EP of your own.

If you choose not to spend EP, cannot spend EP, or your body has been destroyed (see *The Fallen Body* below), your essence departs for your soul anchor and you begin reincorporating there. See *Death and Reincorporation* in the Exploration chapter.

> Whether or not you choose to revive, both revival and discorporation occur on your turn in the round after you died. If your next turn after death is in the same round you died in, you skip that turn.

The Fallen Body

A dead Deathless leaves a body behind, which is a targetable object in the square where they fell. Allies and enemies alike may interact with it.

- **Healing has no effect.** HP-restoring effects do nothing to a corpse. Only revival effects — such as *Breath of Resurrection* or a *Revitalization Charge* — can return a dead Deathless to life without them spending EP.
- **Ongoing effects on the character end on death.** Conditions, sustained spells, concentration effects, and auras originating from the dead character all cease. Effects emanating from worn or carried items, however, remain active.
- **The body can be dismembered.** A creature adjacent to the fallen body may take the **Dismember** action (2 AP) to mutilate it. Each use of this action delays the Deathless's next opportunity to spot-revive by 1 round. After the body has been dismembered three times, or if it is reduced to ash (for example by *Solar Flare*) or banished from the world (for example by *Banish*), the body is destroyed: the Deathless cannot spend EP to revive and must reincorporate at their soul anchor.

Dismembering a fallen Deathless is a valid tactic against hostile immortals — and an equally valid threat against your own party.

Melee Attacks

A melee attack uses the **Martial** characteristic (STR + AGI). Melee weapons can target creatures within their reach — typically adjacent squares (reach 1), though some weapons have greater reach.

Melee Hit Rates

A melee weapon's hit rate is determined by its weight class:

- **Light** melee weapons (daggers, gauntlets): hit rate **2**
- **Medium** melee weapons (longswords, maces, spears): hit rate **3**
- **Heavy** melee weapons (greatswords, mauls, halberds): hit rate **4**

Thrown Weapons

Some melee weapons can be thrown, using the **Martial** characteristic at range. A thrown weapon follows the ranged attack rules for range and penalties, but uses Martial rather than Marksmanship. A thrown weapon always scores at most one hit, regardless of its melee hit rate.

Ranged Attacks

A ranged attack uses the **Marksmanship** characteristic (DEX + PER). Ranged weapons have a listed range band that determines their effective range and the penalty for firing beyond it.

Range Bands

Each range band defines a **range increment** in squares:

Range Band	Increment
Short	10 squares
Medium	20 squares
Long	40 squares
Very Long	80 squares

A weapon can fire at targets within its first increment with no penalty. For each additional increment of distance beyond the first, the attacker takes a **−2d penalty** to the attack roll. If the penalty reduces the attacker's dice pool to zero, the shot automatically fails.

Example: Lira fires a rifle (Medium range, increment 20) at a target 55 squares away. The first 20 squares are free. The target is 35 squares beyond that — two additional increments (21–40 and 41–60). Lira takes a −4d penalty to her Marksmanship roll.

Fire Modes and Ranged Hit Rates

Ranged weapons have a **fire mode** that determines their hit rate:

- **Single shot (S):** The weapon fires one powerful shot. It scores at most **one hit** per attack, regardless of excess successes.
- **Semi-automatic (SA):** The weapon fires in controlled bursts. Hit rate is **3** (or **4** for heavy semi-automatic weapons).
- **Full automatic (FA):** The weapon fires a sustained stream. Hit rate is **2** for light and medium weapons, **3** for heavy weapons.

Heavy Ranged Weapons

Heavy ranged weapons (machine guns, cannons, sniper rifles) must be **braced** before they can be fired accurately. Firing a heavy weapon without bracing is called **hip-firing** and incurs a **−2d penalty** to the attack roll. A heavy weapon can be braced using the Brace action (1 AP).

Ammunition

Characters are assumed to carry sufficient standard ammunition for their weapons; tracking individual rounds is not required. The exception is weapons that fire specialized ammunition — such as rocket launchers or grenade launchers — where the ammunition itself determines the weapon's damage and effects. For these weapons, each shot consumes one unit of ammunition, and reloading costs **1 AP**.

Misfires and Fumbles

When an attack roll results in a **critical failure** (zero or negative total successes), the weapon has malfunctioned or the wielder has made a serious error. The consequences depend on whether the attack was ranged or melee.

Misfires (Ranged)

A critical failure on a ranged attack roll is a **misfire**. The weapon jams, misfires, or overheats. The attack fails automatically, and the weapon cannot be used again until the wielder spends **1 AP** to clear the malfunction (unjam the mechanism, vent heat, cycle the action).

Weapons with the **Reliable** keyword are resistant to misfires. A Reliable weapon only misfires if the total successes are **−2 or worse** (rather than 0 or below). On a result of exactly 0 or −1, the attack simply misses.

Weapons with the **Overload** keyword are prone to dangerous malfunctions. When an Overload weapon misfires, it does not merely jam — the containment fails or the mechanism detonates. The wielder takes damage equal to **200% of the weapon's base damage** (reduced by Armor and Ward as normal), and the weapon is **disabled** until it receives a field repair (1 minute outside of combat, or a Shop check at difficulty equal to the weapon's tier during combat as a 3 AP action).

Weapons with the **Unreliable** keyword must roll a save on **every attack they make**; if the save dice come up 0, the weapon misfires regardless of the original attack roll. Unreliable and Reliable cancel each other out.

Fumbles (Melee)

A critical failure on a melee attack roll is a **fumble**. The wielder overextends, loses their grip, or strikes something they didn't intend to. The attack fails automatically, and the wielder suffers one of the following consequences (GM's choice or roll D6):

1. **Overextended:** The wielder is off-balance. They suffer −2d on all checks until the start of their next turn.

2. **Dropped weapon:** The weapon is knocked from the wielder's hand and lands in an adjacent square. Retrieving it requires a minor action (or a free action for Sidearm weapons).
3. **Opening:** The wielder has left themselves exposed. The target may immediately make a free strike against the wielder as a response (if the target is able to attack).
4. **Self-inflicted:** The weapon strikes the wielder or a nearby ally. The wielder (or an adjacent ally, if any) takes damage equal to the weapon's base damage, reduced by their own defenses.
5. **Weapon stress:** The weapon absorbs the force of the mishandled blow. It gains the **Dulling** negative keyword until the end of the encounter.
6. **Stumble:** The wielder stumbles into an adjacent square of the GM's choice. If that square is occupied by an enemy, the wielder provokes a free strike.

Dual Wielding

A character wielding a one-handed weapon in each hand can attack with both as part of a single Attack action (2 AP). The character makes a separate attack roll for each weapon, resolving them independently: different targets, different damage, and different weapon effects.

Dual wielding is not without cost. Fighting with two weapons divides the wielder's attention and coordination:

- **Off-hand penalty:** The attack with the off-hand weapon (the wielder's choice of which weapon is the off-hand) suffers a **–2d penalty**. If the off-hand weapon is **Medium**, this penalty increases to **–3d**. Heavy weapons cannot be used in the off-hand.
- **Reduced hit rate:** While dual wielding, the hit rate of **both** weapons increases by 1 (e.g., a Light weapon's hit rate rises from 2 to 3, a Medium weapon's from 3 to 4). This reflects the difficulty of landing precise follow-up strikes while managing two weapons.

The primary value of dual wielding lies not in raw damage output but in **versatility**: wielding a longsword alongside a parry dagger gives you offensive reach and a strong defensive maneuver; pairing a force sword with a burning blade lets you stack debuffs; carrying a pistol in one hand and a melee weapon in the other lets you engage at any range. Characters who dual wield for the tactical flexibility will find it rewarding; characters looking for a simple damage increase will find the penalties eat into their gains.

Attack Powers while Dual Wielding

Any attack power with **Weapon** range — not just the Basic Attack — can be used with both weapons. The wielder makes a separate attack roll and damage roll for each weapon, applying the off-hand penalty and hit rate increase as normal. If the power has a damage multiplier (e.g., 200% damage), the multiplier applies to both weapons' damage rolls.

However, **secondary effects** — conditions, debuffs, forced movement, or any effect beyond raw damage — apply only once, even if both weapons hit. The wielder chooses which weapon's hit triggers the secondary effect. This prevents dual wielding from doubling the impact of powerful riders while still rewarding the extra damage output.

Restrictions

- Both weapons must be one-handed (1 Hands value).
- A character cannot dual wield while also wielding a catalyst, shield, or reliquary — there are only two hands to go around.
- Dual wielding applies only to the Attack action and attack powers that specify **Weapon** range. It does not grant extra uses of spells or non-weapon powers.
- Powers with the **Dual Wield** keyword are designed for dual wielding and override the off-hand penalty and hit rate increase with their own effects, as described in their power text.

Dual Wielding with Ranged Weapons

A character may dual wield ranged weapons (such as two pistols). The same rules apply: the off-hand weapon suffers –2d (–3d if Medium), and both weapons' hit rates increase by 1. Each weapon consumes its own ammunition or charge normally, if any.

Area Targets

Many powers and some weapons affect an area rather than a single target. An area is defined by its shape and size. All creatures and objects within the area are affected unless the power specifies otherwise (e.g., "all enemies in burst" excludes allies).

Shapes

Burst

A burst is a circular area centered on a point. A **Burst N** affects every square that is within N squares of movement from the origin square, using the standard movement rules (including the diagonal movement rounding rule). For example, a Burst 1 affects the 4 orthogonally adjacent squares; a Burst 2 also reaches the diagonal neighbors and the squares two steps away orthogonally.

A burst's range line reads **Burst N within R**, meaning the center point can be placed on any square within R squares of the caster. A **Close Burst N** is centered on the caster's own square and has no separate range.

Cone

A cone originates from the caster and expands outward. A **Cone N** extends N squares from the caster and widens by 1 square for every 2 squares of length (rounded down). The caster chooses the direction of the cone when using the power. The cone's width at its origin is 1 square.

Line

A line originates from the caster and extends in a straight path. A **Line N** is N squares long and 1 square wide. The caster chooses the direction.

Wall

A wall is a contiguous line of squares placed within range. A **Wall N** consists of up to N squares arranged in any connected shape (each square must share a side with at least one other square in the wall). Walls are typically 1 square wide and block movement and line of sight unless the power states otherwise.

Resolving Area Attacks

Area attacks do not roll against individual targets' Evasion. Instead, the caster rolls their characteristic check against the power's difficulty. If the check succeeds, the power takes effect on every valid target in the area. Targets may then resist individually if the power grants a resistance check (typically Dodge against a set difficulty, or Dodge opposed by the caster's check result).

A creature that succeeds on its resistance check against an area attack either negates the effect entirely or reduces it, as specified by the power. The Dive reaction can also be used to escape an area attack entirely.

Area attacks never score multiple hits. Each affected target takes the power's listed damage once.

Cover

Terrain, structures, and even other creatures can provide cover when they stand between an attacker and its target.

To determine whether a target has cover, draw a straight line from any corner of the attacker's square to any corner of the target's square (or squares, for a large creature). If at least one such line passes through an obstacle that could grant cover, the target has cover. Whether that cover is light or heavy depends on the nature of the obstacle.

If all lines pass through the cover, and it is an obstacle that would grant heavy cover, such as a wall, then the cover is total.

- **Light cover** – roughly half of the target is obscured (e.g., a low wall, a tree trunk, or an ally standing in the way). When a hit is scored against a target in light cover, the target makes a cover save before the hit is applied. A cover save is a saving throw (roll 3 dice; 2 or more successes passes). If the save succeeds, the attack misses.
- **Heavy cover** – roughly two-thirds of the target is obscured (e.g., firing through an arrow slit, or a creature peeking around a corner). Heavy cover works like light cover, but the cover save requires only 1 success instead of 2.
- **Total cover** – the target is entirely obscured; there is no line of effect. A creature behind total cover cannot be targeted or affected by attacks at all.

Cover applies the same way regardless of whether the attack is single-target or an area effect.

Line of Effect

An area power must have **line of effect** from its origin point to each target – an unobstructed path that is not blocked by total cover. A creature behind total cover within an area is unaffected. Creatures behind light or heavy cover are affected but may benefit from their cover save as normal.

Actions during Combat

Every character has a large and varying set of actions available to take during combat.

Standard Actions (1 AP)

Brace
Disengage
Draw/Stash
Drop Prone
Stand Up
Take Aim

Standard Actions (2 AP)

Attack
Combat Maneuver
Dash
Dismember
Use Item

Standard Actions (3 AP)

Charge

Standard Actions (Special)

Move
Use Skill
Use Power
Cast Spell

Reactions

Combat Maneuver (Reactive)
Counterspell
Dive
Fire Overwatch
Opportunity Attack

Explanation of Actions

Special Actions

Move

When you take a move action, you can move up to your speed. Move actions cost progressively more action points as you take them; the first one costs 1, the second 2 and so on.

Use Item

You can use an action to make use of an item in your possession. The amount of action points required for this varies depending on the item; it is usually a standard action.

Use Power

You can use a combat power or magic spell available to you, consuming action points as specified in the power's description. Most powers can be used as a standard action, but some may also require a full action.

Use Skill

On occasion, you may wish to take an action in combat that requires a skill roll (such as using Acrobatics to run over a cable, using Shop to restart a stuck mechanism, etc.) The GM adjudicates the number of action points using a skill requires depending on the situation.

Minor Actions

Minor actions cost 1 AP each to perform.

Brace

You can brace a heavy weapon or a large shield to stabilize or plant it. For a **heavy weapon**, bracing means propping it against a stable surface or taking

a more stable firing position. Once braced, you remain braced until you move. While braced, you can fire the weapon without the hip-fire penalty. For a **large shield** (one with the Brace property), bracing means planting the shield and taking cover behind it. Until you move, take an action other than Command or Brace, or are knocked prone, you benefit from **light cover**.

Command

You issue an order to a summoned or dominated creature. The creature carries out your instruction to the best of its ability on its next turn, using its full AP pool. Mindless summoned creatures **require** a Command each round to act at all; willful summons and dominated creatures act autonomously but can be given specific orders with this action. See *Summoning and Binding* for full rules.

Disengage

When you are in melee combat, you can disengage to move one square in any direction of your choosing. This movement does not provoke attacks of opportunity.

Draw/Stash

As a minor action, you can draw a weapon or item you have equipped to wield it, or you can stash a weapon or item you are currently wielding.

Drop Prone

You can drop prone as a minor action. Doing so increases your evasion by 1 point. While you are prone, you can only crawl to move, reducing your land movement speed to half.

Take Aim

You can take aim at a target to increase your accuracy against it. When you do so, you can make your next ranged attack against the target with +2 automatic successes.

Standard Actions

Attack

You use an attack power. The default attack power available to every character is the Basic Attack described above. Other attack powers granted by advances or other abilities may be used instead.

Stand Up

If you are prone, you can stand up as a standard action.

Dash

You break into a sprint, moving up to double your movement speed. Unlike a normal move action, a Dash must be in a straight line. Movement during a Dash provokes opportunity attacks as normal.

Dismember

You mutilate the corpse of a fallen Deathless in an adjacent square, delaying their spot-revival. See *Death and Revival* for the full rules.

Full Actions

Charge

To take a charge, declare a target you can see. You must move toward that target in a straight line, moving up to twice your speed and ending your charge directly adjacent to your target. At the end of the charge, you can use a melee attack power. You gain a +4d power bonus to your Martial characteristic when you make attack rolls during a charge.

Combat Maneuvers

In the chaos of battle, a skilled combatant can attempt far more than simply striking to wound. Hooking an enemy's leg to bring them down, knocking a weapon from their hand, targeting a specific weak point, throwing sand in their eyes, deflecting a killing blow with the flat of a blade — these are all **combat maneuvers**. A combat maneuver is any attempt to achieve a specific tactical effect beyond dealing normal damage, whether on your own turn or in reaction to an enemy's action.

Performing a Maneuver

To perform a combat maneuver on your turn, spend **2 AP** and declare what you are attempting *before* you roll. You then make your attack roll (Martial for melee, Marksmanship for ranged) with a **penalty** determined by the GM based on the ambition and difficulty of what you are attempting. If the attack hits, the maneuver takes effect. The more successes you score above the target's Evasion, the more dramatic the result.

A combat maneuver that involves striking the target with a weapon — such as a called shot or a hamstringing slash — deals damage as a single-hit strike, regardless of excess successes (excess successes improve the maneuver's effect, not the number of hits). A maneuver that does not involve actually striking the target — such as a grapple, a shove, or throwing sand in someone's eyes — does not deal damage at all.

If the attack misses, the maneuver fails regardless of how good the idea was.

The GM sets the penalty and adjudicates the outcome based on two considerations:

1. **How difficult is the maneuver?** A shove against a creature your own size might warrant -1d. Severing a specific tentacle might be -3d. Shooting a small object out of someone's hand at long range might be -5d or more. The creature's size relative to yours, the precision required, and the plausibility of the attempt all factor in.
2. **How well did it work?** A maneuver that barely hits (0 excess successes) produces a minimal version of the desired effect. Each additional excess success makes the result more dramatic. A barely-successful disarm might knock the weapon loose at the target's feet; a dramatically successful one sends it flying out of reach or shatters it entirely.

The GM may also require the target to make a resistance check (typically Stamina or Dodge) against maneuvers that impose ongoing effects, just as with any other combat effect.

Reactive Maneuvers

A combat maneuver can also be performed as a **reaction**. When an enemy takes an action that you could plausibly interfere with — a charge you could try to trip, a strike you could try to parry, a grapple you could try to twist out of — you may declare a reactive maneuver. This uses your reaction for the round.

A reactive maneuver is an **interrupt**: it resolves before the triggering action completes. Make an opposed check — typically your Martial against the attacker's Martial, though the GM may call for other characteristics depending on the nature of the maneuver (Athletics for brute-force resistance, Dodge for evasive maneuvers). If you succeed, the maneuver takes effect; the degree of success determines how completely you shut down the triggering action.

Unlike an offensive maneuver, a reactive maneuver does not deal damage — you are interrupting, not attacking.

Example: An Ashwalker charges Kael. Kael declares a reactive maneuver: he braces his spear low and attempts to trip the charger as she closes. The GM calls for opposed Martial. Kael rolls 7 successes against the Ashwalker's 5. The trip succeeds — the Ashwalker stumbles and falls Prone at Kael's feet, and her charge ends without an attack. Had Kael only barely succeeded, the GM might rule that the charge still carries her into melee but she arrives off-balance, losing her charge bonus.

Common Types of Maneuver

There is no fixed list of maneuvers a character can attempt. Any situation-appropriate tactic is valid, and creative thinking should be encouraged. The following categories are provided as **guidance** to help the GM calibrate penalties and outcomes. They are examples, not an exhaustive set.

Precision Attacks

A precision attack targets a specific object, body part, or weak point. The attacker must declare exactly what they are targeting: "I aim for the hand holding the staff," "I shoot the chain holding the chandelier," "I try to sever the grasping tentacle."

The penalty depends on the size and accessibility of the target. Hitting a creature's weapon arm might be -2d; hitting a specific finger, an eye, or a small held object might be -4d or -5d. Hitting a tiny or partially concealed target at range is harder still.

On a successful hit, the targeted thing takes damage and suffers appropriate consequences. A hand struck hard enough might drop what it holds. A tentacle dealt enough damage might be severed. A rope, a hinge, or a mirror can simply be destroyed if the damage suffices.

The degree of success matters. A barely-successful called shot to the hand deals damage but might not force the target to drop anything. A called shot that exceeds the target's Evasion by 3 or more could cripple the limb or destroy the held object outright.

Example: Lira is fighting an Ashen Priest who is channelling a ritual through a glass focus. She declares a precision attack against the focus (-4d, a small object held in one hand) and rolls her Marksmanship. She hits with 2 excess successes. The GM rules that the focus shatters and the ritual collapses.

Forced Movement

Shoves, tackles, bull rushes, shield bashes, and any attempt to bodily move another creature by force. The penalty is based on relative size: no penalty against a creature your own size, -2d per size category larger. Forced movement maneuvers are typically resisted by the target's Athletics or Stamina.

On success, the target is pushed a number of squares based on the margin of success — 1 square on a bare success, plus 1 for every 2 additional excess successes. Exceptional results might knock the target Prone as well, or send them through an obstacle. Context matters: shoving someone toward a cliff edge, into a fire, or through a railing all have natural consequences.

Disabling Attacks

Any maneuver that aims to impair a creature's ability to fight without necessarily dealing lethal damage: disarming a weapon, blinding with a handful of grit, hamstringing to reduce mobility, fouling a mechanism, or tangling an arm. The penalty is based on how debilitating the intended effect is and how protected the target is against it.

On success, the target suffers an appropriate condition or penalty. A disarm might cause the target to drop a weapon; a blinding attack might impose penalties to attack rolls for a round. On a dramatic success, the effect is more severe or longer-lasting: the weapon is flung out of reach, the target is fully Blinded for several rounds, or the hamstrung leg reduces their movement speed for the rest of the encounter.

Creatures that lack the targeted feature are immune to the corresponding maneuver — you cannot blind an ooze or disarm a creature that fights with natural weapons (though you might be able to damage those natural weapons with a precision attack).

Trips and Takedowns

Leg sweeps, hooking a kneecap, tackling an opponent to the ground, knocking someone off-balance. These maneuvers work both offensively and as reactions against charges and other movement.

The penalty depends on the target's stability: no penalty against a normally-balanced humanoid, -2d against a quadruped or a creature bracing itself, more against very large or many-legged creatures. The target typically resists with Athletics or Martial (defender's choice).

On success, the target is knocked Prone. On a dramatic success (3 or more excess successes), the target might also be Dazed or Stunned briefly from the impact, or be thrown rather than merely tripped.

As a reactive maneuver, a trip is particularly effective against charges: if the trip succeeds, the charge ends immediately and the charger falls Prone.

Defensive Maneuvers

Parries, deflections, and interpositions — any attempt to use combat skill to negate or reduce an incoming attack. These are almost always reactive maneuvers.

When you are hit by an attack while wielding a weapon, you may attempt to parry as a reactive maneuver. Make an opposed Martial check against the attacker. On success, the hit is negated. On a dramatic success, you deflect the blow so decisively that the attacker is momentarily off-balance, granting you advantage on your next action against them.

Weapons with the **Parry +Nd** keyword grant their bonus dice on defensive maneuver checks. A character fighting with a weapon in each hand, or with a weapon and a shield, is naturally better positioned for defensive maneuvers — the GM may reduce the difficulty or grant bonus dice as appropriate.

Example: Kael is struck by a Fleshforged's massive claw. He declares a defensive maneuver, attempting to parry with his longsword. The GM calls for opposed Martial. The Fleshforged rolled 8 successes on its attack; Kael rolls 6 on his parry attempt. He fails — the claw smashes through his guard and the hit applies normally. Had he been wielding his parry dagger in his off-hand, the additional +4d from its Parry keyword might have made the difference.

Grappling

Seizing and restraining an opponent. To initiate a grapple, you must have at least one free hand and be adjacent to the target. Make an opposed Athletics check against the target's Athletics or Martial (defender's choice).

On success, the target is **Restrained**. However, grappling is a commitment: you cannot move or use weapons while maintaining a grapple, and you must spend 1 AP on each of your subsequent turns to maintain it. If you do not, the grapple ends. The grappled creature may spend 1 AP on its turn to attempt an opposed Athletics check to break free.

On a dramatic success, you establish such a dominant hold that the target's attempts to escape are made at -2d.

A creature more than one size category larger than you cannot be grappled unless you have an ability that specifically allows it. A creature two or more sizes smaller can be grappled automatically without a check.

Maneuvers and Advances

Combat maneuvers represent what any competent fighter can attempt through skill, strength, and daring. **Powers** and **advances** represent superhuman feats that go beyond what a maneuver can achieve. An advance might reduce or remove the penalty for a particular type of maneuver, grant bonus dice, or add guaranteed effects on success. A Power like *Called Shot: Vitals* does not merely let you aim for a weak point — it guarantees devastating results that no ordinary fighter could reliably produce.

When a character has both a maneuver and a Power that could apply to the same situation, the player chooses which to use. The maneuver is always available but uncertain; the Power is reliable but costs a power slot and may have prerequisites.

Saving Throws

Many effects and status conditions last until the affected creature "saves" against them. A saving throw is a simple roll made at the end of the affected creature's turn: roll 3 dice. If 2 or more dice show successes, the saving throw passes and the effect ends. If fewer than 2 successes are rolled, the effect persists until the creature's next turn, when they may try again.

Cover saves use the same mechanic but with a different success threshold depending on the type of cover (see Cover).

Note that a saving throw is not the same as a **resistance check**. A resistance check uses a specific characteristic (such as Stamina or Potential) against a difficulty set by the power. Resistance checks are made when the effect is first applied, to determine whether it takes hold at all. Saving throws are made afterward, at the end of each turn, to end an ongoing effect.

Status Conditions

Battles are fought with vicious means, and in the course of a fight, characters can not only suffer damage, but may be afflicted with status conditions as well. A list of them follows:

Blinded

A blinded character cannot see. While they are blinded, they lose their perception bonus to their Evasion and make all attack rolls at a -4 penalty.

Disoriented

A disoriented character does not know their position relative to their surroundings. Every time a disoriented character attempts to move, they must roll a scatter die. On a 10, they go in the direction of their choosing; otherwise, they move in the direction of the scatter die.

Stunned

A stunned character cannot take any actions. While Stunned, a creature is also Exposed.

Vulnerable

Attacks against a vulnerable creature deal their maximum damage.

Dazed

A dazed creature loses 1 AP and has their evasion halved.

Exposed

An exposed creature cannot take reactions and their dodge rating becomes 0.

Panicked

A panicked creature is in thrall to its fight or flight reflex. On its turn, it must use all its AP either to attack the object of its fear (it may use powers to do so) or to run away from it; it cannot do both or take any other actions.

Staggered

A staggered creature is both vulnerable and exposed.

Shred (x)

A shredded creature loses x armor. Unless otherwise specified, this effect lasts indefinitely (or at least until repaired).

Disrupt (x)

A disrupted creature loses x ward.

Slowed (x)

A slowed creature's movement speed is reduced by x.

Still

A still creature cannot expend focus. Any ability that would require focus cannot be used.

Prone

A prone creature has +1 Evasion against ranged attacks but −1 Evasion against melee attacks. A prone creature can only crawl, reducing its movement speed to half. Standing up from prone requires the Stand Up action (2 AP).

Immobilized

An immobilized creature cannot move by any means, including teleportation. It can still take all other actions normally.

Restrained

A restrained creature cannot move, takes a −2 penalty to Evasion, and makes all attack rolls at −2d.

Frightened (of X)

A frightened creature takes a −2d penalty on attack rolls and cannot willingly move closer to the source of its fear.

Weakened

A weakened creature makes all attack rolls at −2d.

Dominated

A dominated creature acts under the controller's direction on the controller's turn. It can only take basic actions (move, basic attack). At the end of each of the dominated creature's turns, it may attempt a saving throw to end the effect.

Exhausted

An exhausted creature takes a −2d penalty on all checks and has its movement speed halved.

Poisoned

A poisoned creature is suffering from a toxin. The specific effects of being Poisoned (ongoing damage, penalties, etc.) are defined by the power or effect that inflicted the condition. Poisoned can be removed by the Cleansing Light prayer, the Antidote recipe, or other effects that specifically remove the Poisoned condition.

Diseased

A diseased creature is afflicted by a magical or mundane illness. The specific effects of the Disease are defined by the power that inflicted it. Unless otherwise specified, healing received by a Diseased creature is halved. Disease can be removed by the Cleansing Light prayer or other effects that specifically remove Disease.

Bleeding

A bleeding creature has an open wound that continues to deal damage. The specific ongoing damage is defined by the power that inflicted the condition. Bleeding can be removed by any healing effect, by the Cleansing Light prayer, or by an Alchemy check (difficulty set by the GM).

Burning

A burning creature is on fire. The specific ongoing Thermal damage is defined by the power or effect that caused the condition. A burning creature or an adjacent ally can spend 1 AP to attempt to extinguish the flames (saving throw). Burning can also be removed by full immersion in water or similar effects.

Summoning and Binding

Some powers and rituals allow a character to bring creatures onto the battlefield — whether conjured from raw magical energy, raised from the dead, or called from another plane. These summoned creatures are a powerful tool, but they come at a steep cost to the summoner's own effectiveness.

Summoned Creature Basics

A summoned creature is a separate entity on the battlefield. It has its own stat block, its own initiative count, its own pool of AP and Focus, and it takes its own turn. It is, for all intents and purposes, another combatant.

This is what makes summoning so potent — and what makes it so expensive. A summoning power that places a functional combatant on the field is worth far more than a power that deals damage once, so the cost must reflect that.

A summoned creature uses the stat block specified by the power or ritual that created it. The GM guide provides guidelines for building summon stat blocks appropriate to each tier. As a general rule, a combat summon called by a power of tier N has a stat block roughly equivalent to a creature of tier N–1.

When a summoned creature is reduced to 0 HP, it is destroyed (or banished, dispersed, etc. as appropriate to its nature). The summoning effect ends and the summoner no longer pays sustain costs. Summoned creatures cannot be revived, healed by EP, or resurrected — they are expendable by nature.

Mindless and Willful Summons

Summoned creatures fall into two categories based on their nature, and the distinction fundamentally changes how they behave in combat.

Mindless Summons

Conjured elementals, animated constructs, and similar entities with no will of their own are **mindless**. They are perfectly obedient but entirely inert: a mindless summon does nothing on its turn unless the summoner issues a **Command** (1 AP) during the summoner's own turn. When commanded, the creature carries out the instruction to the best of its ability on its next turn, using its full AP pool.

Without a Command, a mindless summon holds its position and takes no actions. It does not dodge, does not attack creatures that strike it, and does not move out of hazards. It is a tool, not an ally.

Mindless summons do not roll initiative. When the summoner uses the Command action, the creature acts immediately after the summoner's turn ends, using its full AP pool to carry out the instruction. If the summoner does not Command the creature, it does not act that round.

The total cost to the summoner each round is therefore: **sustain cost** (typically 1 AP + Focus) **plus** the **Command action** (1 AP). A summoner with 4 AP who sustains a mindless creature and commands it has only 2 AP remaining for their own actions. This is a heavy price, and the summoned creature's contribution must be worth it.

Mindless summons are safe. They never rebel, never misinterpret orders, and never act against the summoner's interests. Their limitation is that they require constant direction.

Willful Summons

Undead, fiends, spirits, and other entities with their own minds and desires are **willful**. A willful summon does not need to be Commanded — it acts autonomously on its turn, pursuing the summoner's goals as it understands them. This makes willful summons cheaper in AP: the summoner pays only the **sustain cost**, not the Command, leaving more AP for their own actions.

The price is risk. When a willful creature is first summoned, the summoner must win a **binding check**: an opposed check of the summoner's Command characteristic against the creature's Potential. This check is made immediately when the summoning power resolves.

- **Success:** The creature is bound and acts in the summoner's interest for the duration of the effect. It interprets the summoner's intent reasonably and fights effectively, though it may not employ optimal tactics unless specifically directed (the summoner can still use the Command action to issue specific orders if desired).
- **Failure:** The creature is not bound. It appears, but it is not under the summoner's control. What happens next depends on the creature's nature and disposition: a lesser spirit may simply dissipate; a fiend may turn hostile; a powerful undead may attack the summoner outright. The summoner's power and sustain cost are wasted, and they now have an angry entity on the field.
- **Dramatic failure (zero successes):** As failure, but the creature is enraged or empowered by the botched binding. The GM should make the consequences memorable.

A willful summon that is bound may still attempt to break free if the summoner is incapacitated, stunned, or otherwise unable to maintain concentration. If the summoner drops to 0 HP or is rendered unconscious, the creature immediately makes a Potential check against the summoner's Command. On success, it breaks free and acts according to its own nature.

Combat Summoning

Combat summoning is performed through **summoning powers** — spells and prayers with the **Summon** keyword. These powers follow the standard sustained power rules:

- **Initial cost:** The power's listed AP and Focus cost. Summoning powers are expensive: typically 3 AP and 2–3 increments of Focus to cast, reflecting the immense magical effort of pulling a creature into existence or across planes.
- **Sustain cost:** Paid each round to maintain the summon. Typically 1 AP and 1 increment of Focus. If the summoner cannot or chooses not to pay the sustain cost, the creature immediately vanishes.
- **Duration:** As long as the summoner sustains the power, or until the creature is destroyed.

A summoner can sustain only **one** summoning power at a time, unless an advance or other effect specifically allows more. Sustaining a summoning power follows the same rules as sustaining any other power: the summoner cannot sustain two different sustained effects simultaneously without a specific ability that permits it.

The summoned creature appears in an unoccupied space within the power's range at the end of the summoner's turn. Willful summons roll initiative normally and act on their own turn starting the following round. Mindless summons do not roll initiative — they act immediately after the summoner's turn when Commanded.

Ritual Summoning and Binding

Not all summoning happens in the heat of battle. Rituals can call and bind creatures over longer durations, producing servants, guardians, and allies that persist without the constant drain of a sustained power.

Ritual summoning follows the standard ritual rules (see the Skills chapter) with the following additions:

- **Binding duration:** The ritual specifies how long the binding lasts: hours, days, or in rare cases permanently. The summoner does not pay a sustain cost during this time — the binding holds on its own.
- **Binding check:** Willful creatures summoned by ritual still require a binding check, made as part of the ritual's casting check. The ritual may specify a higher or lower difficulty for this check depending on the creature's power. A Circle of Binding (if prepared in advance) grants advantage on this check.
- **Breaking free:** A willful creature bound by ritual may attempt to break free periodically. The ritual specifies how often (typically once per day, or when the summoner is asleep or vulnerable). Each attempt is an opposed check of the creature's Potential against the summoner's Command. If the creature succeeds, it is free and may act according to its nature.
- **Mindless creatures** bound by ritual simply persist for the binding duration. They follow the last standing order they were given and do not require Command actions outside of combat. In combat, the normal Command rules apply.

Ritual summoning is how a sorcerer acquires a permanent elemental guardian, how a necromancer raises a retinue of undead, or how a warlock bargains with a fiend for long-term service. The upfront cost in time, materials, and risk replaces the round-by-round sustain cost of combat summoning.

The Summoner's Dilemma

Summoning is deliberately designed as a tradeoff, not an upgrade. A character who summons a mindless creature in combat is spending roughly half their AP each round on sustain and commands, plus a significant ongoing Focus cost. They are trading their own effectiveness for an additional body on the field. This is powerful when the summoner needs to be in two places at once, hold a chokepoint, or absorb hits — but a character who simply wants to deal the most damage will usually be better served by spending those AP and Focus on their own attacks and powers.

Willful summons are more AP-efficient but carry real risk. A failed binding check can turn a costly power into a disaster. Characters who specialize in summoning — through advances that reduce sustain costs, improve binding checks, or allow multiple summons — can tip this balance, but specialization is itself a cost.

Vehicle Combat

Ashen features two scales of vehicle combat. **Tactical vehicles** — skimmers, armored transports, and other craft small enough to share a battlefield with infantry — use the standard combat grid. **Capital vessels** — airships and other

craft measured in tens or hundreds of meters — use a separate strategic scale with its own movement and targeting rules. For background on how these vehicles work, see *Skimmers* and *Airships* in the Setting chapter. Both scales share a common stat block format and damage model.

Vehicle Statistics

Every vehicle has the following statistics:

- **Hull Points (Hull):** The vehicle's structural integrity. When Hull reaches 0, the vehicle is destroyed.
- **Armor:** Physical damage reduction, as for creatures.
- **Ward:** Magical damage reduction, as for creatures.
- **Speed:** How fast the vehicle moves, measured in squares (tactical) or bands (strategic).
- **Maneuverability:** A category that describes how responsive the vehicle is, which determines what maneuvers it can perform and modifies Piloting checks:
  - **Agile (+2):** Small, responsive craft — interceptors, racing skimmers, light scout ships. Can perform all maneuvers, including Evasive Action and shake-off attempts.
  - **Standard (0):** Most vehicles — military skimmers, transports, frigates, and mid-sized airships. Can perform all maneuvers.
  - **Heavy (−2):** Large or cumbersome vessels — armored transports, heavy gunships, and most capital warships. Cannot perform Evasive Action. Can attempt shake-off, but at +2 difficulty.
  - **Sluggish (−4):** The largest vessels — dreadnoughts, bulk haulers, and anything over roughly 200 meters. Cannot perform Evasive Action or shake-off maneuvers at all. These vessels rely on armor, point defense, and escort craft for protection.
- **Size:** The vehicle's size category, as for creatures. Tactical vehicles are typically Size 2–4; capital vessels are Size 5 or larger.
- **Crew:** The number of crew stations the vehicle supports and the minimum crew needed to operate it.
- **Weapons:** The vehicle's mounted armaments, listed with their own damage, range, and fire mode statistics.

Scale Conversion

Tactical vehicles and characters share the same damage scale. A skimmer with 40 Hull is destroyed by the same amount of punishment that would kill a creature with 40 HP.

Capital vessels operate at **strategic scale**, where one point of Hull damage is equivalent to **10 points of tactical damage**. A capital vessel with 80 Hull would take 800 points of tactical-scale damage to destroy — an absurd amount of personal firepower, but a manageable number at strategic scale where ship weapons deal 10–30 damage per salvo.

When converting between scales:

- **Strategic → tactical:** Multiply by 10. A ship weapon dealing 15 Hull damage at strategic scale deals 150 HP damage to a person-sized target. This is invariably lethal and should be treated as such — characters caught in a ship-weapon strike do not roll saves; they find cover or they die.
- **Tactical → strategic:** Divide by 10 (round down, minimum 0). A shoulder-fired anti-vehicle rocket dealing 25 tactical damage deals 2 Hull damage to a capital vessel. Personal weapons that deal less than 10 tactical damage per hit deal 0 Hull damage and cannot harm a capital vessel at all.

Damage Thresholds

Vehicles do not suffer status conditions. Instead, they degrade through damage thresholds. When a vehicle's Hull drops below a threshold, it suffers the listed consequence. These apply at both scales.

- **75% Hull — Damaged:** One system is knocked offline (GM chooses: a weapon, the engines, sensors, or shields). A Shop check (difficulty 4) and 1 stretch of work can restore the system temporarily.
- **50% Hull — Heavily Damaged:** The vehicle's Speed is halved (round down). All crew checks suffer −2 dice. A second system goes offline.
- **25% Hull — Critical:** A third system goes offline. The vehicle is on fire, venting atmosphere, or otherwise in immediate danger. At the start of each round, the vehicle takes additional Hull damage equal to 5% of its maximum Hull (round up) unless a crew member spends their turn on damage control (Shop check, difficulty 6, to stop the bleed for one round).
- **0% Hull — Destroyed:** The vehicle is wrecked. How it dies depends on the damage it sustained. A ground vehicle grinds to a halt or detonates its fuel supply. For capital vessels, check which systems were knocked offline during the fight:
  - If the damage is mostly **external** (hull breaches, engines, helm, sensors), the vessel loses lift and begins to fall. The crew has 3–5 rounds to evacuate before impact.
  - If the damage is mostly **internal** (magazine, shields, drive on a Mist-reactor vessel), the reactor containment fails. The vessel explodes catastrophically, dealing Hull damage equal to half its maximum Hull to everything within Close range and killing everyone still aboard.
  - If the damage is **mixed**, the GM chooses or rolls: on a 1–3 the vessel falls; on a 4–6 the reactor goes.

When a system goes offline, roll on the appropriate table. If the result has already been knocked offline, take the next entry down the table (wrapping to the top if necessary).

TACTICAL VEHICLE SYSTEM DAMAGE (D6)

Roll	System Disabled
1	**Weapons:** One mounted weapon (chosen randomly) cannot fire.
2	**Drive:** Speed halved (stacks with the Heavily Damaged penalty). If already halved, the vehicle is immobilized.
3	**Steering:** Piloting checks suffer –4 dice. The vehicle cannot turn more than 45 degrees per Drive action.
4	**Sensors:** Gunners suffer –2 dice to all attacks. The vehicle cannot detect threats beyond visual range.
5	**Armor Breach:** The vehicle's Armor is reduced by a quarter (round down). Crew lose the benefit of cover from one facing (GM determines which).
6	**Cargo:** Passenger compartment or cargo hold is compromised. Passengers take 2D8 damage from shrapnel and debris; loose cargo is destroyed or scattered.

CAPITAL VESSEL SYSTEM DAMAGE (D8)

Roll	System Disabled
1	**Main Battery:** One main weapon system cannot fire until repaired.
2	**Point Defense:** Point-defense weapons go offline. The vessel cannot intercept missiles or engage tactical-scale targets.
3	**Engines:** Speed reduced by 1 band per round (minimum 0). If already at 0, the vessel is adrift.
4	**Helm:** Navigation controls unresponsive. The vessel cannot maneuver — no Evasive Action, Present Broadside, or Ramming Speed until repaired. The vessel drifts in its current direction.
5	**Shields:** Ward generators fail. The vessel's Ward drops to 0.
6	**Sensors:** Long-range detection is lost. All attacks beyond Close range suffer an additional +2 difficulty. The vessel cannot detect threats at Extreme range.
7	**Hull Breach:** Compartments near the impact are open to the elements. Crew in the affected section take 2D10 damage and must make an Athletics check (difficulty 4) or be swept out. In a Fog zone, the breach floods the section with Fog — treat as Moderate Fog exposure.
8	**Magazine:** Ammunition stores or power conduits are hit. An internal explosion deals Hull damage equal to 10% of the vessel's maximum Hull. If the magazine has already been hit, the second hit deals 25%.

Crew Stations

A vehicle's crew operate from **stations**. Each station allows one character to contribute to the vehicle's performance during their turn. A character occupying a station uses their own skills and characteristics to make checks, modified by the vehicle's statistics.

The standard stations are:

- **Helm:** The pilot. Controls movement and maneuvers. Uses the **Piloting** skill for all checks. Only one character can occupy the helm.
- **Weapons:** A gunner. Fires one of the vehicle's mounted weapons. Uses **Marksmanship** as normal, but the weapon's profile replaces the gunner's personal weapon. A vehicle may have multiple weapon stations.
- **Engineering:** The mechanic. Repairs damage, boosts systems, and manages emergencies. Uses the **Shop** or **Magitek** skill (whichever is more appropriate to the system being worked on). An engineer can spend their turn (4 AP) to attempt a repair: on a success, restore Hull equal to the check's margin of success, or bring one offline system back for 1d6 rounds.
- **Command:** The officer. Coordinates the crew. Uses the **Command** characteristic. On a successful Command check (difficulty 3), choose one crew member: that crew member gains +2 dice on their next check this round. A vehicle can only benefit from one Command action per round.

A character at a station can still use powers and abilities that do not require movement or a free hand, but they cannot leave their station and act in the same turn. Leaving a station costs 1 AP.

Vehicle Armaments

Vehicles mount weapons, shields, and other systems in much the same way characters equip gear. Two constraints govern what a vehicle can carry:

- **Weight (Wt):** The physical mass and volume of mounted systems. A vehicle's **Weight capacity** represents how much hardware its frame can structurally support. Analogous to a character's Bulk capacity.
- **Reactor Draw (RD):** The power demand of active systems — weapons that need charging, shield generators, sensors, and similar equipment. A vehicle's **Reactor capacity** represents how much energy its power plant can supply simultaneously. Analogous to a character's Charge capacity. Unpowered items (solid-slug guns, unenchanted armor plating) have Reactor Draw 0.

Every mountable system lists a Weight and Reactor Draw value. The total Weight and Reactor Draw of all mounted systems must not exceed the vehicle's capacities. Exceeding Weight is physically impossible — the frame cannot support it. Exceeding Reactor capacity causes **brownouts**: at the start of each round, the crew must choose which powered systems to shut down until total Draw is within capacity. Unpowered weapons cannot fire; unpowered shield generators provide no Ward.

Swapping mounted systems requires a workshop and a Shop check. For tactical vehicles, a refit takes one stretch of downtime per system changed. For capital vessels, refitting a single weapon system takes a day; a full refit takes a week or more.

Tactical Vehicle Weapons

Tactical vehicle weapons are mounted on skimmers, APCs, walkers, and similar craft. They use the same damage scale as personal weapons but are significantly more powerful — a single burst from a turret autocannon hits harder than anything a soldier can carry. All tactical vehicle weapons have the

Mounted keyword: they cannot be removed and wielded by hand, and they can only be fired from a weapon station.

Weapons are categorized by their **mount type**, which determines fire arc and the gunner's exposure:

- **Pintle:** A light weapon on a flexible mount, operated by a gunner who is partially exposed. Pintle weapons have a **turret** fire arc (360 degrees) but the gunner has only **partial cover**. Cheap, light, and ubiquitous — most skimmers carry at least one.
- **Fixed:** A weapon bolted to the hull, aimed by steering the vehicle itself. Fixed weapons have a **front** fire arc only. They are lighter than equivalent turret weapons, making them popular on fast craft that can point their nose at the target.
- **Turret:** A weapon in an enclosed rotating housing with a full **turret** fire arc. The heaviest and most flexible mount type; the gunner has **total cover**. Only vehicles with sufficient Weight capacity mount turrets.

TACTICAL VEHICLE WEAPONS

Name	Tier	Damage	Pen	Wt	RD	FM	Range	Mount	Special
Pintle Machine Gun	1	12+D10	0	1	0	FA 3	M	Pintle	
Fixed Autocannon	2	20+D12	4	2	0	SA 3	L	Fixed	Anti-Vehicle
Mist Repeater	2	18+D10	10	2	1	S	M	Fixed	
Turret Autocannon	2	20+D12	4	3	0	SA 3	L	Turret	Anti-Vehicle
Missile Pod	3	30+2D10	0	2	1	S	VL	Fixed	Anti-Vehicle, Explosive
Heavy Mist Lance	3	28+2D8	14	3	2	S	L	Fixed	Anti-Vehicle
Battle Cannon	3	35+2D10	6	4	1	S	L	Turret	Anti-Vehicle, Explosive
Plasma Turret	4	30+2D12	16	4	3	S	M	Turret	Anti-Vehicle, Burning

Shield Generators

A **shield generator** projects an arcane ward field around the vehicle, providing its Ward value. A vehicle without a shield generator has Ward 0. Shield generators are powered systems — they consume Reactor capacity and can be knocked offline like any other system.

When a single attack deals damage that exceeds twice the vehicle's current Ward (before Ward reduces the damage), the generator is **overloaded**: it shuts down and the vehicle's Ward drops to 0 until a crew member restores it. Restoring an overloaded generator requires an action at the Engineering station (1 AP, Shop check difficulty 4). Capital vessel shield arrays use the same overload rule at strategic scale.

SHIELD GENERATORS

Name	Tier	Ward	Wt	RD	Notes
Light Shield Projector	1	4	1	1	Tactical scale. Common on civilian skimmers.
Combat Shield Generator	2	8	2	2	Tactical scale. Standard military issue.
Heavy Shield Generator	3	14	3	3	Tactical scale. Heavy skimmers and APCs.
Ship Shield Array	3	5	6	4	Strategic scale. Small to medium vessels.
Capital Shield Array	4	8	8	6	Strategic scale. Large warships.
Dreadnought Shield Array	5	12	12	8	Strategic scale. Only the largest vessels.

Tactical Vehicles

Tactical vehicles — skimmers, armored cars, walkers, and similar craft — operate on the standard combat grid alongside characters.

Vehicles on the Grid

A tactical vehicle occupies a space determined by its Size, just like a creature. A Size 2 skimmer occupies a 2×2 space; a Size 3 APC occupies 3×3. The vehicle's facing matters: it has a front, rear, and two flanks. Mounted weapons have a **fire arc** (front, rear, left, right, or turret) that determines which directions they can target.

Vehicle Movement

A vehicle moves during the pilot's turn. The pilot spends AP to move the vehicle, just as a character spends AP to move themselves:

- **Drive (1 AP):** Move the vehicle up to its Speed in squares. The vehicle must move in the direction it is facing; it cannot strafe.

- **Turn (0 AP):** As part of a Drive action, the pilot may turn the vehicle up to 90 degrees at any point during the movement. Turning more than 90 degrees in a single Drive action requires a Piloting check (difficulty 3). Failure means the vehicle skids: it completes the turn but moves 1d3 squares in its original direction of travel.
- **Reverse (1 AP):** Move the vehicle up to half its Speed directly backward.
- **Ram (1 AP):** The pilot drives the vehicle into a creature or another vehicle. See *Ramming* below.

Piloting Checks

The pilot makes Piloting checks to perform difficult maneuvers: sharp turns, navigating obstacles, avoiding hazards, or maintaining control after taking damage. When a vehicle drops below a damage threshold, the pilot must immediately make a Piloting check (difficulty 3, or 5 for Critical) or the vehicle spins out, ending its movement immediately and becoming **exposed** until the pilot's next turn.

Passengers

Characters inside or on a vehicle who are not at a crew station are **passengers**. Passengers may act normally on their turns — firing personal weapons, using powers, and so on — but with the following restrictions:

- **Unstable platform:** Ranged attacks made from a moving vehicle suffer –2 dice. This penalty is negated if the vehicle did not move this round.
- **Limited arcs:** A passenger can only target enemies they can see from their position on the vehicle. The GM adjudicates line of sight based on the vehicle's shape and the passenger's location.
- **Embarking and disembarking:** Boarding a vehicle or leaving it costs 2 AP and provokes opportunity attacks if the character is adjacent to a hostile creature.

Targeting Vehicles

Attacks against tactical vehicles follow the normal attack rules with the following modifications:

- **No Evasion:** Vehicles do not have Evasion. Any attack that can reach the vehicle hits automatically unless the pilot uses a reaction (see *Evasive Maneuvers* below).
- **Cover:** Crew and passengers inside an enclosed vehicle have **total cover** from attacks originating outside the vehicle. Crew and passengers on an open vehicle (such as an open-topped skimmer) have **partial cover** (+3 difficulty to target them directly).
- **Targeting crew directly:** An attacker may choose to target a specific crew member instead of the vehicle, but only if that crew member is visible. The attack targets the crew member's defenses, not the vehicle's, but must overcome any cover the vehicle provides.

Evasive Maneuvers

Once per round, when the vehicle is targeted by an attack, the pilot may spend 1 AP as a reaction to attempt evasive maneuvers. The pilot makes a Piloting check; each success adds +1 to the difficulty of the incoming attack. The vehicle moves 1 square in a direction of the pilot's choice as part of this reaction.

Anti-Vehicle Weapons

Most personal weapons are ineffective against armored vehicles. Only weapons with the **Anti-Vehicle** keyword or that deal **Explosive** damage can damage tactical vehicles at full effect. Other personal weapons have their damage halved (after armor) against vehicles.

Powers that deal damage can affect vehicles normally, as magical force does not care about hull plating. However, conditions that target a creature's mind (Dominated, Stunned, Dazed) have no effect on a vehicle — target the pilot instead.

Ramming

A vehicle that moves into a creature or another vehicle can ram it. The pilot makes a Piloting check against difficulty 3 (or the target pilot's Piloting check, if ramming another vehicle). On a hit:

- **Ramming a creature:** The creature takes damage equal to the vehicle's Armor value plus the number of squares the vehicle moved this action. This damage is reduced by the creature's armor as normal. The creature is also knocked prone and pushed to the nearest unoccupied square.
- **Ramming a vehicle:** Both vehicles take damage equal to the other vehicle's Armor value, plus the combined number of squares both vehicles moved this round. Both pilots must make Piloting checks (difficulty 4) or spin out.

A vehicle that rams a creature or object more than two Sizes smaller than itself does not stop or take damage.

Capital Vessel Combat

Capital vessels — airships, dreadnoughts, and similar craft — are too large for the tactical grid. Capital vessel combat uses range bands and crew actions at strategic scale.

The Strategic Scale

At strategic scale, distances are measured in **range bands** rather than squares:

- **Contact** (boarding range, under 100m): Ships can board each other. Personal weapons can target the opposing hull. Ramming is possible.
- **Close** (100–500m): Light weapons and point-defense fire. Small craft can cross this gap in one round.
- **Medium** (500m–2km): Standard engagement range. Main batteries and missile weapons are effective.
- **Long** (2–5km): Heavy weapons and long-range ordnance only. Most fights begin here.
- **Extreme** (5km+): Beyond effective weapons range. Detection, pursuit, and retreat happen here.

Moving one range band costs 1 point of the vessel's Speed. A vessel with Speed 3 can close three bands in a single round.

Rounds at Strategic Scale

Capital vessel combat uses the same round structure as tactical combat. Each crew member acts on their own initiative, taking actions at their station. The vessel itself does not have a turn — its actions are the sum of its crew's contributions.

A round of strategic combat represents roughly the same amount of time as a round of tactical combat: a few seconds of frantic activity. The difference is purely one of scale, not of time.

Ship Weapons

Ship weapons use the same stat format as personal weapons (damage, range, fire mode, penetration) but at strategic scale. A ship weapon dealing 20 Hull damage is equivalent to 200 points of tactical damage — enough to obliterate anything smaller than a vehicle.

The size of a vessel determines what it can mount. A small scout ship's main guns are the same caliber that a dreadnought relegates to point defense. The categories below describe weapons by role; a given vessel will only mount weapons appropriate to its size and Reactor capacity.

Point Defense

Rapid-fire light weapons — rotary autocannons, flak batteries, light mist guns — designed to engage fast, small targets at close range. Point-defense weapons deal damage at **tactical scale**, not strategic. On the smallest capital vessels (scouts and interceptors, roughly thirty meters long), these *are* the main guns; on larger vessels they serve a purely defensive role, shooting down incoming missiles and strafing boarding craft.

Gun Batteries

Direct-fire weapons that form the main armament of small-to-medium vessels and the secondary armament of anything larger. Light mist guns, railgun turrets, and plasma projectors fall into this category. Gun batteries engage at Close to Medium range and deal moderate Hull damage. A frigate's broadside of mist guns is enough to cripple another frigate; against a dreadnought, the same guns can only chip away at the hull.

Main Batteries

The heaviest direct-fire weapons a vessel carries. On a frigate this might be a pair of mist lances; on a dreadnought it is an array of exawatt mist lances that can empty the sky for miles in front of the ship. Main batteries engage at Medium to Long range and represent the vessel's primary killing power in a direct engagement.

Missiles

Self-propelled guided munitions whose size, range, and destructive power scale dramatically with the vessel that launches them. Small ships carry **rocket pods** little different from ground-launched anti-vehicle missiles. Medium vessels mount **tactical missiles**: guided munitions with shaped warheads, effective at Medium to Long range. The largest warships carry **cruise missiles** and **aeroballistic missiles** — half-ton warheads on self-guided airframes that can strike targets at distances of dozens to hundreds of kilometers, far beyond normal engagement range. These strategic munitions are typically fired during the approach phase before ships close to engagement range; once battle is joined, the ship relies on its batteries.

All missiles have a **magazine** value: the number of shots carried. Once a magazine is empty, the weapon cannot fire until rearmed at a port or supply vessel. Weapons with the **Guided** keyword can be fired at targets beyond line of sight if another source (a spotter, allied vessel, or sensor lock) provides targeting data.

Ship Weapon Stats

Ship weapons have a **minimum range band** and a **maximum range band**. A weapon listed as "Md–Lg" can fire at targets in the Medium or Long bands but not at Close or Contact range. Point-defense weapons cover Contact and Close; gun batteries typically cover Close to Medium; main batteries cover Medium and Long; heavy ordnance covers Long and Extreme.

A gunner at a weapon station fires a ship weapon using their Marksmanship check against a base difficulty of **3** (modified by range, conditions, and target maneuvers). On a hit, the weapon deals its listed Hull damage, reduced by the target's Armor.

SHIP WEAPONS (STRATEGIC SCALE UNLESS NOTED)

Name	Tier	Damage	Pen	Wt	RD	Range	FM	Special
Rotary Autocannon	1	15+2D10 *	2	1	1	Ct–Cl	FA 3	Point Defense
Flak Battery	2	12+2D8 *	0	2	1	Ct–Cl	S	Point Defense, Burst 3
Light Mist Gun Battery	2	8+D6	3	3	2	Cl–Md	SA 3	
Railgun Turret	3	12+D8	6	4	3	Cl–Md	S	
Mist Lance Battery	3	15+D10	8	6	5	Md–Lg	S	
Exawatt Mist Lance Array	5	20+3D10	14	10	8	Md–Lg	S	
Rocket Pod	1	10+D10	8	1	0	Cl–Md	S	Magazine 6
Tactical Missile Rack	3	18+D10	10	4	2	Md–Lg	S	Magazine 8, Guided
Cruise Missile Silo	4	25+2D10	12	6	3	Lg–Ex	S	Magazine 4, Guided, Long-Range
Aeroballistic Missile	5	35+2D12	16	10	6	Ex	S	Magazine 2, Guided, Long-Range

** Point-defense weapons deal damage at tactical scale, not strategic.*

Range Modifiers

- **Close:** No modifier.
- **Medium:** No modifier.
- **Long:** +2 difficulty.
- **Extreme:** +4 difficulty. Only weapons with the Long-Range keyword can fire at Extreme range.

Ship Maneuvers

The helm officer moves the ship and performs maneuvers. On their turn, the pilot may:

- **Ahead (1 AP):** Move the vessel up to its Speed in range bands toward or away from a target.
- **Evasive Action (2 AP):** *Agile, Standard, or Heavy only.* Until the pilot's next turn, all attacks against this vessel suffer +2 difficulty. The vessel cannot fire main batteries while performing evasive action (point-defense weapons are unaffected). Requires a Piloting check (difficulty 3, modified by the vessel's Maneuverability). On failure, the +2 difficulty is only +1.
- **Ramming Speed (2 AP):** Commit to a ram. The vessel moves its full Speed toward the target. If it reaches Contact range, both vessels take Hull damage equal to the other's Armor. Both pilots make Piloting checks (difficulty 5); failure means the ramming vessel's own damage is doubled. Ramming is a desperate act — the attacker always takes damage.
- **Present Broadside (1 AP):** Position the vessel to bring maximum firepower to bear. Until the pilot's next turn, all gunners on this vessel gain +2 dice to their attacks against a single designated target.

Boarding Actions

Generally speaking, airships fight at long ranges by throwing missiles at each other, or firing batteries of suitably destructive direct-fire weaponry, like hypervelocity railguns or mist lances, whose short range and lack of terminal guidance is made up for in their ability to cripple or destroy an enemy ship in a single hit. In such a climate, attempting to board a hostile craft may seem equal parts pointless and suicidal. However, Deathless involved in air-to-air fighting will often find themselves contemplating such actions — for them, falling several miles or having an all-too-close encounter with point defence cannons is unpleasant, but not the end; and furthermore, given the scarcity of airships, capturing one is usually much preferable to destroying it.

Airships move in three dimensions at hundreds of kilometers per hour. Pulling alongside and lashing hulls together, as in naval tradition, is not practical. Boarding a capital vessel requires a **forced insertion**: the boarding party must cross the gap between vessels under their own power and breach the target's hull.

Common insertion methods include:

- **Fast attack craft:** A small tactical vehicle (an interceptor ship, a shuttle, or even a drop pod) closes to Contact range with the target and delivers the boarding party to the hull. The pilot makes a Piloting check (difficulty 4) to match speed and dock or crash-land on the target's deck. On failure, the craft overshoots — the boarding party must wait one round and try again.
- **Teleportation:** A character with access to a teleportation power or ritual can transport the boarding party directly onto the target vessel. The caster must be able to perceive the target (visually or through sensors) and the vessel must be within the power's range. The target vessel's Ward applies as additional difficulty to the teleportation check, at the GM's discretion.
- **Jump:** Characters with flight, jump packs, or sufficient magical mobility can cross the gap individually. This requires the vessels to be at Contact range. Each character must make an Athletics or Acrobatics check (difficulty 4) to land safely; failure means a bad landing (prone, 2D10 damage from impact) or a miss entirely (the character is now falling and must save themselves).

Once the boarding party is on the target vessel, combat transitions to the tactical grid. Represent the interior of the target vessel as a series of rooms and corridors. The boarding party must fight through defenders to reach critical stations — the helm, the engine room, the magazine.

While boarding is in progress, the vessel being boarded continues to move and may take fire from other combatants.

A vessel with Agile, Standard, or Heavy maneuverability that is being boarded can attempt to **shake off** boarders while they remain on the outside of the ship. Sluggish vessels are simply too ponderous — they must rely on point defense and their own security teams. The helm officer makes a Piloting check (difficulty 4, modified by Maneuverability) and performs a violent maneuver — a barrel roll, a sudden dive, or a hard burn. Every creature on the vessel's exterior (including boarders who have not yet breached the hull) must make an Athletics check (difficulty 5) or be thrown clear. Boarders who have already entered the vessel's interior are unaffected, but all creatures aboard (including the vessel's own crew) suffer the effects of the unstable platform penalty (–2 dice) for the remainder of the round.

Point Defense

Capital vessels may mount **point-defense** weapons: rapid-fire light guns designed to engage small, fast targets. Point-defense weapons can target tactical-scale vehicles and characters at Close and Contact range. Their damage is dealt at tactical scale, not strategic scale — they are anti-fighter and anti-boarding weapons, not ship-killers.

A gunner at a point-defense station can also use a reaction (1 AP) to attempt to intercept incoming missiles or rockets. The gunner makes a Marksmanship check against the missile's attack roll; on success, the missile is destroyed before it hits.

Capital Vessel Damage

Capital vessels use the same damage threshold system described under *Damage Thresholds*, with the following additions:

- When a system is knocked offline, the GM should choose a system that creates immediate tactical consequences: losing the main battery forces the crew to rely on point defense; losing engines leaves the vessel adrift; losing helm control means no maneuvers until it is repaired.
- At **Critical** threshold, the vessel may begin to lose altitude (if an airship) or take on fog contamination (if the hull is breached in a Fog zone). The GM should describe the deterioration vividly — groaning hull plates, alarms, listing decks — to convey urgency.
- A capital vessel at 0 Hull does not explode instantly. It is mortally wounded and will go down within minutes, but the crew has time to evacuate, perform last-ditch repairs, or make a final stand. The GM should give the crew 3–5 rounds to act before the vessel is truly lost.

Exploration

Ših karimmi, amawai, amawai
Kuyāni yān za urviranzā mai
Ašatawhānt hižung-čissa fīryai
Narwiv yāwhīyav šiyawa kawhai

We miss you, our homeland
How long we have not seen
Your cold snow-tipped mountain peaks
Shining silver against the blue expanse

— The Song of the Lost

The world of Ashen is vast and dangerous. Between battles, characters must navigate hostile terrain, endure the elements, manage their resources, and contend with the consequences of their immortal nature. This section provides rules for everything that happens outside of structured combat.

Overland Movement

Characters traveling overland cover distance based on their mode of transportation and the terrain they are crossing.

BASE TRAVEL SPEEDS

Mode	Distance/Day	Notes
On foot	40 miles	Standard marching pace
Mounted	80 miles	Horse or equivalent beast of burden
Vehicle (ground)	100 miles	Cart, carriage, or motorized ground vehicle
Skimmer	250–500 miles	Magical/mechanical hover vehicle; speed varies by model
Airship	300–600 miles	See *Airship Combat* section for details

TERRAIN MODIFIERS

Terrain	Speed Modifier	Examples
Road/Easy	Normal	Paved roads, open plains, well-maintained paths
Medium (no roads)	-25%	Light forest, grassland without paths, gentle hills
Difficult	-60%	Swamps, mountain passes, dense jungle, rubble-choked ruins
Harsh	-90%	Vertical climbs, the Thorn Forest, active volcanic terrain

Forced March

Characters can push beyond a normal day's travel (typically 8 hours of movement). For each additional hour of travel, each character must make an Endurance check (difficulty 4, increasing by 1 per additional hour). On failure, the character gains the Exhausted condition until they complete a rest.

Navigation

When traveling off established roads, the party must designate a navigator who makes an Investigate check at the start of each day. The difficulty depends on the terrain and conditions:

- Open terrain with clear landmarks: 2
- Forest or hills with limited visibility: 4
- Swamp, dense jungle, or featureless desert: 6
- Inclement weather: +2 to difficulty
- No map or prior knowledge of the area: +2 to difficulty

On failure, the party veers off course, losing 25% of the day's travel distance. On a critical failure (0 successes), the party becomes lost and must spend the following day reorienting.

Terrain

Terrain Types

Open terrain includes plains, roads, and cleared areas. Movement is unimpeded and visibility is excellent.

Forest provides natural concealment but slows movement. Light forest is medium terrain; dense forest is difficult terrain. Visibility is limited to short range.

Mountain terrain ranges from medium (foothills, established passes) to harsh (cliff faces, high peaks). Altitude above the treeline imposes a -1d penalty on all physical checks unless the character is acclimatized.

Swamp is difficult terrain. Characters must make Endurance checks (difficulty 4) each day of travel through swamp or risk contracting disease.

Desert is medium terrain by day and presents extreme heat hazards. Characters without adequate water must make Endurance checks (difficulty 4, increasing by 1 per day) or become Exhausted.

Arctic terrain is medium to difficult. Extreme cold requires adequate clothing or shelter; without it, characters take ongoing cold damage (GM-adjudicated).

Urban terrain varies. Intact cities are easy terrain on streets, but ruined or contested urban areas may be difficult terrain due to rubble, barricades, or hostile inhabitants.

Terrain Hazards

Difficult and treacherous terrain affect both tactical and overland movement. See *Difficult and Treacherous Terrain* in the Combat chapter for the full rules.

The Fog

The Fog is the defining feature of the world of Ashen. It is the raw power of creation, seeping from wounds torn in the fabric of the universe during the cataclysm. Devoid of the divine will that once guided it, the Fog is unpredictable and dangerous — spawning creatures, warping life, and saturating the land with

ambient magical energy. It is called the Fog because in areas where it is dense, it clouds the air much like natural fog, reducing visibility — but the two are distinct phenomena and can coexist.

The Fog varies in density across the world. Its density determines what creatures inhabit an area, what technology functions there, and how dangerous it is for mortals and Deathless alike.

Fog Density

Clear: A Clear is a region mostly free of the Fog, though it may see occasional episodes of elevated density, almost like weather. Ambient magical energy is low and everything functions normally. Magitek devices that depend on elevated Fog to operate will not function in a Clear. Magicsense and other means of detecting magic work exceptionally well here, as the Fog does not provide magical "background radiation" to obscure individual auras. Clears are where most mortal settlements are found.

Light Fog: There is some constant ambient magical power, but settlement is still mostly safe. The Fog can occasionally become dense, at which point it may cause unpredictable magical effects or spawn monsters. This is the condition across most of the world outside the Clears. Magicsense functions normally.

Dense Fog: The Fog is constantly roiling and produces magical effects. These areas are rife with monsters and supernatural phenomena. Visibility is reduced to short range at best, imposing heavy concealment beyond 5 squares. Only the Fogborn — humans mutated over generations of exposure — can live here long-term without suffering ill health. Navigation is difficult; unshielded technological and magical navigation aids are subject to interference, and Eerie and Occultism checks take a -2d penalty due to the overwhelming ambient magic. The ambient magical power is so great that magitek devices equipped with the right harvesting technology can run without any external power source, drawing what they need from the environment. This includes magitek power plants, which is why the immortal orders frequently vie for control of such areas despite their dangers. Dense Fog can occasionally intensify to Extreme Fog for a time.

Green plants cannot survive in areas of permanent Dense Fog, as the light-blocking effects make photosynthesis impossible. In their place, thaumatosynthetic flora — strange growths that feed on ambient magical energy rather than sunlight — dominate the landscape. The terrain itself is often warped: implausible weather, supernatural geological formations, and other phenomena that defy natural law are common.

Extreme Fog: These regions are so saturated with magical power that entering them is hazardous without special warding spells and devices. Visibility is reduced to near zero — heavy concealment beyond 2 squares, and total concealment beyond 5 squares. Navigation without shielded instruments is virtually impossible, and even shielded devices are unreliable. Magitek devices and spells may become overloaded and malfunction. Only the most terrifying Mist Creatures roam these areas, and even the Deathless tread here only under duress.

Fog Exposure

Mortals and Deathless who spend prolonged periods in Dense or Extreme Fog without adequate protection suffer the effects of Fog exposure.

- **Dense Fog — mortals:** After 1 week of continuous exposure, a mortal must make an Endurance check (difficulty 6) each day or gain the Exhausted condition. After 1 month, the mortal becomes gravely ill (Diseased condition, difficulty 8 to treat).
- **Dense Fog — Deathless:** Deathless are more resilient but not immune. After 1 month of continuous exposure, a Deathless character takes a cumulative -1d penalty to all checks (maximum -3d). Healing and regeneration are halved. After prolonged exposure (3 months or more), the Deathless begins losing 1 EP per week. These penalties persist until the character spends at least 1 week outside Dense Fog.
- **Extreme Fog:** Effects accumulate as Dense Fog, but on a timescale of hours rather than weeks. Mortals must check against Exhaustion after 4 hours; Deathless begin accumulating penalties after 1 day.

Adequate protection — such as warding rituals, sealed magitek armor, or Fog-shielded vehicles — can delay or prevent these effects at the GM's discretion.

Mist Creatures

The Fog spontaneously generates creatures from raw magical energy. These Mist Creatures range from minor nuisances in Light Fog to apex predators in Extreme Fog — denser Fog draws on a greater reserve of energy and produces correspondingly more powerful beings. Mist Creatures are not part of the ordinary flow of souls; they do not reincarnate and behave in spiritually distinct ways from mortal life.

Some Mist Creatures can survive in Clears, though most cannot long endure the absence of the Fog that sustains them. As a result, Clears are largely free of supernatural monstrosities — one of the chief reasons mortals cluster there.

The Fogborn

Humans who live in the Fog through generations are slowly changed by it, becoming the Fogborn. They are recognizable by their heterochromatic eyes — one of which is always yellow — and by various small physical deformities. Like Mist Creatures, the Fogborn exist outside the ordinary cycle of souls and are spiritually distinct from other mortals.

The Fogborn are often looked down upon by the unmutated races, especially other mortals. The Deathless tend to treat them no differently from ordinary mortals, though some may be ideologically motivated to do otherwise. Fogborn cannot become Deathless and are not available as a player ancestry.

Fog Effects

The Fog is restless even within a single density band. The following tables provide rollable events for areas of Light, Dense, and Extreme Fog. Roll 2D6 on the table appropriate to the prevailing density — once per day of overland travel, once per stretch in a particularly active area, or simply when the scene calls for an injection of strangeness. Many entries reference the exposure rules and the density definitions above; severe effects do not stack with the underlying density's standing penalties unless the entry says otherwise.

Light Fog

LIGHT FOG EFFECTS

2D6	Effect
2	A dense pocket coalesces. The area is treated as Dense Fog for the next hour, including its visibility, navigation, and exposure rules.
3–5	Wisps gather into a minor Mist Creature appropriate to the region. A small encounter ensues.
6–8	Ambient. A faint shimmer at the edge of vision and the taste of iron in the air. No mechanical effect.
9–11	A brief anomaly — a sourceless chime, a gust of unfelt wind, a momentary chill, a fleeting smell of something burning. Flavor only, but the GM may have it foreshadow a later event.
12	A Fog-touched curiosity surfaces in a character's path: a lost trinket, a withered flower out of season, a scrap of paper in an unknown script. The GM decides what it is and whether it persists once carried out of the Fog.

Dense Fog

DENSE FOG EFFECTS

2D6	Effect
2	Extreme Fog spike. For the next hour, conditions worsen to Extreme Fog — visibility, navigation, malfunction risk, and exposure clock all apply.
3–4	A Mist Creature appropriate to the region attacks.
5–6	Distorting currents. Distances shift and landmarks slip; Investigate checks for navigation take a –2d penalty until the party leaves the area, in addition to any standing modifiers.
7–8	Sensory bleed. Whispers from no mouth, half-glimpsed figures at the edge of sight, the smell of smoke or rot that no one can place. Each character must succeed on a Grit check (difficulty 5) or become Frightened of the Fog itself for one stretch.
9–10	Time slip. An hour passes in what feels like minutes, or the reverse. The GM decides which and adjusts overland travel, exposure clocks, and any active ritual or spell durations accordingly.
11	A momentary thinning. The Fog lifts to Light density for one stretch, granting clear sight and a brief window of safe rest.
12	Fog-mark. One character (GM's choice, or randomly determined) is briefly attuned: until they leave the Dense Fog, they take +1d on Eerie checks but accumulate Fog exposure at twice the usual rate.

Extreme Fog

EXTREME FOG EFFECTS

2D6	Effect
2	Reality breach. A section of terrain rewrites itself. The party finds themselves somewhere they were not, with no memory of how they arrived. The GM decides where, and whether anything has been left behind or taken with them.
3–4	An apex Mist Creature notices the party. It need not engage at once, but it has marked them, and will pursue or set an ambush at the GM's discretion.
5–6	Magitek and ritual interference. Active magitek devices spark and must be manually restarted; ongoing rituals and concentration powers must succeed on a difficulty 6 check or end. For the next hour, EP may not be spent to recover Focus.
7–8	Wild magic surge. The next power or spell cast by any character in the party triggers an additional, GM-improvised effect (a target swapped, a colour changed, an unbidden answer to an unasked question, a brief duplication of the caster).
9–10	Vision. One character glimpses a fragment they cannot place: a memory not their own, a place that may not exist, a face they will meet later. The GM may use this to seed plot or simply leave it unresolved.
11	A pocket of Light Fog opens, briefly habitable. The party may rest safely for one stretch before the Extreme Fog reasserts itself; this counts as a short rest if they choose to take one.
12	A Fog-marked artifact emerges from the mist, half-real and ready to be claimed. It dissolves the moment its bearer leaves the Extreme Fog, unless they succeed on a Ritual check (difficulty 9) to anchor it to the world.

Weather

Weather is determined by the GM or rolled randomly at the start of each day. Roll 2D6 and consult the appropriate climate table.

Temperate Climate

TEMPERATE CLIMATE ROLLS

2D6	Weather
2	Storm — heavy rain/snow, strong winds. Visibility reduced to short range. -40% travel speed. Ranged attacks at -2d.
3–5	Precipitation — rain or light snow. Light concealment at long range.
6–8	Normal — clear or partly cloudy. No effects.
9–11	Overcast — cloudy, mild. No mechanical effects.
12	Fog — heavy concealment beyond 5 squares. -25% travel speed.

Mountain Climate

MOUNTAIN CLIMATE ROLLS

2D6	Weather
2–3	Storm — blizzard or thunderstorm. Travel in harsh terrain becomes impossible. -60% in other terrain.
4–6	Showers — intermittent rain or sleet.
7–8	Normal — clear, cold.
9–10	Fog — as temperate fog.
11–12	Strong wind — ranged attacks at -2d. Flight-based travel at -25%.

Tropical / Swamp Climate

TROPICAL CLIMATE ROLLS

2D6	Weather
2–3	Thunderstorm — as storm, plus lightning hazard (GM-adjudicated).
4–6	Sweltering heat — Endurance check (difficulty 3) per 4 hours of activity or gain Exhausted.
7–8	Normal — hot and humid. No mechanical effects.
9–12	Rain — light concealment at long range. Swamp terrain becomes harsh.

Vision, Light, and Senses

Light Levels

Bright light is the default in open daylight, well-lit interiors, or within the radius of a strong light source. No penalties apply.

Dim light includes twilight, candlelight, moonlight, or the edge of a light source's radius. Dim light provides light concealment (-2d to hit targets in dim light from bright light). Awareness checks at medium range or beyond take a -2d penalty.

Darkness is the absence of light — underground, sealed rooms, moonless nights. Darkness provides heavy concealment (-4d to hit). Creatures without darkvision or another sense capable of replacing sight are effectively Blinded.

Special Senses

Darkvision allows a creature to see in darkness as if it were dim light, out to a specified range (typically 20 squares). Darkvision is monochrome and cannot perceive color. It does not function in magical darkness.

Lifesense allows a creature to detect the presence and location of living creatures within a specified range. Lifesense penetrates walls and obstacles but is blocked by more than 1 meter of solid stone or metal, or by effects that mask a creature's vital signs. Lifesense does not detect undead, constructs, or other non-living entities.

Magicsense allows a creature to perceive active magical effects, enchanted objects, and creatures with an active magical aura within a specified range. This is the sense used by the Eerie skill. Magicsense can determine the approximate tier and school of a detected effect with a successful Eerie check.

Tremorsense allows a creature to detect the location of creatures and objects in contact with the same surface (ground, floor, wall) within a specified range. Tremorsense is defeated by flight, levitation, or very light movement (Infiltration check vs. the detecting creature's Awareness).

Blindsight allows a creature to perceive its surroundings without relying on sight, through echolocation, magical awareness, or other means. Blindsight functions in darkness and is not affected by concealment, but is defeated by total cover. Range is specified per creature.

Concealment

Concealment represents visual obstruction that makes a target harder to hit.

- **Light concealment:** -2d to attack rolls against the target. Caused by dim light, light rain, smoke, or partial visual obstruction.
- **Heavy concealment:** -4d to attack rolls against the target. Caused by darkness (for creatures without darkvision), heavy fog, or dense smoke.
- **Total concealment:** The target cannot be targeted by attacks that require line of sight.

Cover

Cover represents physical obstruction between an attacker and a target. When a creature behind cover is hit by an attack, they make a cover save (roll 3 dice) before the attack is resolved. If the save succeeds, the attack misses.

- **Light cover:** Save succeeds on 3 or more successes. Examples: low walls, thin pillars, sparse vegetation.
- **Normal cover:** Save succeeds on 2 or more successes. Examples: solid walls with firing slits, overturned tables, doorways.
- **Heavy cover:** Save succeeds on 1 or more successes. Examples: fortified positions, arrow slits, thick barricades.
- **Total cover:** The creature cannot be targeted directly while behind total cover. The creature must leave total cover to attack.

Types of Transportation

On foot is the default mode of travel. Characters on foot can navigate any terrain passable to a humanoid and carry their own equipment.

Mounted travel uses horses or other beasts of burden. Mounted characters double their base travel speed on roads and open terrain. Mounts can carry approximately 200–300 lbs depending on size and breed. Mounts require food and water and may panic in combat without training.

Ground vehicles include carts, motorized carriages, and armored transports. They offer higher capacity and speed on roads but are restricted to terrain the vehicle can physically traverse. Fuel-cell-powered vehicles require regular refueling.

Skimmers are magical or magitek hover vehicles that travel at high speed above the ground. They can cross most terrain types but are affected by severe weather and cannot operate in enclosed spaces. Skimmer speed varies by model (250–500 miles/day).

Airships are large flying vessels capable of long-distance travel above most hazards. See the *Airship Combat* section for rules regarding airship encounters.

Disease, Hunger, and Exhaustion

Disease

Diseases can be contracted from environmental hazards (swamps, contaminated water), from creatures (venomous bites, plague carriers), or from magical effects (the Diseased condition). A contracted disease follows this progression:

1. **Exposure:** The character is exposed to a disease source. They must make an Endurance check against the disease's difficulty or become Diseased.
2. **Diseased:** The character gains the Diseased condition. The specific effects are determined by the source (see *Status Conditions*). Unless otherwise specified, healing received by a Diseased creature is halved.
3. **Treatment:** Disease can be treated with an Alchemy check (difficulty = the disease's difficulty), the Antidote recipe (for toxin-based diseases), the Cleansing Light prayer, or other curative effects.

Hunger and Thirst

Deathless characters are more resilient than mortals but are not immune to deprivation. A character that goes without adequate food or water suffers the following effects:

- After 3 days without food: the character gains the Weakened condition.
- After 5 days without food: the character gains the Exhausted condition (stacks with Weakened).
- After 1 day without water in normal conditions (or 4 hours in extreme heat): the character gains the Exhausted condition.

These conditions persist until the character eats or drinks adequately.

Exhaustion

Exhaustion can result from forced marches, sleep deprivation, environmental exposure, or running out of resources. The Exhausted condition (-2d on all checks, half movement speed) persists until the character completes a rest.

Suffocation and Drowning

A character with functioning lungs can hold their breath for a number of rounds equal to their Stamina rating. Strenuous activity — combat, swimming, climbing, casting — halves this duration. For longer-form scenes resolved in stretches, count each stretch as ten rounds for the purpose of this duration.

When a character's held breath runs out, or when they are otherwise deprived of breathable air — drowning, poison gas without protection, vacuum, magical asphyxiation, a cord around the throat — they begin suffocating. At the start of each round they continue to lack air, they take damage equal to 25% of their maximum HP and gain the Exhausted condition. When their HP reaches 0 from suffocation damage, they die normally; a Deathless character may revive as usual, but a Deathless who revives while still without air takes another 25% damage on their next round.

A character who is plunged into water or suffocating gas while Surprised, Stunned, or otherwise unable to consciously hold their breath begins suffocating immediately, with no breath-holding period. A character who inhales water — typically the result of a failed swimming check or having a regulator forcibly removed — skips directly to suffocation damage on their next round.

A character who reaches breathable air before reaching 0 HP recovers their ability to breathe at once. After one round of normal breathing they may begin holding their breath again from the full duration. Damage taken from suffocation is healed by ordinary means.

Clockworks ignore these rules entirely; see *Races and the Environment*, below. Characters under the effect of water-breathing or atmosphere-providing magic are likewise exempt for the duration of the effect.

Essence as a Survival Resource

Essence Points (EP) are the fundamental resource that limits Deathless characters over extended expeditions. EP is spent to fuel powers, revive from death, and recover during rests. Characters recover only 3 EP per day of rest, and scarce consumable items are the only way to accelerate this recovery.

Managing EP is the central survival challenge: a party that burns through EP in combat may lack the resources to revive fallen members or recover from injuries during travel.

Races and the Environment

Each playable race interacts with the wilderness on different terms. The rules below override or supplement the standard exploration rules where the two conflict; in all other respects, the preceding sections apply normally. See each race's trait block in the Characters chapter for the combat- and skill-relevant features that complement these environmental quirks.

Humans

Children of the Earth. When taking a long rest in cultivated or living land — fields, forests, orchards, gardens, healthy wilderness — a human recovers at the standard rate. In barren waste, ash zones, ruined ground, or Dense or

Extreme Fog, a human recovers from a long rest at half the usual rate. The Boar-Mother sustains those who rest in her domain.

Adapted Stock. Fog Exposure thresholds (see *Fog Exposure*, above) are doubled for humans. A human in Dense Fog reaches the one-week exhaustion check at two weeks, the one-month disease threshold at two months, and so on; Extreme Fog timers double similarly. This is why the Fogborn are exclusively human: only human biology can endure the Fog long enough to be transformed by it.

Clockworks

Clockwork characters interact with the wilderness on terms quite different from those of flesh-and-blood adventurers. They sidestep the majority of the hazards covered in the preceding sections, but they have a parallel set of weaknesses that biological characters never face.

What Clockworks Need Not Fear

The **Construct** racial trait already establishes that clockworks do not eat, breathe, or sleep, and are immune to poison and disease. In wilderness terms:

- **Hunger and thirst:** not tracked. A clockwork cannot be Exhausted by deprivation, and the starvation rules do not apply.
- **Sleep:** a clockwork can keep watch indefinitely, and may take an entire night's watch alone without penalty. They still benefit from short and long rests by entering a low-power maintenance mode for the appropriate duration; the recovery rules apply normally.
- **Atmosphere:** immune to poison gas, smoke inhalation, and the suffocation rules. A clockwork does not drown, though a submerged one cannot necessarily move freely and may need to be retrieved.
- **Heat and cold:** unaffected by ambient temperature within the range that biological characters can endure at all. The Tropical climate's "Sweltering heat" does not impose its Exhaustion clock on them; freezing weather does not slow them. Only direct contact with fire, lava, supernatural cold, or sustained immersion in such environments deals damage in the usual way.
- **Disease:** immune to diseases of biological origin. Magical curses and Fog-induced afflictions affect them normally unless the specific effect says otherwise.

What Clockworks Must Fear

In exchange for these immunities, clockworks face hazards that biological characters either ignore entirely or shrug off without thought.

Magnetic Interference. Strong magnetic fields disrupt the delicate circuitry that drives a clockwork's mechanism. Such fields are found near unshielded magitek power plants, in the shadow of certain ruined industrial sites, and during the magnetic storms that occasionally roll through Dense Fog regions.

- **Moderate field:** –1d to all checks while in the field.
- **Strong field:** –2d to all checks; at the start of each round of exposure, the clockwork must succeed on a Grit check (difficulty 5) or be Stunned until the end of its next turn.
- **Severe field:** –3d to all checks; on a failed Grit check, the clockwork shuts down for one stretch and must be carried clear. A successful Shop check (difficulty 6) by an ally can stave off the next failure.

Particulate Hazards. Sandstorms, ash fall, silt-laden air, and the interior of certain ruined factories deposit superfine particles that work their way into joints and gears. After 4 hours of exposure without adequate sealing, a clockwork takes –1d on physical checks; this penalty accumulates by another –1d every 4 hours, to a maximum of –3d. The penalty is removed by 1 hour of dedicated maintenance per –1d incurred (a Shop check, GM's discretion), or by a long rest in a clean environment. Sealed face plates, oiled joint covers, and similar gear extend the time before the first penalty applies.

Fog Sensitivity. Clockworks are themselves a form of magitek, and they react to elevated Fog densities much more strongly than mortals or Deathless. Fog Exposure thresholds are halved for clockworks — the inverse of humans. In addition, at the start of each stretch spent in Dense or Extreme Fog, the clockwork must succeed on a Grit check (difficulty 5 in Dense Fog, difficulty 7 in Extreme Fog) or suffer a malfunction: the clockwork is Stunned until the end of its next turn, or, at the GM's option, suffers a randomly determined minor effect (a stuck servo, a spell capacitor misfire, a limb that briefly ceases to obey).

Soot-Beasts

Hardier Stock. Soot-Beasts take only half the usual penalty from heat or cold weather effects, forced marches, and sleep deprivation. Their bred-for-battle resilience carries them through the wilderness as it does through campaigns.

Reduced Supply Needs. Hunger and thirst clocks tick at half the usual rate for a Soot-Beast; they need food and water roughly every other day, and can go on short rations for twice as long as other races before suffering penalties.

Tainted Flesh. The Soot-Beasts' close ancestral link to the Boar-Mother makes them a natural breeding ground for disease and a poor host for poisons. Difficulty checks to resist disease are made at +2 difficulty against Soot-Beasts. Poison damage against a Soot-Beast is increased by 50%, and ongoing poison effects last one round longer than usual.

Echoes

Sustained by Magic. In areas of Light Fog or denser, Echoes need no food or water — ambient magic suffices. In Clears, they eat and drink at the standard mortal-grade rates.

Cold Iron Sensitivity. Cold-iron weapons deal 50% more damage to Echoes, and cold-iron restraints cannot be escaped via Fey Jaunt or any other short-range teleportation effect.

Cold Iron is iron worked entirely without forge fire — cold-hammered into shape through ritual percussion, or drawn from meteoric sources that never melted in any human furnace. It is brittle, expensive to produce, and useless against modern armor. Its only practical application in the Age of Ash is as a fey-bane: shotgun slugs, restraints, ritual blades, and hunter's daggers specifically intended to harm or hold Echoes. Anti-fey orders, certain Mortefactors, and Echo-hunting bounty crews keep small caches; few others bother. A cold-iron weapon is typically a small backup item, drawn only when an Echo is the target, and using it typically requires aiming for an unarmored spot on the victim's body.

Fog-Fragile. Fog Exposure thresholds are halved for Echoes — the inverse of humans. The raw, undirected Fog is hostile to fey beings whose realms it destroyed.

Children of Day. (Mirrors only.) A Mirror gains +1d on Endurance checks while in direct sunlight.

Children of Night. (Shades only.) A Shade gains +1d on Endurance checks while in dim light or darkness.

Currency and Economy

Feathers (ƒ)

The universal unit of account in the world of Ashen is the **Feather** (ƒ) — literal metallic angel feathers that are occasionally found in the ruins of the old world. Their scarcity, durability, and the impossibility of forging counterfeits make them an ideal currency. Feathers are accepted everywhere, though remote settlements may prefer barter for everyday transactions.

Purchasing Power Guide

ITEM / SERVICE

Approximate Cost	Simple meal at a tavern
ƒ2	Comfortable lodging (1 night)
ƒ5	Fuel cell recharge (standard vehicle)
ƒ20	Vehicle rental (1 day)
ƒ50	Passage on a skimmer (short journey)
ƒ100	Passage on an airship (long journey)
ƒ500	Horse (trained riding horse)
ƒ300	Mechanical repair (minor)
ƒ30	Mechanical repair (major)
ƒ200	Medical treatment (professional)
ƒ50	Information (street level)
ƒ10–50	Mercenary hire (1 day)
ƒ100	Skilled artisan labor (1 day)
ƒ30	

For equipment prices, see the *Equipment Tables* section.

Lodging and Resting

Short Rest

A short rest takes approximately 1 hour and requires a reasonably safe location. During a short rest, a character may spend EP to recover:

- **1 EP:** Recover HP equal to 25% of maximum HP.
- **1 EP:** Recover Focus equal to 50% of maximum Focus.

A character may spend multiple EP during a single short rest. This is the only way to spend EP for recovery outside of powers or items.

Long Rest

A long rest takes 8 hours (at least 6 hours of sleep and up to 2 hours of light activity such as keeping watch). At the end of a long rest:

- The character recovers all HP and Focus (this costs EP as with a short rest, but the full recovery is automatic).
- The character recovers 3 EP naturally.

Resting Conditions

Comfortable rest requires adequate shelter (inn, building, or camping kit in fair weather). A comfortable rest provides full short or long rest benefits.

Rough rest occurs without adequate shelter — sleeping on bare ground, in extreme weather without protection, or in a hostile environment. A rough rest provides only the benefits of a short rest, regardless of duration.

Blessed ground — certain locations saturated with ambient magical energy (leyline nexuses, ancient temples, sacred groves) provide additional benefits. When resting on blessed ground, a character recovers 1 additional EP. The GM determines which locations qualify.

Death and Reincorporation

The rules for dying and reviving in the moment of combat are covered under *Death and Revival* in the Combat chapter. This section covers what happens to a Deathless character when spot-revival is not an option — when their EP is depleted, when they choose not to spend it, or when their body has been destroyed.

Soul Anchors

Every Deathless character has a **soul anchor** — a location their essence is bound to. A character can bind to a new soul anchor by resting there and performing a brief binding ritual (10 minutes, no check required). Each character can have only one active soul anchor at a time. By default, a character's soul anchor is the last settlement where they completed a long rest.

Reincorporation

If a Deathless character dies without reviving on the spot, their essence travels to their soul anchor and slowly reincorporates there. The process takes 3 to 7 days, during which the character recovers only 1 EP per day (instead of the usual 3). Once they have accumulated 5 EP, they reincorporate at the anchor with 1 HP and no Focus.

Effects That Prevent Revival

Certain powers and effects can delay or prevent revival entirely. A creature affected by an effect that "prevents revival" cannot spend EP to revive, and does not begin reincorporating until the effect ends. The *Noble Eightfold Blade* and *World Serpent's Embrace* are examples of such effects.

Setting

The World of Ash

The world of Ashen is a ruin, but it is not dead. The cataclysm that the histories call the Last War shattered the old order: it killed the gods, tore wounds in the

fabric of creation, and cursed the warriors who fought in it with an immortality they did not ask for. From those wounds seeps the Fog — the raw power of creation, unbound and purposeless — and it has swallowed most of the world. Where the Fog is thin, mortals huddle in settlements called Clears, eking out lives in the shadow of a broken sky. Where it is thick, nightmares breed and the land itself shifts and writhes.

But Ashen is not a world without hope. The Deathless — immortal veterans of the Last War, cursed to walk until they lay their regrets to rest — have organized themselves into factions, each with its own vision of what the world should become. They are explorers, warriors, scholars, and schemers. They are the player characters, and the world's future is theirs to shape.

History

The Age of Gods

In the beginning, there were the gods, and the world was theirs. The primordial chaos settled into Vêr, the great sea, and Khanj, the dark sky, and from their union came Khâru the Falcon-Headed Sun and Ndang the primordial land. The children of Khâru and Ndang — Night, Day, and their sister Order, called Third — were the first of the younger gods, and in time more followed.

The gods were not content merely to exist. They made peoples in their image, or in images that pleased them. The Boar-Mother, great goddess of Life and Earth, lay with the God of Crafts and bore the Humans, the first of the mortal races. When she slew her lover in a jealous fury, it was Khâru who adopted the orphaned race, and they have been torn between their divine parents ever since. The Lion-Headed God of War, brother to the God of Crafts and jealous of him, pawned his innocence to the Boar-Mother for children of his own: thus were the Soot-Beasts born, creatures shaped for battle in body and temperament. The Goddess Third, who loved toys and tinkers, gave life to the Clockworks, machines of supreme elegance that walked and thought and fought. And far from the affairs of the others, Day and Night — better known in their fey aspects as Might-Be and Once-Was — built their own realms and filled them with the Echoes, fey reflections of humanity seen through stranger lenses.

This was the Age of Gods: a time of direct divine rule, when the world was shaped by will rather than chance, and the races lived under the watchful eyes of their makers.

The Faerie Realms

Of all the works of the gods, the Faerie Realms were perhaps the most wondrous and the most alien. The twin goddesses Might-Be and Once-Was — known by many names: Day and Night in the Boar-Mother's reckoning, the Fateweaver and the Way-Knower among their own followers — each carved out a domain that existed alongside the material world, a reflection twisted by its creator's nature.

Might-Be's realm was one of beauty and caprice. She was the goddess of Magic, Fate, and all things Resplendent, and her lands shifted with her moods: sunlit meadows that could become labyrinths of crystal at a whim, courts of impossible splendour where the price of a wrong word was a century of servitude. The Mirrors, her favoured children, dwelt there as courtiers and tricksters, adept at the arts of misdirection that their mother prized above all else.

Once-Was, by contrast, ruled in darkness and silence. She was the goddess of what is Hidden and Forgotten, and her domain lay underground: vast palaces carved from living stone, lit by phosphorescent fungi and the cold light of captured stars. The Shades, her companions, were hunters and seekers of lost things, and they rode out from the deep places to hunt in the long winter nights of Faerie. In an earlier age, she had been worshipped as Came-To-Pass, an unerring huntress; something changed her, and her old name fell out of use.

The Faerie Realms are gone now, destroyed in the Last War or perhaps simply unmade when their creators fell. The Echoes that once inhabited them walk the material world as refugees from a home that no longer exists, carrying within themselves the last echoes of that strange and beautiful power.

The Last War

What the histories agree on is this: a great war engulfed the world, a conflict so vast that it drew in the gods themselves. It was not a war of mortals alone — the divine powers took the field, and their servants and children fought alongside them. The reasons for the war are disputed. Some texts speak of a betrayal among the gods; others of an invasion from beyond the world's edges; still others claim that the war was inevitable, the gods having sown the seeds of their own destruction in the act of creation itself.

What is certain is the aftermath. The war tore wounds in the fabric of creation — not metaphorical wounds, but real rents in the substance of the world, through which the raw power of creation now seeps as the Fog. The gods died, or were so diminished as to be indistinguishable from dead. Their power survives only in fragments: the reliquaries that the faithful carry, remnants of divine essence that still respond to prayer but offer no guidance, no voice, no will.

The warriors who fought in the Last War were marked by it. Whether by curse, by bargain, or by some consequence of exposure to the unmaking of creation, they became the Deathless: immortal, but stripped of most of their memories, bound to walk the world until they find release. They are the oldest living beings in Ashen, and yet they remember almost nothing of the age they survived.

The end of the war is the great gap in the record. The final battles, the decisive moments, the act or event that brought the conflict to its close — all of this is lost. The Deathless who lived through it remember nothing of those last days. Written records from the period are fragmentary, contradictory, or simply absent, as though something — or someone — excised the conclusion from history. Whether this gap is the result of the cataclysm's own violence, a deliberate act of concealment, or something stranger still, no one can say. It is, by all accounts, the single most important unanswered question in the world.

The Age of Ash

In the aftermath of the Last War, the world did not so much recover as stabilize. The Fog settled into patterns: dense in some regions, thin in others, and where it receded, the first Clears emerged — pockets of land where mortal life could take root again. The Deathless, waking on the banks of rivers or in

the ruins of cities they no longer recognized, began to organize. Some sought answers. Others sought power. Most sought purpose.

The factions that now dominate Deathless society were not founded in a single moment but coalesced over the long years of the Age of Ash. Each represents a different answer to the fundamental question that the Last War left behind: what should the world become? Some factions seek to restore what was lost — the Faerie Realms, the rule of the gods, the cycle of death and rebirth. Others accept that the old world is gone and work to build something new. A few believe the world should be allowed — or helped — to end entirely.

Mortal civilizations, meanwhile, have grown in the shelter of the Clears. They are younger than the factions, and largely dependent on them: the Deathless provide protection, knowledge, and access to the old world's technology, and in return they receive labour, loyalty, and the comfort of something to protect. The relationship is not always benign. Some factions treat their mortal wards as citizens; others, as resources.

The current age is one of uneasy equilibrium. The factions bicker and occasionally skirmish, but no single group has the strength to impose its will on the others. The Fog advances and retreats, and with it the fortunes of the settlements that border it. The world is not healing, exactly, but it is not dying either. It is waiting — though for what, no one agrees.

Cosmology

The Creation

The following text is the oldest known account of the world's origin. It is translated from the *Âl i pHethkê yi Ndang*, a sacred work favored by the devotees of the Boar-Mother, and is one of several creation narratives that survive from the Age of Gods. While the broad strokes are consistent across traditions, the details — and especially the roles assigned to individual deities — vary considerably depending on the source.

At the beginning, there was only the primordial chaos. In time, the chaos settled, and left at the bottom Vêr, the primordial sea, and Khanj, the dark sky. The sea and the sky resolved to each take on an aspect of the other, and from their strange union were born Khâru, the Falcon-Headed Sun, and Ndang, the primordial land. Khâru took the warmth from his mother's depths, but could not hold it in his lofty body; Ndang was great and profound, but took on her father's cold and stillness. Khâru's light and heat warmed the world, but made the sky to grow furious with wind, dried the sea and scorched the earth. When he saw what his unrestrained self had wrought, he resolved to sink beneath the waters for half his time, and thus did he establish order. From this union with his mother were born the sisters Night and Day, and the Third sister, known as Order.

The Pantheon

The gods of Ashen are dead, or so diminished that the distinction is academic. Their power persists in reliquaries and in the lingering effects of their creation, but they no longer speak, no longer intervene, and no longer answer prayers with anything more than reflex. What follows is a summary of the principal deities as they were understood before the Last War.

The Primordials

Vêr, the primordial sea, and **Khanj**, the dark sky, are the oldest entities in the cosmology. They are not gods in the conventional sense — they did not create deliberately, but rather settled out of the chaos like sediment from water. Whether they are conscious, or ever were, is a matter of theological debate. They are not worshipped, but they are acknowledged: Vêr as the source of all potential, Khanj as the boundary of all things.

The Major Gods

Khâru, the Falcon-Headed Sun, also called the Sun Life-Giver. God of light, warmth, and the cycle of day and night. Father of humanity by adoption, after the death of the God of Crafts. Khâru is remembered as a stern but generous patron: demanding of his children, but willing to reward their efforts. His relics are said to be gathered in the great library of the Seat of the Sun.

The Boar-Mother, goddess of Life, Earth, and the primal forces of nature. Mother of humanity (with the God of Crafts) and of the Soot-Beasts (with the Lion-Headed God of War). She is remembered as generous and terrible in equal measure: one who gave freely, but who exacted obedience from those in her debt. Her sacred text, the *Âl i pHethkê yi Ndang*, is the source of the oldest surviving creation myth.

The Boar-Mother's domains are so vast that she is rarely venerated as a single being, but rather worshipped in her three aspects – the most popular with mortals remains the **Spring Maiden**, goddess of youth and fertility, watching over the young couple equally as she does the farmer sowing his seeds. The second aspect is the **Winter Crone**, representing at once the uncaring cruelty of nature as well as the tenacity to overcome it. She is the patron of the old praying for good health, the farmer's storehouse, and the thrifty merchant. Finally, more feared than worshipped, comes the **Beast** – nature red in tooth and claw. Icons of this boar-headed giant are few and far between, but his name is frequently invoked in oaths, and Soot-Beast warriors have been known to take a liking to this forceful deity.

The God of Crafts, whose name is now lost. Father of humanity, lover of the Boar-Mother, slain by her in a jealous rage. Little survives of his worship, and what does is fragmentary. He is remembered chiefly through the humans he sired and the brother who envied him.

The Lion-Headed God of War, brother of the God of Crafts. A jealous god who pawned his innocence to the Boar-Mother in exchange for children of his own — the Soot-Beasts. He is said to have been always itching for war, and his creations reflect his temperament. In addition to his ancient association with battle, the Lion-Head is co-patron (with Might-Be, the Queen of Summer) of the Never-Still, who seek to restore the Faerie Realm. His martial temperament complements the Queen's vitality: where she dreams of renewal, he fights for it.

The Goddess Third, also called Order. Daughter of Khâru and Ndang and youngest sister of Day and Night — the goddesses better known in their fey aspects as Might-Be and Once-Was. A goddess of artifice, craft, and the imposition of order upon chaos, she is the patron of Arcane magic, the most regular and predictable of the three magical disciplines, fit to be codified and

taught from books. She loved toys and tinkers, and when the Last War came, her creations — the Clockworks — marched alongside her. The Perfectors worship her memory and seek to continue her work.

Might-Be, the Fateweaver, Queen of Summer, also called the Glory Resplendent and, in the Boar-Mother's sacred text, Day. Goddess of magic, fate, and beauty; twin to Once-Was and elder sister to Third. She ruled the sunlit courts of Faerie and created the Mirrors in her image. As the ultimate adjudicator of what might be, she is the patron of Divine magic, and her authority is said to hold even the other powers in check. Capricious and dazzling, she is remembered as much for the wonders of her realm as for its cruelties.

Once-Was, the Way-Knower, called Night in the Boar-Mother's reckoning, but known to her Shades as the **Midnight Princess**. Goddess of what is Hidden and Forgotten; twin to Might-Be and elder sister to Third. Formerly worshipped as **Came-To-Pass**, an unerring huntress, before some unknown event changed her nature. She ruled the underground palaces of Faerie and was companion to the Shades. Her domain is what was and what might have been, and she is the patron of Psychic magic — the strangest of the three disciplines, and the one most given to bending what is into what was not. Of all the gods, she is perhaps the most mysterious: even the accounts that survive of her seem to conceal more than they reveal.

The Lesser Powers

The following beings are attested in various sources as objects of worship, patrons of factions, or figures of theological significance. Whether they are gods in the same sense as the major deities, or something else entirely — powerful spirits, ascended mortals, or personified forces — is a question without a settled answer.

The Ferryman, god of Death and Rebirth. Once a psychopomp, a guide of souls between the world of the living and the underworld. In the Age of Ash, the Ferryman is said to still ply the waters of the Kethû, fishing the essences of newly awakened Deathless from its fog-shrouded currents. The Mortefactors revere him.

The Unsleeping, the Lone Vigil, also called the Last Lamp and the Warden of the Door. Patron of the Order of the Lantern, associated with vigilance, guardianship, and the concept of escape. His followers believe the world in its current state is a trap — Purgatory — and that the Unsleeping holds the key to liberation.

The Crown Lawgiver, a god of law, order, and rightful dominion. Patron of the Dragon Slayers, who interpret his doctrine as a mandate to make the world safe for humanity under structured governance.

The Moon Who-Reflects-In-Blood, a goddess of the night, transformation, and undeath. Patron of the Heirs of the Night. Her worship is closely associated with vampirism and the creatures that thrive in darkness.

The Queen of Silence, a goddess of death, endings, and the quiet that follows. Patron of the Brotherhood of the Silent Crow, who seek to restore the natural cycle of death and rebirth that the Last War disrupted.

She Who Waits Beyond, a figure associated with finality and the end of all things. Patron of the Witnesses of the End, who believe the world's destruction was left incomplete and should be finished.

The World Serpent, a primordial being associated with life, poison, and the deep forces of the earth. The western island chain is said to be its bones, and the island of Dragon's Head its skull. Prayers to the World Serpent invoke its power over vitality and venom.

The Nine Aspects

The magical traditions of Ashen recognize nine **Aspects**: fundamental forces or principles that underlie creation. They are not gods, nor are they worshipped as such, but they are the building blocks of ritual magic, and their influence shapes the world in ways both subtle and profound.

- **Ash** — destruction and desolation. The force of unmaking, of things reduced to their most basic state. Dominant in the wake of the Last War.
- **Crown** — law and domination. The force of hierarchy, structure, and imposed order.
- **Forge** — crafting, heat, and origin. The force of making and transformation through fire and will.
- **Key** — opening and summoning. The force that bridges distances and draws things from one place to another.
- **Mist** — magic and the sublime essence. The purest expression of the Fog's power, refined and directed.
- **Scarab** — rebirth and cycles. The force of renewal, of death giving way to life, of patterns repeating.
- **Skull** — death and the end of things. Not destruction (that is Ash), but the natural cessation that the Deathless are denied.
- **Moon** — mind and matter. The force of thought, perception, and the strange relationship between consciousness and the physical world.
- **Maiden** — nature. The force of growth, wildness, and the living world as it exists apart from the will of gods or mortals.

In ritual magic, the Aspects function as influences: a ritual's required Aspects must be present in the environment or provided through sacrificed objects. At higher tiers, the interplay of Aspects becomes critical, and the places where particular Aspects concentrate — leylines, ancient temples, sites of great violence or great creation — become strategically valuable.

Purgatory and the Curse of the Deathless

The Order of the Lantern calls the world *Purgatory*, and while not all factions agree with the theology, the metaphor has stuck. The world as it exists is, in a meaningful sense, a trap. The natural cycle of death and rebirth — the passage of souls from life through the underworld and back again — was broken by the Last War. Souls no longer pass on. The dead do not stay dead, and the living are born into a world that was not meant to persist in its current form.

The Deathless are the most visible symptom of this break. They are souls that cannot move on, bound to the world by regrets they can no longer fully remember. Their curse grants them immortality — when a Deathless dies, their essence travels to a place they are bound to, their soul anchor, and slowly reincorporates there over the course of days. But this immortality is a cage: they cannot grow, cannot change, cannot find peace until they confront whatever it is that holds them.

The factions, at their core, are different responses to this predicament. The Mortefactors study the curse in hopes of understanding it. The Order of the Lantern seeks to escape the trap entirely. The Brotherhood of the Silent Crow

wants to repair the cycle. The Witnesses of the End believe the only way out is through — that the world must be allowed to finish dying. And the rest, in their own ways, are trying to build something worth living in while the question remains unanswered.

Geography

The Shape of the World

The world of Ashen is, to the best of anyone's knowledge, flat — or at least bounded. It behaves in many respects as though it were a sphere: the sun rises and sets, the climate grows colder toward the north and warmer toward the south, and there is a visible horizon. But those who have sailed too far from the continent's shores report the same thing: the Fog thickens until it becomes an impenetrable wall, and beyond that wall there is nothing, or at least nothing that anyone has returned to describe.

There is one known continent, and one major island chain off its western coast. If other lands exist beyond the Fog, no expedition has found them.

The Fog

The Fog is the defining feature of the world. It is the raw power of creation, seeping from the wounds that the Last War tore in the fabric of reality. In the old world, this power was shaped by divine will — directed, purposeful, the medium through which the gods worked their miracles. Now it is unbound: a vast, ambient magical energy that saturates the world without intent or design.

The Fog varies in density. In the **Clears**, it is negligible — thin enough that the ambient magical energy is barely perceptible, and mortals can live and work without ill effect. In areas of **Light Fog**, the air shimmers and strange things can be glimpsed at the edges of vision; travel is possible but wary. **Dense Fog** is dangerous: visibility drops, creatures born of the Fog appear with alarming frequency, and the ambient energy is strong enough to power magitek devices without external fuel. In zones of **Extreme Fog**, the world itself becomes unreliable — distances shift, time passes strangely, and prolonged exposure warps both body and mind. The Fogborn, humans mutated by generations of exposure, are living proof of its transformative power.

The Fog is not merely a hazard. It is also a resource. Magitek power plants draw energy from Dense Fog, and the technology of the old world — airships, plasma weapons, and stranger things — runs on the same ambient energy that makes the Fog so dangerous. This tension — between the Fog as threat and the Fog as fuel — shapes the politics and economy of the Age of Ash.

The Continent

The sole known landmass is dominated by a central mountain range that divides it roughly into quarters: northwest, northeast, southwest, and southeast. A smaller chain of mountains runs along the western coast, and another stretches into the southeast. Between and beyond these ranges lie forests, deserts, river valleys, and the scattered Clears where civilization persists.

The continent spans a wide range of climates: icy coasts in the far north, dense subtropical forests in the northwest, arid wastes in the southwest, and more temperate lands in the south and east. The Fog does not respect climate boundaries — a frozen tundra and a sweltering jungle may both be equally choked with it — but the Clears that form within each region take on the character of their surroundings.

The Kethû

The great river known in the common tongue as the Kethû — though it has as many names as there are languages spoken along its banks — flows from the central mountains southward and westward, dividing the northwest from the southwest. It is a zone of Extreme Fog along its entire length, and crossing it is one of the most dangerous undertakings in the world.

The Kethû is no ordinary river. It is said to be the same watercourse that once ran around the underworld, the boundary between the living and the dead. The Ferryman, the god of Death and Rebirth, is said to still ply its fog-choked waters, and many Deathless awaken for the first time on its banks — as though the Ferryman himself fishes their immortal essences from the current and deposits them on the shore.

For all its danger, the Kethû is a landmark of immense strategic importance. The settlements along its banks are among the oldest in the Age of Ash, and the river's Extreme Fog makes it a natural barrier that has shaped the political geography of the continent.

The Black Bazaar

On the southern banks of the Kethû lies the Black Bazaar: a small, artificial Clear containing a market town. It is one of the few settlements in the world that bars mortals from entry. Only the Deathless are permitted inside, and the Bazaar serves as neutral ground for the factions — a place where rivals can trade, negotiate, and settle disputes without the threat of open warfare.

The Black Guard, a faction in its own right, watches over the Bazaar and serves as a corps of arbiters for inter-faction disputes. Their authority within the Bazaar's boundaries is absolute, and even the most powerful factions respect it — or at least find it prudent to appear to respect it.

The River Clear

On the northern banks of the Kethû, nestled against the foothills of the central mountains, lies the River Clear: one of the largest Clears in the world. Its size and its proximity to the Kethû's water supply make it extraordinarily fertile, and it supports a large and prosperous mortal population.

The River Clear is divided into thirds, each controlled by a different faction: the Dragon Guard, the Children of the Flame, and the Order of the Lantern. The three factions bicker endlessly over resources, influence, and theology, but outright conflict is rare — the Clear is too valuable to risk damaging, and all three know it. For most of its mortal inhabitants, the factional politics are a distant irritation rather than a daily concern. Life in the River Clear is, by the standards of the Age of Ash, remarkably comfortable.

The Northwest: Forests and Weald

West and north of the River Clear, the continent gives way to dense subtropical forest. The canopy is thick enough to filter the Fog in places, creating pockets of relative safety even outside the formal Clears, and the region supports a surprisingly large population for its apparent wildness.

Several large Clears are scattered through the forest, the most notable of which is **Venna Weald**. This is a major settlement divided between three factions — the Listeners, the Vatic Order of Patients, and the Never-Still — who

share the territory in a complex arrangement that is part treaty, part tradition, and part mutual suspicion. The Weald's proximity to old Faerie sites makes it significant to all three factions: the Listeners seek to commune with the primal spirits that linger there, the Patients cultivate the gift of clairvoyance that the region's magical resonance seems to amplify, and the Never-Still believe the Faerie Realms can be restored from exactly such places.

The North Coast

Beyond the forests, the continent's northern coast is icy, windswept, and sparsely populated. Clears are few and far between, and those that exist tend to be small, isolated, and fiercely independent.

The most notable settlement is the **Amkau Clear**, named after the largest river that flows through it. It contains the town of **New Ko Vihya**, a modest but well-defended community, and the ruins of **Old Ko Vihya**, which lie just outside the Clear's boundaries. Old Ko Vihya was once the seat of an order of wizards who practiced magic so reviled that the other Deathless factions — normally incapable of sustained cooperation — banded together to destroy them. The details of what the order did have been deliberately suppressed, but the name of their leader, **Vay Ngien**, is still spoken with disgust. His ruined tower stands on the north coast, outside the Clear, a monument to the one thing the factions have ever agreed on.

The Northeast: The Forest of Night

The northeastern reaches of the continent are dominated by the **Forest of Night**: an enormous expanse of woodland shrouded in permanent, magical darkness. The darkness is not merely the absence of light but an active force, one that resists torches, lanterns, and even magical illumination. Within it, the normal cycle of day and night does not apply.

The Forest of Night is the domain of the **Heirs of the Night**, a faction dedicated to the Moon Who-Reflects-In-Blood. It is a haven for vampires — both those who are merely undead, and those among the Heirs who bear the Deathless curse as well, making them doubly immortal. For most mortals and many Deathless, the Forest of Night is a place to be avoided. For the Heirs, it is a paradise in the making.

The Southwest: The Sand Wastes

South of the Kethû, the continent's southwestern quarter is dominated by the **Sand Wastes**: a vast desert that stretches nearly to the western coast. The heat is brutal, water is scarce, and the Fog, while present, takes on a dry and shimmering quality that is distinct from the damp miasma found elsewhere.

The Sand Wastes are rich in ruins. The dry heat has preserved relics of the Last War — weapons, fortifications, and stranger things — in a state that the damp and fog-choked regions of the continent cannot match. Expeditions into the Wastes are a reliable source of old-world technology and a correspondingly reliable way to die. The ruins are not unguarded: creatures born of the Fog nest in them, and the desert itself is hostile to the unprepared.

The Southeast: The Seat of the Sun

The continent's southeastern quarter is home to the largest Clear in the world: the **Seat of the Sun**. It is the closest thing the Age of Ash has to a great civilization.

The Seat of the Sun is governed by the **Dragon Slayers, Most Fraternal and Knightly Order of**, who rule not as kings but as a military order — a disciplined hierarchy of Deathless knights dedicated to the Crown Lawgiver and the principle that the world should be made safe for humanity. Their governance is efficient, if not always gentle, and the mortal population under their protection is the largest and most prosperous on the continent.

The Seat is also the primary base of operations for the **Perfectors**, whose workshops produce a disproportionate share of the world's remaining industrial output. The alliance between the Dragon Slayers and the Perfectors is one of convenience and mutual need: the Slayers provide order, labour, and protection; the Perfectors provide the technology and infrastructure that makes the Seat function.

The capital of the Seat of the Sun contains the largest library in the world and, it is said, a vast collection of relics of the Sun God Khâru. Whether this collection is a museum, a treasury, or a shrine depends on who you ask.

The Western Islands

Off the continent's western coast stretches a chain of islands nearly as long as the continent is tall from north to south. The islands are said to be the **bones of the World Serpent**, and the largest and northernmost of them is called **Dragon's Head**.

Reaching the islands is perilous. The open sea between the continent and the chain is a zone of Dense to Extreme Fog, and the crossing claims ships and expeditions with grim regularity. Those who have made the journey and returned speak of the islands as places of immense and unsettling power — old places, saturated with a magical energy that feels different from the Fog, more purposeful, as though something vast and ancient were still alive beneath the stone.

The islands are said to hold dark secrets. Whether they are worth the cost of reaching them is a question that every generation of Deathless asks anew.

Magitek and Technology

The technology of the old world was a fusion of craft and magic that the current age calls **magitek**. Airships, plasma weapons, powered armor, magnetic accelerators, vehicles that hover on fields of arcane force — all of these existed before the Last War, and many survive in some form. But the secrets of their construction are largely lost. What remains is scavenged, repaired, reverse-engineered, and jealously hoarded.

The **Perfectors** are the primary custodians of industrial knowledge, and their workshops in the Seat of the Sun are the closest thing the world has to manufacturing. Elsewhere, technology is a matter of salvage: Deathless expeditions into the Sand Wastes, the Fog-choked ruins of old cities, and other dangerous places bring back components and devices that are then painstakingly restored. Conventional firearms, at least, can be produced with current knowledge — they are a post-cataclysm development, crude by old-world standards but reliable and widely available.

One of the more paradoxical features of magitek is its relationship with the Fog. Devices equipped with harvesting technology can draw power directly from Dense Fog, running indefinitely without external fuel. This makes the most dangerous regions of the world also the most strategically valuable for those

with the technology to exploit them — and it means that the Fog, for all its horrors, is the engine that keeps what remains of civilization running.

Skimmers

The most common magitek vehicle is the **skimmer**: a craft that hovers on a field of arcane force, typically a meter or so above the ground. Skimmers range from single-seat racing frames to armored troop carriers the size of a small building. They are fast, maneuverable, and relatively simple to maintain — a skimmer's lift array is one of the few pieces of old-world technology that current artificers can reliably repair and even, in some cases, build from scratch.

Skimmers cannot fly. Their lift fields interact with the ground beneath them; take the ground away and the craft drops. A skimmer can clear obstacles, skim over water, and handle rough terrain that would stop a wheeled vehicle, but it cannot gain significant altitude. This makes them ideal for overland travel and ground combat, but useless for crossing the great chasms, mountain ranges, and ocean distances that divide the world's Clears.

Military skimmers often mount weaponry: a pintle-mounted gun, a fixed forward cannon, or in the case of heavier models, a turret. Armed skimmers are the backbone of faction ground forces, filling the role that armored vehicles occupy in conventional warfare. For rules on using skimmers in combat, see *Vehicle Combat* in the Combat chapter.

Airships

Where skimmers hug the ground, **airships** command the sky. An airship stays aloft through the same principle as a skimmer — a reactor-powered lift array — but at vastly greater scale. A **Mist reactor** draws power from ambient Fog to drive the lift array, feed the air-breathing turbine engines that provide forward thrust, and supply electrical energy to the vessel's onboard systems. The reactor is the heart of the vessel: without it, most airships have no lift at all and fall like rocks. Some smaller designs incorporate wings that reduce reactor fuel consumption during cruising flight and allow the ship to glide to a rough landing if lift is lost, but larger vessels have no such margin.

Mist reactors are old-world technology, and no one alive knows how to build one from scratch. Every airship in the sky runs on a reactor salvaged, repaired, or cannibalized from the ruins of the Last War. This makes airships rare, irreplaceable, and strategically decisive. A faction that controls even a single airship can project power across distances that ground forces cannot hope to cover, and the loss of an airship is a catastrophe measured in decades — the time it takes to find and restore a replacement reactor.

The size and role of airships vary enormously. The smallest are single-reactor scout vessels, perhaps thirty meters long, crewed by a dozen people, fast and lightly armed. The largest — the great dreadnoughts of the pre-war fleets — are hundreds of meters long, carry crews of hundreds, and mount weapons that can level a city block. Most surviving airships fall somewhere in between: armed merchantmen, patrol frigates, or expedition vessels refitted for the needs of the current age.

Because Mist reactors draw power from the Fog, an airship's operational range is effectively unlimited in Fog-covered regions. In Clears, where the ambient Fog is thin or absent, a reactor must run on stored reserves, limiting the vessel's endurance. This creates a strategic calculus: airships are most powerful in the most dangerous parts of the world, and most vulnerable in the safe ones. Long-range flights between distant Clears require careful route planning through Fog corridors, and an airship stranded in a Clear with depleted reserves is little more than a very expensive target.

For the rules governing airship combat, see *Vehicle Combat* in the Combat chapter.

Languages

The world of Ashen is not linguistically unified. Several major language families are spoken across the continent, shaped by geography, the Fog, and the long isolation of communities from one another. What follows is a summary of the principal languages a traveller is likely to encounter.

Sarkat

The closest thing the world has to a common tongue is the Sarkat language — though, like many widely spoken languages, it is better understood as a large family of closely related dialects than as a single uniform language. Sarkat varieties are spoken from the far southeast to the west-central regions of the continent, by Deathless, mortals, and Fogborn alike. Nearly all Deathless know at least one variety of Sarkat.

The two prestige dialects are those of the **Seat of the Sun** (eastern Sarkat) and the **River Clear** (western Sarkat). Despite their shared status, the two belong to different dialect groups and are not immediately mutually intelligible — a source of endless frustration for travellers moving between the continent's two great centres of civilization. Most names in this book are given in their River Clear Sarkat form.

Some examples of Sarkat vocabulary: *Khanj* is both the name of the primordial sky and the common word for "sky" in this language. The sacred text *Âl i pHethkê yi Ndang* is titled in River Clear Sarkat — though its original version is assumed to have been composed in some now long-lost language — and translates simply to "Tale of the Creation of the Earth." To illustrate the difference between the two Sarkat varieties, the word for sky in the Seat of the Sun is *Khaj* — similar enough — but the title of the Boar-Mother's sacred text would be rendered as *Agalak Phethekanya Dag*.

The Fogborn who live around the Black Bazaar, separated from the River Clear by the Extreme Fog of the Kethû, have developed a fairly divergent variety of their own. Most Deathless visiting the Bazaar prefer to speak River Clear Sarkat with one another regardless.

Inggiric

The Inggiric languages are spoken in the southwest and parts of the central west. The eastern Inggiric dialects have significant contact with far western Sarkat varieties, resulting in shared grammar and loanwords, but the two families are fundamentally very different.

The Sand Wastes in particular are home to nomadic peoples who speak a harsh-sounding, guttural variety they call **Leriel-e Inggir** — "Speech of the Sand Country." Some Inggiric place names include **Xen Waryd** (the Long Dune) and **Yrr-a Xyndy** (Camp Khendi), a rare permanent settlement in an otherwise

nomadic culture. The legendary spirit **Iew-e Haxt**, Father of Sand, is also named in this language.

Ngoay

In the northwest and along the frozen north coast, the Ngoay languages are spoken. The people of the north have a reputation for being gruff, and their languages — built of short words and concise grammar — only reinforce the impression.

The name **Vay Ngien** is drawn from Ngoay. Rumour has it that the wizard used a different, Sarkat name in his dealings with other Deathless, but this name has been suppressed along with the rest of his order's legacy. The crumbling tower outside the Amkau Clear is called **Ik Choa Vay Ngien** by the locals; an appellation that combines the words for tower and fortress, and is used for no other structure.

Those who have managed the perilous crossing to Dragon's Head report that the Fogborn who inhabit the island speak a highly divergent Ngoay variety. There are rumours of a hidden fortress in the island's interior, called **Yeak Chô Thaw Thêny**, or the Tower of Ridge Mountain, in the local dialect. Whether it is a coincidence that they, too, call something a tower-fortress is anyone's guess.

Echo Languages

The Echoes, tight-knit and originally extraplanar as they are, speak their own family of languages. In Clears dominated by Deathless Echoes, even mortal humans have sometimes adopted these languages. While several smaller dialects exist, the two prestige varieties are **Azal**, spoken by the Mirrors, and **Wiyan**, spoken by the Shades.

It is common enough for an Echo to speak both that one can frequently hear a Mirror address a Shade in Azal and receive a response in Wiyan — a strange display of ancestral pride that would look like a breakdown in communication to an outsider but is, in practice, perfectly functional.

Some Echo words have been borrowed or calqued into other languages. The epithets "Queen of Summer" and "Midnight Princess" for the goddesses of the Mirrors and Shades, respectively, are translations from their languages: Might-Be is known in Azal as *Yāndehten*, and Once-Was in Wiyan as *Innuwikšaya* — although the nouns *Queen* and *Princess* were supplied by speakers of languages that require the weight of nominals. The Echoes, for their part, are fond of using adjectives without any explicit referent, and the names of their goddesses most literally translate to *Summery* and *Midnighty*.

Other Languages

Smaller language families and isolates are spoken in the northeast, the forests of the central west, and various coastal regions. The Forest of Night is home to its own linguistic traditions, though few outsiders have spent enough time there to document them. The Soot-Beasts, for their part, are said to have languages of their own that predate their contact with the other races, though most Soot-Beasts encountered in the Clears speak Sarkat fluently.

Factions

The Deathless are immortal, but they are not united. In the centuries since the Last War, they have organized themselves into factions: orders, brotherhoods, and loose alliances bound together by shared beliefs about what the world is and what it should become. Most factions are aligned with the memory of a particular deity, and their goals reflect that patron's domains and values.

Membership in a faction is voluntary but significant. A faction provides purpose, community, and resources — things that an immortal being with fragmented memories and no natural death to look forward to desperately needs. Leaving a faction is possible but rarely easy, and those who belong to no faction at all — the Free Agents — are viewed with a mixture of respect and pity.

What follows is a description of the major factions of the Age of Ash.

The Order of the Lantern

Symbol: A stylized lantern. **Patron:** The Unsleeping.

The Order of the Lantern is built on a single, radical theological claim: the world as it currently exists is **Purgatory**. Not a metaphor, not a poetic description of suffering, but a literal state of spiritual imprisonment. The Unsleeping, their patron, is believed to be a divine guardian who remained behind when the other gods died — not to rule, but to keep vigil, holding open the possibility of escape for those with the wisdom to find the way.

The Lanterns, as they are commonly called, are scholars, mystics, and explorers. They study the nature of the Fog, the mechanics of the Deathless curse, and the structure of the world itself, seeking the cracks in the prison walls. They are intensely interested in the lost conclusion of the Last War, believing that the answer to what happened at the end may also be the key to escape.

The Order controls a third of the River Clear, where it maintains extensive archives and research facilities. Its members are often encountered in the field, investigating anomalies in the Fog, exploring ruins for clues about the old world, or following up on reports of anything that seems to violate the normal rules of reality. They are generally well-regarded by other factions — their goals are abstract enough not to threaten anyone directly — but their willingness to probe the fundamental nature of the world makes some uneasy.

The Most Ancient and Noble Order of Mortefactors

Symbol: A crossed scythe and bird wing under a human skull. **Patron:** The Ferryman.

The Mortefactors are, by their own account, the oldest continuous faction in the Age of Ash. They are dedicated to the study of the Deathless curse: its mechanics, its origins, its variations, and — they hope — its cure. Where the Order of the Lantern asks *why is the world a prison?*, the Mortefactors ask *why can we not die?*

Their work is part medical, part theological, and part detective work. They catalogue the experiences of Deathless across the world, seeking patterns in how the curse manifests: what triggers awakening, what determines the location of a soul anchor, whether the fragmented memories of the Deathless follow any discernible logic. They maintain the most comprehensive records of individual Deathless that exist — a library of identities, many of them belonging to people who have long since forgotten themselves.

The Ferryman, their patron, occupies a unique position among the lesser powers: he is, by most accounts, still active. The Mortefactors' relationship with him is not one of worship so much as professional respect — he does his work, and they do theirs, and occasionally the two intersect when a newly awakened Deathless is pulled from the waters of the Kethû.

The Mortefactors are widely respected but not widely loved. Their work requires a clinical detachment that many find unsettling, and their archives contain secrets that some Deathless would prefer to remain forgotten.

The Most Fraternal and Knightly Order of Dragon Slayers

Symbol: A dragon impaled upon a spear. **Patron:** The Crown Lawgiver.

The Dragon Slayers are the largest and most powerful faction in the Age of Ash, and the closest thing the world has to a legitimate government. From their seat in the Seat of the Sun, they govern the largest Clear on the continent, command the largest mortal population, and project military power across a wider area than any other faction.

Their stated purpose — making the world safe for humans — is straightforward, and they pursue it with the organized efficiency of the military order they are. The Dragon Slayers build roads, patrol trade routes, clear Fog incursions, and maintain the infrastructure that keeps mortal civilization functioning. They are, in the eyes of many mortals, the heroes of the Age of Ash.

The truth is more complicated. The Dragon Slayers are not merely protectors but rulers, and their vision of a safe world is one in which humanity lives under the structured governance of Deathless knights who know best. Their patron, the Crown Lawgiver, is a god of law and rightful dominion, and the Slayers interpret this as a mandate: order must be imposed, and they are the ones to impose it. This puts them at odds with factions that prize freedom, secrecy, or any vision of the world that does not place humanity — and its Deathless guardians — at the centre.

Their name is something of an anachronism. The original Dragon Slayers were founded to combat the great wyrms that terrorized the early Age of Ash, and they earned their reputation in that crucible. The dragons are mostly gone now, but the name — and the martial culture it represents — endures.

The Keepers of the Door

Symbol: Two keys crossed over a gate. **Patron:** Once-Was Way-Knower.

The Keepers of the Door are, by design, the faction that other factions know the least about. They are dedicated to the discovery and safeguarding of secrets: knowledge that is hidden, forbidden, or simply forgotten, collected and preserved against the day it might be needed.

Their patron, Once-Was, was the goddess of what is Hidden and Forgotten — a fitting choice for an order that operates largely in the shadows. The Keepers maintain a network of agents, informants, and hidden caches across the continent, and they are said to know things about every other faction that those factions would rather keep private. Whether this makes them the world's best intelligence service or its most dangerous blackmailers depends on perspective.

The Keepers are particularly interested in the blank spaces of history: the lost conclusion of the Last War, the suppressed records of Old Ko Vihya, the true nature of the Western Islands, and any number of smaller mysteries that the other factions have either overlooked or deliberately ignored. They do not share what they find freely, but they can sometimes be persuaded — for a price, or in exchange for secrets of equal value.

For Game Masters, the Keepers of the Door are an invaluable source of plot hooks. They are the faction most likely to approach the players with a strange job, a cryptic warning, or a piece of information that changes everything.

The Perfectors

Symbol: A bridge built of gears. **Patron:** Third.

The Perfectors worship the memory of the Goddess Third and seek to continue her work: the imposition of rational order upon a chaotic world, through the medium of technology. They are engineers, artificers, and industrialists, and their workshops in the Seat of the Sun produce the majority of the world's manufactured goods.

The Perfectors' vision is not merely practical but philosophical. They believe that the world broke because it was insufficiently ordered — that the gods, for all their power, were too capricious, too emotional, too *alive* to build something that would last. The solution, in their view, is a world governed by mechanical precision: predictable, efficient, and free of the divine caprice that led to the Last War. It is an ideology that appeals most strongly to the Clockworks, many of whom see in the Perfectors a reflection of their own nature.

In practice, the Perfectors are indispensable. They maintain the magitek infrastructure that the Seat of the Sun depends on, they repair and reverse-engineer the old-world technology that other factions recover, and they are the primary source of new innovations — modest ones, by old-world standards, but significant in an age of salvage and decline. Their alliance with the Dragon Slayers is the backbone of the largest civilization in the world.

Their weakness is a certain rigidity of thought. The Perfectors are deeply suspicious of magic that cannot be systematized, of divine power that does not follow rules, and of anything that smacks of the chaotic fey traditions. This puts them at odds with the Listeners, the Never-Still, and anyone else who believes that the world's salvation lies in something other than gears and logic.

Other Factions

The Black Guard maintain and police the Black Bazaar. They serve as arbiters of inter-faction disputes within its walls, and their neutrality — enforced by a willingness to bar any faction that breaks the peace — makes them the closest thing the Deathless have to an impartial judiciary.

The Children of the Flame are dedicated to maintaining and expanding the Clears. Aligned with the Sun Life-Giver, they are the faction most directly responsible for pushing back the Fog and creating safe spaces for mortal habitation. Their work is unglamorous but essential, and they are well-regarded by the mortal populations they protect.

Name	Pin	Stated Purpose	Aligned Deities
Black Guard	A fortress gate superimposed on a balance	Maintenance and policing of the Black Bazaar	–
Children of the Flame	An eternal flame	Maintaining and expanding the Clears	The Sun Life-Giver
Dragon Guard	A shield bearing the silhouette of a dragon's head	Restoring a world fit for dragons	Vrtra Dragon-Father
Dragon Slayers, Most Fraternal and Knightly Order of	A dragon impaled upon a spear	Making the world safe for humans	The Crown Lawgiver
Heirs of the Night	A sword with bat wings	Make the world a paradise for creatures of the night	The Moon Who-Reflects-In-Blood
Keepers of the Door	Two keys crossed over a gate	Discovering and safeguarding secrets	Once-Was Way-Knower
Lantern, Order of the	A stylized lantern	Escaping the trap of Purgatory	The Unsleeping
Listeners, The	A dream-catcher with antlers	Restoring the Boar-Mother and the primal spirits	The Boar-Mother
Mortefactors, Most Ancient and Noble Order of	A crossed scythe and bird wing under a human skull	Studying the curse of the undying and helping those afflicted by it	The Ferryman
Never-Still, The	A hand holding a heart	Restoring the vitality of the Faerie Realm	The Lion-Head & the Might-Be Queen of Summer
Patients, Vatic Order of	A hand with the index and middle finger extended, thumb, ring and pinky folded, and an eye in the middle of the palm	Cultivating the art of clairvoyance	The Glory Resplendent, Might-Be Fateweaver
Perfectors, The	A bridge built of gears	Fashioning an orderly, mechanical world	Third
Silent Crow, Brotherhood of the	The skull of a crow	Restoring the cycle of death and rebirth	The Queen of Silence
Waiting Fangs, The	A dagger piercing the skull of a snake	Self-defence	–
Witnesses of the End	An hourglass	Complete the ending of the world	She Who Waits Beyond
Free Agents	A sword crossed with a feather	–	–

Table 2: List of Factions

The Dragon Guard seek to restore a world fit for dragons. Where the Dragon Slayers hunted the great wyrms, the Dragon Guard revered them, and they believe that the return of the dragons is the key to the world's restoration. They are aligned with Vrtra Dragon-Father and are, understandably, not on good terms with the Dragon Slayers.

The Heirs of the Night serve the Moon Who-Reflects-In-Blood and seek to make the world a paradise for creatures of the night. They dwell in the Forest of Night and are closely associated with vampirism. Other factions regard them with a mixture of wariness and pragmatic tolerance.

The Listeners seek to restore the Boar-Mother and the primal spirits of the natural world. They are animists and spiritualists, attuned to the lingering echoes of divine power in wild places, and they maintain a strong presence in the forests of the northwest.

The Never-Still are dedicated to restoring the vitality of the Faerie Realm. Aligned with both the Lion-Head and the Might-Be Queen of Summer, they believe that the fey domains can be rebuilt and that doing so is essential to healing the world. They are dreamers and idealists in a world that has little patience for either.

The Vatic Order of Patients cultivate the art of clairvoyance under the patronage of the Glory Resplendent, the Might-Be Fateweaver. They are seers and oracles, and their readings – while not always reliable – are sought after by those who wish to glimpse what is to come.

The Brotherhood of the Silent Crow serve the Queen of Silence and seek to restore the cycle of death and rebirth. They are, in a sense, the Mortefactors' theological cousins, but where the Mortefactors study the curse of the Deathless with clinical detachment, the Silent Crows approach the broken cycle as a spiritual wound that demands healing through devotion and ritual.

The Waiting Fangs are a faction whose stated purpose is simply self-defence. They are secretive, pragmatic, and widely suspected of being rather

more aggressive than they claim. Their true agenda, if they have one, is not public knowledge.

The Witnesses of the End believe that the ending of the world was left incomplete and should be finished. Aligned with She Who Waits Beyond, they are the most feared and least trusted of the factions — not because they are necessarily hostile, but because their ultimate goal is the annihilation of everything that exists. Whether they are nihilists, mercy-killers, or something stranger is a matter of considerable debate.

Free Agents are Deathless who belong to no faction. Some are former members of other orders who left or were expelled; others never joined in the first place. They are respected for their independence and pitied for their isolation. In a world where purpose is the only thing standing between an immortal and madness, going it alone is either very brave or very foolish.

GM Guide

Pacing and Time

The rulebook describes three resolutions at which Ashen tracks time: open time, where minutes and hours pass between meaningful actions; stretches, where roughly five minutes pass between each significant choice; and rounds, where every action is counted in seconds and action points. As the GM, you decide which resolution a scene runs at, and—more importantly—when to switch between them. The right choice is rarely about realism; it is about where the table's attention should sit. Open time gives the players narrative latitude; stretches put a clock on a tense situation without dragging it into turn-by-turn bookkeeping; rounds let every second matter when lives are on the line.

The sections that follow offer guidance on each resolution and on the seams between them.

Stretches: Keeping Pressure On

Stretches shine in scenes where two sides are acting in parallel and neither side has yet noticed the other—or where they have noticed but the confrontation has not yet snapped into violence. Players moving through a guarded dungeon, breaking into a townhouse before the city watch comes around the corner, lifting a relic from a dragon's hoard while the dragon dozes: in all of these, the question is not "who hits whom first" but "do the players finish what they came to do before the other side reacts?"

To run a scene in stretches, sketch the opposition as a parallel track to the players' actions. The watch patrol is six stretches away from the front door. The dragon stirs and lifts its head on a 1 in 6, rolled at the start of every stretch. The ritual the players are interrupting completes in four stretches unless they disrupt it. Then, on each stretch:

- Each player declares a single significant action and rolls for it.
- You advance every parallel clock by one stretch and resolve any triggered events (the patrol turns the corner, the dragon opens an eye, the ritual reaches its next phase).
- You describe the new state of the scene, including any sensory cues the players' characters would notice—torchlight bobbing closer down the corridor, the dragon's breathing changing pitch.

Stretches are particularly good at giving players agency over the costs of their plan. Sneaking past the patrol takes longer than sprinting past it, but sprinting risks being heard. Picking the lock carefully takes three stretches; forcing it takes one but leaves obvious damage. The stretch makes these trade-offs concrete without requiring you to adjudicate them in seconds.

Rounds: When to Drop In, When to Skip

A scene running in stretches can collapse into rounds at any point, and a scene that begins in rounds can dissolve back into stretches once the immediate threat is past. The transition is always the GM's call, and the trigger is almost always the same: the resolution of a single second now matters. The dragon's eye opens. The watch sergeant draws steel. The ritual's final syllable hangs in the air.

When you cross that line, call for initiative. The default is to roll initiative once per encounter—each combat scene gets a fresh order, with fresh circumstances reflected in modifiers and surprise. This keeps the initiative roll meaningful: characters who have invested in Initiative are rewarded every time the dice come out, and the order at the table reshuffles with each new threat.

For some scenes, especially small dungeons or fast-moving chases where encounters come quickly one after another, you may prefer to roll initiative once for an entire act and reuse it across every combat in that act. This keeps the table moving and avoids interrupting momentum with bookkeeping. The cost is real, though: characters built around initiative—scouts, duellists, gunslingers—lose most of their opportunity to shine, because their advantage is paid for once and amortized across every fight. A reasonable compromise is to roll once per act for routine encounters and re-roll for set-piece battles, signalling to the table that the next fight matters more than the last one.

A combat scene need not end by snapping all the way back to open time. If the characters cut down the last cultist but the alarm bell is ringing in the next tower, drop back into stretches: each stretch, the surviving characters declare an action—bar the door, search the bodies, drag the wounded priestess to cover—while the reinforcements close in. Only when the last clock has run out, or the players have decisively escaped or won, should the scene dissolve into open time.

The GM's Clock

Whatever resolution a scene is running at, the GM is also tracking the world around the players. Torches burn down. Spells expire. Wandering threats roam. Weather turns. Ritual circles pulse and dim. The GM's clock is the set of regular checks you make to keep the world breathing, and the cadence of those checks should match the resolution of the scene.

In stretches, a 1-in-6 check at the start of each stretch handles most short-term hazards: a guard happens by, the torch gutters in a draft, the fog thickens in the room. Use a d6 in plain view at the table when you want the players to feel the pressure; roll it behind the screen when you want the threat to be ambient rather than explicit.

In rounds, the GM's clock is mostly handled by the duration fields on ongoing effects (the bleed lasts three rounds, the smoke clears after five), but you may still want a heartbeat—a chant from the next room growing louder each round, a structural beam groaning, a portal slowly closing. Announce these at the top of each round so the players can react to them.

In open time, the clock runs slower and broader. A wandering monster check each in-fiction hour, a weather check each morning, a check for whether news of the players' last exploit has caught up to them each time they enter a new settlement. The principle is the same as in stretches: regular, predictable checks turn the world into a system the players can plan against, rather than a series of GM-fiat surprises.

The Long View

The same logic that makes stretches useful at the scale of minutes can be applied at the scale of hours, days, or hundreds of miles. If the party is crossing the high road by skimmer at thirty miles an hour, a stretch is absurd—five minutes of skimmer travel is a featureless straight line. But the underlying procedure still works: pick a unit of travel that contains about one meaningful decision, advance it one tick at a time, and roll your GM's clock against each tick.

For wilderness travel by skimmer or mount, a tick of one to two hours, or fifty to a hundred miles, is usually about right. On each tick:

- The party covers their travel distance and the GM describes anything they pass that warrants attention.
- The GM rolls for weather changes, vehicle malfunctions, and random encounters appropriate to the terrain.
- The party may declare an action that takes the full tick—scanning the horizon for pursuit, attempting to repair a stressed engine, hunting for game—and roll for it.

For longer expeditions—a week-long march through the Sand Wastes, a month-long voyage across the Western Islands—the tick can stretch to a day or more. The same three steps still apply, only the scale of the events they trigger changes: instead of weather, it is supply attrition; instead of a random encounter, it is a sickness, a desertion, or a rumour overtaking the party from behind.

The result, at every scale, is the same texture: the world acts on a clock the players can hear ticking, the players act with full knowledge of the trade-offs, and the GM never has to invent pressure on the fly because the pressure was always already in the schedule.

Designing Creatures

This section provides guidelines for creating enemy creatures for use in combat encounters. Creatures in Ashen use the same mechanical framework as player characters: they have attributes, characteristics, derived statistics, equipment (or natural equivalents), and powers.

Creature Stat Blocks

A creature stat block should include the following:

- **Hit Points (HP):** How much damage the creature can sustain.
- **Focus Points (FP):** The creature's reservoir for powers. Creatures that rely purely on physical attacks may have low or no FP.
- **Armor:** Physical damage reduction, whether from natural hide, worn armor, or construction.
- **Ward:** Magical damage reduction, from innate magical resistance or protective enchantments.
- **Evasion:** How difficult the creature is to hit. Derived the same way as for characters: half the creature's Dodge rating (rounded down), modified by armor or natural agility.
- **Action Points (AP):** Almost always 4, the same as player characters.
- **Movement Speed:** 2 + the creature's Speed rating, as for characters.
- **Main Attack Characteristic:** The dice pool the creature rolls for its primary attacks (Martial for melee combatants, Marksmanship for ranged, a casting characteristic for spellcasters).
- **Resistance Characteristics:** The creature's Stamina, Potential and Grit ratings, used to resist powers and effects.
- **Attacks and Powers:** The creature's available actions, including base weapon damage and any special powers.

Encounter Balance

A fight is balanced when the **action economy** is roughly equal on both sides. On a featureless battlefield where both sides can fully employ their abilities, a group of enemies equal in number to the player characters — each enemy being of the same tier as the party — constitutes a fair fight.

When the number of enemies differs from the number of players, the creatures must be adjusted:

- **Fewer enemies than players:** The creatures need higher HP, better defenses, and stronger powers to compensate for being outnumbered. A single "boss" creature facing a full party should have dramatically more HP and access to multi-target or area powers to offset the action economy disadvantage.
- **More enemies than players:** Each creature should be weaker than a same-tier PC — lower HP, simpler attack options, and fewer powers. Minion-type creatures may have only a single attack and minimal HP.

Stat Guidelines by Tier

The following table provides baseline statistics for a standard creature at each tier. These values represent a creature roughly equivalent to a player character of the same tier wearing medium-weight equipment.

CREATURE STAT GUIDELINES

Stat	T1	T2	T3	T4	T5	T6
HP	20–25	30–40	45–60	65–85	90–120	120–160
FP	13–18	20–30	30–45	45–65	65–90	90–130
Armor	5	8	10	13	17	22
Ward	4	5	8	10	13	17
Evasion	2–3	3–4	4–5	5–7	7–8	8–9
Main Attack	5–7	7–9	10–12	13–15	15–17	16–18
Primary Resistance	4–6	6–8	8–11	11–14	14–16	16–18
Damage (per hit)	7–10	10–14	14–18	18–23	22–29	27–35

Use the lower end of each range for more fragile or evasion-oriented creatures (rogues, casters, skirmishers) and the higher end for tougher brutes and tanks.

The Role of Powers in Creature Design

The relationship between armor values and base damage shifts dramatically across tiers, and this has major implications for how creatures should be designed.

Low Tiers (T1–T2): Restraint

At Tiers 1 and 2, base weapon damage comfortably exceeds typical armor values. A T1 creature dealing 8 damage against a target with 5 armor still lands 3 points per hit — meaningful against a 20 HP character. Basic attacks are effective, and most creatures at these tiers can function with simple attack options.

Powers must be used with caution. A 200% damage power at T1 deals 14–20 damage, which can drop a player character in a single hit. Creatures at these tiers should use high-damage powers sparingly, or telegraph them so players have a chance to react. Reserve 200% powers for tough or elite enemies, and avoid 300% entirely — it is almost always an instant kill.

Mid Tiers (T3–T4): Transition

At Tiers 3 and 4, armor begins to absorb a significant fraction of incoming damage. A T3 creature dealing 16 damage against 10 armor lands only 6 points — survivable, but slow to kill a 50 HP character through basic attacks alone. Creatures at these tiers need at least one or two 200% powers to threaten well-armored characters, and should begin to have access to effects that degrade defenses (Shred, Disrupt) or bypass them (penetration, damage types that target the weaker of armor or ward).

High Tiers (T5–T6): Necessity

At Tiers 5 and 6, armor and ward values approach or exceed base damage. A T5 creature dealing 25 damage against a target with 17 armor lands only 8 points per hit — a character with 100+ HP can shrug off basic attacks almost indefinitely. Without 200–300% powers, creatures at these tiers simply cannot threaten well-equipped player characters.

High-tier creatures *must* have a toolkit that includes some combination of:

- **High-percentage powers:** 200–300% damage to punch through defenses.
- **Defense degradation:** Shred and Disrupt effects to erode armor and ward over the course of a fight.
- **Armor bypass:** Penetration, effects that ignore armor entirely, or damage types that target the weaker defensive stat.
- **Multi-hit attacks:** Multiple smaller hits apply armor separately per hit, but can overwhelm through volume — and each hit can carry riders (conditions, ongoing damage).
- **Qualitative effects:** Conditions like Exposed, Vulnerable, or Staggered that strip defensive layers and set up devastating follow-up attacks.

This mirrors the design of player-facing powers at these tiers: the tier guidelines note that T5–T6 power comes from qualitative shifts, not raw damage multipliers.

Creature Roles

When designing encounters with multiple creatures, it helps to assign each creature a combat role. The stat guidelines above represent a balanced baseline; roles shift the emphasis:

- **Brute:** High damage and HP, low Evasion and Ward. Relies on raw physical power to overwhelm opponents. Armor near baseline, few or no magical abilities. Simple but dangerous.
- **Knight:** High HP, Armor and Ward, lower damage. A defensive frontliner that holds ground and protects other creatures. May have abilities that punish enemies for ignoring it (opportunity attacks, auras, taunt effects).
- **Skirmisher:** High Evasion and Movement Speed, lower HP. Hits and runs, uses positioning to avoid retaliation. May have abilities that trigger on movement.
- **Artillery:** High damage at range, low HP and Evasion. Dangerous if left alone, fragile if engaged in melee. Needs other creatures to screen for it.
- **Controller:** Moderate stats across the board, but access to area powers and conditions. Shapes the battlefield rather than dealing raw damage.
- **Caster:** High FP and casting characteristics, lower physical stats. Uses spells or powers as primary offense. Ward above baseline, Armor below.
- **Elite:** A creature designed to face multiple PCs. Higher HP (1.5–2x baseline), access to more powers, and possibly extra AP or reactions.
- **Minion:** A creature designed to be fielded in numbers greater than the party. Minimal HP (half baseline or less), one basic attack, no powers. Compensates with action economy.

Boss Creatures

A true boss is a creature designed to face an entire party alone or with only a handful of minions at its side. Bosses are fundamentally different from standard creatures: they must combine multiple roles — dealing damage, absorbing punishment, and disrupting the party's plans — all in a single stat block. A boss that can only do one of these things will be quickly neutralized by a coordinated party.

Stat Adjustments

A boss should have significantly above-baseline statistics. As a starting point:

- **HP:** 2–3x the baseline for its tier. A boss that dies too quickly is anticlimactic; err on the side of durability.
- **Defenses:** Armor, Ward and Evasion should all be at or above baseline. Bosses cannot afford a glaring defensive weakness that the party can exploit to trivialize the encounter.
- **Resistance Characteristics:** Above baseline across the board. A boss that can be reliably stunned or dominated in the first round is not a boss for long.
- **Attacks and Powers:** A boss needs a diverse toolkit. It should have at least one high-damage single-target attack, one area or multi-target power, and one disruptive ability (a condition, a forced movement effect, or something that changes the battlefield). At high tiers, defense-degrading effects (Shred, Disrupt) are essential to prevent the fight from stalling.

Action Economy

The most critical challenge in boss design is the action economy. A single creature with 4 AP facing a party of four characters with 4 AP each is outnum-

bered four-to-one in available actions. Without compensation, the boss will be locked down by conditions and destroyed before it can act meaningfully.

At low tiers (T1–T2), simply increasing the boss's AP to **5–6** can be sufficient. The party's powers are limited in scope, and the extra actions let the boss attack, move, and use an ability each turn without feeling overwhelming.

At higher tiers, raw AP increases are not enough — the party has access to powerful conditions and combination attacks that demand the boss be able to act outside its own turn. Two mechanisms address this:

Legendary Action

Once per round, after another creature's turn ends, this creature may take a single action costing up to 2 AP.

This gives the boss one extra action per round at a time of the GM's choosing. It is appropriate for mid-tier bosses (T3–T4) and for high-tier bosses that are accompanied by a few supporting creatures.

Greater Legendary Action

Whenever another creature completes its turn, this creature may take a single action costing up to 2 AP.

This gives the boss an action after *every* other creature's turn — potentially 4 or more extra actions per round against a full party. This is appropriate for the most powerful high-tier bosses (T5–T6) that are meant to face a full party alone. Greater Legendary Actions make a creature extremely dangerous and should be paired with careful HP tuning to avoid fights that drag on too long.

Design Considerations

- **Condition immunity:** Bosses should be immune to at least Dominated, and may be immune to Stunned as well. Being fully locked out of actions for even one round can be catastrophic for a solo creature. Consider granting resistance (automatic saves at the start of the boss's turn) to other disabling conditions rather than full immunity, so that the party's control abilities still feel impactful.
- **Phased encounters:** A boss with 3x baseline HP can feel like a slog. Consider breaking the fight into phases — at certain HP thresholds, the boss changes behavior, gains new powers, or the environment shifts. This keeps the encounter dynamic and gives the party a sense of progress.
- **Minion support:** Even a boss designed for solo play benefits from 2–3 minions. Minions occupy the party's attention, provide targets for area powers (making the players choose between hitting the boss and clearing adds), and help the boss's action economy without requiring Greater Legendary Actions.

Progression and Rewards

Character power in Ashen advances along three axes: experience (which buys advances, skill points and Essence Points), wealth (which buys equipment), and item access (which determines what equipment is available to buy at all). These three must advance roughly in step. A party that is rich in XP but poor in feathers has high HP and many powers but hits like a T0 recruit; a party swimming in feathers but low on XP dies easily despite carrying excellent gear. The guidelines below help the GM keep these axes in balance without reducing progression to a formula.

Table 3 shows the approximate cumulative XP at which a character is considered to be at each tier. These are not hard gates — tier is emergent from the advances a character has purchased — but they are a useful reference for the GM when planning mission difficulty, loot, and pacing. A character whose cumulative XP falls within a tier's band should have access to tier-appropriate advances and should be facing tier-appropriate challenges.

Category	Start	T1	T2	T3	T4	T5	T6
Cumulative XP	1000	1000–2500	2500–5000	5000–10000	10000–18000	18000–30000	30000–48000
SP earned	1	1–2	2–5	5–10	10–18	18–30	30–48
EP total	11	11–12	12–15	15–20	20–28	28–40	40–58

Table 3: Tier Thresholds

Experience Points

XP is awarded for concrete actions: defeating enemies, completing missions, and recovering valuables. The GM tallies XP at the end of each session.

Combat XP

Each creature defeated awards XP to every character who participated in the encounter. Use Table 4 for baseline values, then apply the role modifier for the creature's combat role.

Tier	T0	T1	T2	T3	T4	T5	T6
Base XP	5	15	25	40	65	100	175

Table 4: Base Creature XP

- **Minion:** ×0.5 (rounded down).
- **Standard:** ×1.
- **Elite:** ×2.
- **Boss:** ×4.

If a creature's tier differs from the party's, adjust its value: one tier above the party pays ×1.5, two or more tiers above pays ×2. One tier below pays ×0.75; two or more tiers below pays ×0.5. These multipliers stack with role multipliers.

Mission XP

Completing a mission objective — returning with the target, escorting the convoy, killing or capturing the mark — awards a flat XP bonus to each character. Use the mission's tier, not the party's.

MISSION XP

Mission Tier	T1	T2	T3	T4	T5	T6
Completion XP	100	150	250	400	600	1000

A mission may have secondary objectives worth a fraction of the completion bonus — typically half. Failing the primary objective but completing secondary objectives still awards secondary XP.

Loot XP

Characters earn **1 XP for every 10ƒ of value** obtained during the session, whether from recovered loot, salvaged materials, or payment received. This is assessed on market value, not personal utility: a caster who recovers a T3 greatsword earns XP for its value even if they will never swing it.

Loot XP serves two purposes. It rewards exploration and thoroughness, and it creates a natural link between wealth and progression — a party that invests time in looting earns both spending money and advancement.

Pacing

The numbers above are calibrated so that a typical session — two significant combats, some loot, and progress toward or completion of a mission — yields roughly the following total XP per character:

EXPECTED SESSION XP

Party Tier	T1	T2	T3	T4	T5	T6
XP / session	150–250	250–400	400–650	650–1000	1000–1500	1500–2200

At this rate, a tier lasts roughly eight to twelve sessions. Characters cross SP and EP thresholds (every 1000 cumulative XP) naturally along the way, gaining skill points and Essence Points at a pace that tracks their growing power.

If the campaign feels too slow or too fast, adjust the mission XP bonus — it is the simplest dial to turn without disrupting the combat-to-reward relationship.

Awarding Wealth

Wealth enters the game through two channels: **mission pay** (reliable income from patrons and factions) and **loot** (variable income from salvage, treasure, and windfalls).

Mission Pay

Most Deathless work for a faction, a patron, or an employer. Mission pay is the primary source of income and should be announced before the party accepts the job, so that players can weigh the reward against the risk.

MISSION PAY PER CHARACTER

Mission Tier	T1	T2	T3	T4	T5	T6
Pay (ƒ)	100–300	300–600	600–1500	1500–3000	3000–6000	Favors

At Tier 6, feathers lose their meaning. The people who can commission T6 work pay in political influence, territorial concessions, legendary materials, or debts of service. If a T6 patron offers coin, it is either a king's ransom or an insult.

Patrons may also offer non-monetary compensation — access to restricted facilities, introductions to artisans, or a claim on future salvage rights — which may be worth more than the listed pay range.

Loot and Salvage

Loot supplements mission pay and provides the "treasure hunt" motivation that keeps exploration rewarding. As a guideline, loot found in the field should be worth roughly **half** to **equal** the mission pay for that tier. This means a party that explores thoroughly earns noticeably more than one that beelines for the objective, without making mission pay feel irrelevant.

Not all loot is coin. Equipment found in ruins may be damaged, requiring repair costs (typically 20–30% of market value). Exotic materials may need a buyer. Salvaged magitek may have value only to a specific faction. These frictions are good — they create side objectives, NPC relationships, and reasons to visit settlements.

Wealth Benchmarks

Table 5 shows the approximate cumulative wealth a character should have earned (from all sources, including their starting ƒ 500) by the time they are solidly established at each tier. These values assume the party can afford a full tier-appropriate kit — one weapon, one set of armor, and one catalyst or reliquary if relevant.

Tier	T1	T2	T3	T4	T5	T6
Full Kit Cost	500–1500	1500–4000	4500–10000	13000–22000	24000–37000	Quest
Cumulative Earned	500–1000	2500–4500	7000–14000	22000–36000	46000–73000	—

Table 5: Cumulative Wealth Benchmarks

The gap between cumulative earned and full kit cost represents savings, consumable spending, repairs, ritual components, and the general cost of living. Characters who spend frugally will have a comfortable buffer; characters who burn through consumables and ritual components will feel the pinch — both are valid play experiences.

If the party's wealth is significantly ahead of or behind these benchmarks, the easiest correction is to adjust mission pay for the next few sessions. Windfall loot (a vault, a bounty, a patron's bonus) can also close a gap quickly without disrupting the session-to-session economy.

Item Availability

Having feathers is not the same as having access. The commercial availability of equipment depends on its tier and on where the characters are.

Tiers 0–2: Common Goods

Old War salvage (T0) is everywhere. Tier 1 and 2 equipment is manufactured or restored by local smiths, armorers, and artificers and can be found in any settlement with a functioning market. Availability is not a concern — if the characters have the feathers, they can buy it.

Tier 3: Specialist Work

Tier 3 equipment represents the upper end of what skilled artisans can produce. It is available in major settlements and trading hubs, but a frontier outpost or a small Clear may not stock it. Characters may need to commission a piece and wait days or weeks for delivery, or travel to a larger settlement. This is a soft gate, not a hard one: the equipment exists on the open market, it just is not always on the shelf.

Tier 4: Master Craftsmanship

Tier 4 is the ceiling of commercially available equipment. Only the great trading hubs — Aurum, Ironhaven, the floating markets of the Western Islands

— reliably stock T4 gear, and even there the selection is limited. Most T4 purchases are commissions: the character specifies what they want, pays in advance, and waits. Lead times of one to four weeks are normal.

Masterwork items (generic items enhanced beyond their base tier) follow the same pattern. A master artisan can produce them, but they are expensive, slow to make, and the artisan may have conditions — rare materials, a favor, or simply a long queue.

Tier 5 and Above: Beyond Commerce

Tier 5 equipment is not commercially available in any meaningful sense. The materials are too rare, the techniques too specialized, and the makers too few. Characters who want T5 gear must find it — in ancient ruins, in the hoards of powerful creatures, or in the vaults of factions willing to part with it for a price measured in service rather than feathers.

This is by design. The transition from T4 to T5 is the point where character progression shifts from economic to narrative. The party cannot simply grind missions, accumulate feathers, and buy their way to the top. They must engage with the world: seek out legendary artisans, delve into dangerous places, negotiate with powerful factions, or earn the right to wield what they find. The feather values listed in the equipment tables for T5 items represent replacement cost or insurance value, not a price anyone will actually charge.

Tier 6 equipment is unique by definition and is covered under *Awarding Legendary Rewards* below.

Awarding Legendary Rewards

Legendary items, powers, and advances (see *Legendary* in the Basic Rules chapter) are among the most significant rewards a GM can offer. Because they are quest-bound and extraordinary by definition, they require more thought than standard loot or level-up choices.

When to Award Legendary Rewards

Legendary rewards should mark turning points in the campaign — moments that change who a character is or what they can do. Good occasions include:

- **Completing a major story arc:** Defeating a campaign-defining threat, fulfilling a prophecy, or resolving a mystery that has driven the plot for multiple sessions.
- **Character milestones:** A character confronting their past, unlocking a latent ability tied to their origin, or earning the trust of a powerful patron.
- **Discovering something ancient:** Entering a ruin no one has breached in centuries, recovering a weapon from a fallen hero, or making contact with a forgotten power.

The pacing of legendary rewards should follow the arc of the campaign:

- **Tiers 1–2:** Legendary rewards should not feature at all. Characters at these tiers are still finding their footing, and the extraordinary nature of legendary rewards has no baseline to contrast against. Let the players discover what "normal" looks like before breaking the rules.
- **Tiers 3–4:** Legendary rewards should be very rare — at most one per character across both tiers, and many characters may receive none. At these tiers, legendary weapons and armor do not yet exist; the most powerful generic equipment reaches tier 4 without requiring masterwork or legendary status. Any legendary rewards at these tiers should be limited to advances, powers, or artifacts that do not directly affect a character's combat statistics — a prophetic vision, a pact with a powerful entity, or a strange relic whose purpose is not yet clear.
- **Tiers 5–6:** Legendary rewards become more frequent as the campaign reaches its climax. This is where legendary weapons and armor enter play (legendary items exist only at tiers 5 and 6), and where legendary powers and advances can represent the culmination of a character's arc. A character might receive two or even three legendary rewards across these tiers.

Legendary Items

A legendary item should feel like it has a history. Give it a name, a backstory, and at least one trait that makes it behave differently from anything the players could buy or craft. The item's legendary trait (which does not count against its enchantment slots) is the hook: it should do something no ordinary enchantment can replicate.

When placing a legendary item in the world, consider:

- **Foreshadowing:** Mention the item before the players find it — in lore, in an NPC's story, or as a rumour. The discovery is more satisfying when the players recognise what they've found.
- **Cost of acquisition:** The quest to obtain it is part of the reward. A legendary weapon found in a chest with no effort feels less legendary than one pried from the hands of a dying guardian.
- **Enchantment slots:** A legendary item found early in its story may have empty enchantment slots. Letting a player fill those slots over time — finding the right enchantments, seeking out the right artisans — extends the reward across multiple sessions.

Legendary Powers and Advances

Unlike items, legendary powers and advances are intrinsic to a character. They represent something the character *becomes*, not something they *have*. This makes them deeply personal rewards, and they work best when tied to a character's arc.

Some principles:

- **Tie it to the character's story:** A legendary power is most compelling when it grows out of something the character has struggled with or worked toward. A psychic who has been haunted by visions of a past life might unlock a legendary Time power when they finally confront that memory.
- **Rarity, not uniqueness:** Legendary powers and advances need not be strictly one-of-a-kind. A small group of beings might share a legendary trait — the six constructs built by a goddess, the last three knights of a fallen order. What matters is that it cannot be learned from a book or purchased with experience points.
- **Mechanical restraint:** A legendary power should be strong, but its strength should come from doing something *different* rather than simply doing more damage. A power that ignores a fundamental rule (bypasses resistance, acts outside the normal turn order, affects a type of target that is normally immune) is more interesting than one that deals 400% damage.

Tier	Light LV	Light MV	Light HV	Medium LV	Medium MV	Medium HV	Heavy LV	Heavy MV	Heavy HV
0	4+D3	3+D4	2+D6	5+D3	4+D4	3+D6	6+D3	4+D6	3+D8
1	6+D3	4+D6	3+D8	8+D3	6+D6	5+D8	11+D3	8+D8	6+D12
2	7+D4	6+D6	4+D10	11+D4	9+D8	7+D12	15+D4	12+D10	9+2D8
3	11+D4	9+D8	7+D12	15+D6	12+D10	9+2D8	20+D6	16+D12	12+2D10
4	14+D6	12+D10	8+2D8	19+D8	16+D12	12+2D10	25+D8	20+2D8	15+2D12
5	17+D8	14+D12	11+2D10	23+D10	20+2D8	15+2D12	30+D10	24+2D10	18+3D10
6	21+D10	18+2D8	14+2D12	27+2D8	24+2D10	18+3D10	35+2D6	29+2D12	22+4D10

Table 6: Weapon Damage by Tier

Designing Equipment

This section provides guidelines for designing new weapons, armor, catalysts, and other gear, as well as for balancing existing equipment across tiers.

Weapon Damage by Tier

Table 6 gives canonical damage values by tier, weight class, and variance. Variance describes the shape of the damage distribution: **LV** (low variance) has a high floor and a low ceiling, suited to reliable and precise weapons; **MV** (medium variance) is the standard for most weapons; **HV** (high variance) has a low floor and a high ceiling, suited to brutal or unpredictable weapons.

This leads to the following average damage by tier (MV):

DAMAGE AVERAGES

Tier	Light	Medium	Heavy
0	5.5	6.5	7.5
1	7.5	9.5	12.5
2	9.5	13.5	17.5
3	13.5	18.0	23.0
4	17.5	22.8	28.8
5	21.2	28.5	35.0
6	26.8	35.2	41.5

The die progression used across the table is D3, D4, D6, D8, D10, D12, 2D8, 2D10, 3D8, 3D10, 3D12, 4D10, 4D12, with average values of 1.5, 2.5, 3.5, 4.5, 5.5, 6.5, 9, 11, 13.5, 16.5, 19.5, 22, 26 respectively.

Ranged Weapons

Ranged weapons follow the same damage table as melee for their weight class, with a few adjustments:

- **Single-shot weapons** deal damage at tier+1 (e.g., a T2 single-shot rifle uses T3 damage values). This compensates for the inability to make multiple attacks per round.
- Weapons with very long range may have slightly lower damage.
- Weapons with area effects (cone, blast) may have lower per-target damage.
- **Anti-vehicle weapons** (e.g., rocket launchers) are a separate category — they can only target size 3+ creatures and have extreme damage values outside the normal scaling.

Special Weapon Patterns

- **Split damage weapons** (e.g., Hoarfrost): the listed damage is dealt twice — once reduced by Armor, once by Ward. The effective total is 2× the listed damage, but both defenses apply. These weapons appear weaker on paper but perform strongly against balanced targets.
- **High-penetration weapons**: may have lower base damage as a tradeoff. Penetration bypasses Armor directly, so low damage + high Pen can outperform high damage + no Pen against armored targets.
- **Silvered or special-material weapons**: may trade damage for keywords or penetration that bypass specific resistances.

Armor Scaling by Tier

Table 7 gives the average values stats for armor by weight class and tier. Modifiers follow the armor's weight class: light armor grants +1 to +2 Evasion, medium armor grants 0 to +1, and heavy armor imposes –1 to –4. Higher-tier armor within a weight class may improve evasion slightly compared to lower-tier examples.

Charge (Magical Encumbrance)

Charge is the magical equivalent of Bulk. A character has both a Bulk capacity (derived from Strength and Endurance) and a Charge capacity (derived from Attunement). When designing items, assign Charge according to their magical intensity:

- **Non-magical items** (mundane weapons, basic armor): Charge 0.
- **Lightly magical items** (enchanted weapons, warded armor): Charge roughly half Bulk.
- **Heavily magical items** (catalysts, reliquaries, magical robes): Charge equal to or greater than Bulk. Such items may have Bulk 0 but high Charge.

The underlying design principle is that physical warriors invest in Bulk capacity, casters invest in Charge capacity, and hybrid builds need both. Equipment should reinforce that tradeoff rather than paper over it.

Price Scaling by Tier

Approximate price ranges in feathers (ƒ):

Tier	Light Armor	Light Ward	Light Bulk	Med Armor	Med Ward	Med Bulk	Heavy Armor	Heavy Ward	Heavy Bulk
0	2	2	1	3	2	2	6	4	3
1	3	3	1	5	4	2	8	6	4
2	5	4	1	8	5	3	11	8	4
3	8	5	2	10	7	3	15	10	5
4	12	9	2	19	12	3	25	20	5
5	11	8	2	15	10	4	24	16	6
6	14	11	2	19	13	4	30	20	7

Table 7: Armor Scaling

PRICE SCALING

Tier	Weapons	Armor	Catalysts	Consumables
0	0–50	0–50	–	10–50
1	100–500	100–500	200–600	50–250
2	500–1500	500–1500	600–1500	150–500
3	1500–3500	1500–3000	1500–3000	300–1000
4	5000–8000	5000–6500	3000–6000	500–2000
5	8000–15000	8000–12000	6000–10000	1000–5000
6	Unique	Unique	Unique	2000–10000

At T6, standard weapons, armor, and catalysts leave the commercial market entirely — such items are unique or priceless, obtained through quests or legendary rewards rather than purchased.

Weapon Keywords

The following keywords appear on weapons throughout the rulebook. When designing a new weapon, prefer an existing keyword over a bespoke rule unless the mechanical effect is genuinely new.

- **Heavy:** Must be braced before firing. Firing without bracing is hip-firing, which imposes a penalty.
- **Rapid Fire:** +2 automatic successes when the target is within half the weapon's range.
- **Assault:** Hip-fire penalty halved (–1 instead of –2 for single shots; –2 instead of –4 for auto).
- **Sidearm:** Draw or stow as a free action once per turn. Can be drawn even when a hand is occupied by a two-handed weapon.
- **Burning:** Target catches fire on hit, taking ongoing Thermal damage (save ends).
- **Explosive:** Deals damage in a blast radius.
- **Jet:** Propelled projectile.
- **Overload:** Carries a risk of overheating or malfunctioning.
- **Poisonous (N):** Target must pass a D(N) Stamina check or become Poisoned.
- **Parry +Nd:** Adds +N dice to parry checks made with the weapon.
- **Powered:** Requires a power source or charge.
- **Reliable:** Reduced malfunction chance.

Setting Secrets

This section contains information about the world of Ashen that is intended for the Game Master's eyes only. Players who read this section risk spoiling mysteries that are meant to be discovered through play.

The Last War: A Note on Design

The conclusion of the Last War is deliberately left blank. The broad strokes — the war itself, the death of the gods, the release of the Fog, the creation of the Deathless — are fixed. But what happened in the final moments, what act or event or betrayal brought the war to its catastrophic close, is not defined. This is intentional.

The gap exists so that each Game Master can establish their own truth. The players' Deathless characters remember nothing of the war's end, and the historical record is genuinely absent. This means that the answer to "what happened?" can be different in every campaign, tailored to the themes and conflicts that the GM wants to explore.

Some example truths a GM might establish:

- **The Betrayal:** One of the gods — perhaps one still worshipped by a player's faction — deliberately sacrificed the others to end the war on their own terms. The Fog and the Deathless curse are side effects of a divine murder.
- **The Seal:** The war was fought to contain something — an entity, a force, a truth — and the conclusion was not a victory but a sealing. The world is a prison, but not for the Deathless: for whatever is locked beneath it.
- **The Accident:** There was no grand plan. The combined power unleashed in the war's final battle simply exceeded what creation could bear, and the world broke. The gap in the record exists because there was no coherent "end" — just a collapse.

The GM should decide which truth (or which variation) their campaign uses early, and plant clues accordingly. The factions' conflicting beliefs about the Last War provide natural vectors for revealing information gradually.

The Heart of the World

Deep beneath Dragon's Head, the largest of the Western Islands, lies the wounded Heart of the World. It is held in what were once the great jaws of the World Serpent — the same being whose bones form the island chain itself.

The Heart is the source of the Fog, or more precisely, it is the wound through which creation bleeds. The Last War damaged it, and the Fog is the result: raw

creative power leaking from a break in the fundamental structure of reality. The Heart still beats, after a fashion, and the energy it releases sustains both the Fog and the ambient magical power that magitek devices draw upon.

What happens if the players reach the Heart is up to the GM. Some possibilities:

- It can be healed, ending the Fog but also ending the ambient magical energy that powers civilization. The world becomes mundane — and the Deathless curse may or may not lift with it.
- It can be destroyed, which would finish what the Last War started. She Who Waits Beyond would approve.
- It can be studied, revealing the truth about the Last War and the nature of the Deathless curse — but not necessarily providing a solution.
- It is guarded, by something ancient and powerful, and reaching it is only the beginning of the challenge.

Vay Ngien and Old Ko Vihya

The order of wizards that once occupied Old Ko Vihya was destroyed by a rare coalition of factions, and their records were deliberately suppressed. The GM should decide what Vay Ngien and his followers were actually doing, but some possibilities include:

- They discovered how to permanently kill a Deathless and were using this knowledge for purposes that horrified the other factions.
- They were attempting to reopen the wounds in creation — to widen the cracks that produce the Fog — in pursuit of unlimited magical power.
- They found a way to restore the memories of the Deathless and learned something so terrible that the other factions agreed it was better forgotten.

Vay Ngien's tower still stands and could serve as a dungeon, a source of forbidden knowledge, or a warning about what happens when curiosity goes too far.

Ending The Game

The setting presented in this book, if you choose to use it, encourages a natural endgame: a faction — ideally the player characters — reaches the Heart of the World and performs one of two rituals that resolve the state of creation itself. Neither ritual is a secret; the factions know, in broad strokes, what is possible. What they lack is the means. Both rituals require materials of extraordinary rarity, a journey to the most dangerous place in the world, and a sacrifice that cannot be taken back.

The two rituals represent the setting's fundamental question: is this broken world worth saving, or is it kinder to let it end? Neither answer is presented as correct. A campaign may treat one as the obvious goal and the other as the villain's plan, or it may leave the choice genuinely open until the final session.

RITE OF UNMAKING — RITUAL 6

ASH SKULL

She Who Waits Beyond has been patient. She will be patient a little longer, if she must.

Skill: Occultism, *Difficulty*: 15, *Magnitude*: 35, *Casting Time*: 7 days
Sacrifice: 1 vial of Materia Nigra (consumed) + the permanent death of a willing Deathless participant (the sacrifice's soul is annihilated; they do not reincorporate)

Effect The caster completes the work that the Last War began: the Heart of the World stops beating, and creation unravels. The Fog dissipates — not because it is healed, but because the wound it bled from no longer exists. Over the hours and days that follow, the world comes apart. Magic fails. The land fractures and dissolves. The sky goes dark. What remains, if anything, is beyond mortal knowledge.

The Deathless curse ends with the world. Every Deathless is granted a final, true death. Whether this is mercy or annihilation depends on one's theology.

This ritual cannot be reversed once completed.

Failure The Heart shudders but does not stop. The caster and all participants within Burst 10 suffer 300% Void damage (ignores Armor and Ward). The Materia Nigra is consumed. The sacrifice is still annihilated. The ritual may be attempted again with new materials and a new sacrifice.

RITE OF THE SECOND BIRTH — RITUAL 6

SCARAB SUN

The world was made once. It can be made again.

Skill: Occultism, *Difficulty*: 15, *Magnitude*: 35, *Casting Time*: 7 days
Sacrifice: 1 vial of Materia Rubrior (consumed) + reliquary fragments of a single dead god, totalling at least 20 tiers' worth of divine essence (consumed)

Effect The caster heals the Heart of the World and, in doing so, channels the accumulated divine essence of the sacrificed reliquary fragments into it. The dead god whose fragments were offered is reborn — not as they were, but shaped by the state of the world and the intent of the caster. The reborn god assumes dominion over the healed world.

The Fog ceases. The ambient magical energy that sustained magitek is replaced by the reborn god's power — different in character, but no less potent. The Deathless curse is lifted: the cycle of death and rebirth resumes, and the Deathless become mortal once more. Whether they retain their memories of the Age of Ash is at the GM's discretion.

The identity of the reborn god shapes the new world profoundly. A world under the Boar-Mother is not a world under the Falcon-Headed Sun. The GM should consider what the god valued in life and how their character has been altered by death, fragmentation, and rebirth.

This ritual cannot be reversed once completed.

Failure The Heart flares with unstable divine energy. The reliquary fragments are consumed, but the god is not reborn --- instead, a fragmentary divine echo manifests, hostile and incoherent, with the statistics of a T6 Boss creature. The Materia Rubrior is consumed. The ritual may be attempted again with new materials and fragments of the same or a different god.

Designing Rituals and Recipes

This section provides guidelines for designing new rituals and alchemical recipes. Rituals and recipes occupy a different design space from combat

Tier	Diff.	Magn.	Cost (ƒ)	Casting Time	Scope	Identity
1	3–4	2–3	50–200	5–10 min	Single target	Local effect
2	5–6	4–5	200–500	10–30 min	Small area	Moderate duration
3	7–8	6–7	500–1500	30 min–1 hr	Large area	Lasting effect
4	9–10	8–9	1500–4000	1–4 hours	Transformation	Permanent minor effects
5	11–12	10–12	4000–10000	4–12 hours	Reality-altering	Permanent major effects
6	13+	13+	Priceless	1+ days	Legendary	Campaign-defining

Table 8: Ritual Tier Scaling

powers: they are slow, expensive, and often transformative, and their balance is driven by cost and narrative stakes rather than by the action economy.

Tier Scaling

Each point of power available to the ritual beyond its magnitude reduces the difficulty by 1, to a floor equal to the ritual's tier. This lets well-prepared casters perform rituals above their comfortable skill level, at the cost of accumulating reagents, influence, or assistants.

Sacrifice Types

A ritual's sacrifice is the resource it consumes. The appropriate type depends on tier and on the nature of the effect.

- **Components** (T1–T4): money and materials. A standard cost with no lasting impact beyond the price. Components are consumed whether or not the ritual succeeds.
- **Essence** (T3–T5): the caster takes strain or a long-lasting debuff. Used for rituals that channel dangerous forces. The debuff persists for days or weeks, representing a physical or spiritual cost paid by the caster personally.
- **Influence** (T4–T6): requires a concentration of specific aspects, either in the environment or in sacrificed objects. A ritual requiring Mist influence of magnitude 5, for example, must be cast in a strongly magical environment (a leyline, an ancient temple) or the caster must sacrifice a magical object that provides that level of aspect resonance. Influence is consumed: the environmental attunement fades, or the object is destroyed.

Aspect Requirements

Not every ritual demands aspect resonance, and lower-tier rituals should avoid it entirely so that they remain accessible to anyone with the skill and materials.

- **T1–T3:** no aspect requirements.
- **T4:** may require one aspect as Influence. Without the required aspect, difficulty increases by +2.
- **T5–T6:** require one or two specific aspects as Influence, provided by environment or sacrificed objects.

The aspects are Ash (destruction, desolation), Crown (law, domination), Forge (crafting, heat, origin), Key (opening, summoning), Mist (magic, the sublime essence), Scarab (rebirth, cycles), Skull (death, the end of things), Moon (mind, matter), and Maiden (nature).

Skills

Three skills cover all rituals and recipes, and they are not interchangeable:

- **Ritual** governs arcane magic and the structured traditions of Psychic practice. It is systematic and reproducible; a failed check wastes materials but carries predictable consequences.
- **Occultism** governs divine magic and the esoteric Psychic domains (Fate, Void). It relies on communion with entities rather than formula, and failed checks may have unpredictable or dangerous consequences.
- **Alchemy** covers every recipe — potions, poisons, reagents, and explosives. Ritual and Occultism do not apply to alchemical work.

Design Checklist

When designing a new ritual or recipe, verify each of the following before placing it in play:

1. Difficulty and magnitude fall within the tier's band.
2. Sacrifice type is appropriate to the power level.
3. Casting time is proportional to the effect.
4. Effect description is clear and has measurable outcomes.
5. Failure consequence is defined (or the ritual uses the standard "components lost" failure).
6. Skill is specified (Ritual, Occultism, or Alchemy).
7. Aspects are required only at T4 or higher.
8. Difficulty modifiers are listed for rituals with variable scope.
9. The ritual fills a narrative or mechanical niche not already covered by a combat power.

Universal Reagents

Alchemical reagents are the raw material of most recipes. Readily obtainable universal reagents cap at magnitude 6, corresponding to T3. The **Philosopher's Reagent** recipe (T5, Alchemy) produces magnitude-8 reagents, and anything beyond that is unique or legendary and must be found or quested for. This cap is a hard balance lever: it prevents high-tier recipes from becoming routine, and gives the GM a natural hook for high-tier alchemy plots.

Ashen — Character Sheet

Identity

CHARACTER NAME

RACE / SUBTYPE

BACKGROUND

TIER

TOTAL XP

Vital Resources

HP

FP

EP

f

Current HP

Current FP

Attributes

STR

END

DEX

AGI

ATT

SGT

INT

PER

WIL

PRS

Characteristics

	RANK	BONUS	RATING
Martial STR+AGI			
Marksmanship DEX+PER			
Initiative SGT+INT			
Speed AGI+END			
Stamina STR+END			
Potential ATT+WIL			
Arcane ATT+INT			
Psychic SGT+WIL			
Command PRS+WIL			
Dodge AGI+PER			
Grit END+WIL			

Status Conditions

- ☐ Blinded
- ☐ Dazed
- ☐ Disoriented
- ☐ Exposed
- ☐ Panicked
- ☐ Staggered
- ☐ Stunned
- ☐ Vulnerable
- ☐ Prone
- ☐ Immobilized
- ☐ Restrained
- ☐ Frozen
- ☐ Weakened
- ☐ Dominated
- ☐ Exhausted
- ☐ Poisoned
- ☐ Diseased
- ☐ Bleeding
- ☐ Burning
- ☐ Frightened
- ☐ Still
- ☐ Disrupt ×
- ☐ Shred ×
- ☐ Slowed ×

Skills

Trained skills (☐) start at rank 0; untrained start at rank 1.

	RANK	BONUS	RATING
Acrobatics AGI+DEX			
Athletics STR+END			
Awareness SGT+PER			
Deceive INT+PRS			
Eerie ATT+WIL			
Impose STR+PRS			
Influence PRS+INT			
Investigate INT+PER			
Subterfuge AGI+DEX			
Occultism ATT+INT			
☐ **Access** DEX+INT			
☐ **Alchemy** ATT+INT			
☐ **Electronics** DEX+INT			
☐ **Magitek** ATT+INT			
☐ **Piloting** AGI+PER			
☐ **Ritual** ATT+WIL			
☐ **Shop** STR+DEX			

Combat Values

Evasion

Armor

Ward

Move Speed

AP / Turn

Carry Cap

Bulk / Cap

Charge / Cap

RESISTANCES

Advances

NAME	TIER	XP	HP	FP

Ashen — Equipment & Powers

Weapons

NAME | TIER | PRICE

DMG | PEN | BULK | INC | RANGE | FM

TECHNOLOGY / TREATMENT / ENCHANTMENTS / KEYWORDS

NAME | TIER | PRICE

DMG | PEN | BULK | INC | RANGE | FM

TECHNOLOGY / TREATMENT / ENCHANTMENTS / KEYWORDS

NAME | TIER | PRICE

DMG | PEN | BULK | INC | RANGE | FM

TECHNOLOGY / TREATMENT / ENCHANTMENTS / KEYWORDS

Armor Layers

NAME / MATERIAL | TIER | PROFILE

ARMOR | WARD | EVA | BULK | CHG | RESIST

ENCHANTMENTS / SPECIAL

NAME / MATERIAL | TIER | PROFILE

ARMOR | WARD | EVA | BULK | CHG | RESIST

ENCHANTMENTS / SPECIAL

NAME / MATERIAL | TIER | PROFILE

ARMOR | WARD | EVA | BULK | CHG | RESIST

ENCHANTMENTS / SPECIAL

Catalysts & Reliquaries

NAME / TYPE (ARCANE / PSYCHIC) | TIER | CLASS

DMG | INC | CASTING | BULK | CHG | HANDS

ENCHANTMENTS / SPECIALIZED

RELIQUARY NAME | ASPECTS

TIER | DMG | INC | WILL | FAVOR

Arcane Spells (Memorized)

Name / Tier / AP / DC / Cost / Key Effect

Psychic Powers

Name / Tier / AP / DC / Cost / Augment

Martial & Marksmanship Exploits

Command Powers

Divine Prayers (from Reliquary)

Aspects: _____ *Prayers available by tier:*

Notes & Racial Traits

Carried Gear & Consumables

Bulk / Cap | Charge / Cap | Maint. (10%)